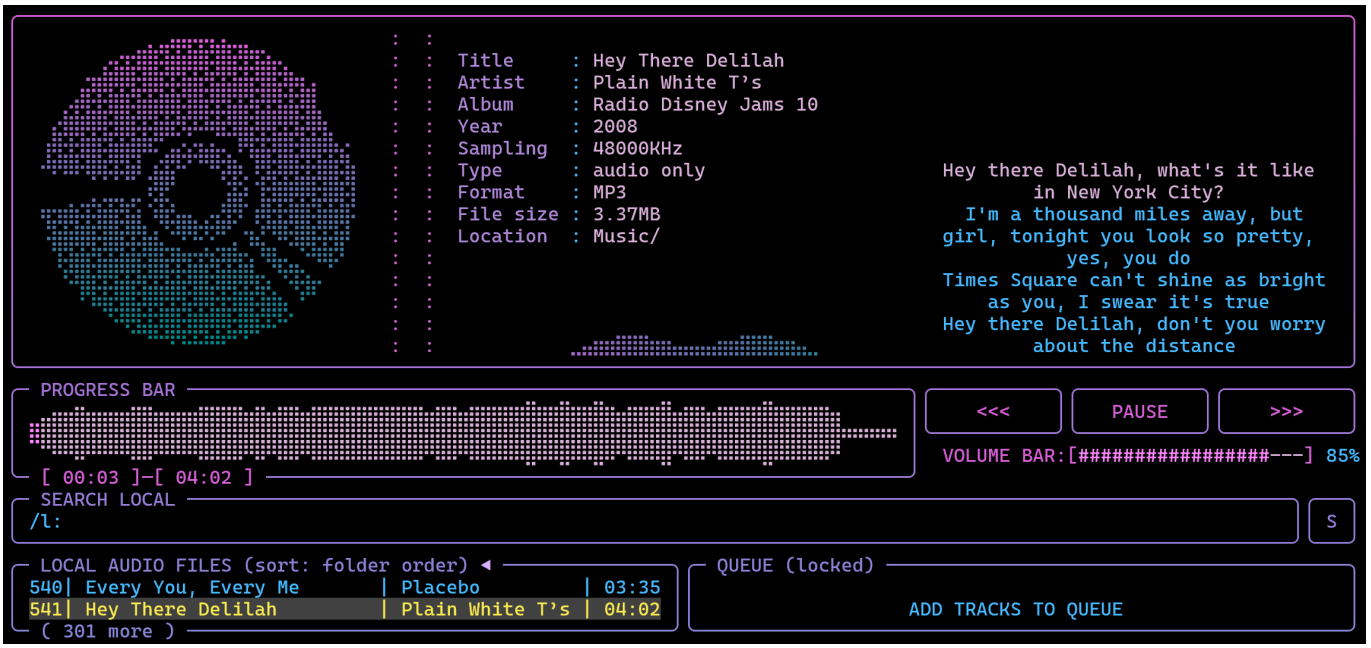
Mousiki User Guide v4.8.0 (Windows · Linux · macOS) – music player, radio and audio book player

Welcome: a quick tour

Mousiki Plus is a music player, an internet radio and an audio book player in one TUI app. It runs inside your terminal and can be controlled via your keyboard. It visualizes your music as colours, braille pictures and an oscilloscope, and you can steer it from your phone. This page gives you the short introfuctiory version of what it can do and how to use it; the chapters after it explain every key for every player mode and menu/overlay Mousiki Plus offers.

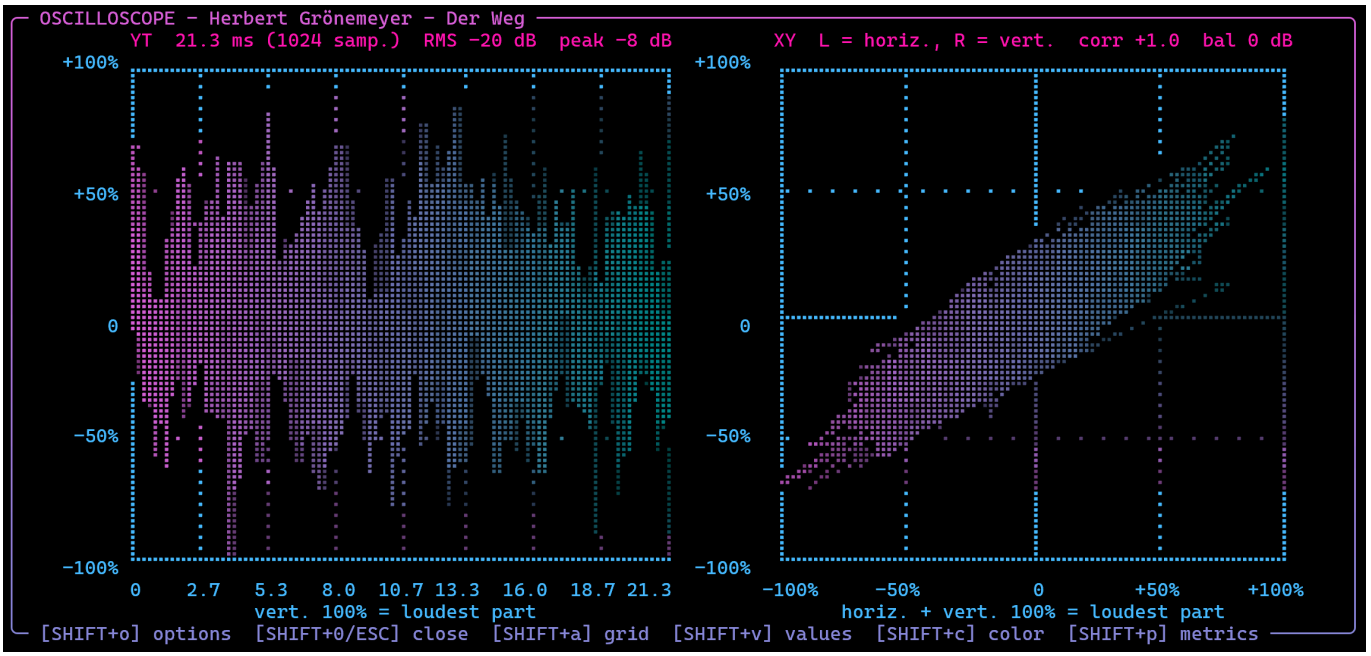
General notice: Mousiki Plus is a highly upgraded fork of the original v1.0.0 by itzender5820 that started as a Windows port. So far it has been tested well on Windows and WSL (Windows Linux VM), bith using the Windows terminal app. Feel free to contribute, e.g. via reporting issues using different OS and terminal apps on https://github.com/StSchwerdtfeger/mousiki-plus. See the original authors github repo here https://github.com/itzender5820/mousiki

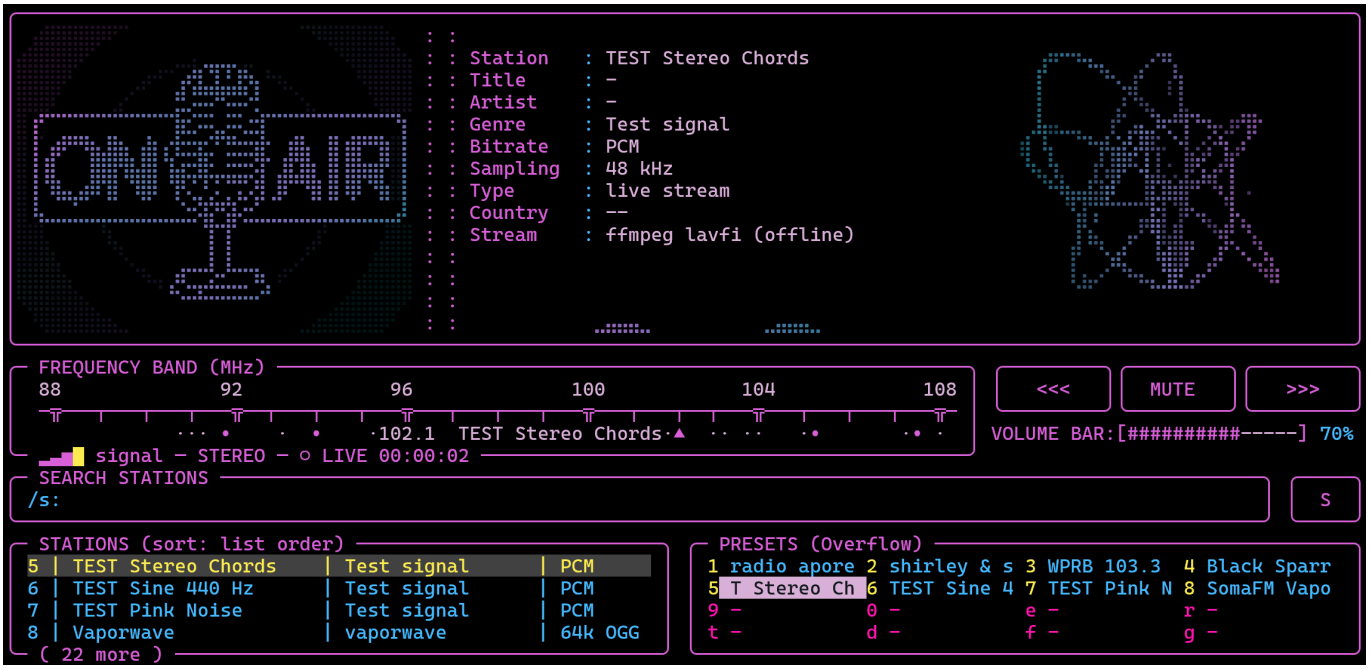


What you can do with it

- **Play your music:** add your music folders via the settings paths tab ([s] to open the settings, [TAB] to move to the paths tab) and Mousiki builds a library with fuzzy search over file names and tags (`/`). Plays MP3, FLAC, WAV, M4A, OGG, OPUS, tracker modules, console and C64 music and more.
- **Play the web:** search, stream and download from **YouTube, SoundCloud and Bandcamp**, or add a whole YouTube playlist in one go.
- **Listen to the radio:** press the mode key (`SHIFT` and `+` on a German keyboard, `'` on an English one) and the program becomes an online radio with a tuning dial, stations from Radio Browser, presets, timeshift (pause and rewind live radio) and recording.
- **Listen to audio books:** `SHIFT` and `+` again and the program is an audio book player: your books in one pane, their chapters in the other, an opening book in place of the disk, accelerating seek for long chapters and a tag editor made for books (see chapter 12).

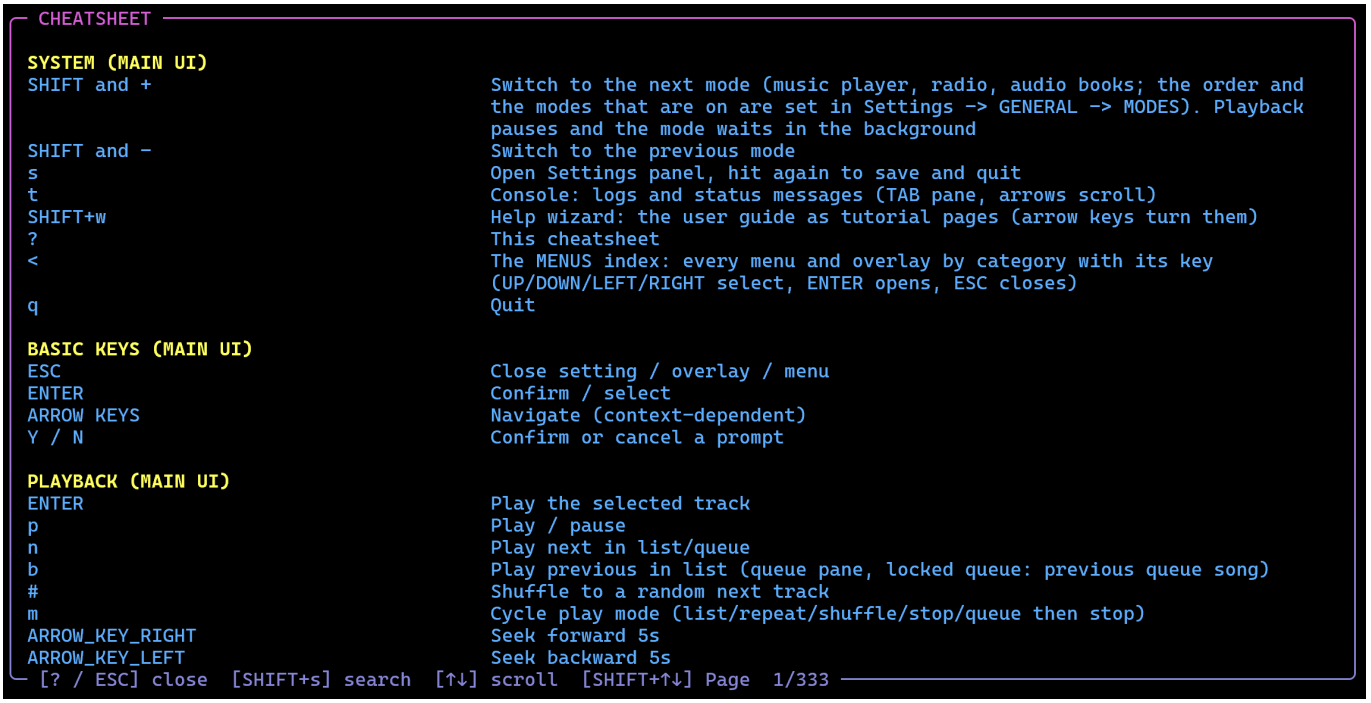
- **See your music:** an **oscilloscope** (also optimized for oscilloscope music) and a **spectrogram**, as braille pictures or as real images in Kitty / Sixel terminals, in the main screen, full screen or in their own window. A spectrum bar is also included by default, as well as a sphere animation that also interacts with the music played.
- **Sing along: synchronized lyrics** fetched for you, word by word, with translations and a big-letter **karaoke mode**.
- **Organize:** a **queue**, saved **playlists**, a **tag editor** that finds missing titles by audio fingerprint, a **listening history** with top lists and smart lists, a 10-band **equalizer**, loudness normalization and a sleep timer.
- **Make it fit your style:** 32 **colour themes** plus your own creations; most basic key commands can also be rebound. Default keybounds were set using a german keyboard so feel free to report how the default English or other keyboard bindings are working out.
- **Control it from afar:** use your **phone as a remote** (scan a QR code), or use the system's media keys and now-playing widget (Windows, Linux, macOS), or bind global keys with `mousiki --cmd`. `mousiki --selftest-fetch` checks that lyrics, covers and the update check still work.





Getting started

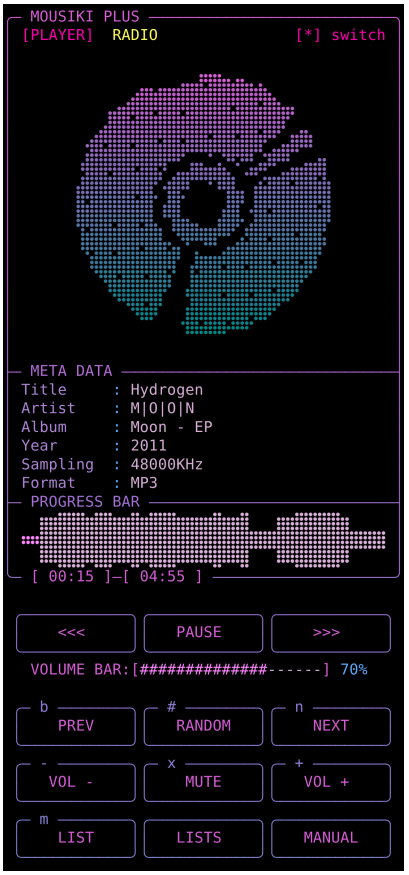
1. **Start it.** Open a terminal (on Windows use **Windows Terminal**) and type `mousiki` or `lala`. The help wizard opens by itself on the first start (`ENTER` goes on, `ESC` closes it); `SHIFT+w` opens it again any time.
2. **Add your music.** Press `s` (Settings), go to the paths tab and add your music folder. Press `s` again to save. Your titles appear in the list. Rescan library via `SHIFT+r` inside Mousiki after adding new titles to your music paths.
3. **Play something.** When the focus is on the search bar or local audio files pane (◀; can be changed via `TAB`) move with `↑` / `↓` to a song (use `SHIFT+ ↑ / ↓` for a whole page jump) and press `ENTER` to play the highlighted title, `p` to pause and resume, `n` / `b` for the next and previous title, `→` / `←` to jump/seek 5 seconds, `+` / `-` for the volume.
4. **Find things.** Press `/` and type a few letters of a title, artist or folder; typos are forgiven. Nite that Mousiki also includes transliteration (`SHUFT+w`) and transliterated search for Chinese/Korean/Japanes titles.
5. **Try the extras.** `k` starts the karaoke mode, `SHIFT+o/i` opens the oscilloscope/spectrogram settings, `,/.` changes the visualisations or opens the lyrics field, `SHIFT+p` the playlist editor, `SHIFT+h` your listening history, `SHIFT+e` the equalizer. Mousiki also includes a meta data editor that fetches meta data from the web, a cover fetch menu (fetching album covers from the web), a file converter (higher res to lower res) and more...
6. **Switch to the radio.** Press the next-mode key (`SHIFT` and `+` on a German keyboard, the `'` key on an English one). Press it again to come back; your music waits where you left it.
7. **Lost?** `<` (German keyboard; `SHIFT+,` on an English one) lists **every menu and overlay** by category with its key: pick one with the arrows and press `ENTER` to open it. `?` shows the cheat sheet with every key you have bound, `SHIFT+w` the wizard, `?` the cheat sheet and `q` quits. Both the help wizard and cheat sheet include a serach function as well, so you don't have to seek thorugh rows of commands yourself.



Use your phone as a remote

Switch on **Settings → GENERAL → REMOTE / UPDATES → Remote App, scan the QR code that appears and your phone shows a small Mousiki screen displaying the spinning disk/radio aniamtion/audio book cover or

default image, meta data, buttons for functions such as play, next, volume, your lists and playlists, the radio with its stations or books and their chapters. It needs a PIN and works in your home network only; the details are in chapter 13. There is also a .apk you can download from the Gitub repo, which is essentially just a small web browser app showing the same as you get in your smartphone browser.



How this guide is organised

Mousiki is three programs in one: a terminal music player (chapters 1 to 10), an online radio (chapter 11) and an audio book player (chapter 12). The player also has an oscilloscope, a spectrogram, a karaoke mode and many more features. Press `SHIFT` and `+` on a German keyboard (the `'` key on an English one) to switch to the next mode and `SHIFT` and `-` (the `;` key on an English one) to go back to the previous one (see Three modes in one program and Keyboard layouts).

Chapter 13 describes the phone remote and the command-line remote, chapter 14 the automated tests and chapter 15 how upgrades treat your settings.

The music player chapters walk through **every entry of the in-app cheat sheet** (`?`) and explain what each command does. Some settings that can only be changed in the config.txt are also discussed at the end of chapter 10. The radio chapter only describes what is new in the radio; everything both modes have in common (equalizer, oscilloscope, loudness normalization, sleep timer …) is explained once in the player chapters. The key shown for each command is the **default binding**. Your own bindings may differ if you changed them in `config.txt` or under **Settings** → **Reference**; the cheat sheet always shows the keys you actually have. Not every key is rebindable. Since the default keys were set using a German keyboard, I would love to here your opinion on "Discussions" in my Github repo in order to improve the use of the app in the future for Users outside Germany.

Contents

- **Welcome: a quick tour**
  - What you can do with it
  - Getting Started
  - Use your phone as a remote
  - How this guide is organised
- **Before you start**
  - Starting Mousiki: `mousiki` or `lala`
  - Rebindable vs. fixed keys
  - `ALT` on macOS (`Option`)
  - Uppercase letters
  - Keyboard layouts (German and English)
  - Menus with tabs and text boxes
  - Three player modes in one program
  - What can Mousiki play? Audio formats, tracker modules and chiptunes
  - The main screen
  - Playback mode letter
- **The Help Wizard (`SHIFT+w`)**
- **1. System (main UI)**
- **2. Playback (main UI)**
  - Sound quality: sample rate and resampling
  - Equalizer overlay (`SHIFT+e`)
  - The five play modes (`m`)
- **3. Navigation & view, lyrics and visualizations (main UI)**
  - How the sort mode and `SHIFT+n` work together
  - How the lyrics form (`l`) works
  - Lyrics timing overlay (`ALT+L`)
  - READ LYRICS overlay (`CTRL+L`)
  - The oscilloscope (lyric visual)
  - Oscilloscope tuning overlay (`SHIFT+o`)
  - Oscilloscope full screen (`SHIFT+0`)
  - Scope window (`)`: German `SHIFT+9`, English `SHIFT+0`)
  - Spectrogram window (`(`: German `SHIFT+8`, English `SHIFT+9`)
  - Spectrogram (`SHIFT+i`, `SHIFT+u`)
  - Loudness normalization overlay (`SHIFT+v`)
  - Karaoke overlay (`k`)
  - Sleep timer overlay (`SHIFT+z`)
  - Creator overlay (`^`)
- **4. Search (main UI)**
  - Big list overlay (`SHIFT+l`)
  - Big folder overlay (`SHIFT+f`)
  - File conversion overlay (`SHIFT+c`)
  - Latin letters for Japanese, Korean and Chinese text
  - Cover fetch overlay (`ALT+c`)
- **5. Queue (main UI)**
  - Big queue overlay (`SHIFT+k`)

    - Locked queue (`!`)
    - Undo clear (`CTRL+SHIFT+z`)
    - Queue to playlist (`CTRL+SHIFT+u`)
    - Clear queue prompt (`SHIFT+x`)
    - Bulk add (`SHIFT+g`)
- **6. Playlists**
    - Add a track straight to a playlist (`SHIFT+a`)
    - What `ENTER` does in the playlist editor
    - Exporting a playlist (M3U8 / M3U)
    - Leaving
- **7. Meta editor**
    - What `ENTER` does in the meta editor
    - The cover in the meta editor: Cover Options
    - The style of a track: Style Option
    - Using the AcoustID lookup
    - Choosing what is fetched: the fetch options
    - Album and year: MusicBrainz and the choice overlay
- **8. History**
    - The four tabs
    - ADD SMART HISTORY TO QUEUE
- **9. Downloads**
- **10. Settings (individual tabs)**
    - Moving around and editing (all tabs)
    - Tab 1: COLORS
        - Border gradient (SMOOTHNESS)
        - Colour themes
    - Tab 2: GENERAL
    - Tab 3: ANIMA/VIZ
    - Tab 4: PATHS
    - Tab 5: REFERENCE
    - Tab 6: ABOUT APP
    - Settings that exist (only) in `config.txt`
- **11. Radio mode**
    - 11.1 Switching between player and radio
    - 11.2 The radio screen
    - 11.3 Keys on the main screen
    - 11.4 What the radio shares with the player
    - 11.5 Searching: stations, station lists and `p:`
    - 11.6 PRESETS menu (`SHIFT+p`)
    - 11.7 RADIO BROWSER menu (`SHIFT+s`)
    - 11.8 STATION LISTS menu (`SHIFT+k`)
    - 11.9 Big STATIONS overlay (`SHIFT+l`)
    - 11.10 Timeshift and recording (`SPACE`, `[`, `]`, `{`, `}`, `y`)
    - 11.11 Listening history (`h`)
    - 11.12 Radio settings
    - 11.13 The radio's files

    - 11.14 Not done yet
- **12. Audio book mode**
    - 12.1 Switching, setting up and the screen
    - 12.2 Books, chapters and the keys
    - 12.3 The book tag editor (SHIFT+m)
    - 12.4 Bookmarks and book notes
    - 12.5 The list of time stamps, the library overlay and the reading history
    - 12.6 Chapter marks and cutting a file into chapters
    - 12.7 Settings in the audio book mode
- **13. Remote control and key bindings**
    - 13.1 The remote app (Android / phone browser)
    - 13.2 System media controls: media keys and now playing (Windows, Linux, macOS)
- **14. Automated tests**
- **15. Upgrades and your settings**
- **About this app**
    - Original developer of v1.0
    - Windows port, incl. extensive modifications up to v4.8.0 (including the radio and audio book modes)
    - Third-party software and licences

Before you start

Starting Mousiki: `mousiki` or `lala`

Mousiki starts with either of two commands in a terminal: **`mousiki`** or the shorter **`lala`**. Both open the same program.

- **Installer / packages:** the Windows installer puts both on your `PATH` when the task *Add Mousiki to PATH* is ticked (`mousiki.cmd` and `lala.cmd`), the Linux `.deb` installs `/usr/bin/mousiki` and `/usr/bin/lala`, on macOS *Install Terminal Commands (optional).command* on the disk image adds `/usr/local/bin/mousiki` and `/usr/local/bin/lala` (Mousiki.app itself needs no command: double-click it). The portable `.zip` contains both launchers (`mousiki` / `lala`, on Windows `mousiki.cmd` / `lala.cmd`). A shortcut to the Mousiki Plus executable can also be found in your App menu using this version.
- **Portable Version:** Includes the launchers, but you have to add them to your path yourself.
- **Built yourself:** `setup.sh` (Linux / macOS) creates both commands in `~/.local/bin`, `setup.ps1` (Windows) in `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Mousiki\bin` and adds that folder to your user `PATH` (open a new terminal afterwards). Pass `--no-install` / `-NoInstall` to skip that.

The terminal font: braille dots

The disk, the pictures, the waveform and the oscilloscope are drawn with **braille characters**. How full and round their dots look depends on the terminal's **font**: the screenshots in this guide are Windows Terminal with **Cascadia Mono**. When a font has no braille characters, the terminal borrows them from another font and the pictures turn into small, scattered dots. A Nerd Font is not needed.

Mousiki uses its own font, **Cascadia Mono**, for its own window only (Settings -> GENERAL -> TEXT AND TRANSLITERATION -> *Terminal Default Font* switches that off, see below; another font than Cascadia Mono can be named in `config.txt`: `TerminalFont=`), and gives the terminal's font back when it quits. Where that works:

- **macOS Terminal:** yes. Mousiki.app (from the `.dmg`) also installs Cascadia Mono into `~/Library/Fonts` the first time it starts. macOS asks once whether Mousiki may control Terminal: allow it, otherwise the window keeps Terminal's font.
- **iTerm2:** yes, through a profile *Mousiki* (your profile with Cascadia Mono; iTerm2 *Dynamic Profiles*) that Mousiki's tab switches to while it runs.
- **Windows Terminal:** through a profile *Mousiki* that the Mousiki launchers open (Start menu, desktop, `mousiki-wt.cmd`); Cascadia Mono comes with Windows Terminal. The profile brings its own colour scheme, *Mousiki Retrowave* (black background), for everybody. The status lines are a fixed grey in every terminal, whatever its colour scheme says. A tab opened another way (your own profile) keeps its font and colours: open Mousiki through a launcher or the *Mousiki* profile (`wt -p Mousiki`).
- **The old Windows console window:** yes, for that window.
- **Other terminals** (GNOME Terminal, Konsole, Kitty, WezTerm, Ghostty ...): a program cannot change their font. Choose the font in the terminal's profile; on Linux the `.deb` recommends `fonts-cascadia-code`. Ghostty draws braille characters itself, whatever the font.

Rebindable vs. fixed keys

- **Rebindable keys** have an action name like `HKeyPlay` in `config.txt` and appear under **Settings → Reference**. Change them in either place.
- **Fixed keys** are written as literal key names in the cheat sheet (for example `ESC`, `ENTER`, the arrow keys, `*`, `Y` / `N` in prompts, `CTRL+s`, `CTRL+SHIFT+x`, or the keys inside the playlist and meta editors). These cannot be rebound; *why* is listed under *Settings → REFERENCE*.

Paging: `PgUp` / `PgDn` and `SHIFT+↑` / `SHIFT+↓`

Wherever a list or a page scrolls, **`PgUp` / `PgDn`** turn a whole page, exactly like **`SHIFT+↑` / `SHIFT+↓`**: the lists on the main screen and in the big overlays, the cheat sheet, the Help Wizard, the history, the playlist editor, the READ LYRICS overlay, the meta editor, the settings tabs, the chapter list of the audio books and the lists of the radio. Not every keyboard has the two keys `PgUp` / `PgDn` without holding `FN` (laptops), and some terminals handle `FN` combinations badly, so the `SHIFT+↑` / `SHIFT+↓` pair does the same everywhere: use whichever works on your keyboard. Same goes fpor F keys - in my case I'd have to use FN to release the FN lock, which I set up in order to use those keys for special functions of my laptop, such as handling the keyboard light, screen light etc. Key bindings where mostly decided to be as universal as possible and avoid such potential problems.

`ALT` on macOS (`Option`)

This guide writes the modifier as `ALT` (`ALT+C`, `ALT+←` / `ALT+→`). On a Mac that is the **Option (⌥)** key: a macOS build of Mousiki shows `OPTION+C` / `OPTION+LEFT/RIGHT` in the cheat sheet, everything else is identical. Things to know:

- **Lyrics timing overlay and chapter marks: `SHIFT+j` on macOS.** `ALT+L` would need the Option key to be sent as Meta (Terminal.app: *Use Option as Meta key*; iTerm2: *Esc+* for the left Option key), because Option+L types a special character otherwise. So on macOS the overlay opens with `SHIFT+j` by default,

in the main screen and in karaoke, and so do the audio book player's chapter marks (they share the key). This default is chosen when `config.txt` is first made; an older file keeps `ALT+L` (then set the Option key as Meta, or rebind it: Settings → Reference → *Lyrics Timing Overlay*). Windows and Linux keep `ALT+L`.

- **Cover fetch overlay: `SHIFT+q` on macOS.** It opens the cover fetch menu by default, so no Option key setting is needed. As with the timing overlay, this default is chosen when `config.txt` is first made; an older file keeps `ALT+C` (rebind it under Settings → Reference → *Open Cover Fetch*). While you type in the search field of the menu, `Q` is just a letter; `SHIFT+q` closes the menu from everywhere else.
- **Option+←/→** (tab switch) is sent as `ESC b` / `ESC f` by Terminal.app and iTerm2 out of the box, and Mousiki understands both that and the xterm form, so it works without any terminal setting.
- **Colours in macOS Terminal before macOS 26.** Mousiki's fades (the disk, borders, visualizations, covers) use 24-bit colours, which macOS Terminal only knows from macOS 26 on; older versions showed them as wrong colours. There Mousiki now turns them into the nearest of the 256 fixed colours, so the look matches the pictures in this guide, with slightly coarser fades. iTerm2, and macOS Terminal on macOS 26 and later, show the full colours. (`MOUSIKI_COLORS=256` forces the 256 colours in any terminal, `MOUSIKI_COLORS=truecolor` switches the conversion off.)

Uppercase letters

Several commands use **Shift + letter** (`T`, `N`, `M`, `P`, `H`, `X`) because the plain lowercase letter already does something else. Where this guide writes `SHIFT+t`, it means the uppercase `T` (the cheat sheet writes it the same way). Special signs where mostly avoided, but some choice rely on convenience using a German keyboard (again, I am happy for feedback to change the defaults given other types of keyboards).

Keyboard layouts (German and English)

Mousiki reacts to the **character** a key types, not to the key itself. Most commands are letters, digits or arrows and sit in the same place everywhere, but a few symbols are typed with different keys on a German (QWERTZ) and an English (US / UK QWERTY) keyboard. This guide writes those keys as the **character** and, where it matters, names both combinations. The cheat sheets name the switch key and the window keys for the layout Mousiki detects (`MOUSIKI_KEYBOARD=us|gb|de|…` overrides the detection).

Character	Command	German keyboard	English keyboard (US / UK)
`*`	Next mode (karaoke: lyrics bigger)	`SHIFT` and `+`	`'` (a config.txt from an older version: `SHIFT+8`)
`_`	Previous mode (karaoke: lyrics smaller)	`SHIFT` and `-`	`;` (older: `SHIFT` and `-`)
`(`	Spectrogram window	`SHIFT+8`	`SHIFT+9`
`)`	Oscilloscope window	`SHIFT+9`	`SHIFT+0`
`=`	Oscilloscope full screen	`SHIFT+0`	the `=` key
`+`	Volume up	the `+` key	`SHIFT` and `=`
`-`	Volume down	the `-` key	the `-` key (the radio also takes `_` as long as it is not rebound)

Character	Command	German keyboard	English keyboard (US / UK)
?	Cheat sheet	SHIFT and ß	SHIFT and /
<	Menus index (all menus and overlays)	the < key	SHIFT+,
/	Search	SHIFT+7	the / key
:	In the search prefixes (/r:, /a:, /s:, /sc:, /b:, /p:, /f:)	SHIFT and .	SHIFT and ;
#	Shuffle next / random channel	the # key	US: SHIFT+3; UK: the # key (SHIFT+3 is £)
! $ %	Queue lock / move to top / to bottom	SHIFT+1 / SHIFT+4 / SHIFT+5	the same
< >	Equalizer: previous / next preset (also , / .)	the < key / SHIFT and <	SHIFT and , / SHIFT and .
[ ]	Radio: 30 s back / forward (timeshift)	ALT GR+8 / ALT GR+9	the [/] keys
{ }	Radio: 5 min back / back to live	ALT GR+7 / ALT GR+0	SHIFT and [/ SHIFT and]

. (lyrics area / scope block cycle), , , the letters, digits and arrows are the same on both. A US Mac keyboard is like the US column; on a German Mac [ ] { } are OPTION+5 / 6 / 8 / 9. Every rebindable key can be moved to one that suits your keyboard (Settings → REFERENCE).

Menus with tabs and text boxes

The **playlist editor** (SHIFT+p), **listening history** (h) the **meta editor** (SHIFT+m) and the radio's **STATION LISTS** menu (SHIFT+k in the radio) all follow the same rule:

- ← / → **switch the tab**. This also works while a text box (playlist name, search box) has the focus, as long as **nothing has been typed into it yet**.
- As soon as you type or edit something in a text box (a character, BACKSPACE, DEL, HOME / END, SHIFT+←/→, CTRL+V …), the box is **in use**: ← / → now move the caret/courser inside it. The legend at the bottom changes from [←→] Switch Tab to [←→] Cursor and from [ESC] Exit to [ESC] Leave field, so you can always also indirectly see which of the two is active, apart from th focus indicator "◀".
- ESC **leaves the box** (the text stays) and ← / → switch tabs again. TAB (focuse next pane) and ENTER leave it as well. Only an ESC *outside* a text box closes the menu; if there are unsaved changes (for example a name you typed for a new playlist) it first asks Save changes to "…" before exiting?.
- ALT+← / ALT+→ switch the tab from everywhere, also while you are typing.
- CTRL+s **saves** (the playlist, the station list, or the meta editor's pending edits after a Yes/No question). It works from every pane, also while typing.

The meta editor's **field editor** (FILE, ARTIST, TITLE, ALBUM, YEAR) is a text box you enter on purpose with ENTER, so there ← / → always move the caret; ESC (or ENTER) takes you back to the library.

Settings (both modes) keep TAB as the tab switch and ← / → for cycling a value or picking a colour cell. While a field is being edited there (after ENTER: a colour, a path, a value or a key), ← / → move the caret and TAB does nothing; only ENTER (apply) or ESC (cancel) leave the field. See Settings.

Three player modes in one program

	Music player	**Radio**	**Audio books**
What it plays	Your local files and YouTube, SoundCloud and Bandcamp streams	Internet radio stations	The books in your audio book folder
Settings file	`config.txt`	`radio_config.txt`	`config.txt` (the same settings as the player)
Guide	Chapters 1 to 10	Chapter 11	Chapter 12

The **next** mode key is SHIFT and + on a German keyboard (the character *) and the ' key on an English (US / UK) one. The **previous** mode key is SHIFT and - on a German keyboard (the character _) and the ; key on an English one. (The English defaults avoid SHIFT+8; [ ] { } are taken by the radio's timeshift. A `config.txt` that was written by an older version keeps * / _ - SHIFT+8 / SHIFT+- on an English keyboard - until you change them under Settings → Reference.) By default the order is music player, radio, audio books; **Settings → GENERAL → MODES** switches a mode off (one always stays on) and changes the order (see chapter 10). The + key on its own is **volume up** in every mode (- is volume down). The player and the audio book player are **paused and kept in memory** while another mode runs, so coming back is instant; the radio is **closed completely** when you leave it, since it does not automatically record radio stations output to enable instant coming back to where you stopped.... The cheat sheet of both modes shows the switch key as its first line, adapted to your keyboard layout (detected automatically, MOUSIKI_KEYBOARD=us|de|fr|... overrides it). The keys can be rebound (Settings → Reference → *Next Mode* / *Previous Mode*). SHIFT+m stays the meta editor.

What can Mousiki play? Audio formats, tracker modules and chiptunes

Besides MP3, FLAC, WAV, OGG, Opus, M4A and the other usual formats, the player plays retro formats from your music folders. They show up in the list, the search and the queue like any other file:

Kind	**Extensions**	**What it needs**
Tracker modules (Amiga / PC demoscene)	`.mod` `.xm` `.it` `.s3m` `.mptm` `.stm` `.669` `.mtm` `.med` `.okt` `.far` `.ult` `.ams` `.dbm` `.digi` `.dmf` `.dsm` `.gdm` `.imf` `.j2b` `.mdl` `.mt2` `.psm` `.ptm` `.umx` `.plm`	FFmpeg built with **libopenmpt** (most current builds are)
Game console music	`.nsf` `.nsfe` (NES), `.spc` (SNES), `.gbs` (Game Boy), `.vgm` `.vgz` (Sega and others), `.ay`, `.hes`, `.kss`, `.sap`, `.gym`	FFmpeg built with **libgme**

Kind	Extensions	What it needs
Commodore 64 SID tunes	`.sid .psid .rsid`	The **sidplayfp** program on the `PATH` (Linux: package `sidplayfp`; Windows has no official build: the easiest source is MSYS2, `pacman -S mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-sidplayfp` in its UCRT64 shell, then copy `sidplayfp.exe` and its DLLs into one folder such as `C:\tools\sidplayfp` and run `setup.ps1` again; `setup.sh` / `setup.ps1` install it or add it to the `PATH`)

- The module's title (and for SID: name, author and year from the file header) is used as metadata; the TYPE column says *tracker module*, *game music* or *C64 SID (n tunes)*.
- The **meta editor can edit the tags** of tracker modules and chiptunes, in two places. What the file can hold is written into the file itself: the **title** of a MOD / XM / S3M / IT / MPTM file (the module's song name; the rest of the file is untouched) and the **title and artist** of a SID tune (the PSID header). Everything else (artist, album and year of a tracker module; album and year of a SID tune; all tags of game music such as NSF / SPC / VGM) is saved in a small side file next to the music, in a folder called `chip_tracker_meta data` (file `metadata.json`). Mousiki shows these values in the lists, in the search and in the metadata block like normal tags. The side file follows a renamed file and is removed again when nothing is left in it; copy the folder along with the music if you move it!!
- A SID tune has no end, so it is rendered once for `SidPlayLength` seconds (default 180, see Settings that exist only in `config.txt`) into `~/.cache/mousiki/sid/` and then played from there; the next time it starts at once. Only the first sub-tune is played.
- setup.sh and setup.ps1 take care of the tracker and chiptune tools. They upgrade an FFmpeg that is already installed (skip with --no-upgrade / -NoUpgrade) and make sure it has libopenmpt and libgme: setup.ps1 installs the full Gyan.FFmpeg build, setup.sh rebuilds FFmpeg on macOS and otherwise warns. If an older FFmpeg comes first on your PATH, it is the one Mousiki uses, so remove it or put the new one first. For C64 SID tunes they install sidplayfp (Linux: package manager; macOS: built from source) or link it onto the PATH. On Windows the project publishes no sidplayfp build: get a sidplayfp.exe (for example from MSYS2), put it in one of the folders setup.ps1 searches (e.g. C:\tools\sidplayfp or %LOCALAPPDATA%\Mousiki\bin) and run setup.ps1 again, which adds its folder to your PATH.
- Via MSYS2 (get and install it from msys2.org) you can install it via `pacman -S mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-sidplayfp`using the MSYS2 UCRT64 shell. You can have to copy it out of the C:\msys64\ucrt64\bin together with the DLLs it needs and put it into your Mousiki folder (e.g. inside a folder called sidplayfp). The DLLs neede are: can be evaluated (before you move it!!) via the MSYS shell command: `ldd /ucrt64/bin/sidplayfp.exe | grep -i ucrt64`
- If the required tool is missing, the status line says which one, and the track is skipped.
- Mousiki does not link any of these libraries: libopenmpt (BSD) and libgme (LGPL) are used through FFmpeg, sidplayfp (GPL) runs as a separate program.

The main screen

The main screen has a **local/online/playlist list** on the left (titled `LOCAL AUDIO FILES`, `ONLINE RESULTS` or `SAVED PLAYLISTS`), a **Queue** panel, a metadata panel with lyrics or a visualizer, and a search box. Only one pane has **focus** at a time: the search box (while you type), the list or the queue. However, its only half true in the sense that when you focus the serach bar, you can still hover over tracks in the library and play them via hitting `Enter`... The focused pane is marked with a small ◀ after its title, in the **FOCUS** colour (Settings >

COLORS). Focus decides where the arrow keys work and also some commands (see `TAB` below), but as mentioned for the case of search bars in focues, they also indirectly let you control library/result panes.

Window size. The list and queue panes use every row the terminal has left under the metadata panel, progress bar and search box, so a maximised window is filled down to its last line. Resize at any time, also while a menu is open: Settings, Console, the playlist and meta editors and the listening history take the same height as the main screen, and the cheat sheet (`?`) uses the full terminal height. The playlist and meta editors keep a few rows at the bottom for their legend and status messages (a status mesage and log overlay can be opened via `t`from the main UI). The meta editor's legend is always four rows (plus the status row), at least a 120 x 32 terminal shows every key in full; on narrower terminals the labels get shorter (`Fetch missing tag` becomes `Missing`) and only below about 80 columns the last keys of a row are replaced by `…`. The same tree-table legend (`┌─ Label │ keys`, labels shortened on narrow terminals) is used by the playlist editor (Move / Tracks or Playlist), the CONVERT and big QUEUE overlays, the READ LYRICS overlay (Move / Translate / Session; it has no status line of its own, its messages go to the status message and log overlay, `t` on the main screen, so the panes never change size), the karaoke screen and, in the radio, the PRESETS menu, the station-list menu and the big stations overlay. E.g. the karaoke legend fills the last two terminal rows in two groups with *Overlay* (close, lyrics size, timing) and *Player* (play/pause, next/previous, seek, volume, mute). The cheat sheet and the listening history keep no empty rows. The history shows a status message in a row of its own only while there is one. In general, the music player mode is not well tuned to handle the appearencs of status messages well (the radio player is on the other hand) because e.g. the Settings menu overwrites them quickly to show the warning message that changes have not been saved yet (which was priorized over other messages). So as already mentioned, a log and status messageg overlay was included that can be accessed via `t` from the main UI... Use this when you want to e.g. get notice of missing packeges as they are needed to play tracker and chiptune models...

Playback mode letter

The small box next to the search bar shows the current playback mode as a letter: `L` play along list (local audio file or search list(off an donline serach results)), `R` repeat current track, `S` shuffle from list or songs from the queue (you can still search open and play songs from a library list, but the next song will be from the queue again, when tracks are listed there, same goes for the `L`mode which also priorizes the queue), `O` stop after current track is finished, `Q` play queue then stop.

The Help Wizard (`SHIFT+w`)

Another shorter version of this user guide you are reading is also **inside the program**. `SHIFT+w` opens the **Mousiki Plus Help Wizard** in all player modes (from every menu and overlay that is not taking typed text): a welcome page opens and a **table of content** and a page per subject, written in the order of this guide's chapters can be found.



The welcome page of the help wizard (`SHIFT+w`).

It starts with a **welcome page** (with the spinning disk) and a **table of content**; after that come the pages of the chapters which can be accessed via the table of content which itself can be accessed via `t`. `SHIFT+w` opens it again at any time and brings you to the page you left. Note that chapter 9 and 13 have an intro page, other than that the mean header titles bring you e.g. directly to the first sub-chapter, e.g. hitting enter on "4. Lyrics and Karaoke" brings you to chapter 4.1 straight away...

Key	What it does
`SHIFT+w` / `ESC` / `q`	Open / close the wizard
`→` / `←`	Next / previous page **inside the current main chapter**: from page 3.1 only the pages 3.x can be reached. The way to another chapter is the table of content. The welcome pages and the table of content count as one chapter.
`t` or `BACKSPACE`	Back to the **table of content** (`TOC` in the legend), with the entry of the current page highlighted
`↑` / `↓`	On the table of content: pick an entry (the page scrolls with it). On any other page that is taller than the terminal: scroll it one row; a scrollbar in the disk's gradient colours at the right edge shows that the page scrolls.
`SHIFT+↑` / `SHIFT+↓`	A whole page up / down (on the table of content: jump five entries)
`ENTER`	On the welcome page: to the table of content. On the table of content: open the highlighted entry.
`SHIFT+s`	**Search the whole wizard** via a search function (see below)

- The **top border** names the chapter: `MOUSIKI PLUS HELP WIZARD – 2 MUSIC PLAYER MODE – 2.3 CURATING YOUR FILES`; the bottom border lists the keys that work on the current page. Every page

starts and ends with an empty line to make it look nicer, so don't confuse this as the text ending at one page (scrollbars also indicate the length of a page since later version)
- Colours: headings use the **header colour**, everything in `[square brackets]` (the keys) uses the **legend colour**, the rest the list colour.
- The keys the wizard names are the **shipped defaults**, like the cheat sheet's. A key you rebound yourself is shown under **Settings → REFERENCE**.
- Playback keeps running while it is open. The wizard takes every key until you close it, like the cheat sheet (`?`), which stays the quick, scrollable list of every key command and needs you to exit the wizard first in order to access.

Searching (`SHIFT+s`). In the wizard and in the cheat sheet (`?`), in both modes, `SHIFT+s` opens a search field. Type a few words, in any order: the results appear while you type, the best first. The search forgives typos (`plalyist`), finds parts of words (`queu`) and related words (`delete` also finds `remove`), and it marks what matched (based on a baked in table, but it is not a sophisticated semantic search, e.g. based on a verctor database or something like that). In the **cheat sheet** each result is a command line (key, description and category); `ENTER` closes the search and scrolls the table to that line. In the **wizard** each result is a chapter with the title and up to two text fragments around the matches; `ENTER` opens the chapter at the matching line. `↑` / `↓` choose a result (`SHIFT+↑` / `SHIFT+↓` jump over five at a time). The search field is a normal text box (caret, marking, `CTRL+c` / `x` / `v`). `ESC` clears the query first and leaves the search when it is already empty.

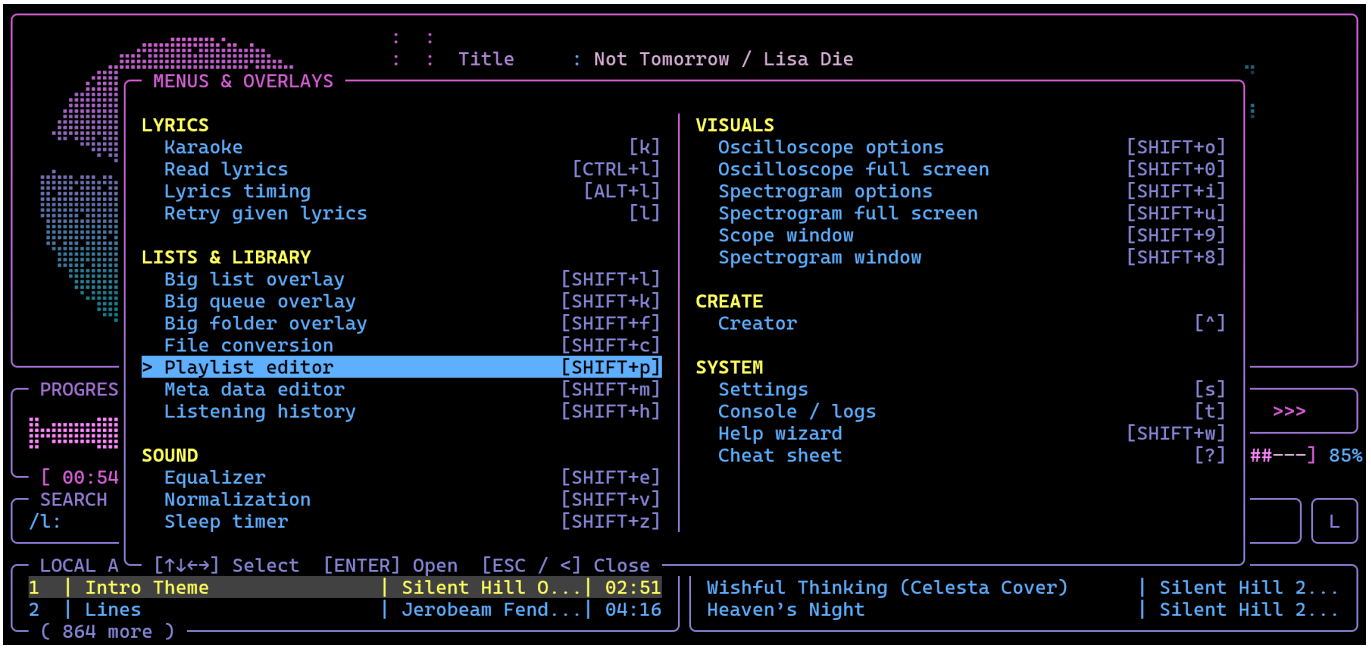
The text is a plain file, For other developers: `Mousiki_Help_Wizard.txt` in the repository: a page starts with a line `[[New Page]]`, `[[Header]]` colours the capitalised words in front of it, `[[Header_line]]` anywhere in a line colours the whole line, `[KEY]` is drawn in the legend colour, `{VERSION}` is the running version and lines starting with `=>>>` are notes to the author (see the top of the file). It is compiled into the program by `python3 tools/wizard_to_inc.py` (writes `src/wizard_text.inc`). To try an edit without rebuilding, start Mousiki with `MOUSIKI_WIZARD_FILE=/path/to/Mousiki_Help_Wizard.txt`...

1. System (main UI)

Key	Action	What it does
`*` (German `SHIFT` and `+`, English `'`)	Switch to the radio	Switches to the radio mode or audio book mode (and back from there). The player is paused and waits in the background. See Three player modes in one program from before...
`s`	Open Settings	Opens the Settings panel (see Settings for every tab). Inside Settings, `s` again **saves to `config.txt` and closes**. `ESC` or `q` **discards** the changes made on the screen and closes.
`SHIFT+r`	Rescan library	Rescans the music folders, e.g. after files were copied or downloaded in the meantime or after coming back from the radio. Also works in the meta editor, even while the library pane or the fetch list has the focus.
`"` (`SHIFT+'` on a US keyboard; German `SHIFT+2`)	Transliteration to latin letters	Switches **Japanese kana, Korean and Chinese text to Latin letters** and back: titles, artists, albums and file names in the lists and panels, the lyrics in the lyrics field, the karaoke overlay and the READ LYRICS overlay (also the translation). See Latin letters. The key also works while the karaoke or READ LYRICS overlay is open (not while you type in its search

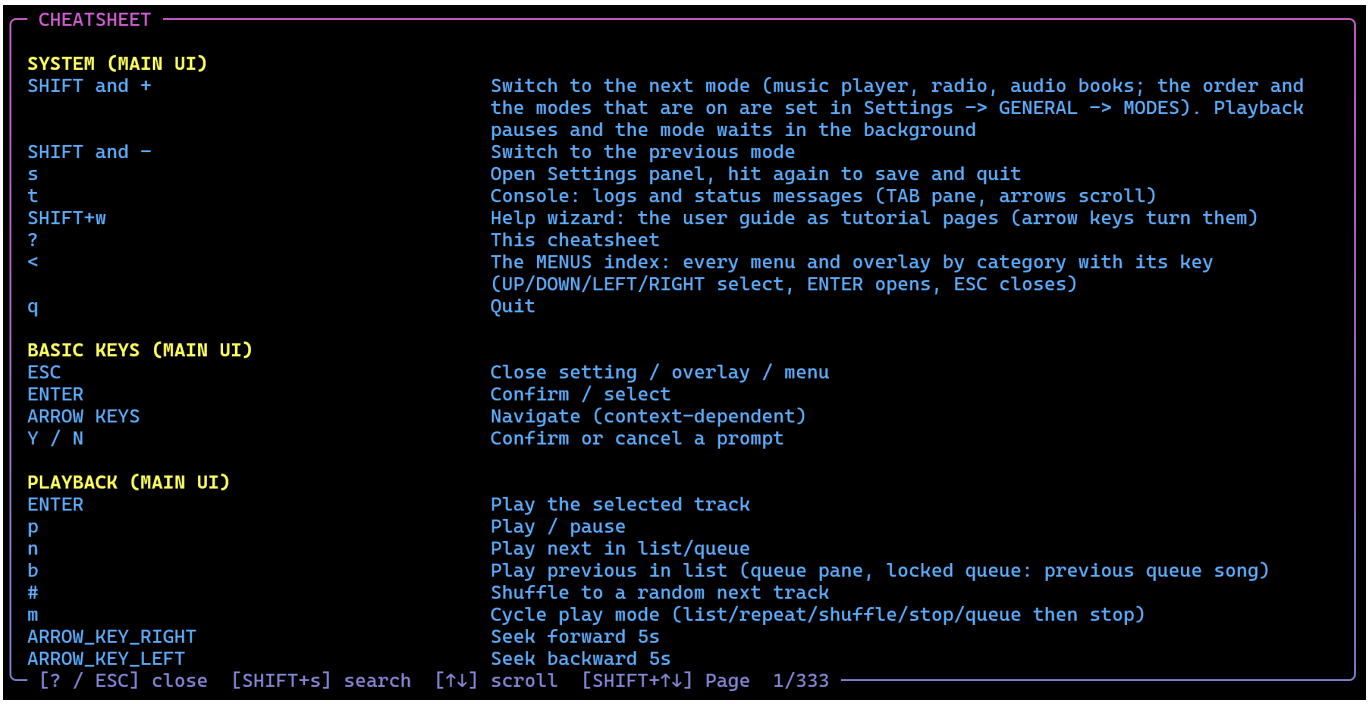
Key	Action	What it does
		or options), and the karaoke title bar follows it. The key can be changed (`HKeyTranslit`); the state is saved (`LatinLetters=` in `config.txt`).
`t`	Console / logs / status messages	Opens a read-only view with two panes. The top pane, **CONSOLE / LOGS**, shows what the app has been doing (the commands it ran, sort and filter changes, queue messages, load timings and so on). The pane below, **STATUS MESSAGES** (8 rows), keeps every status message with its time (`[14:03:22] Latin letters: on`), those of the Settings screen and the overlays too; the main screen shows none of them. Each pane keeps its own place: `TAB` switches the pane (the ◀ marks it), ↑/↓ scroll it one line (`SHIFT`: a page), `HOME` goes to the oldest line, `END` back to the newest (a pane at the newest line follows new lines). The logs keep the last 800 lines, the messages the last 500. On a small terminal the status pane gets what is left after three log rows. Close it with `ESC`, `t` or `T`.
° (German `SHIFT+^`; other keyboards `&`)	Choose audio device	Opens the **CHOOSE AUDIO DEVICE** overlay: the sound outputs of this computer, the one in use marked; `ENTER` switches at once (the same overlay as Settings -> GENERAL -> AUDIO -> *Choose Audio Device*). Works in the music player, the radio and the audio books. The default key depends on the keyboard: ° where it is `SHIFT+^` (German, Austrian, Swiss layouts), `&` elsewhere (US / UK keyboards have no °; `%` stays the queue's "to the bottom" key). Rebindable (`HKeyAudioDevice`; in the radio `HKeyAudioDevice` in `radio_config.txt`).
`SHIFT+w`	Help wizard	Opens the Help Wizard: this guide as tutorial pages. Arrow keys turn the pages, `t` shows the table of content, `ESC` closes. It opens by itself on the first start after an install. Use `SHIFT+s`to open th search function.
`?`	Cheat sheet	(German `SHIFT` and ß, English `SHIFT` and `/`.) Opens the command list. Use ↑/↓ to scroll (the list is longer than most terminal windows). `SHIFT+s` searches the commands (typos are forgiven, matches are marked, `ENTER` jumps to the line). Close with `?` or `ESC`.
`<`	Menus index	(German: the `<` key, English: `SHIFT+,`.) Opens **MENUS & OVERLAYS**: a list of all menus and overlays, in categories (LYRICS, LISTS & LIBRARY, SOUND, VISUALS, CREATE, SYSTEM), each with its key next to the title. ↑/↓ select, ←/→ jump to the other column, `ENTER` opens the highlighted one, `ESC` or `<` closes. The keys shown are the ones you have bound (rebindable as *Menus / Overlays Index* in Settings → REFERENCE).
`q`	Quit	Quits the application from the main screen. Only the lowercase `q` quits: `SHIFT+q` does nothing, so it cannot quit by accident when you aim for `SHIFT+w` (the help wizard).
`ESC`	Close / back / clear	Closes whatever is open (an overlay, a menu, a prompt; in Settings it discards the changes). On the **main screen** it returns to the *home view*: the full local library, with no search query and no folder filter, scrolled to

Key	Action	What it does
		the top. It does not change the sort mode. In some overlays it clears the filters applied to a library pane and clears the serach query.
ENTER	Confirm / select	Confirms the highlighted choice or starts the highlighted item. What it does depends on where you are (play a track, queue a playlist, commit a search and so on).
ARROW KEYS	Navigate	Move up and down through lists, left and right to seek or move a text caret. What they do depends on the current screen. Page Up and Page down as well as SHIFT+Up and SHIFT+Down work as moving in pages in those panes or overlay screens that are scrollable.
Y / N	Confirm or cancel a prompt	Answers Yes/No prompts such as "Want to clear queue?" or "Fetching metadata via AcoustID ... Continue?".



Tips

- Almost every overlay closes with ESC.
- Prompts swallow other keys while they are open, so nothing underneath can be triggered by accident. **The cheat sheet (?)** is the screen this guide follows. The footer shows how far you have scrolled (1/87).



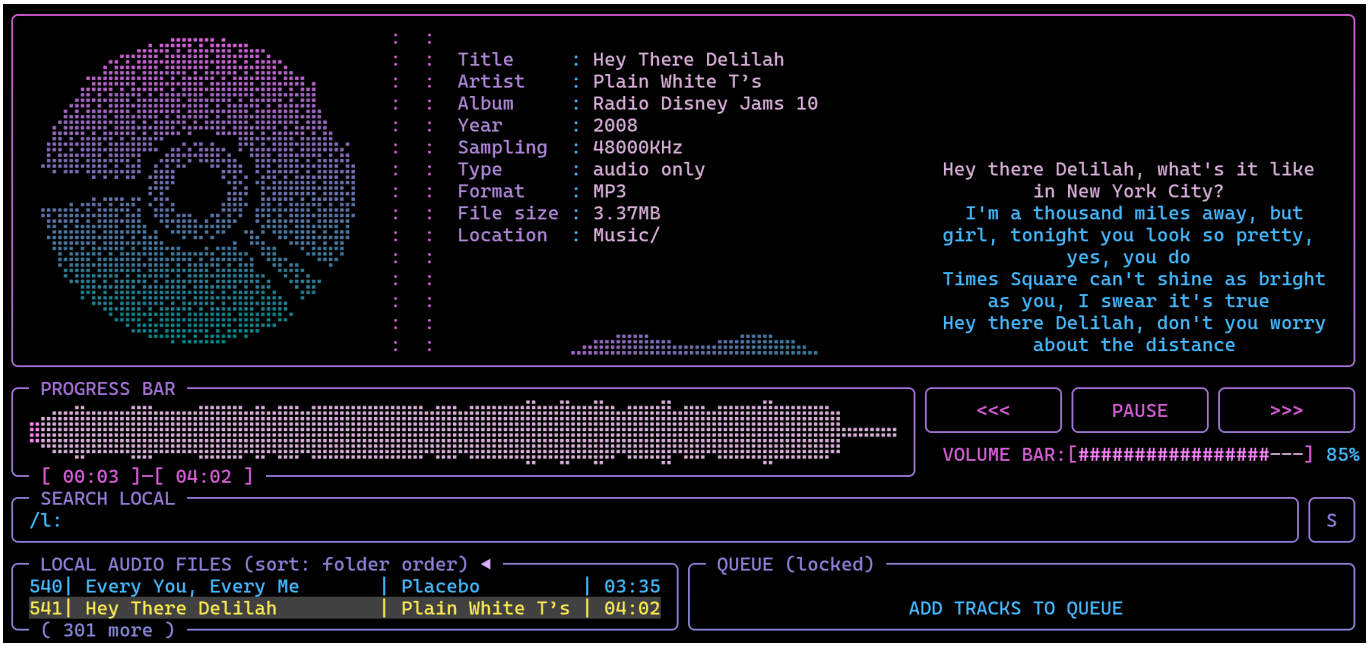
The cheat sheet, opened with `?`. Scroll with ↑/↓; `Shift+s` opens the search function; `?` or `ESC` closes it.

---

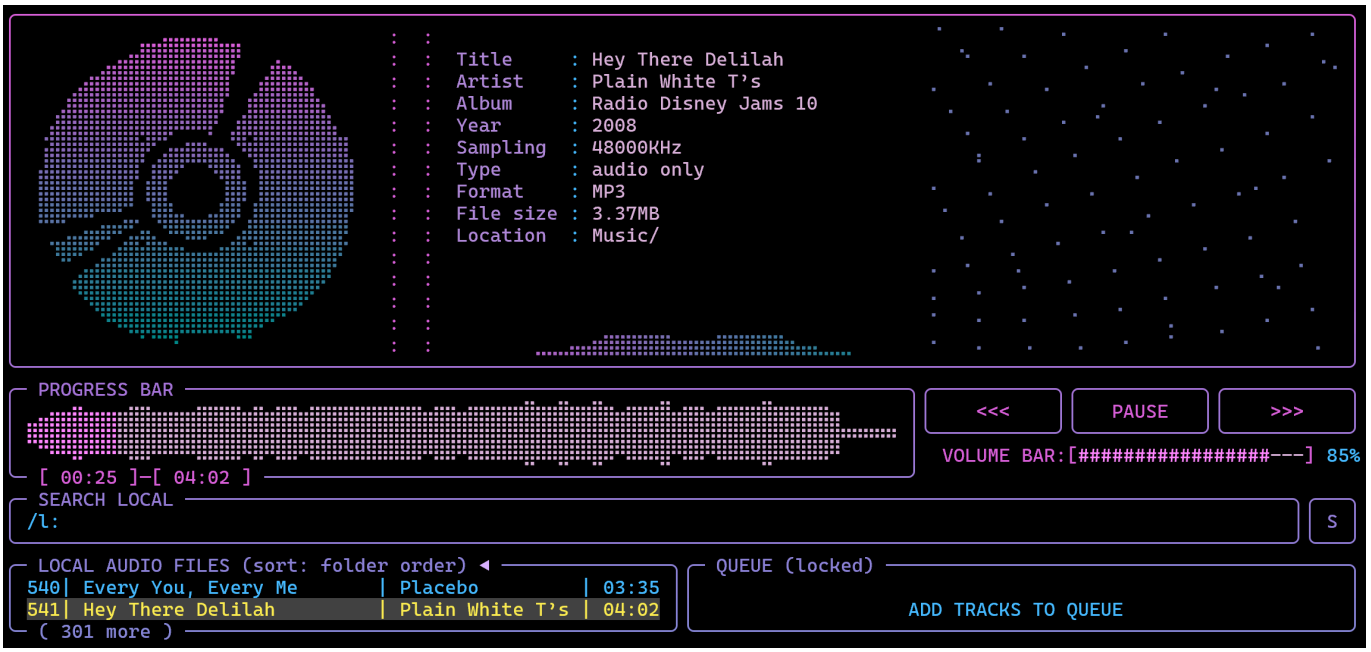
2. Playback (main UI)

The main screen while a track plays: the disk, the metadata panel, the visualizer and the lyrics area at the top, then the progress bar with its waveform, the volume bar, the search box, and the local file list and queue at the bottom. The box on the right of the search bar shows the play mode letter (here `S` for shuffle).

The metadata panel lists **Name, Artist, Album, Year**, sampling, type, format, file size and location. Name, Artist and Album always take exactly one row each; a value that is too long for the column scrolls as a marquee, so the visualizer below it is never moved or overwritten.



Main screen with the lyrics engine on: the lyrics fill the right-hand area.



*Main screen with no lyrics shown: the audio-reactive **lyric ball** (sphere; Settings → ANIMA/VIZ → Lyrics/Viz Default) fills the area instead.*

Below you find a list of the main functions related to the playback itself. Other overlays that can be opened in from this menu are explained elsewhere further below (see TOC at the top of this manual or serach this document via CTRL+f in your browser / pdf viewer or IDE when using the .md version).

Key	Action	What it does
ENTER	Play the selected track	Starts the highlighted track. Pressing it again on the same track reloads it. On a **playlist row** it does not play. It queues every track in that playlist instead. With the focus on the **queue** (TAB, small pane or big overlay) it plays the highlighted queue item. SHIFT+ENTER in the queue (small pane or big overlay) plays the highlighted item **and moves the whole queue along to that point**: the items in front of it go to the end of the queue in their order, as if they had been played (useful with a locked queue, where played tracks go to the end anyway; on Windows Terminal and other consoles that report the Shift key).
p	Play / pause	Pauses or resumes the current track.
n	Next	Plays the next track. If the **queue** has items, the next queue item plays. Otherwise the next track in the list plays (relative to what is *playing*, not where your cursor is).
b	Previous	Plays the previous track in the list. With the focus in the **queue pane** (TAB) it plays the previously played queue song but does not reorder the queue - works only while the queue is **locked** (!), because only a locked queue keeps played tracks (they sit at its end); on an unlocked queue b does nothing.
#	Shuffle next	(US keyboard: SHIFT+3.) A one-off jump to a **random track from the current list**, independent of the shuffle play mode. **With a queue** it plays a random title of the queue instead.

Key	Action	What it does
`m`	Cycle play mode	Steps through the five play modes (see below).
→	Seek forward	Jumps forward **5 seconds**.
←	Seek backward	Jumps back **5 seconds**.
+	Volume up	(English keyboard: `SHIFT` and `=`.) Raises the in-app volume in steps of 5 (up to 100). Same key as in the radio and audio book mode.
-	Volume down	Lowers the in-app volume in steps of 5 (down to 0). Same key as in the radio and audio book mode.
`x`	Mute	Sets the volume to 0 without pausing. Pressing it again restores the previous volume.
`v`	Toggle loudness normalization	Turns loudness normalization on or off, so you can compare a track with and without it. When turned on, the status line shows the track's measured loudness and the correction applied. The target and maximum boost are set with the `SHIFT+v` overlay (see *Loudness normalization overlay* below) or in `config.txt`.
`E` (Shift+E)	Equalizer	Opens the **10-band equalizer** overlay with presets. The sound changes live while you adjust it. See *Equalizer overlay* below.
`V` (Shift+V)	Normalization tuning	Opens a small overlay to switch loudness normalization on or off and to change its target level and maximum boost **live**. See *Loudness normalization overlay* in chapter 3.
`^`	Creator	Turns a text into sound: oscilloscope music for the XY scope or a spectrogram sound, with a looping preview. See *Creator overlay* in chapter 3. (German keyboard: `^` is a dead key, press it and then `SPACE`.)
`Z` (Shift+Z)	Sleep timer	Opens a small overlay to pause playback after 15, 30, 60, 90 or 120 minutes, or to stop after the current song. See *Sleep timer overlay* in chapter 3.

Sound quality: sample rate and resampling

- **Every file plays at its own sample rate** (44.1, 48, 88.2, 96 kHz …): it is decoded at that rate and the audio device is opened with it, so nothing is converted on the way. Above 96 kHz the track is brought down to 96 kHz by default; **Settings** → **GENERAL** → ***Rate Cap at 96 kHz*** (`RateCap96=false`) switches that off, so such a file plays at its own rate (up to 768 kHz) - then the decoded audio needs correspondingly more RAM (see *Track Buffer*) and the audio device has to accept the rate. It applies from the next track that is loaded.
- **Long and big files need little memory.** A short track is decoded completely into memory (32-bit float, 8 bytes per stereo sample pair). A track that would take more than the **Track Buffer** (256 MB by default) that way (stereo; roughly: longer than 12.7 minutes at 44.1 kHz, 11.6 minutes at 48 kHz, 5.8 minutes at 96 kHz; a mono track twice as long; an hour-long mix would take well over a gigabyte) is held as a **2-minute window** around the playing position instead: the decoder stays up to 90 s ahead of playback and keeps the last 30 s, so a short step back is instant. A seek outside the window decodes

from the new position (WAV and FLAC directly, MP3 through a seek table, other formats through FFmpeg's fast seek) - results in a fraction of a second of silence at most. Loudness normalization and the waveform come from a separate pass over the file that keeps only the figures. The audio is exactly the same (same rate, same 32-bit samples); a 200 MB file takes about 50 MB instead of gigabytes of RAM. To avoid huge RAM usage implementing true gapless track changes was not pursued.

- **The tags of the library are kept between runs.** The first start reads the tags (title, artist, album, year, length) of every file in the background; after that they are kept in a small file, `~/.cache/mousiki/tag_cache.txt` (`tag_cache_books.txt` for the audio book library). At the next start every file whose **size and modification time** did not change gets its tags from there **at once**, so search, sort and the artist / album filters work right away even in a big library; only new and changed files are read again (a file whose tags you edit counts as changed). The file is written anew when the background reading is done. Deleting it costs nothing but one slower start.
- Where a conversion is unavoidable (a file above 96 kHz while *Rate Cap at 96 kHz* is on, and so on) it uses a long, sharp filter: FFmpeg's `aresample` with a 64-tap filter for files and for the radio (internet streams are brought to 48 kHz), and the steepest setting of the audio library when the sound device itself cannot take the rate (on Windows the system's own converter does that part).
- The **equalizer**, **normalization** and its **limiter** only work while they are on; with both off the samples reach the device unchanged apart from the volume. The scopes can get the signal before all of them when *Osci music mode* is turned in the `SHIFT+o` overlay.

Equalizer overlay (`SHIFT+e`)

Opens a window in the middle of the screen with a **10-band graphic equalizer**. Each band is a vertical slider from **−12 dB** to **+12 dB**, with the center line at 0 dB. The bands sit at **31, 62, 125, 250, 500 Hz, 1, 2, 4, 8 and 16 kHz**. The selected band is highlighted, and its gain and name are shown underneath. The top line of the window shows the current **preset**, whether the **EQ is ON or OFF**, and the **preamp** (see below). The key legend at the bottom of the window is drawn in the same color as the window's border.

The equalizer works on everything the player plays and changes the sound **while the music plays**, so you can adjust it by ear. Playback keeps running while the overlay is open, but its keys are the only ones that react until you close it. The overlay opens on every main screen.

Key	Action
`←` / `→`	Select the previous / next band (wraps around)
`↑` / `↓`	Raise / lower the selected band by 1 dB
`,` or `<`	Previous preset
`.` or `>` or `TAB`	Next preset (the built-in presets first, then your custom presets)
`0`	Set the selected band to 0 dB
`SPACE`	Switch the equalizer on / off. The gains stay as they are.
`R`	Reset all bands to **Flat**. The on / off state is not changed.
`S`	**Save** the current curve as a **custom preset**. A *Save as:* prompt opens under the sliders (see *Custom presets* below).
`DEL` or `X`	**Delete** the selected custom preset. Press it twice to confirm.

Key	Action
ESC or SHIFT+e	Close the overlay. The settings are **saved to** `config.txt` when it closes.

Switching on. Moving a band or choosing a preset also turns the equalizer on, so what you change is always what you hear. Use SPACE to compare against the original sound.

Presets. The preset keys cycle through the list below in this order, and then through your own custom presets (see below), in the order you saved them. If the gains do not match any preset exactly (for example after you moved a band), the top line shows **Custom**. Stepping to the next or previous preset then continues from the last preset you used.

Preset	Gains in dB, 31 Hz → 16 kHz
Flat	0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0
Bass Boost	+6, +5, +4, +2, +1, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0
Treble Boost	0, 0, 0, 0, 0, +1, +2, +4, +5, +6
Vocal	-2, -3, -3, +1, +3, +4, +3, +2, 0, -1
Rock	+4, +3, +2, -1, -2, -1, +1, +3, +4, +4
Pop	-1, +1, +3, +4, +3, 0, -1, -1, -1, -1
Jazz	+3, +2, +1, +2, -2, -2, 0, +1, +2, +3
Classical	+4, +3, +3, +2, -1, -1, 0, +2, +3, +3
Electronic	+5, +4, +1, 0, -2, +2, +1, +1, +4, +5
Hip-Hop	+5, +4, +2, +3, -1, -1, +2, 0, +2, +3
Acoustic	+4, +4, +3, +1, +2, +2, +3, +3, +3, +2
Loudness	+6, +4, +1, 0, -1, -1, 0, +1, +4, +5

Custom presets. Shape the sliders the way you like, then press S to keep the curve as a preset of your own.

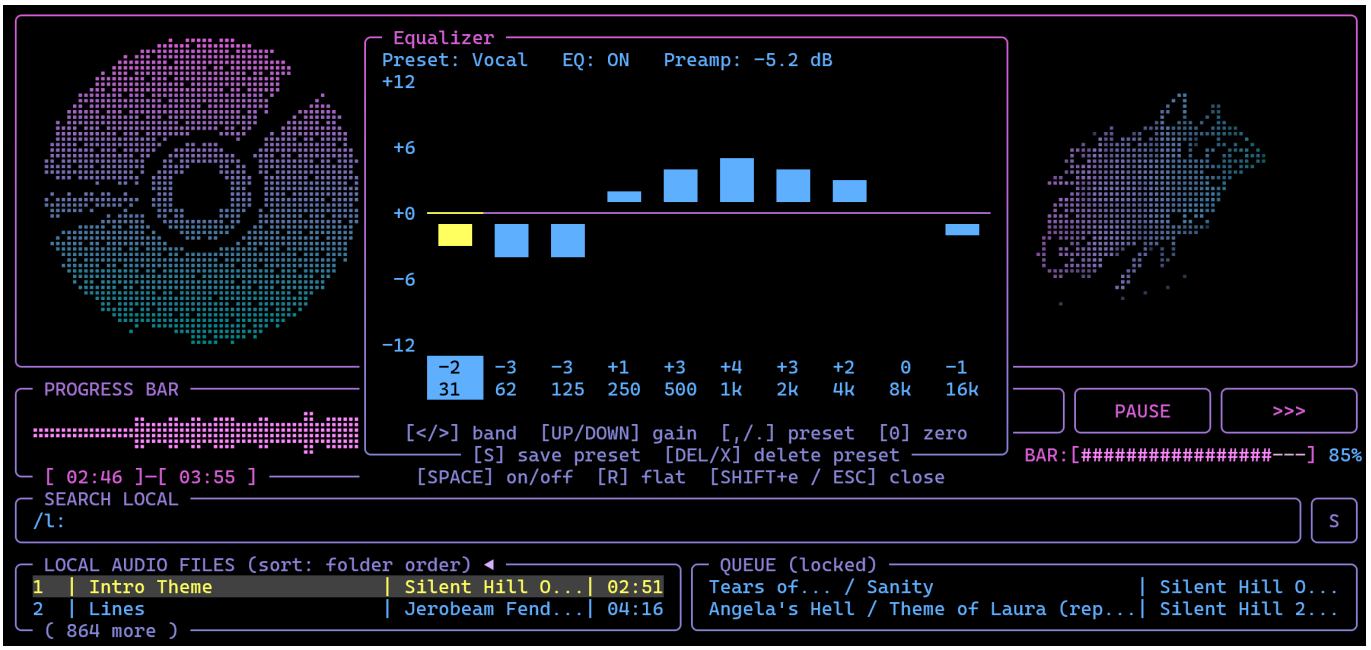
- A **Save as:** prompt replaces the line under the sliders and the legend changes to the prompt's keys. Type a name (up to **16 characters**) and press ENTER to save it, or ESC to cancel. Only the prompt closes on ESC; the equalizer stays open. The usual text keys work in the prompt: ← / →, HOME / END, SHIFT+← / SHIFT+→ to mark, and CTRL+C / CTRL+X / CTRL+V.
- The new preset is added **after the built-in presets** and appears on the top line under its name whenever the sliders match it. It is written to `config.txt` **immediately**, not only when the overlay closes.
- If you moved a band away from one of your custom presets, the prompt starts with that preset's name, so ENTER alone **updates** it. A name that already belongs to a custom preset (capital letters don't matter) **replaces** that preset.
- The names of the built-in presets and the word *Custom* cannot be used. The characters =, { and } are replaced by -, because the configuration file uses them. You can keep up to **24** custom presets.

- To **delete** one, select it with `,` / `.` so that the top line shows its name, press `DEL` (or `X`), and press it again within the overlay to confirm. Any other key cancels the deletion. The built-in presets cannot be deleted. The sliders keep their current values after a deletion and show **Custom**.
- Short messages such as *Saved* "*My Mix*", *Updated* "*My Mix*" or *Deleted* "*My Mix*" appear on the line under the sliders and disappear with the next key press.

Preamp. Boosting bands makes the whole signal louder and can push it into distortion. The player therefore lowers the level automatically by the height of the loudest point of your curve. The **Preamp** value on the top line shows this (for example `-7.1 dB` for Bass Boost). The sound will be slightly quieter with a strong boost than without the equalizer, and that is intended, as mentioned, to avoid distortion. Raise the volume if you need it louder. The equalizer is bypassed completely when it is off or all bands are 0 dB.

Good to know.

- On a track with a low sample rate (22.05 kHz, for example) the top band is too close to the limit of the signal and is skipped.
- **Loudness normalization** (`v`) measures the track *before* the equalizer. With a strong boost or cut a track can therefore end up a little louder or quieter than the normalization target.
- The window is 21 rows high (15 on a terminal with fewer than 24 rows, see the next point), so it still fits on a 24-row terminal.
- On a terminal with fewer than 24 rows the sliders are drawn in steps of 4 dB instead of 2 dB, so the window fits. The gains themselves still change in steps of 1 dB.



In radio mode the same overlay opens on the same key (`SHIFT+e`) with the same keys and presets. The radio keeps its own curve and settings,its own custom presets in `radio_config.txt`, independent of the player's (see 11.4). This could be done different and may changes in the future such that at least custom presets are shared. However, you can also open Mousiki again in another terminal tab to peek what values another mode uses or you just copy custom presets from one config to the other (config files are found in the user/.config folder...).

The five play modes (`m`)

Each press moves to the next mode in this order: **list** → **repeat** → **shuffle** → **stop** → **queue then stop** → **list** …

Mode	Letter	Behavior when a track finishes
List	`L`	Plays the next track in the list (the queue takes priority when it has items).
Repeat	`R`	Replays the same track again.
Shuffle	`S`	Plays a random track of the list. The queue is not shuffled: it always plays in its order (only `#` picks a random title of it).
Stop	`O`	Plays the track and then stops, with no automatic advance. The "no track loaded" screen with the cassette is shown.
Queue then stop	`Q`	Plays the queue **once**, then stops. It never falls through to the library: when the queue is used up, playback ends (like Stop mode), also when the queue was empty to begin with and a library track finishes. With the queue **locked** (default) each item goes to the back as it is played and the pass ends after the last unplayed item, so the queue is back in its original order afterwards. Tracks you add during the pass (`a`, `e`, bulk add) still play before it ends. Unlocked, played items leave the queue and it stops when it is empty. `n` always skips on, also after the pass is over (it starts a new one).

3. Navigation & view, lyrics and visualizations (main UI)

The cheat sheet splits these keys into groups: **NAVIGATION & VIEW** (the lists and what they show), **FILE CONVERSION** (the conversion overlay and its keys), **LYRICS & KARAOKE** and **VISUALIZATIONS** (oscilloscope and spectrogram). The loudness normalization and sleep timer overlays are listed under **SOUND** and **SLEEP TIMER** (chapter 2); their detailed descriptions follow further down in this chapter. The big list, queue and folder overlays have their own group, **BIG OVERLAYS**.

Navigation & view (cheat sheet: NAVIGATION & VIEW)

Key	Action	What it does
`↑`	Explore list up	Moves the highlight up in the focused panel (list or queue).
`↓`	Explore list down	Moves the highlight down in the focused panel.
`TAB`	Switch between panels	Moves focus between the **list** and the **queue**. This decides which panel the up/down arrows, `d` (remove), `4`/`5` (move) and `a` (add / bulk add) act on.
`f`	Filter by folder	Narrows the local list to the **folder of the highlighted track**. It also switches the sort back to *folder order*. The pane title then shows `sort: folder order, folder: <name> [c] clear`. The filter stacks on top of an active search.
`c`	Clear filter	Removes the folder filter. It leaves the sort mode alone.

Key	Action	What it does
`T` (Shift+T)	Cycle local list sort mode	Cycles the sort of the local list through four modes: **folder order** → **title/file name A-Z** → **artist A-Z** → **recently added**. The current mode is shown in the pane title (see below). Using `SHIFT+n`either shows title or file name in the library pane / meta data - see next entry:
`N` (Shift+n)	Toggle metadata-only track list	Switches every list row between **filename** and **metadata title** (the embedded title tag). The first line of the metadata block follows it and is labelled **File** or **Title** accordingly. Files with no title tag, or whose tags have not been read yet, keep showing their filename. This also switches what "title A-Z" sorts by (see below). Also available in **Settings** → **GENERAL**.
`w`	Toggle waveform style	Switches the waveform in the progress bar between **raw** and **smooth**.
`r`	Refresh UI	Forces a full redraw. Use it when a terminal resize or a switch of terminal sessions left the screen torn or stale.

Lyrics & karaoke (cheat sheet: LYRICS & KARAOKE)

Key	Action	What it does
`.` / `,`	Cycle lyrics area forward / backward	Cycles the lyrics area through four views: **sphere** → **oscilloscope** → **spectrogram** → **lyrics** → **sphere …** by default (`,` walks the same order backwards); the order is set with **Viz Order 1..4** on Settings → ANIMA/VIZ, and views switched off there with **Use Lyrics / Use Oscilloscope / Use Spectrogram / Use Sphere** are skipped. Basically the three visuals are the lyrics engine's *off* states: no lyrics are fetched from the network while one of them is shown, and the view stays until you change it again (the view Mousiki starts with is **Lyrics/Viz Default**). Coming back to the lyrics fetches them for the current track right away.
`l`	LYRICS REFETCH AND VERSION CONTROL	Opens the lyrics overlay. The upper part fetches lyrics again with a **manual title and artist**; `ENTER` (**Refetch**) keeps the lyrics in use as an older version (`lyrics/<name>.v<date>.<source>.lrc`, max 10), so timing you saved is never overwritten. The lower part, **LYRICS IN USE**, lists the lyrics embedded in the file, the fetched copy and older copies (three rows, scrolls with `↑`/`↓`; reach it with `↓` or `TAB` from the form); `SPACE` switches to the highlighted one, `d` deletes a saved copy after you confirm with `y` (lyrics embedded in the file cannot be deleted). Lyrics embedded in a file are used before anything is fetched. **Lyrics Name Variants** (Settings → GENERAL → TRANSLITERATION, on by default): when the search with the title and artist as they are finds nothing, Mousiki tries other spellings one after the other - the Latin-letters spelling it shows, the title or artist without their Latin or without their Japanese part (`Lemon (レモン)` → `Lemon` / `レモン`), and the title alone - and the status says which one worked. It applies to every network lyrics search, the refetch included, and costs time only when the first search finds nothing. The form works with the lyrics engine off

Key	Action	What it does
		too (the fetched lyrics are then kept for the karaoke mode and READ LYRICS). Its fields: **SONG TITLE**, **ARTIST NAME** and **FT (opt)**, the optional featured artist(s) ("feat." / "ft."), which are added to the search as `ft. <name>`; a `feat.` part of the title is moved there when the form opens. The same form opens with `l` **over READ LYRICS** (for the track that plays: start it with `p`) and **over the karaoke screen**; `ESC` or the fetch returns there, and the reader shows the new lyrics as soon as they are loaded.
`ALT+l` (macOS: `SHIFT+j`)	Adjust lyrics	Opens a small overlay menu for live adjustment of the lyrics timing.
`k`	Karaoke overlay	Shows the lyrics of the playing track over the whole screen, karaoke style. It fetches the lyrics itself when the lyrics engine is off on the main screen (that setting is left alone). See *Karaoke overlay* below.

Visualizations (cheat sheet: VISUALIZATIONS) - the oscilloscope and the spectrogram in the lyrics area, full screen and in their own windows; the lyrics/viz. area itself is switched with `,` / `.`.

Key	Action	What it does
`O` (Shift+O)	Oscilloscope tuning	Opens a small overlay to change the oscilloscope **live**: style (braille / image), frame rate, music mode, afterglow, line thickness, tail, glow, Z axis, rotation, colours and more - each style (braille or image) keeps its own values. See *The oscilloscope* below.
`I` (Shift+I)	Spectrogram options	Opens the spectrogram overlay (style, motion, scale, frequencies, gain, range, window, colours ...). See *Spectrogram* below.
`U` (Shift+U)	Spectrogram full screen	The Audacity style spectrogram over the whole screen, with frequency labels and a time ruler. `ESC` or `SHIFT+u` closes it.
`=` (German `SHIFT+0`, English the `=` key)	Oscilloscope full screen	The oscilloscope over the whole screen: the **YT** trace on the left, the **XY** figure on the right, values in the border, optional grid. `ESC` or the same key closes it. See *Oscilloscope full screen* below.
`)` (German `SHIFT+9`, English `SHIFT+0`)	Scope window	Opens / closes the oscilloscope in **its own window**, drawn by the graphics card at the monitor's refresh rate. See *Scope window* below. (The key is the character `)`.) Works always, also while the oscilloscope is switched off on the GENERAL tab.
`(` (German `SHIFT+8`, English `SHIFT+9`)	Spectrogram window	Opens / closes the spectrogram in **its own window**, scrolling smoothly at the monitor's refresh rate. See *Spectrogram window* below. Works always.

How the sort mode and `SHIFT+n` work together

The sort mode in the pane title always tells you what is being sorted on:

Sort mode	Pane title shows	Sorted by
Folder order	`sort: folder order`	The order the files were found on disk
Title A-Z, `SHIFT+n` **off**	`sort: file name A-Z`	The file name
Title A-Z, `SHIFT+n` **on**	`sort: title A-Z`	The embedded title tag (falling back to the file name where there is none)
Artist A-Z	`sort: artist A-Z`	The artist tag (falling back to the artist guessed from the parent folder)
Recently added	`sort: recently added`	**Newest first**: when the file arrived in your library (the later of its modification time and its creation / change time, so a file you copied or downloaded into a music folder counts from then, even if it is an old recording). The times are read once and kept until the next rescan (`SHIFT+r`) or until you choose the mode again.

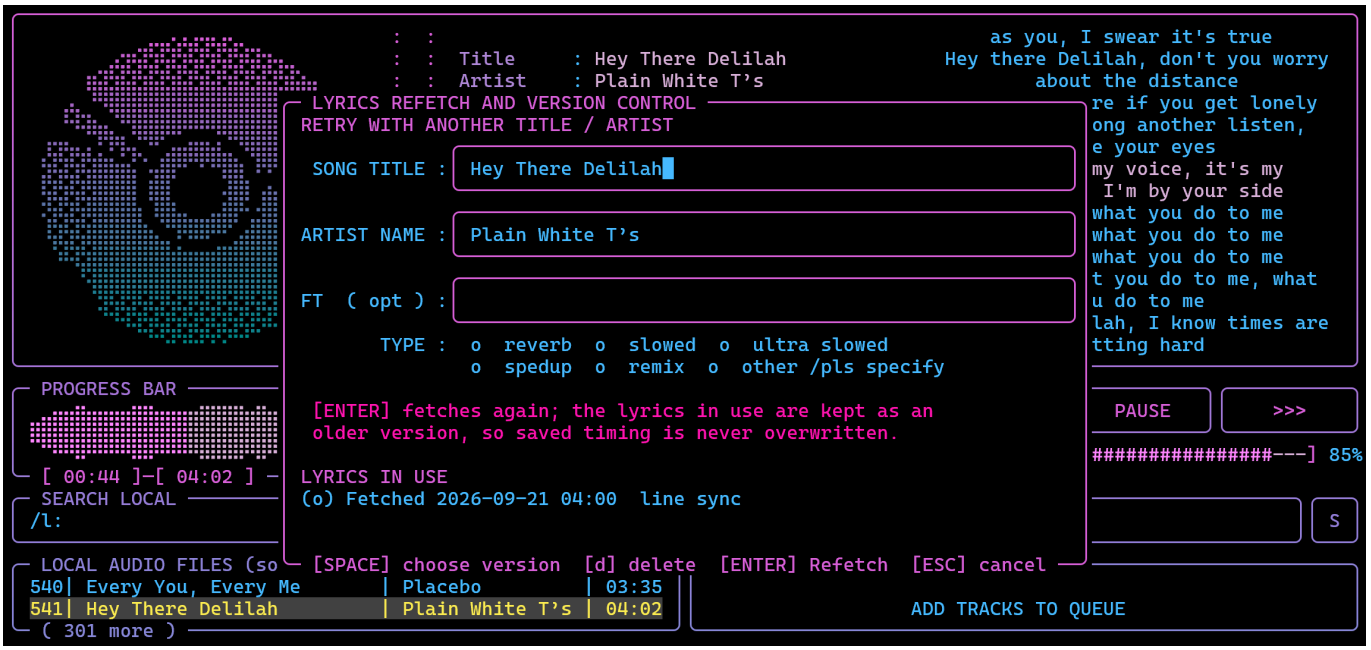
Toggling `SHIFT+n` re-sorts the list immediately and keeps your cursor on the same track.

A **search** always ranks by match quality, so while a query is active the sort mode is not used. It applies again once the query is cleared.

How the lyrics form (`l`) works

Key in the form	Function
`TAB` / `↓`	Next field
`↑`	Previous field
`SPACE`	Tick or untick a checkbox (slowed, ultra-slowed, sped up, reverb, remix, other). Slowed, ultra-slowed and sped up are mutually exclusive.
Typing	Fills the text fields: `←` / `→` move the caret, `SHIFT+←` / `SHIFT+→` mark, `HOME` / `END`, `DEL`, `CTRL+c` / `CTRL+x` / `CTRL+v` work as in every text box. A capital `A` or `B` is typed like any letter; only the arrow keys change the field.
`ENTER`	Fetch lyrics with these settings (works from any field)
`ESC`	Cancel

`l` also works with the lyrics engine off: the lyrics are fetched and kept for the karaoke mode and READ LYRICS overlay, and show in the lyrics field once the engine is switched on.



Lyrics timing overlay (ALT+L)

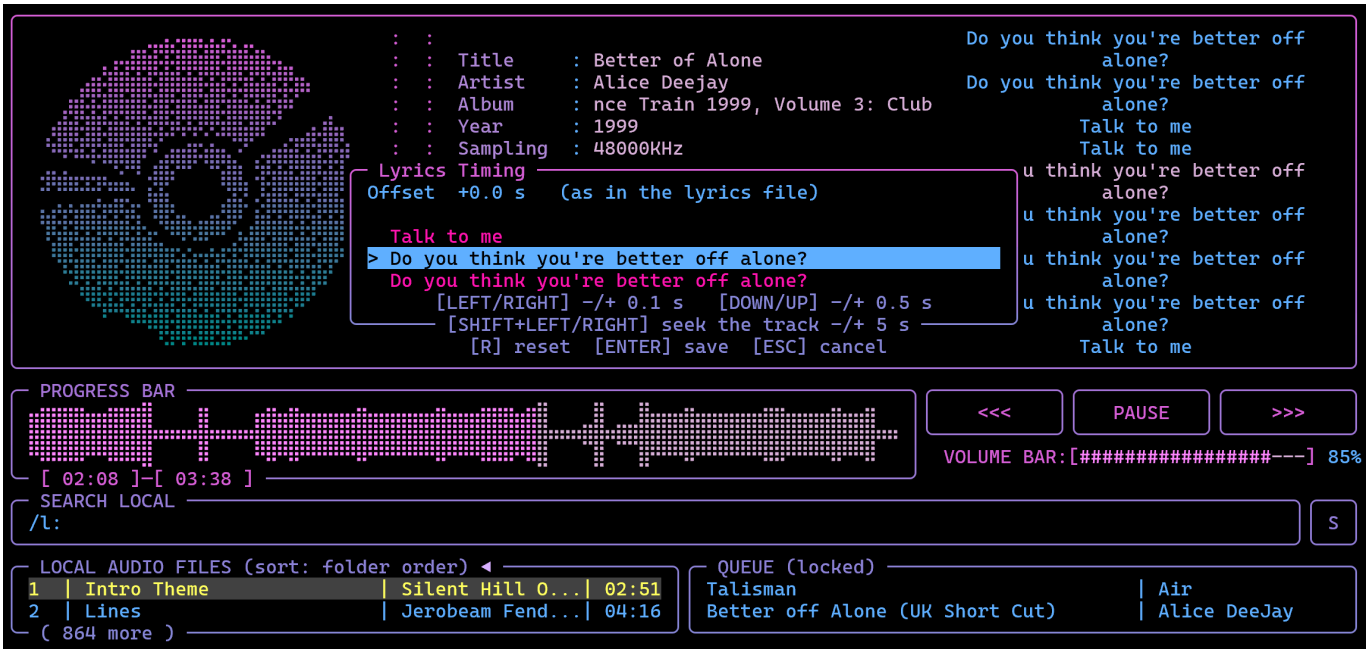
For tracks whose synced lyrics run ahead of or behind the music. The overlay shifts **all** lines (and, for word-synced lyrics, all words) of the playing track by the same amount. The change is visible **live** while the music plays, in the lyrics area and in the three lines shown in the overlay itself (previous, current and next line, with the current one highlighted). ALT+l (macOS: SHIFT+j) opens only while synced lyrics are loaded for the track; otherwise the status line says so. It opens **from the main screen and from inside the karaoke overlay** (k); opened from there, the panel floats over the big lyrics and closing it goes back to karaoke.

Key	What it does
→ / ←	Lyrics **later** / **earlier** by 0.1 s
↑ / ↓	Lyrics **later** / **earlier** by 0.5 s
SHIFT+→ / SHIFT+←	**Seek** the running track forward / back by 5 s, to hear a passage again while re-timing it
R	Back to 0 (the timing as it is in the lyrics file)
ENTER or S	**Save** the offset into the track's lyrics file and close
ESC or ALT+l (macOS: SHIFT+j)	Cancel: the offset from before the overlay was opened comes back (back to karaoke when it was opened from there). Different timed versions can also be managed in the refetch overlay (l) and delted from there.

- A **positive** offset (+0.3 s) means the lyrics appear later than their timestamps say, so use it when the lyrics are **too early**. A negative offset makes them appear earlier. The range is ±120 s.
- Saving writes a standard [offset:...] tag at the top of the track's .lrc file (in the lyrics folder next to the track, in milliseconds, with the usual LRC sign convention: positive = earlier). The timestamps themselves are not changed. The offset is read back whenever the lyrics are loaded from that file, and other players that know the tag use it too. Saving 0 in the file removes the tag.
- The offset belongs to **one track's lyrics file**. Fetching the lyrics again with l (retry) only overwrites the file when the fetched text **and** offset are identical to it; if the text or the offset differs (for example

because you re-timed the lyrics), your current copy is kept as an older version. If there is no lyrics file for the track, the offset still applies until the track changes, but saving reports that it could not be saved.

- While the overlay is open, SHIFT+← / SHIFT+→ seek the running track, so you can re-time the lyrics against the music.



READ LYRICS overlay (CTRL+L)

Reads the lyrics saved for the **playing** track (when nothing plays: the track hovered in the list) as plain text, and translates them on request. It is a full-screen overlay; playback keeps running but the lyrics wont change when a track change and lyrics can also be searched for, so it is an independent menu/overlay that just opens lyrics of the current track if lyrics are given when opened...

NOTE/LIMITATION: Some tracks may show some words split into syllables. This is due how those files are structured. The other option would be that all words are bound together... The overlay does not allow for adjustments of that but I think it is something that one can live with.

Key	What it does
TAB	Move the keys between the two top panes: **READ LYRICS** (the lyrics files) and **TRANSLATION** (the saved translations). The pane that has them carries a ◀
← / →	Choose in the pane that has the keys: the lyrics file, or the translation (the chosen translation is shown)
d / DEL	In the TRANSLATION pane: **delete** the chosen translation (asks for y)
↑ / ↓	Scroll one row. SHIFT+↑ / SHIFT+↓ (or SPACE / b): one page up / down. HOME / END: top / bottom
t	Opens the **translate overlay**: service, language to translate into, language of the lyrics. ENTER there **fetches** the translation, ESC closes it. This is the only place that fetches and may take a bit to complete.
SHIFT+t	**Show / toggle / hide** the saved translations (a translation that exists is shown at once when a file is opened or finished). It never fetches: hidden → first translation

Key	What it does
	→ next translation … → hidden
`e`	**Export** the lyrics: a small overlay (`←` / `→` choose, `ENTER` writes, `ESC` closes) offers *Original only*, *Original* + *translation* (the translation that is shown, when one is saved), *Original* + *transliteration* (the Latin spelling of kana, Hangul and Chinese characters, when the lyrics have any) and *Original* + *transliteration* + *translation*. The text file goes into an **`export`** folder inside the lyrics folder (`<music folder>/lyrics/export/`), named after the track and what it holds (`Song (translation en).txt`); with extra lines each original line is followed by its transliteration and translation and a blank line, the stanza breaks stay. An export with the same contents replaces the earlier one. The Latin spelling of kanji comes from the kanji reader in the background (the lines are handed to it as soon as the lyrics open); if it has not finished when you press `ENTER`, the overlay says how many lines are left, and a second `ENTER` exports anyway (the kanji then stay as they are in those lines). The overlay names the folder and the file before you press `ENTER`
`p`	**Play / pause** the track of the reader: it starts when it is not the loaded one (the reader stays open), otherwise it pauses / resumes
`SHIFT+←` / `SHIFT+→`	Seek 5 s back / forward (only while this track is the loaded one)
`f`	**Follow** the song on / off. Scrolling by hand turns it off
`l` (`HKeyRetryLyrics`)	The lyrics **re-fetch and version control** form, as on the main screen, for the track that plays (start it with `p` first). `ESC` or the fetch returns to the reader, which loads the new lyrics when they have arrived
`a` or `CTRL+n`	**Add manually**: assigns a `.lrc` / `.txt` file to a track by hand. An overlay opens with two search bars side by side (left **LYRICS FILE**, right **TRACK**) and below each its result list: **LYRICS FILE** searches every `lyrics` folder of the library, subfolders included (a full path typed in works too), **TRACK** searches the library; its first entry is always **Current track** (the track the reader shows). `TAB` moves between the lyrics list, the track list and the button **Add chosen lyrics to chosen/current song** at the bottom; `←→`/`↑↓` pick; `ENTER` in a list **locks** the highlighted lyrics file / track in (marked `»` in the header colour; the **Current track** is locked in by default; the locked-in panes below the lists show both (a lyrics file that was already added to the locked track by hand shows there as locked in, with the note *Added manually; hit DEL to unassign*), plus what lyrics the locked track already has), `ENTER` on the button adds; the overlay is a full-window screen with a bordered pane for each part and a key legend underneath, laid out like the one of READ LYRICS (it shortens its labels on a narrow window) (search fields, result lists with a count line each, locked-in fields); **`CTRL+t`** (also while typing in a search field) switches the track list between *artist* - *title* and **file names** (the pane title says what is on: `TRACKS (file names)`; the search follows the shown form); **`CTRL+f`** shows only the tracks **without saved lyrics** (`TRACKS (… , no lyrics)`; lyrics embedded in the audio file do not count); `PgUp` / `PgDn` and `SHIFT+↑↓` turn a page in the list that has the focus; **`CTRL+c`** (from anywhere, also in a search field) **clears the choice**

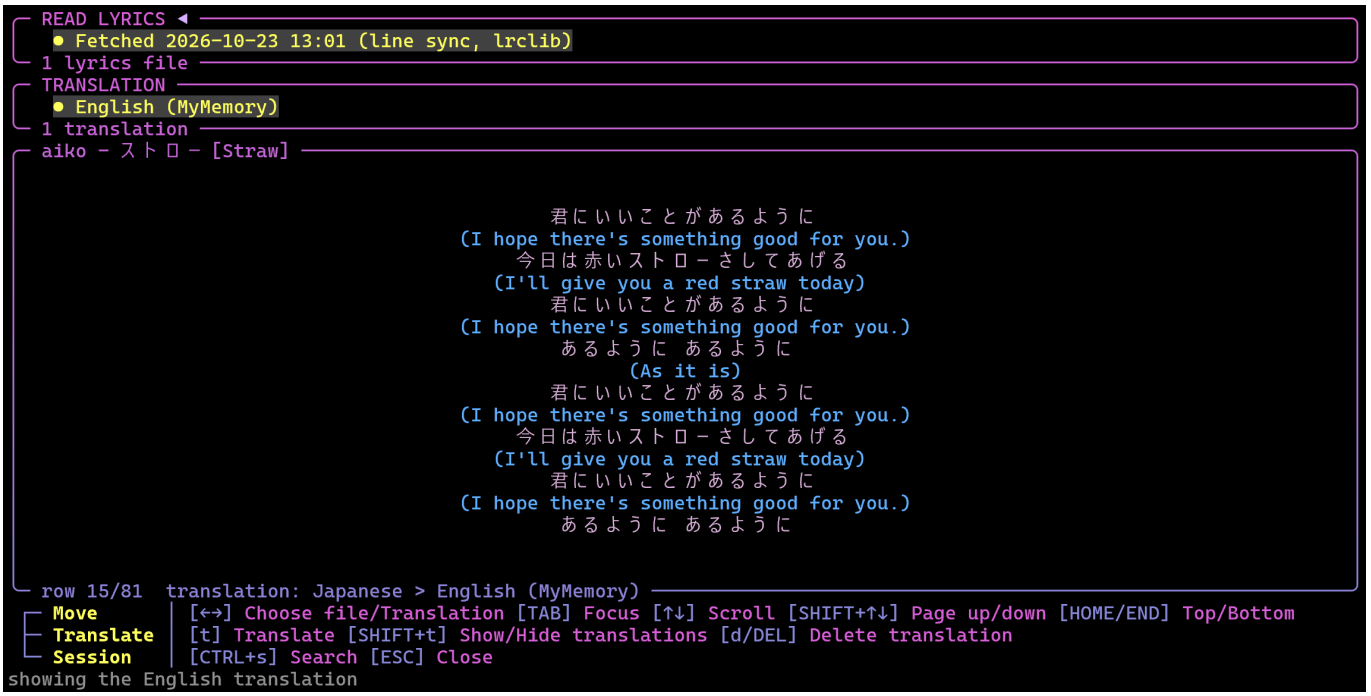
Key	What it does
	(the lyrics file is unlocked and the current track is the locked track again); `ESC` closes. The lyrics in use so far are put aside as an older version (nothing is lost) and the file becomes the copy in use, tagged `manual`; for the track that plays it loads at once. `DEL` (twice, the second press confirms) **unassigns** the manually added lyrics of the **locked-in track**: that copy is taken out of use and the newest older copy comes back; the lyrics file itself is never touched or deleted
`ALT+L` (macOS: `SHIFT+j`; `HKeyLyricsTiming`)	The **lyrics timing overlay**, as on the main screen: shifts all lines of the playing track earlier / later, live in the reader; `ENTER` saves into the lyrics file. Only for the track that plays and has synced lyrics loaded; otherwise the message goes to the status log (`t`)
`CTRL+s`	**Search the lyrics files** (see below): every lyrics file of the library by file name, as an alternative to the lyrics of the playing track
`ESC`, `q` or `CTRL+L`	Close

Lyrics by file name (the way it worked before *Add manually*). Mousiki finds lyrics for a track by name: a file called exactly like the track, with the extension `.lrc`, in the `lyrics` folder next to the track (`Music/Artist/Song.mp3` → `Music/Artist/lyrics/Song.lrc`); an `.lrc` right next to the track (`Music/Artist/Song.lrc`) is read as well. So you could always add your own lyrics by copying and renaming a file by hand. *Add manually* does that for you: it needs no renaming (any name, also `.txt`), it can take a file from any `lyrics` folder (or a path you type) for any track of the library, it keeps the lyrics that were in use as an older version, and it can be undone with `DEL`.

Search lyrics files (`CTRL+s`). Opens a small **SEARCH LYRICS FILES** panel over the reader. It lists every `.lrc` / `.txt` file in the `lyrics` folders of your library: the `lyrics` folder inside each folder that holds your tracks, inside each music folder from Settings → PATHS and inside the download cache. The list is read when the panel opens. Type to filter by **file name** (every word you type has to be in the name, in any order, upper / lower case does not matter), ↑ / ↓ pick (`HOME` / `END` jump), `ENTER` shows the file in the reader, `BACKSPACE` deletes a letter, `ESC` or `CTRL+s` closes the panel. A row shows the file name and, in brackets, the folder it belongs to. The chosen file is read like a track's own lyrics: plain text, centred, and `t` translates it (the translation is saved in `translations/` of that file's own lyrics folder, and found there again). It stays until you close the reader with `ESC` or `CTRL+L`; opening the reader again shows the lyrics of the playing track.

- The **READ LYRICS pane** is one line with the lyrics files of the track: the lyrics embedded in the audio file, the fetched copy in use (marked ●) and the older copies that a refetch put aside (see *How the lyrics form works*). The line scrolls sideways when the files do not fit; ◀ / ▶ show that there are more.
- The **TRANSLATION pane** is one line with the translations saved for the chosen file, e.g. `● English (Google Translate) | English (MyMemory) | French (MyMemory)`; ● marks the one that is shown. A file keeps **one translation per language and per service**: translating into English with MyMemory does not touch the Google translation, and translating again with the same service replaces only that service's translation. Below the pane, the border says how many there are, or that one is being fetched.
- The text below is the plain lyrics: timestamps, word timings and tags such as `[ar:…]` are removed and runs of empty lines become one. The lyrics are **centered**, with two blank rows above and below them.

- **Playing along (`p`).** While the track of the reader is the loaded one, the lyrics are drawn the way the lyrics engine draws them: the active line in the active colour, the words already sung highlighted (and the animation of Settings → Lyrics, when one is set), the Latin letters when they are on; the view scrolls along (`f` switches that off; any scrolling does too) and the translation below the active line is lit with it. The border shows the position (`playing 1:12 / 3:40`). The timing is the one of the file shown (its `[offset:]` included); lyrics without time stamps are spread over the track like in the karaoke view. A lyrics file that was opened with `CTRL+s` has no track to play.
- **Translating (`t`).** Use `↑` / `↓` to pick a row of the overlay and `←` / `→` to change it (a letter jumps to the next language starting with it); `ENTER` fetches, `ESC` closes (the choice is saved in `config.txt`).
  - **Service** – *Google Translate* (default): the key-less web endpoint of Google Translate. It is unofficial and rate limited; the lyrics are sent in a few large requests and a `429` ("too many requests") is retried with growing pauses. If it still answers `429`, wait a minute or pick another service. *MyMemory*: free and key-less, about 5000 characters a day per address (set the environment variable `MOUSIKI_MYMEMORY_EMAIL` to raise that); it translates line by line and is slower. (LibreTranslate was dropped: it needs a paid API key.)
  - **Translate into** – the target language (about 60 are listed). Default: English.
  - **Lyrics are in** – *Auto-detect* (default; the service finds out the language) or a language of your choice. Set it by hand when the detection was wrong, for example for short lyrics or mixed languages.
  - Python 3 and an internet connection are required (the helper is `scripts/translate_lyrics.py`). Lyrics that are already in the target language are reported as such and nothing is saved.
- **A translation takes a while** and runs in the background: opening or closing the translate overlay, choosing another file or closing READ LYRICS does **not** stop it, and it is saved when it is done (the main screen tells when READ LYRICS is closed). While it runs, pressing `ENTER` for another one shows a **warning** instead of starting it. The translation is shown in `( )` **right below the original line**.
- Translations are saved in the lyrics folder, in an extra `translations` folder: `<folder of the track>/lyrics/translations/<name>.<language>.<service>.txt` (one file per lyrics file, target language and service, for example `.en.google.txt`, `.en.mymemory.txt` and `.fr.google.txt`; files from older versions without the service in the name are still read and are replaced by the next translation of the same service). Next time they are read from there, without a connection; delete one in the TRANSLATION pane. When the lyrics are fetched again, a saved translation no longer fits and is ignored.



READ LYRICS with a translation shown below the lines.

The oscilloscope (lyric visual)

When there are no lyrics to show (lyrics engine off, nothing found, or the fetch is still running) the lyrics area is filled by a **lyric visual**. Messages such as *fetching lyrics ...* or *No synchronized lyrics found* appear for a moment as a **small box over the bottom of the visual**, which keeps its full size (it no longer shrinks by a row, so a spectrogram does not jump). With Settings → ANIMA/VIZ → **Lyrics/Viz Default** (or **When No Lyrics Show**, while the lyrics view has no lyrics) set to `osci` (or after pressing `,/.` to the oscilloscope view) that visual is an **XY/YT oscilloscope** instead of the sphere or spectrogram.

What it can do, in short:

- **XY oscilloscope** of the music (left channel = horizontal, right = vertical), with an automatic **phase portrait** for mono tracks, a **45° mid/side view** and an automatic or (in *osci music mode*) fixed scale -- the mode for **oscilloscope music**, which then gets the decoded signal before EQ, normalization and volume. What is an XY mode oscilloscope anyway? It models the amplitudes of each of the stereo channels and is usually used to detect phase changes. Assume to plain sine waves on each channel in sync then the XY mode oscilloscope will show a diagonal line (which is the case for mono channels, at least when the setting "Mono Phase Portrait" is set of in the oscilloscope settings). If they are out of synch by 90° magnitude it will show a circle...
- A **YT mode** next to the XY figure: the classic time-domain scope (amplitude over time, triggered), alone, **on top of the XY figure** (*XY + YT (overlap)*), **below it in a row of its own** (*XY + YT (row)*) or **next to it in a column of its own** (*XY + YT (col)*, XY left, YT right) -- overlay row *Scope mode*. A full-screen view shows both side by side (`SHIFT+0`, below).
- Two **styles**: **braille** characters in any terminal, or an **image** -- a real pixel picture with a glowing beam -- in terminals with Kitty graphics or Sixel (Windows Terminal 1.22+, WezTerm, Kitty, foot ...).
- A **phosphor** look: afterglow (Decay), a bright head and a fading tail, smooth anti-aliased lines between the samples (or only the sample dots), a **Z axis** that dims the beam by speed or brightens it by level, a trace length of 128 – 1024 samples.

- **Nine colour schemes**: the VIZ gradient of the settings, palettes that follow the beam speed (a rough "pitch" colour: temperature, aurora, magma, ice, neon, spectrum …), and **classic green**: one phosphor green for the whole picture, only the brightness of the beam varies, like an old scope.
- **30 – 165 frames per second**, and all values kept separately for each style. Higher values may lag, so you might just want to keep this between 30 and 90 and switch to the window mode for your screens refresh rate...
- A separate **scope window** (), German SHIFT+9, English SHIFT+0) drawn by the graphics card at the monitor's refresh rate, which draws every sample. For this the brightness of the lines were adjusted, since they used to fade strongly when the window was set to full screen.

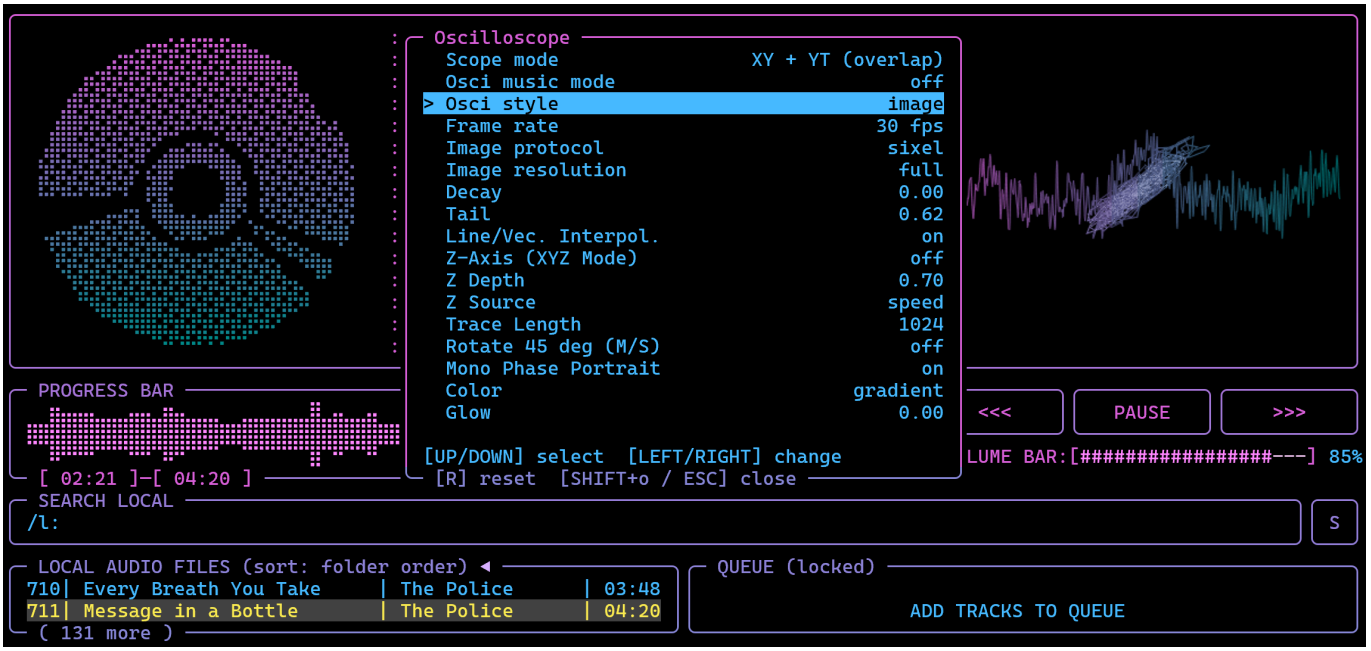
How it draws. Like a real scope in X-Y mode, the **left channel moves the beam horizontally and the right channel moves it vertically**. A track with a wide stereo image fills the area with a cloud, a pure tone with a phase shift between the channels draws an ellipse, and out-of-phase material leans the other way. The picture is drawn into the largest centred square of the lyrics area, so circles stay circles. A quiet track is boosted automatically, so it still fills the area.

Mono tracks. In a true XY scope a mono signal (left = right) can only draw a diagonal line (no phase shift can be detected here, so to speak). When a track is (nearly) mono, the scope therefore fades over to a *phase portrait* of the signal instead (the signal against its own rate of change), which draws loops and circles whose shape follows the sound. The switch is smooth, so a track hovering near the limit does not flicker.

Look. The trace is drawn with smooth, anti-aliased lines. Like the phosphor of an old oscilloscope it leaves a short **afterglow** that fades out, and the newest part of the trace is brighter than the oldest. The colour is the **VIZ** gradient (Settings → Colors → VIZ) running left to right, dimmed where the beam is weaker, so the fading trail also fades in colour.

Oscilloscope tuning overlay (SHIFT+o)

Opens a window in the middle of the screen where the look of the oscilloscope can be changed **while the music plays**. It sits clear of the lyrics area, so you can watch the scope while you adjust it. The same overlay exists in the radio (on the same key).



Key	Action
↑ / ↓	Select a row (wraps around)
← / →	Decrease / increase the selected value, or step through its choices
R	Reset the rows of the style in use to their defaults
ESC or SHIFT+o	Close the overlay. The values are **saved to `config.txt`** when it closes.
SHIFT+i / SHIFT+u	Switch straight to the **spectrogram** options / full screen, without closing this overlay first (the values are saved).

Playback keeps running while the overlay is open, but its keys are the only ones that react until you close it. The overlay opens on every main screen. The rows are:

Row	Choices / range	What it does
Scope mode	XY / YT / XY + YT (overlap) / XY + YT (row) / XY + YT (col)	Which picture the scope draws (`OsciMode=` `xy`, `yt`, `overlap`, `row` or `col`; one setting for both styles). **XY**: the beam figure described above. **YT**: the classic time-domain scope -- the signal (left and right mixed) runs from left to right, amplitude up and down, and a **trigger** (a rising zero crossing, with a small noise guard) starts every picture at the same point of the wave, so a steady tone stands still instead of crawling. The **Trace Length** row sets how many samples fit across the width (fewer = zoomed in, a few periods of a bass note; more = a longer stretch). **XY + YT (overlap)** draws the YT trace *on top of* the XY figure in the same buffer, the trace a little dimmer, with one shared afterglow and palette. **XY + YT (row)** gives each its own half of the area: the XY figure in the top half, the YT trace in the bottom half. **XY + YT (col)** does the same side by side: the XY figure in the left half, the YT trace in the right half. Decay, Dot threshold, Line/Vec. Interpol., Color, Glow, the style (braille / image), the frame rate and Osci music mode (fixed scale instead of automatic size) apply to every picture; Tail, Z-Axis, Rotate 45 deg and Mono Phase Portrait only shape the XY figure. The scope window (SHIFT+9) follows the mode too (see *Scope window*).
Osci style	braille / image	**braille**: the scope is drawn with Braille characters. **image**: a real pixel picture with glow, drawn by the terminal itself (see *Image style* below).
Frame rate	30 / 45 / 60 / 90 / 120 / 165 fps	Kept **per style**: the braille and the image scope each have their own frame rate (and all their other values), and the one of the style in use applies. How often the screen (and the scope) is redrawn. Only the lines that changed are sent, so 120 and 165 work in a fast terminal (Windows Terminal, WezTerm, Kitty, Alacritty ...) on a monitor with that refresh rate; a terminal never shows more frames than its monitor does. At 165 fps the radio's screen is about 2.3 MB/s of output and about a quarter of one CPU core; if the terminal lags behind, step down. The image style sends at most 60 pictures per second whatever the frame rate (see below).

Row	Choices / range	What it does
Osci music mode	on / off	Kept per style (braille and image each have their own). For **oscilloscope music** (tracks composed so that the scope draws pictures, e.g. Jerobeam Fenderson's): the scopes get the **decoded signal itself**, before the equalizer, normalization, limiter, volume and the mono fold (what you hear does not change); the picture keeps a **fixed scale** (full level = the edge) instead of adjusting its size to the loudness; the mono phase portrait is off. The scope window (which follows the *image* style's setting) then also smooths more between the samples and draws a finer beam (see *Scope window*). The XY figure is then drawn like a real CRT: **every sample since the last picture** is drawn exactly once (a figure is never cut to Trace Length and broken into dots), the curve between the samples is smoothed, and the beam **adds its light** to the phosphor in proportion to the time it spends on a spot: slow strokes and corners are bright, the fast jumps between shapes nearly vanish (so Line/Vec. Interpol. adds no extra lines), parts that stand still stay crisp and moving parts leave a soft trail. The afterglow then fades per sample, not per frame; the picture is equally bright at any frame rate, and parts that stand still are equally bright at any Decay (Decay only sets how long a moving figure trails). Files **below 96 kHz** (44.1 / 48 kHz) round the jumps between shapes off over a few samples; with *Low-rate blanking* on (the default) moves faster than any stroke are faded out as jumps -- the small wiggles a 48 kHz file has along sharp corners are part of the file and stay. All of this is the **CRT** *Beam*; set it to **classic** for the look from before (the newest Trace Length samples, max-blended, with the occasional line around the edges) -- the braille style starts with *classic*. For the look of osci-render, set **Decay to about 0.10** in this mode, **Image resolution to full** and, if the terminal keeps up, **Image detail to high**. For the full effect, play lossless files (FLAC / WAV): MP3, AAC, Opus and internet radio round off corners and blur lines.
Beam	CRT / classic	Kept per style (`OsciCrtBeam=` / `OsciImageCrtBeam=`), with and without Osci music mode. **CRT** (default of the image style): every sample is drawn once and adds light by the time the beam spends on a spot -- in music mode clean figures without jump lines, with ordinary music a glowing core where the beam lingers and faint fast strokes around it. **classic** (default of the braille style): the look from before -- the newest *Trace Length* samples with the *Tail* fade, max-blended, straight lines between the samples; busier, with the jumps between shapes drawn as lines. The scope window follows it.
Dwell brightness	on / off	Only shown with the CRT beam (with or without music mode), kept per style (`OsciDwellBrightness=`, on by default). **on**: the beam's light follows the time it spends on a spot -- slow strokes bright, the fast jumps between shapes nearly invisible. **off**: every stroke is equally bright, so the jump lines (often a frame around the edges of the picture) show again, while the rest

Row	Choices / range	What it does
		of the CRT beam (every sample once, soft trails) stays. Also in the scope window.
Low-rate blanking	on / off	Only shown in Osci music mode with the CRT beam, kept per style (`OsciLowRateBlanking=`, on by default). For files below 96 kHz (44.1 / 48 kHz): moves faster than any stroke are faded out as jumps between shapes. Files at 96 kHz and above are never touched. Also in the scope window.
Rough mode	on / off	Only shown without Osci music mode, kept per style (`OsciRoughMode=` / `OsciImageRoughMode=`; on by default for braille, off for image). This was actually a suboptimal previous version, but looked cool to me and is therefor kept as a mode: The automatic size follows the *previous* picture's loudest point only, as in Mousiki 2.x: when a beat suddenly gets louder, the new picture is too big and the beam is clamped to the edges, so it runs along the border of the square for a moment -- the rougher, livelier look of the old scope (the overlay shows *on (edge clipping)*). Off, the picture's own loudest point counts at once and nothing is clipped. Best seen with the classic beam (the CRT beam dims the clipped stretches).
Image protocol	auto / kitty / sixel / off	Image style only: which terminal graphics protocol is used.
Image resolution	third / half / full	Image style only: the picture is drawn at a third, half or the full resolution of the screen area and enlarged on the way to the terminal. Lower = much less work and data per picture (half: about a quarter of the drawing work and half the Sixel data) and a smoother scope at high frame rates; the beam gets softer and a little wider. Default `half`.
Image detail	normal / high	Image style only (`OsciImageDetail=`): the widest picture that is drawn. **normal** = up to 560 pixels across (640 per picture in the big overlay), **high** = up to 1024 (1280): thinner, sharper lines and finer small figures, best together with *Image resolution* full. High means up to about three times the pixels per picture -- easy for Kitty, but with Sixel (Windows Terminal) lower the frame rate if the picture stutters.
Decay	0.00 – 0.99	The **afterglow**. Each frame the picture is dimmed by this factor, so higher values leave longer trails. `0.00` shows only the current trace. Values near `0.99` smear for a long time.
Dot threshold	0.01 – 1.00	Braille style only. How bright a point must be before it is drawn. **Lower** values give a thicker, softer line with a long fade. **Higher** values give a thin, sharp core, but fast parts of the trace can break into gaps.
Tail	0.00 – 1.00	The brightness of the **oldest** part of the trace compared with the newest (`1.00`). Low values give a comet with a bright head and a fading tail, `1.00` makes the trace uniformly bright.

Row	Choices / range	What it does
Glow	0.00 – 1.00 (step 0.05)	Image style only: how strongly the line glows.
Line/Vec. Interpol.	on / off	Connects the sample points with smooth lines.
Z-Axis (XYZ Mode)	on / off	Lets the beam brightness follow a third signal, like a real XYZ scope.
Z Depth	0.00 – 1.00 (step 0.05)	How strongly the Z signal dims the beam.
Z Source	speed / level	`speed`: the faster the beam moves, the dimmer it gets (like a CRT). `level`: the further from the centre, the brighter.
Trace Length	128 – 1024 samples (step 128), then 2048 / 4096 / 8192	How much of the signal is drawn at once. In the YT picture it is the time span (1024 samples = 21 ms at 48 kHz, 8192 = 170 ms); in the XY picture, how much of the recent path is drawn. Longer traces take more time to draw.
Rotate 45 deg (M/S)	on / off	Rotates the picture by 45°, so mid/side (mono/stereo difference) lies on the axes.
Mono Phase Portrait	on / off	Fades a (nearly) mono signal over to a *phase portrait* (see *The oscilloscope*). Off draws the plain diagonal line.
Color	gradient, settings, temperature, aurora, magma, ice, neon, spectrum, classic green	`gradient` uses the VIZ colours of **Settings** → **COLORS**. The palettes in the middle follow the beam speed. **classic green** is a single phosphor green (`Palette=green` in the config files) with the brightness of the beam as the only variation -- the look of an old analog scope.

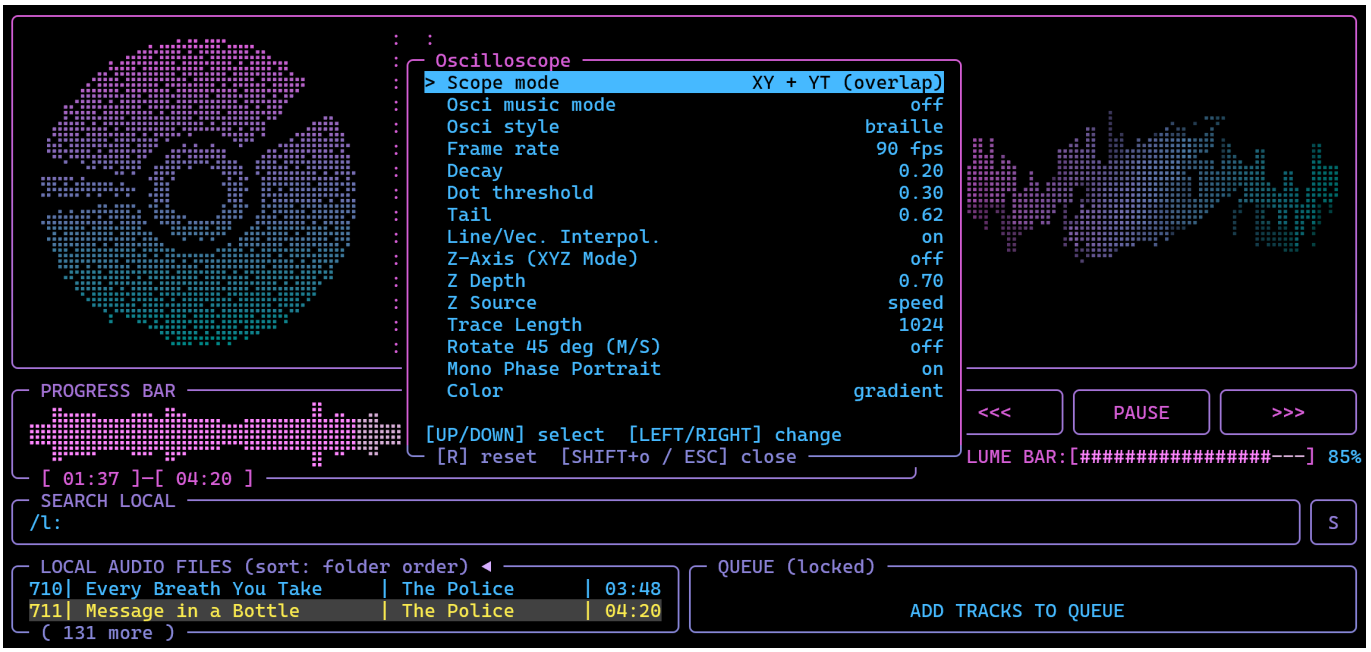
Each style keeps its own values. The braille and the image style have separate sets of every row -- Frame rate, Osci music mode, Decay, Tail, Glow and all the others (Image protocol and Image resolution exist only for the image style) - so switching the style does not lose your tuning; `R` resets only the style in use (its frame rate stays). Decay, threshold and tail move in steps of 0.01 (tail 0.02).

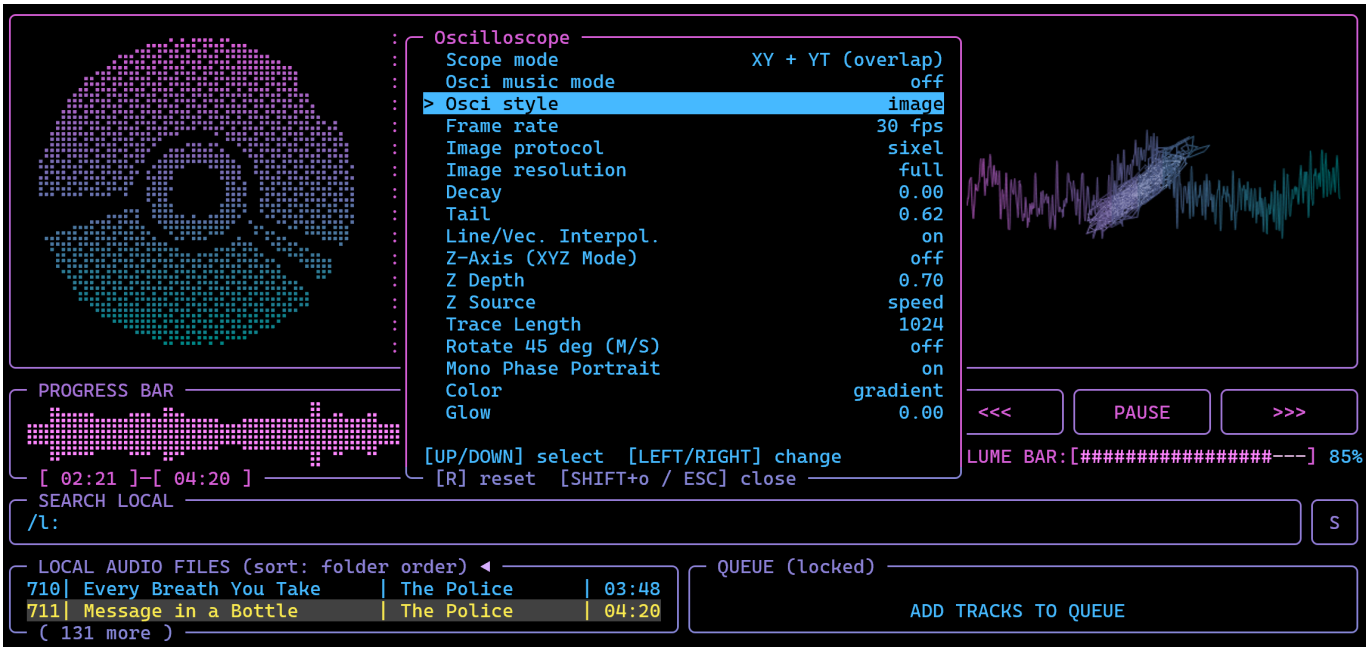
Two starting points for the braille style: for a crisp, "real oscilloscope" look try Decay `0.65`, Dot threshold `0.35`, Tail `0.60`. For a glowing, dreamy look try `0.90`, `0.20`, `0.25`.

Image style. The terminal draws the picture itself, via the **Kitty graphics protocol** (Kitty, WezTerm, Ghostty, Konsole ...) or **Sixel** (Windows Terminal 1.22+, foot, xterm ...). Without either, the braille scope stays.

`MOUSIKI_GFX=kitty|sixel|off` forces a protocol and `MOUSIKI_CELLPX=10x20` sets the cell size (otherwise it is asked from the terminal). In Windows Terminal a smaller Sixel picture is stretched vertically through the Sixel pixel aspect ratio (see below); `MOUSIKI_SIXEL_ASPECT=1` uses that in another terminal too (only useful where the terminal honours the aspect ratio). The scope sends at most as many pictures per second as the **Frame rate**, and never more than 60 with Kitty, 60 with Sixel at `half` / `third` resolution and 30 with Sixel at `full`. A picture is only sent when there is a new one: the text around it is drawn without touching the picture's cells. With Sixel, a smaller picture is enlarged by repeating its pixels (in Windows Terminal the rows through the Sixel pixel aspect ratio, so they are not sent twice); Kitty terminals scale the picture themselves. If the scope stutters, lower **Image resolution** or **Frame rate** first.

In radio mode the overlay is the same, with the radio's own values in `radio_config.txt`, and the environment variables are the same `MOUSIKI_GFX` and `MOUSIKI_CELLPX` (the older names `MOUSIKI_RADIO_GFX` / `MOUSIKI_RADIO_CELLPX` still work; see 11.4).





Oscilloscope full screen (`SHIFT+0`)

The oscilloscope over the whole screen, like the spectrogram's full screen (SHIFT+u), but with **both pictures at once**: the **YT** trace (amplitude over time) on the **left**, the **XY** figure (left channel horizontal, right channel vertical) on the **right**. Each has its own phosphor buffer, so both keep their own afterglow, but they show the same audio. The key is the character =: **SHIFT+0 on a German keyboard** (on an English one the = key itself; SHIFT+0 there types), the scope window). It is a normal key binding (HKeyScopeBig in the player, ScopeBig in the radio), so it can be changed on the REFERENCE tab.

- **Layout.** The two pictures are **boxes of the same size** that look square on screen (a character cell is about twice as high as wide, so a box has twice as many columns as rows): the horizontal grid lines of YT and XY are on the same screen rows. When the terminal is resized the boxes shrink or grow but keep their shape and stay in the middle; what is left over is empty margin. The title is the track (radio: station and song). The name of each picture is centred above its box, kept short so it never reaches into the other picture's field (*samp.*, *horiz.*, *vert.*; when the terminal is narrow the least important parts drop out first): the YT time span in the chosen unit, and what the XY axes are (left / right channel, or side / mid with *Rotate 45 deg*), plus the measurements picked in SHIFT+p. The bottom border only lists the keys (SHIFT+a grid, SHIFT+v values, SHIFT+c color, SHIFT+p metrics; on a narrow terminal the compact form SHIFT+a/v/c/p).

- **Look.** The overlay follows the **Osci style** of the SHIFT+o overlay and uses that style's own values (braille: Decay, Dot threshold, Trace Length, Line/Vec. Interpol., Color, Osci music mode ...; image: the glow, palette ... of the image style). With **braille** both pictures are drawn in braille dots. With **image** on a terminal that speaks the **Kitty graphics protocol** or **Sixel** (see *Image style* above) both pictures are real **pixel images**: smooth beams with glow, the grid, frame and axes as thin pixel lines under the beam (so they are not made of dotted characters), the axis values and names as text around them. Image resolution, Image protocol and the frame rate rule apply as in the main screen (the two pictures count double for Sixel, so lower *Image resolution* first if it stutters). The small windows (SHIFT+o, SHIFT+c, SHIFT+p) cut a hole into the pictures where they cover them. Without Kitty / Sixel the overlay draws braille, whatever *Osci style* says. *Scope mode* does not matter here: the two pictures are always YT and XY.

- **SHIFT+o** opens the oscilloscope options on top of it, so the look can be tuned while watching both pictures. ESC closes the options first, the overlay with the next ESC (or the overlay key again).

- **SHIFT+a** turns the **axes / grid** on or off (ScopeGrid= in the config files; **on by default**). Both pictures are drawn as a **box with a solid frame** (straight lines on all four sides at +-100 %): YT gets a solid zero line, dotted lines at every amplitude division and every time division; XY gets the two axes through the centre and dotted lines at every division. The number of divisions is set in SHIFT+p. The grid only shows where the trace is not, so it never changes how the trace looks.

- **SHIFT+v** adds the **axis values** (ScopeValues=, **on by default**, works with or without the grid): a column on the left of each box with the vertical axis (+100% ... 0 ... -100%, one value per division), and a row below it with the horizontal axis -- **milliseconds** under YT (0 to the full time span), **percent** under XY (-100 to +100). The values are not an AM modulation depth: they are **percent of the picture's scale**. With the automatic size (the default) 100 % is the loudest part of the signal, with *Osci music mode* it is full scale (what the converter can output). Each picture says it in a line below its box. The boxes become a little smaller to make room for the values. They use the grid colour.

- **SHIFT+c** opens a **small window** for the **grid colour**: type a number from **0 to 255** (the 256-colour palette; the window shows a swatch of the colour), ENTER accepts, ESC cancels, an empty value goes

back to the default, which is **the colour of inactive list elements** (the list text colour of your colour scheme). It is saved as `ScopeGridColor=`.

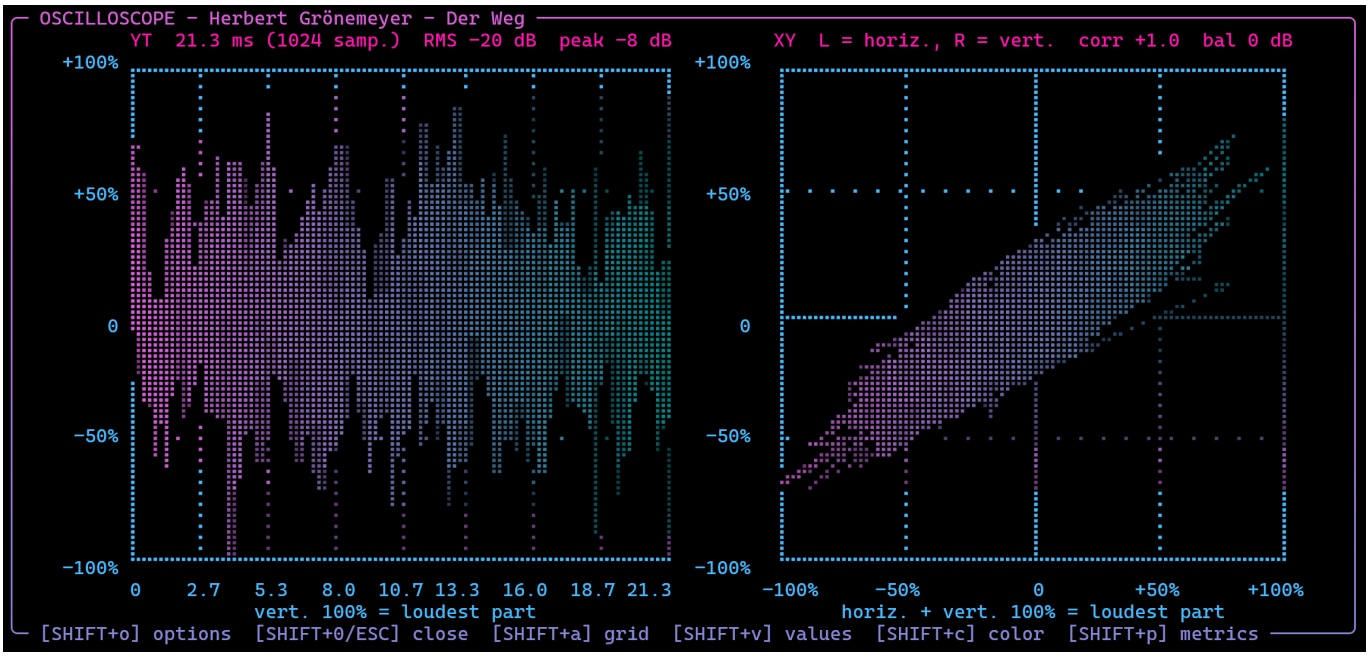
- `SHIFT+p` opens a **small window for the grid metrics**, separately for the YT and the XY picture (`UP/DOWN` select a row, `LEFT/RIGHT` change it, `R` resets everything, `SHIFT+p` or `ESC` close; every change is saved at once):

Picture	Row	Choices
YT	Time unit	**milliseconds** (default), **samples**, **divisions** (the name then shows *ms/div*)
YT	Time divisions	4, **8**, 10, 16 (vertical grid lines)
YT	Value divisions	2, **4**, 8, 10 (horizontal grid lines)
YT	Info	off, **RMS level** (the average loudness), **peak hold** (the highest peak of the last two seconds), or **both** (default) -- in dB, shown in the picture's name
XY	Divisions	2, **4**, 8, 10 (grid lines per axis)
XY	Info	off, **correlation** (`corr`, +1 = both channels identical / mono, 0 = unrelated, -1 = opposite phase), **balance** (`bal`, which channel is louder, e.g. `L+2 dB`), or **both** (default)

  The axis values are always percent of the picture, and each picture says so in a line below its box: *100% = loudest part* (the picture is scaled automatically so the loudest part of the signal fills the box) or, with *Osci music mode*, *100% = full scale*. They never change while the music plays, only when the grid settings change.

  The readouts are made to be read, not to flicker: This might be suboptimal but was hard to watch before, so RMS level, correlation and balance are averages over about a second, the peak is held for two seconds, and what is shown is refreshed only twice a second and rounded (whole dB, correlation to 0.1). Levels are in dBFS: 0 dB is the loudest a file can be (a full-scale sine has an RMS of -3 dB), typical music sits at about -20 to -10 dB RMS with peaks around -3 dB; `-- dB` means silence. They do not depend on the automatic size of the picture. Correlation tells how mono the sound is (values near +1 mean the picture is a thin diagonal in XY; near 0 a wide cloud; negative values are a mono-compatibility warning), balance whether the sound is leaning to one side. Config: `ScopeYtTimeUnit`, `ScopeYtTimeDiv`, `ScopeYtValueDiv`, `ScopeYtInfo` (`off|rms|peak|both`), `ScopeXyDiv`, `ScopeXyInfo` (`off|corr|balance|both`).

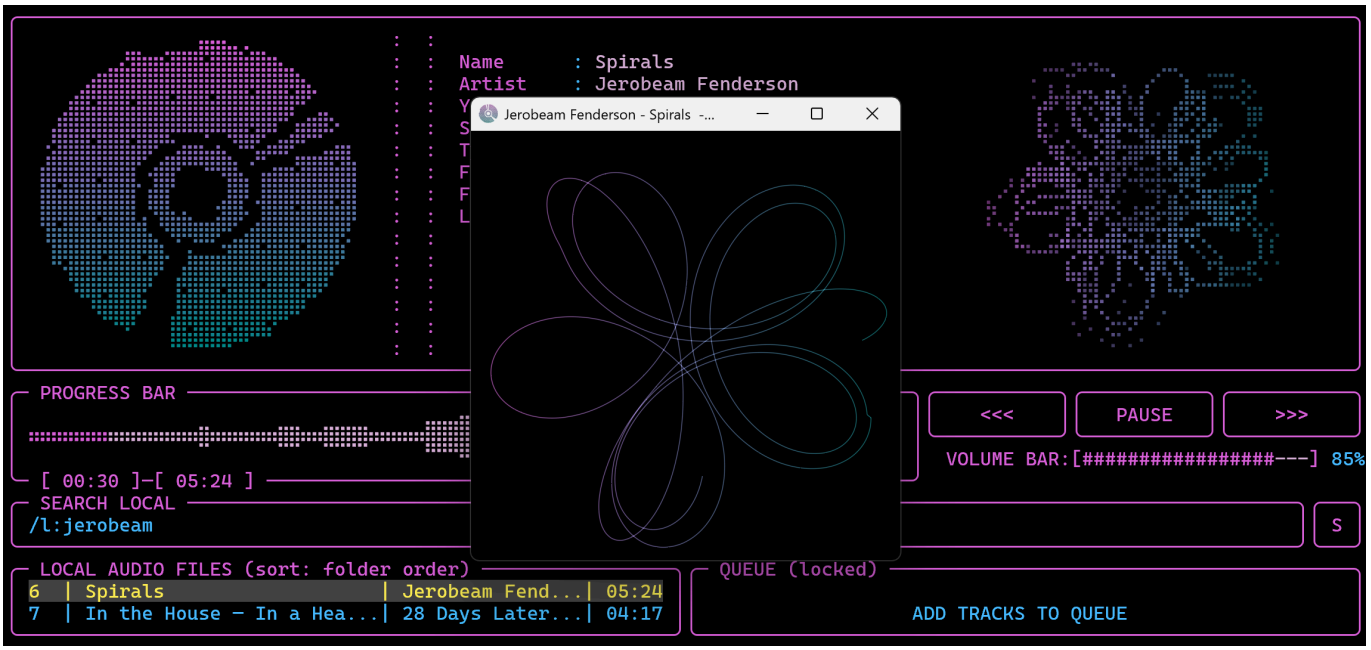
- The usual playback keys keep working. `SHIFT+u` (the spectrogram's full screen) replaces this overlay, and the other way round.



The big oscilloscope overlay with YT and XY pictures.

Scope window (): German SHIFT+9, English SHIFT+0)

The key that types) opens the oscilloscope in **its own window** next to the terminal (again: closes it). It is drawn by the graphics card, like an analog scope: **every sample** that is played is drawn once as a soft beam, the phosphor keeps an afterglow, dense parts of the trace glow brighter and a bloom lies around the beam. It runs at the refresh rate of your monitor (60, 120, 144 Hz …), independent of the terminal and of **Frame rate**. Integrated graphics are plenty; a dedicated graphics card is not needed! Above limitations had to do with KiTTY and sixel, are not a nowadays common hardware limitation...



Key (in the window)	Action
F, F11 or double-click	Fullscreen on / off
T	Always on top on / off

Key (in the window)	Action
`ESC`, `Q` or the key of `)` (`9` on a German, `0` on an English keyboard, with or without `SHIFT`)	Close the window (the `)` key in the terminal does the same)

- **The window follows the style of the `SHIFT+o` overlay.** With **Osci style = image** it is the smooth analog scope described above and uses the values of the *image* style: Decay (afterglow), Glow (bloom), Color palette, Z-Axis / Z Depth / Z Source, Rotate 45 deg, Mono Phase Portrait and Line/Vec. Interpol. (off = sample dots). Trace Length and Tail have no meaning there, because the window draws every sample exactly once. All scope modes (XY, YT, overlap, row, col) are drawn at the **full resolution of the window** as one smooth picture. They get their own brightness lift (`kImageBrightness` in `scope_window_app.cpp`, next to `kBeamAddLight`; higher = brighter), since otherwise lines used to fade away in full screen mode.
- **The scope mode follows too.** With *Scope mode* set to YT, *XY + YT (overlap)*, *XY + YT (row)* or *XY + YT (col)* in the `SHIFT+o` overlay the window draws that picture over its whole width (YT is a wide picture), in the dot style: in the *image* style the dots are simply finer and touch each other, because the smooth GPU beam only knows the XY figure -- so there the glow is missing in these four modes.
- **Braille style in the window.** With **Osci style = braille** the window shows the *braille* scope instead: the same dot grid as in the terminal (2 × 4 dots per cell, the same afterglow, brightness steps and colours), but every lit dot is a square on the screen -- so the braille look can be seen as large as the window, or the whole screen in fullscreen, goes. It uses the braille style's own values from the overlay: Decay, Dot threshold, Tail, Trace Length, Line/Vec. Interpol., Z-Axis, rotation, mono phase portrait, Color and Osci music mode. Changing the style in the overlay switches the open window at once. (The overlay itself is opened in the terminal; the window has no menu of its own.)
- **Smooth curves:** the window interpolates between the samples (Lanczos, to about 192 000 points per second, 384 000 in *Osci music mode*), like the output filter in front of a real scope, so fast strokes become curves and not small polygons. With **Line/Vec. Interpol.** off it draws only the real samples as dots.
- **Osci music mode** (`SHIFT+o`): the unprocessed signal, a fixed scale, no phase portrait, the finer beam and the stronger smoothing above, and - as in the terminal - the beam's light follows the time it spends on a spot, so the fast jumps between shapes nearly vanish and slow strokes stay bright: for oscilloscope music the figures come out as sharp as the file allows. Decay about 0.10 gives the look of osci-render.
- **Brightness** adjusts itself: a tone that retraces the same figure all the time would otherwise burn white, quiet sparse music would be faint.
- **Title**: the playing track (radio: station and song).
- The window remembers its position, size, fullscreen and always-on-top in `~/.config/mousiki/scope_window.txt` (on Windows `%USERPROFILE%\.config\mousiki\`). It stays open when you switch between player and radio and closes with Mousiki.
- **Needs SDL2** (2.0.18 or newer, zlib licence), which Mousiki loads when the window opens; nothing else in Mousiki needs it. The Windows installer and portable zip include `SDL2.dll`, and `setup.ps1` puts it next to `mousiki.exe` when you build yourself (or download `SDL2-<version>-win32-x64.zip` from github.com/libsdl-org/SDL/releases and copy `SDL2.dll` there). On Linux / macOS the system's SDL2 is used: the `.deb` recommends `libsdl2-2.0-0`, `setup.sh` installs it (`libsdl2-2.0-0`, `SDL2`, `sdl2`, `brew install sdl2`), and for the portable zips install it yourself (Ubuntu: `sudo apt install libsdl2-2.0-0`, macOS: `brew install sdl2`). Without it, the window keys (`)` / `(`) say what is missing.
- The window is a second copy of Mousiki (`mousiki --scope-window`) that gets the audio through a pipe. A graphics driver problem can therefore only close the window, never the player, and dragging

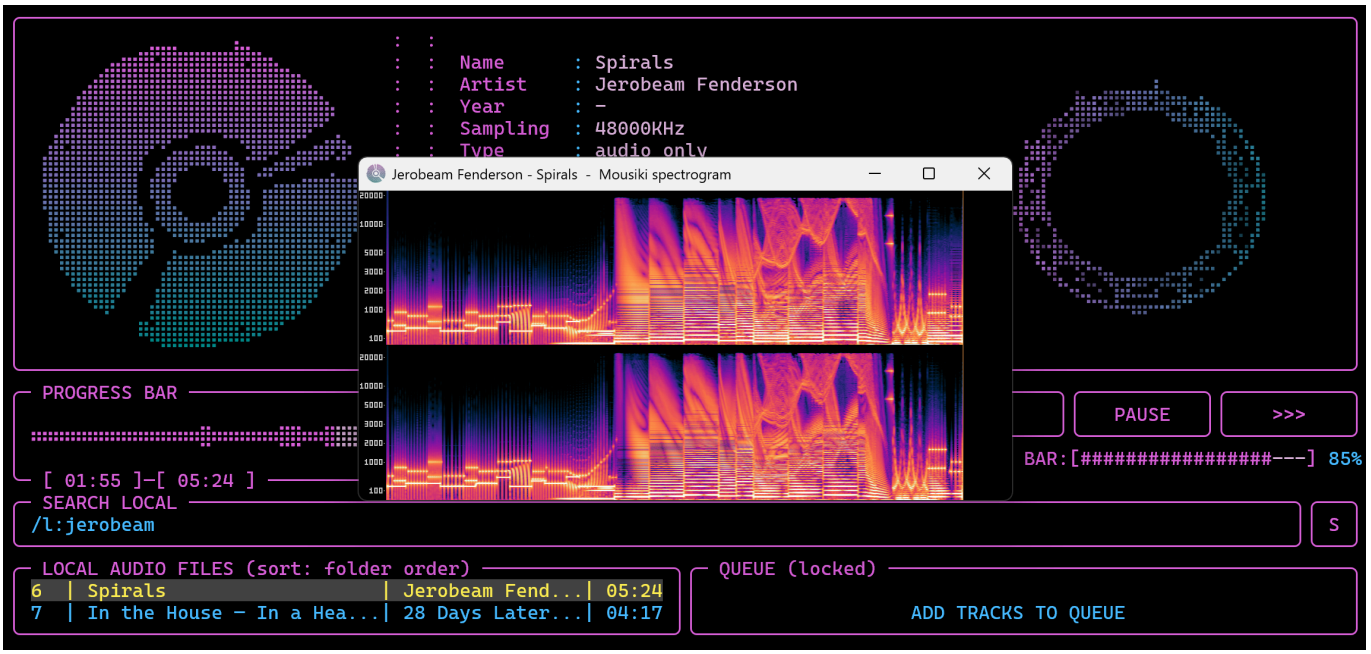
the window never stalls the music or the terminal. If the window cannot start, the status line shows why (the reason is also in `~/.cache/mousiki/scope_window_error.txt`). See status/log overlay via `t` to look at status messages.

Spectrogram window (`(`: German `SHIFT+8`, English `SHIFT+9`)

A spectrogram is a colorized/visualization of the short time (Fast) Fourier transform (ST(F)FT) of an audio signal, i.e. the visualizes the FFT of time points and shows the magnitude of different frequencies involved to form a signal at each time point.

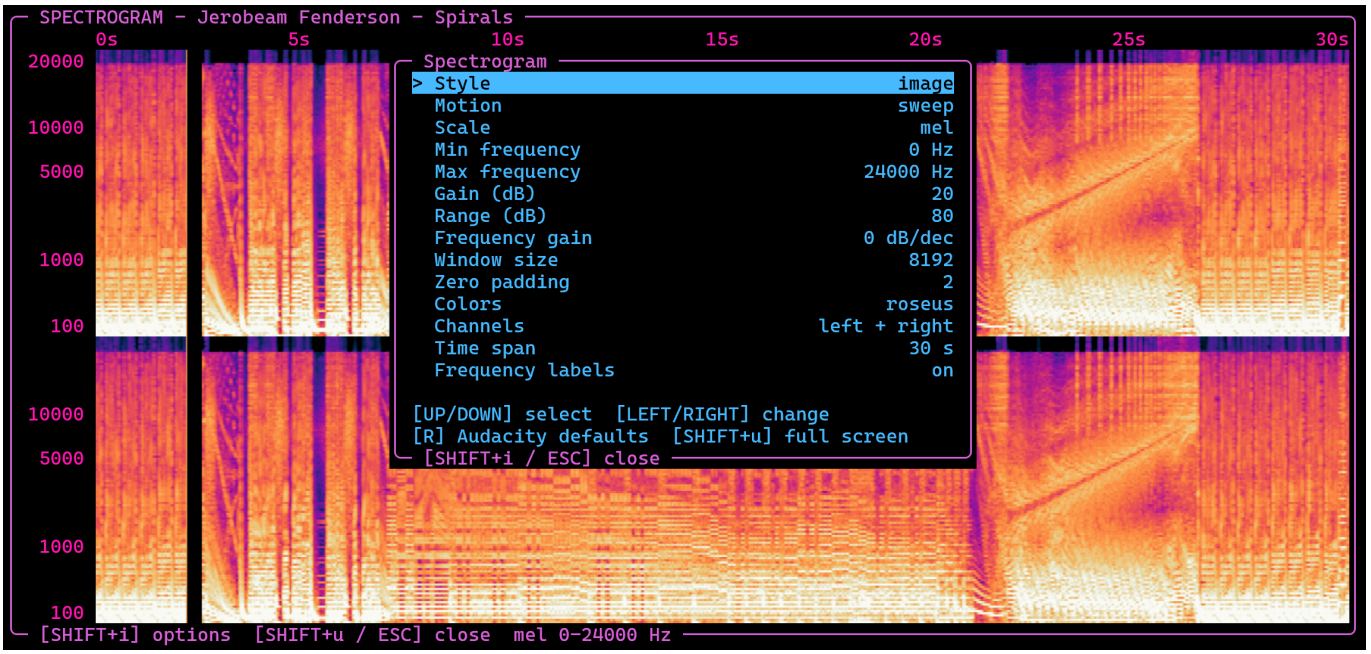
The key that types `(` opens the **spectrogram in its own window** (again: closes it), drawn by the graphics card like the scope window. This is the way to a **perfectly smooth** scrolling spectrogram: a terminal can only move a picture by whole pixels or cells, and only as often as it can take the data, while the window redraws at the monitor's refresh rate (60, 120, 165 Hz ...) and moves the picture by fractions of a pixel.

- **The same spectrogram:** the analysis is the one of the terminal spectrogram (Audacity's way, the decoded signal before EQ, normalization and volume), with the options of the `SHIFT+i` overlay - scale, frequencies, gain, range, frequency gain, window size, zero padding, colours (also *gradient* using the theme color gradient used for the disk set in the settings), channels, time span, labels and motion (*scroll* = the newest column on the right, moving smoothly; *sweep* = a page at a time with a playhead; lags in the in-terminal overlay so better use the window version for this mode; for the small field version in main UI the lag does not really appear that intense).
- **Frequency labels** on the left (Audacity's round numbers), when **Labels** is on.
- Keys in the window: `F`, `F11` or double-click fullscreen, `T` always on top, `ESC`, `Q` or the key of `(` (`8` on a German, `9` on an English keyboard, with or without `SHIFT`) close.
- The window mode works whatever the lyrics area / scope block shows and also while the spectrogram is switched off on the ANIMA/VIZ tab (so does the full screen, `SHIFT+u`: the switch only concerns the field in the main screen). It can be open at the same time as the scope window.
- Title: the playing track (radio: station and song; audio book: book and chapter). Position, size, fullscreen and always-on-top are kept in `~/.config/mousiki/spectro_window.txt`; it stays open when you switch between player and radio and closes with Mousiki.
- Wndowed version needs SDL2, like the scope window. It is a second copy of Mousiki (`mousiki --spectro-window`) that gets the audio through a pipe; if it cannot start the status line says why (also in `~/.cache/mousiki/spectro_window_error.txt`).



Spectrogram (SHIFT+i, SHIFT+u)

The third visual for the lyrics area (and the radio's scope block): a **spectrogram** made the way **Audacity** makes its spectrogram view, with Audacity's default settings and colours - time runs from left to right, the frequency goes up, the colour shows how strong each frequency is. A stereo track is drawn as two channels above each other (left on top), like a stereo track in Audacity. For a perfectly smooth picture open it in its own window with ((German SHIFT+8, English SHIFT+9; see *Spectrogram window*). Switch to it with ,/. (sphere → oscilloscope → spectrogram → lyrics) or with **Lyrics/Viz Default** = spectro (radio: **Osci/sphere** = spectro). The default visual is the oscilloscope; the spectrogram is drawn in the image style (the overlays no longer have a *Display* row: switching the visual is the . key's job).



What it can do, in short:

- **Audacity's spectrogram** with Audacity's defaults and colours (below), of the decoded signal, so volume, EQ and normalization never change the picture; stereo as two channels (or one mix).

- All of Audacity's **frequency scales** (linear, logarithmic, mel, bark, erb, period), a free **frequency range**, **gain**, **range**, **frequency gain**, **window size** and **zero padding** -- changed live, and the last minute is computed again at once, so a change shows immediately.
- Four **colour schemes**: Roseus (Audacity), classic, grayscale, and a gradient from your own VIZ / OSCI colours.
- **5 – 60 s** across the width, moving as **sweep** (page by page with a playhead) or **scroll** (the newest on the right).
- Three places to show it: the **lyrics area** (radio: the scope block), **full screen** with frequency labels and a time ruler (`SHIFT+u`), and its own **window** drawn by the graphics card, perfectly smooth at the monitor's refresh rate (`(`, German `SHIFT+8`, English `SHIFT+9`).
- Two **styles**: an **image** (Kitty graphics / Sixel), and **braille** for any terminal.

Exactly like Audacity (defaults): a 2048-sample **Hann** window scaled so that a full-scale sine reads 0 dB, **zero padding 2**, the power of every frequency bin in dB, the **Mel** frequency scale from **0 to 20 000 Hz**, **gain 20 dB** and **range 80 dB** (colour = (level + gain + range) / range: −20 dB and louder is the top colour, −100 dB and quieter the bottom one), frequency gain 0 dB per decade, every pixel row shows the strongest frequency bin it covers, and the colour map **Roseus** ("Color (Roseus)", Audacity's default). It analyses the decoded audio itself (before equalizer, normalization and volume), as Audacity analyses the file, so the volume does not change the picture.

Two styles (overlay row *Style*):

- **image**: a real picture drawn by the terminal (Kitty graphics or Sixel, like the oscilloscope's image style), pixel for pixel like Audacity. It works whatever style the oscilloscope uses and follows the oscilloscope overlay's **Image protocol** row (`auto` asks the terminal). Where the terminal speaks neither protocol, the braille version is shown and the *Style* row says `image (no Sixel/Kitty here)`.
- **braille**: in any terminal. Every text cell is 2 × 4 braille dots; the louder a spot, the more dots and the brighter the colour. Does not look to nice but is the fallback version when no iamge mode is available to a lack of KiTTY or sixel...

Motion: *sweep* (default) writes the newest column from left to right with a thin playhead line and a short dark gap ahead of it (so the new page and the rest of the old one never run into each other), a page at a time like Audacity follows playback. In the image style only the strip being written is sent - up to 30 times a second - which keeps it smooth and light even in full screen. *scroll* keeps the newest column on the right and moves everything. Every pixel column stays tied to one moment of the track, and the picture moves on an even clock (not in the audio's buffer-sized bursts). How the image style moves it depends on the terminal:

- **Sixel in Windows Terminal** (also from WSL): the terminal itself shifts the picture already on screen one cell to the left (DECCRA, "copy rectangular area", which Windows Terminal applies to Sixel pictures too), and only the newest cell column is sent - a few KB per step instead of the whole picture, so even full screen keeps up. It moves in steps of one cell (about 10 pixels): with the default time span of 30 s a full-screen picture of ~230 columns takes ~8 steps a second; a shorter **Time span** (10–15 s) makes it run faster and look more fluid. `MOUSIKI_SIXEL_SHIFT=0` switches this off; `=1` tries it in another terminal (only useful where copying a rectangle also moves the picture).
- **Other Sixel terminals:** the whole picture is sent again each time it moves, at most ~3 MB/s: a small picture moves on every pixel, a full-screen one in even steps of a few pixels -- and a terminal that draws Sixel slowly shows it in jumps.

- **Kitty graphics:** the whole picture, compressed, like other Sixel terminals. For the smoothest picture anywhere use *sweep* (only the strip being written is sent), or *scroll* in the braille style.

While an overlay (`SHIFT+i`, `SHIFT+o` ...) covers part of the picture, the rest - above, below and beside it, also the columns right next to its edges - keeps running; the covered part is drawn again when the overlay closes. When the picture goes away (another view, a menu, the settings) its cells are blanked, so nothing of it is left on the next screen.

Full screen (`SHIFT+u`): the spectrogram over the whole screen, with the track (radio: station and song) as its title, **frequency labels** on the left like Audacity's ruler (both channels), a **time ruler** on top and the scale and range in the bottom line. `SHIFT+i` opens the options on top of it, `ESC` or `SHIFT+u` closes it. Playback keys keep working.

Options (`SHIFT+i`) -- ↑/↓ select, ←/→ change, `R` puts everything back to Audacity's defaults (style and motion stay), `ESC` or `SHIFT+i` closes and saves. `SHIFT+o` / `SHIFT+0` switch straight to the **oscilloscope** options / full screen without closing this overlay first:

Row	Choices	Default
Style	braille / image	image
Motion	sweep / scroll	sweep
Scale	linear / logarithmic / mel / bark / erb / period (Audacity's scales)	mel
Min frequency	0, 20, 50, 100, 200, 300, 500, 1000, 2000 Hz	0 Hz
Max frequency	1000 ... 24000 Hz (never above half the sample rate)	20000 Hz
Gain (dB)	−20 ... 100	20
Range (dB)	10 ... 200 (steps of 5)	80
Frequency gain	0 ... 60 dB per decade (brightens the highs; 0 dB at 1 kHz)	0
Window size	256, 512, 1024, 2048, 4096, 8192 samples: how many samples one column analyses. **Bigger** = sharper, thinner frequency lines (good for tones and voices), but short sounds smear in time; **smaller** = crisp clicks and drum hits, but the frequencies get blurry. The picture is computed again at once from the last minute of audio, so you see the difference immediately.	2048
Zero padding	1, 2, 4, 8: the window is padded with silence to a longer FFT, which draws the same information on a finer frequency grid (smoother, less blocky low end, especially with the Mel scale). It costs memory and time, not detail. Also recomputed at once.	2
Colors	roseus (Audacity's default), classic (Audacity's "Color (classic)" colours, but from black instead of light grey), grayscale (black to white), gradient (black, then the **VIZ** colours of **Settings** → **COLORS**, radio: the **OSCI** colours -- like the oscilloscope's *gradient*)	roseus

Row	Choices	Default
Channels	left + right (stacked, like Audacity) / mix	left + right
Time span	5 … 60 s across the width, in steps of 5 s (also recomputed at once)	30 s
Frequency labels	on / off (full screen)	on

The settings are stored as `Spectro<Name>=` lines in `config.txt` (radio: `radio_config.txt`). The spectrogram only starts with the picture: it shows what was played since it became visible.

Loudness normalization overlay (`SHIFT+v`)

Opens a small window in the middle of the screen where loudness normalization can be switched on and off and tuned **while the music plays**. What you change is what you hear: the level glides to the new value within about a second, so there is no click. (The plain `v` key still toggles normalization on and off without opening anything.)

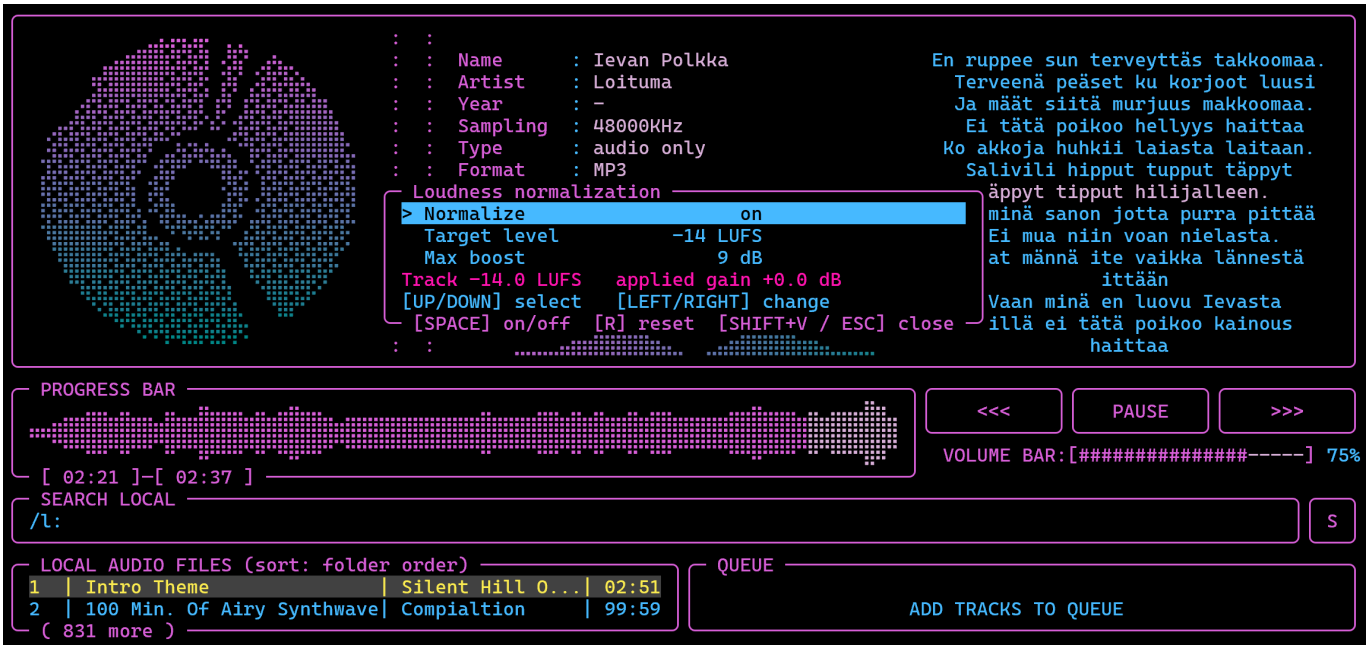
Key	Action
`↑` / `↓`	Select a row (wraps around)
`←` / `→`	On the **Normalize** row: switch off / on. On the other two rows: decrease / increase the value by 1.
`SPACE` or `v`	Switch normalization on / off from any row
`R`	Reset **Target level** and **Max boost** to their defaults. The on / off state is not changed.
`ESC` or `SHIFT+v`	Close the overlay. The values are **saved to `config.txt`** when it closes.

Playback keeps running while the overlay is open, but its keys are the only ones that react until you close it. The overlay opens on every main screen.

Row	Range	Step	Default	What it does
Normalize	off / on		on	Loudness normalization on or off. Same switch as the `v` key and **Settings → GENERAL → Normalize Volume**.
Target level	-40 – 0 LUFS	1	-16	The loudness every track is measured against and played at. `-16` leaves more headroom, `-14` matches YouTube and Spotify. A lower number is quieter overall.
Max boost	0 – 24 dB	1	9	The most a quiet track may be raised. Loud or heavily compressed tracks are lowered regardless.

Live line. Below the three rows a grey line shows what is happening with the track that is playing right now: its measured loudness and the gain that is applied to it (`+` = raised, `-` = lowered). If a quiet track would need more than **Max boost**, the applied gain stops at that limit, so this line is the quickest way to see whether the

boost limit is holding a track back. For the first seconds of a track it shows *measuring loudness* until enough audio has been analysed.



In radio mode the overlay and its range are the same. A live stream has no end, so the loudness is measured **since you tuned in** (see 11.4).

Karaoke overlay (k)

Fills the whole screen with the lyrics of the track that is playing: the line being sung sits in the middle, the words already sung are drawn in the active-word colour (Settings → COLORS → LYRICS) and the word being sung is underlined (bold in the big sizes), the lines before and after it are dimmed. Lines are centred and separated by an empty row. The track's title and artist are on the top border, the position and length (`[ 1:23 / 3:45 ]`) on the bottom border.

The karaoke picture sits on **both sides**, with four empty columns between each picture and the lyrics, so the lyrics stay centred. It is drawn in the **disk colours** (Settings → COLORS → DISK, top → bottom colour) with a colour wave that runs across it from the left to the right edge, like the radio's ON AIR sign.

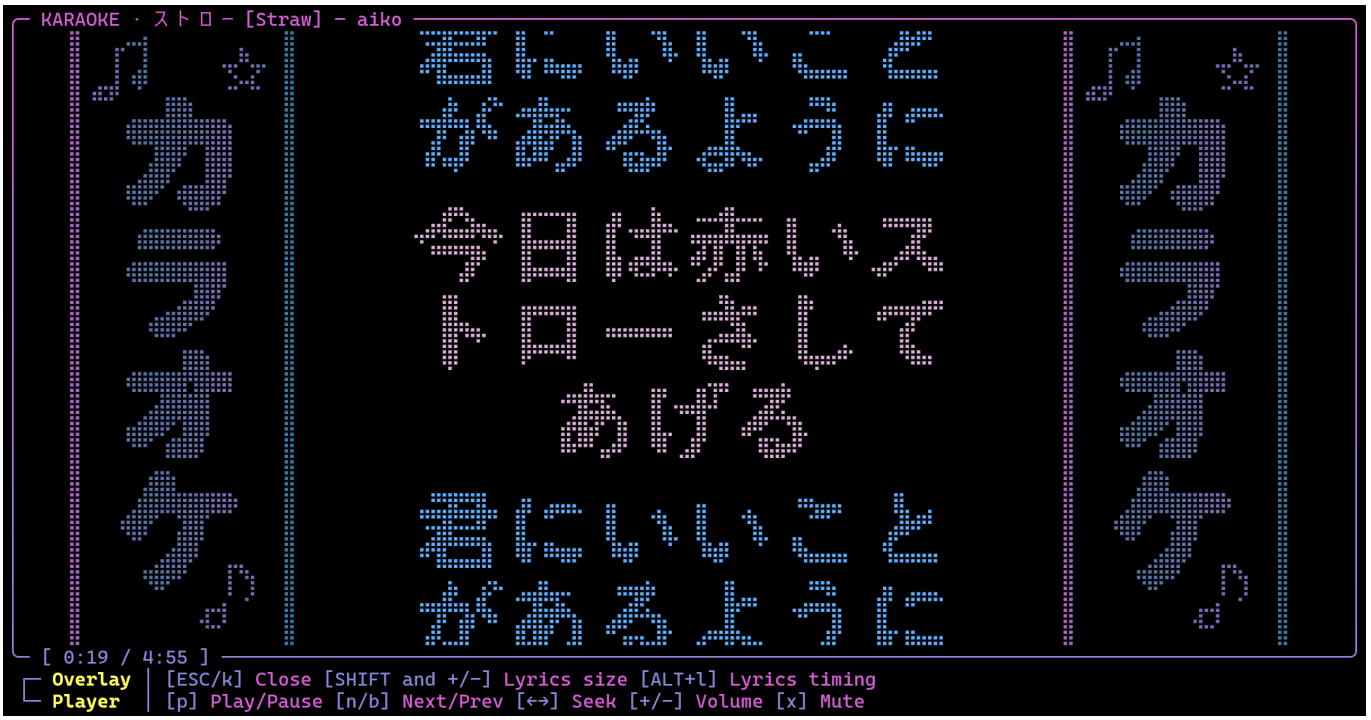
Lyrics size. The mode keys make the lyrics bigger / smaller (`SHIFT` and `+` / `SHIFT` and `-` on a German keyboard, `'` / `;` on an English one), in steps of 1 from **1 to 5**. Only the lyrics change, the pictures stay as they are. Size 1 is normal text. From size 2 on the letters are drawn with Mousiki's own pixel font in braille dots, each step one pixel bigger (a letter is 3 x 2 cells at size 2, 6 x 4 at size 3, up to 12 x 8 at size 5); long lines wrap between words. The built-in font covers the Latin letters, digits, punctuation, the German umlauts and ß and the common accented letters. **Japanese, Chinese, Korean (and Cyrillic, Greek)** lines are drawn big too: their glyphs are taken from a font installed on your computer and drawn in the same braille dots. These characters need more dots to stay readable, so their steps are different: a letter is 16 / 24 / 32 / 40 dots high, that is **4 / 6 / 8 / 10 rows** for the sizes 2 / 3 / 4 / 5, and a full-width character is as wide as it is high (8 / 12 / 16 / 20 columns). A line with no spaces, like a Japanese line, wraps wherever the row is full, and a line that would be taller than the screen steps down a size by itself (down to normal text if even size 2 is too tall). With only about 50 columns between the two pictures, big letters of sizes 4 and 5 would hardly fit two or three to a row, so **at sizes 4 and 5 the two pictures are left out and the lyrics take the whole width** whenever the song's lyrics contain Japanese / Chinese / Korean text. Mixed lines (Latin and Japanese) are drawn with the system

font as a whole. Mousiki looks for the font itself: Windows (Yu Gothic, Meiryo, MS Gothic, Microsoft YaHei, Malgun), macOS (Hiragino, PingFang, Apple SD Gothic) and Linux (Noto Sans CJK, Source Han Sans, WenQuanYi, Droid Sans Fallback, IPA / Takao, Unifont in the font folders; install e.g. `fonts-noto-cjk` if there is none). Bold faces are preferred, thin strokes would vanish. To use a particular font, set the environment variable `MOUSIKI_CJK_FONT` to its file (`.ttf`, `.otf` or `.ttc`). Without any such font, and for emoji, a line is shown in normal text as before. The bottom border briefly shows `[ lyrics size n / 5 ]`, and the size is saved to `config.txt` (`KaraokeLyricsSize=`) when the overlay closes. The keys are the characters `*` and `_`: on a German keyboard `SHIFT` and `+` / `SHIFT` and `-`, on an English (US / UK) keyboard `SHIFT+8` / `SHIFT` and `-`; the legend names them for your keyboard.

Resizing. The layout is worked out again for every frame, so it follows the terminal size: the lyrics re-wrap to the width between the pictures, the pictures are cropped evenly at the top and bottom on a short terminal, and when the lyrics would get narrower than 30 columns the pictures are left out and the lyrics take the whole width.

Key	What it does
`ESC` or `k`	Close the overlay
`*` / `_` (German `SHIFT` and `+` / `SHIFT` and `-`, English `'` / `;`)	Lyrics bigger / smaller (1 - 5)
`p`, `n` / `b`, `#`, `←` / `→`, `+` / `-`, `x`, `m`, `v`	Work as on the main screen (play/pause, next/previous, shuffle next, seek, volume, mute, play mode, normalization)
`l` (`HKeyRetryLyrics`)	Opens the lyrics **re-fetch and version control** form over the karaoke screen (wrong or missing lyrics: fix the title / artist, pick another saved version); closing it returns to karaoke.
`a`	**Add manually**: opens READ LYRICS for the playing track with the *Add manually* overlay open straight away (see READ LYRICS). Also `CTRL+n` inside the re-fetch form.
`ALT+L` (macOS: `SHIFT+j`)	Opens the lyrics timing overlay **over the karaoke screen**, which is the easiest place to judge an offset: the big lyrics move live while you adjust it. Closing it (save or cancel) returns to karaoke, not to the main screen.

- The overlay always uses the lyrics engine, **also when it is off on the main screen** (`.`, Settings → ANIMA/VIZ → Use Lyrics Engine): it then fetches the lyrics of the playing track itself -- and again after a track change while it is open -- without changing that setting, so the main screen keeps its visual. While they are being fetched, or when none were found, the overlay says so.
- Synced lyrics follow the timing correction of the lyrics timing overlay, which `ALT+L` (macOS: `SHIFT+j`) opens **from here as well** (see the key table above). Lyrics without timestamps are scrolled along with the song.

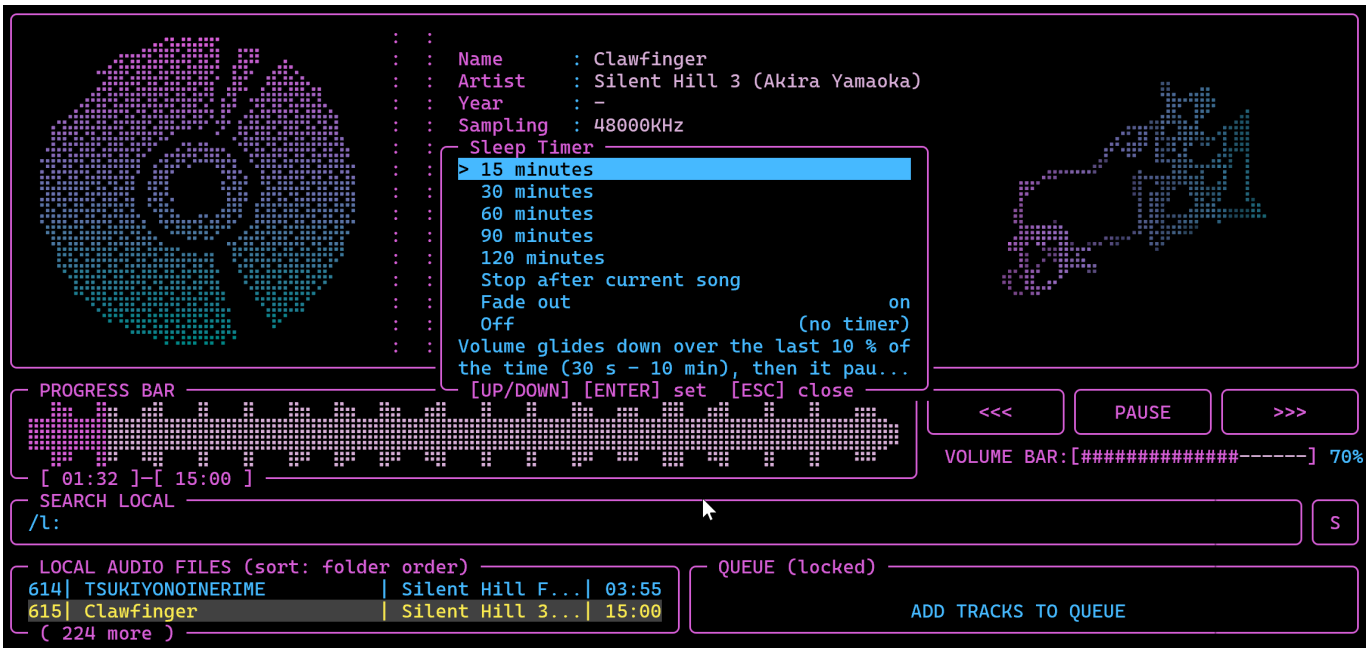


Sleep timer overlay (SHIFT+z)

A small overlay for falling asleep to music. Playback keeps running while it is open.

Key	What it does
↑ / ↓	Pick an entry: **15 / 30 / 60 / 90 / 120 minutes**, **Stop after current song**, **Fade out** or **Off**.
ENTER	Set the picked entry and close the overlay. Picking the running minute entry again restarts its countdown. On the **Fade out** row it switches the fade on or off instead, and the overlay stays open.
ESC or SHIFT+z	Close the overlay without changing anything.

- While a timer is armed the remaining time (or `after song`) is shown in the title of the search bar, e.g. `SEARCH LOCAL [SLEEP 24:10]`.
- When a minute timer runs out, playback is **paused**, not stopped: the position is kept and `p` resumes it.
- **Fade out** (on by default, `SleepFade` in `config.txt`): over the last 10 % of the time (at least 30 seconds, at most 10 minutes) the volume glides down, so the music fades away instead of stopping abruptly. It multiplies your volume setting and is undone when the timer is cancelled.
- **Stop after current song** ends playback when the song that is playing ends, even if the queue still has tracks or the play mode is Repeat. It needs a playing song to attach to.
- The two kinds of timer exclude each other: setting one replaces the other. The timer is **not saved** and is gone after a restart.
- **Stop play mode:** the sleep timer never changes the play mode (`m`). *Stop after current song* is a one-shot on top of it, so with the Stop mode already on it is simply redundant, and your play mode is unchanged afterwards.



In radio / aduio book mode the timer works the same way with the minute entries and the fade-out. In the radio mode when it runs out the stream is **stopped**, since there is no *Stop after current song* entry, because a radio has no song to wait for (see 11.4).

Creator overlay (^)

The creator has two modes, chosen in the first row (**Creator mode**): **Text to sound** and **Microphone**.



Mode: Text to sound

The creator **makes music out of a text**. It renders a WAV file, saves it, plays it and shows it in a full-screen preview. Two kinds of sound are possible:

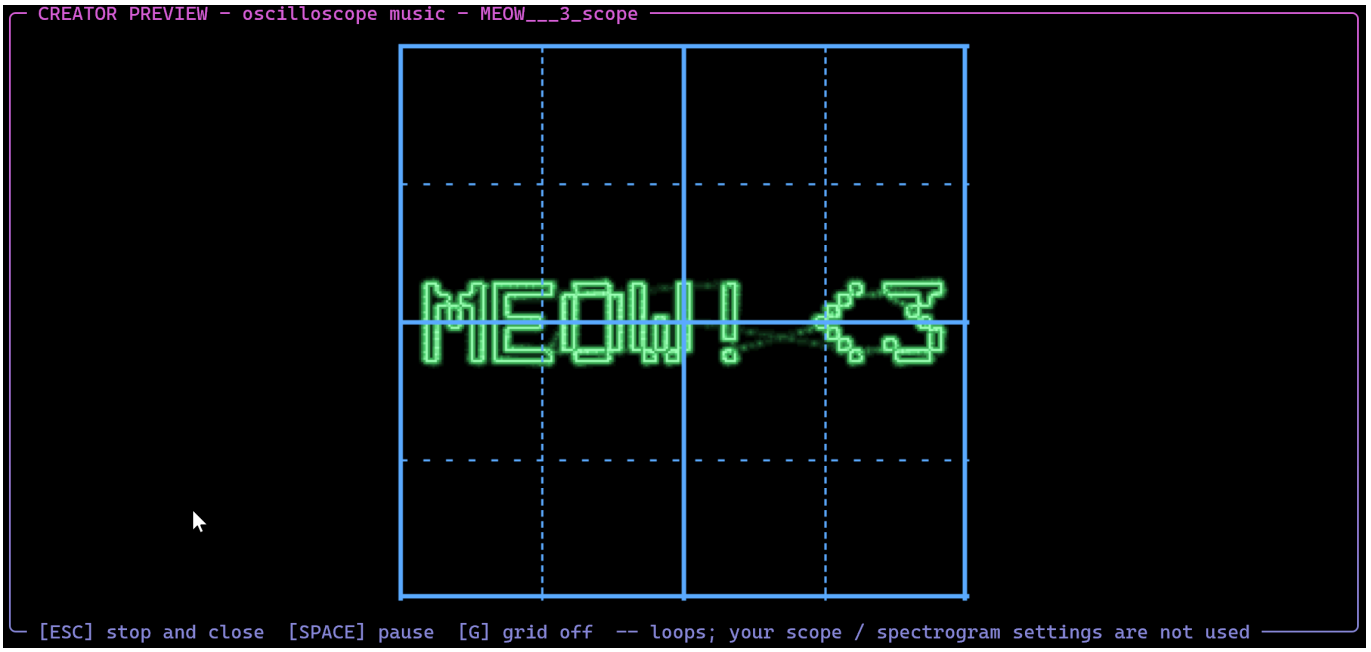
- **Oscilloscope (XY)** – *oscilloscope music*. The left channel is the horizontal and the right channel the vertical position of a beam; the outlines of your text are drawn again and again, 30 to 120 times a second (that is also the hum you hear). The preview shows it at once.

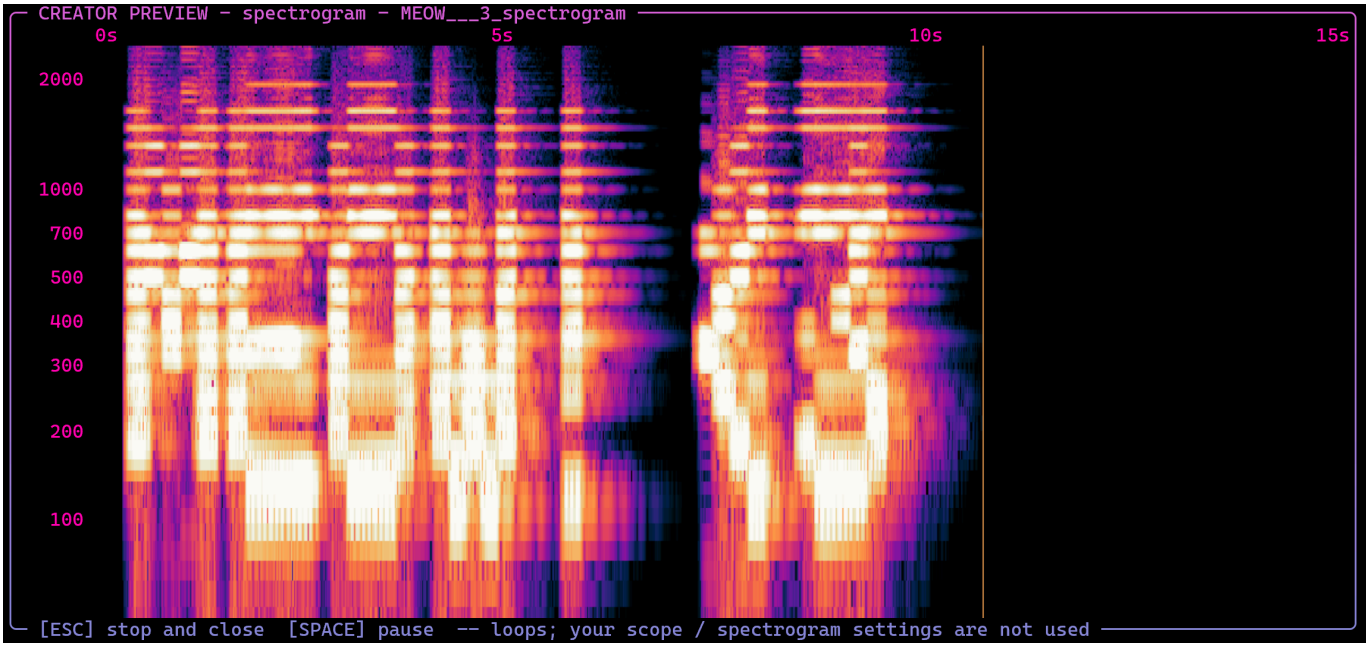
- **Spectrogram** – the text **is** the spectrogram: time runs from left to right, pitch from bottom to top and brightness is loudness. To make this always sound pleasant, only the notes of a **musical scale** are played (pentatonic minor by default, so every combination sounds harmonious), at most 12 notes sound at once, notes glide softly into each other and a light reverb joins them. *Exact* plays every pitch instead (more like the text, less like music).

Row	What it does
Text	The field. Typing, caret, selection and clipboard work as everywhere. | starts a new line. Text is drawn with Mousiki's pixel font (Latin letters) or an installed font (Japanese, Cyrillic …). ENTER moves on. The small braille picture under the rows shows what will be used.
Sound	Oscilloscope (XY) or Spectrogram.
Length	5, 10, 20, 30 or 60 seconds.
Invert	**Auto**, **On** or **Off**. *On* makes the background loud instead of the letters.
Oscilloscope rows	**Frame rate** (30 / 60 / 90 / 120 per second), **Motion** (None, Spin, Tumble, Pulse – the text moves while it plays) and **Detail** (Low, Medium, High: how exactly the outline is followed).
Spectrogram rows	**Scale** (pentatonic minor / major, major, minor, whole tone, chromatic, exact), **Octaves** (3 to 6, from the low C2 upwards) and **Reverb** (Off, Light, Hall).
Scope grid	On / Off: the grid of the oscilloscope preview (only for *Oscilloscope*; G switches it in the preview too).
Create, save and preview	Renders and saves the WAV, plays it and opens the preview.
Created files…	Lists the files made so far (newest first). ENTER plays the picked file and opens its preview; ESC goes back. This is the only place where the created files can be played.

Keys: ↑ / ↓ or TAB pick a row, ← / → or ENTER change a value, ENTER on *Create* creates, ESC closes (^ again closes it too, except while you type in the text field). **SPACE does nothing in this overlay** (it only types a space inside the text field), so a stray space, e.g. from a dead key on a German keyboard, can never create a file.

- **The preview:** after *Create* (or after opening a file from *Created files…*) a full-screen **preview** opens and the file plays in a loop. For *Oscilloscope* it shows the XY scope in oscilloscope-music mode (as a real picture on terminals with Kitty graphics / Sixel, else in braille); for *Spectrogram* it shows the spectrogram, with a line that sweeps across it. The preview has **its own settings**: it neither uses nor changes what you set with SHIFT+o and SHIFT+i. It loops until you stop it: ESC closes the preview and takes you back to the creator overlay (a second ESC closes that); the song that was playing before comes back (from its start; if nothing was playing, playback just stops), SPACE pauses.





- The file is saved as `<your first music folder>/creator/<name>_scope.wav` or `…_spectrogram.wav` (`~/Music/creator` when no music folder is set; an existing name gets a number). The folder is marked with a small file (`.mousiki-creator`), so **its files are not part of your library**: they do not show up in the file list, the search or the queue, and you listen to them only through *Created files…* in this overlay (they are ordinary WAV files, so you can still copy or share them from the folder).
- **Tips for the scope:** short words, or several short lines with `|`, give big letters. Many small details make the beam slow, so the picture flickers; *Detail: Low* or a bigger frame rate helps.
- **Tips for the spectrogram:** the text becomes a melody-like pattern; short words are most readable in the preview.
- Rendering runs while the overlay waits and takes a moment for long clips (at most a few seconds).
- In the radio the creator is not available; the player plays the files like any other file (they are in your library).
- The key is `HKeyCreator` in `config.txt` (default `^`).

Mode: Microphone

Shows your **microphone live** in the big preview and records it on request (also the groundwork for a karaoke mode with singing scores).

Row	What it does
Live view	**Spectrogram** (default), **Oscilloscope (XY)** (left against right channel) or **Oscilloscope (YT)** (the wave over time).
Scope grid	On / Off (both oscilloscope views).
Start the microphone preview	Opens the big preview. A song that is playing stops (the microphone would hear it) and comes back when you close the preview.
Created files…	As above; recordings are listed here, too.

In the preview: `ENTER` starts a **recording** (the title shows `REC m:ss`) and stops and saves it (`mic_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS.wav` in the creator folder, at most 5 minutes); `V` changes the view, `G` the grid, `ESC` closes the preview and returns to the overlay (a running recording is saved). Recordings are played from *Created files…* like everything else the creator makes. A microphone with one channel shows the same signal left and right, so *XY* draws a diagonal line; *YT* and the spectrogram are the useful views then. If no microphone can be opened (or the system refuses access), the overlay says so; on macOS and Windows you may have to allow microphone access for your terminal.

4. Search (main UI)

The cheat sheet (`?`) lists these under two headings: **SEARCH LOCAL (MAIN UI)** (`/`, `/r:`, `/a:`, the playlist and folder searches) and **SEARCH ONLINE (MAIN UI)** (`/s:`, `/sc:`, `/b:`).

Key	Action	What it does
`/`	Search local folder	(German `SHIFT+7`.) Opens the search box. The list updates **live as you type**. Press `ENTER` to keep the result, or `ESC` to cancel and restore the previous view.
`/r:` + query	Search artists only	Local search limited to the **artist**: the artist tag, or the artist folder when a file has no tag. `/r:miles` lists only tracks by artists matching "miles", not tracks that merely have it in the title. The search bar is labelled **SEARCH ARTISTS**.
`/a:` + query	Search albums only	Local search limited to the **album** tag. The bar is labelled **SEARCH ALBUMS**. (Album tags are resolved in the background after a scan, so a freshly added folder may need a moment.)
`/s:` + query	Search online (YouTube)	Type `s:` followed by your query, then press `ENTER`. Online searches only run on `ENTER`, never per keystroke.

Key	Action	What it does
`/sc:` + query	Search SoundCloud	The same for **SoundCloud** (through yt-dlp). `ENTER` on a result plays it, the queue keys queue it, the download key saves it to the download folder. The audio is kept as SoundCloud sends it (no second conversion). Tracks SoundCloud only plays as a **30-second preview** (Go+ and some label releases) and tracks that cannot be played at all are **left out** of the results; to tell them apart each result is looked at in full, so a SoundCloud search takes a few seconds longer than a YouTube one.
`/b:` + query	Search Bandcamp	The same for **Bandcamp** tracks (the search is asked from Bandcamp by `scripts/bandcamp_search.py`, the download is done by yt-dlp). Bandcamp streams the free 128 kbit/s MP3; the full-quality files are for buyers on Bandcamp itself.
`↑` / `↓`, then `ENTER`	Play from the search	Moving through the results with `↑` / `↓` while typing and pressing `ENTER` **plays the highlighted entry right away** (the search stays as the list's filter and the list keeps the highlight). Without moving, `ENTER` only keeps the search, as before.
`/p:` + query	Search saved playlists	Type `p:` followed by part of a playlist name. The playlist list filters live. `ENTER` on a playlist row queues all of its tracks.
`/f:` + query	Search folders	Type `f:` followed by part of a folder name (or of `<parent folder> <folder>`, e.g. `beatles abbey`). The folder list filters live. `ENTER` on a folder row opens it in the LOCAL AUDIO FILES pane and lists all of its files, exactly like the `f` filter (`c` clears it again).
`L` (Shift+L)	Big list overlay	Floats a larger version of the list pane (LOCAL AUDIO FILES) over the main UI. See below.
`F` (Shift+F)	Big folder overlay	A folder tree of the library with a search bar, floated over the main UI. See below.
`C` (Shift+C)	File conversion overlay	Convert high resolution files to MP3 / AAC / Opus. See below.

In radio mode the search works the same way (fuzzy, live, `ESC` clears; the station under the cursor is highlighted while you type, and `ENTER` tunes it); it searches stations, and `p:` the saved station lists (see 11.5).

Local search details

- The search is **fuzzy**. For example "X Files" also finds "X-Files".
- More about the fuzzy search: accents, some special letters and umlauts are ignored (`arzte` finds *Die Ärzte*, `strasse` finds *Straße*); two swapped letters count as one slip (`teh beatles`); a word typed only as far as it goes matches (`test cov` finds *test_song-cover3*, also with a number behind the word); and words typed **run together** find the words of a name in order, even with words in between skipped (`testcover` finds *test_song-cover3*, `bohrhap` finds *Bohemian Rhapsody*; the fewer words are skipped, the higher it ranks). An exact piece of the name always ranks first.

- It matches the file name, the artist, the embedded title tag and the album tag. Files whose tags have not been read yet can still be found by file name.
- Results are ranked purely by match quality, best first.
- While the search box is open, ↑/↓ move through the live preview. ←/→ move the text caret, and SHIFT+←/→ marks text.
- A folder filter (f) keeps applying to search results.

Big list overlay (SHIFT+l)

Opens a large window, styled like the lyrics form (l), that shows the same list as the small pane (LOCAL AUDIO FILES, or the online / playlist results) with many more rows. It shares the cursor with the small pane, so both always point at the same track.

Key	Action
SHIFT+↓ / SHIFT+↑	Next / previous **page** (faster scrolling). At the end of the list the cursor jumps to the last / first entry.
↑ / ↓	Move one row
ESC or SHIFT+l	Close the overlay

Everything else keeps working from inside the overlay: ENTER plays, T cycles the sort mode, f / c set / clear the folder filter, / searches (the search bar is part of the overlay), a adds to the queue, n / b / p / seek / volume as usual, and l opens the lyrics form on top of it. The queue pane is hidden while the overlay is open, so its footer shows the current queue size (queue: N) together with a page counter. Full-screen menus (Settings, Playlists, ...) hide the overlay while they are open and it returns when they close.



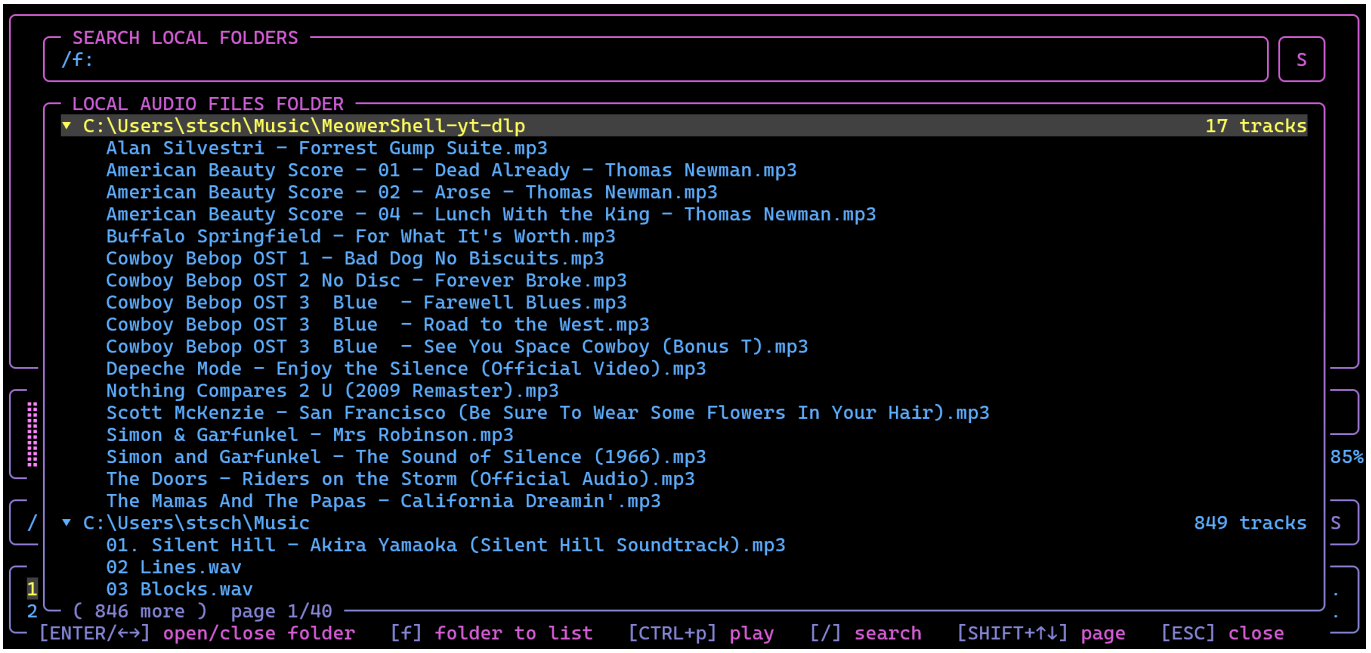
Big list overlay can be opened via SHIFT+L and closed via the same command or ESC. Fast scrolling (scroll per page) is possible via SHIFT+↑/↓.

Big folder overlay (SHIFT+f)

A large window with a search bar and the **LOCAL AUDIO FILES FOLDER** pane: a tree of all folders of your library (the folders of the PATHS tab and the download folder, with the number of tracks in each). ENTER opens a folder; its subfolders and files appear slightly indented below it, and ENTER closes it again.

Key	Action
↑ / ↓, SHIFT+↑ / SHIFT+↓	Move one row / one page
ENTER, → / ←	Open / close the folder (← on a closed folder or a file jumps to its parent folder)
f	On a **folder**: show that folder in the LOCAL AUDIO FILES pane, exactly like f on a track (folder order, c clears it again). On a **file**: the same for the file's folder, with the file highlighted. Both close the overlay.
CTRL+p	**Play** the highlighted file (the overlay stays open, so you can keep browsing); on a folder it only shows a hint
/ or TAB	Type in the search bar: only folders and files whose name matches (all words) stay in the tree, with the way down to them opened. ENTER, TAB or ESC hand the keyboard back to the tree.
ESC or SHIFT+f	Close the overlay

Playback keys (pause, next / previous, seek, volume, mute, normalize) keep working. The key can be changed with HKeyFolderOverlay in config.txt. The overlay and the big list / queue overlays exclude each other.



The folder overlay (SHIFT+f).

File conversion overlay (SHIFT+c)

Turns high resolution files into lighter ones. A large window with a search bar and the list **FILES TO CONVERT**: every file of the library with its format, sample rate / bit depth, bitrate, size and the estimated size after the

conversion. The first line inside the list holds the pre-filter and the target, the second shows the export folder, the progress of a running conversion or the result of the last one.

Key	Action
↑ / ↓, SHIFT+↑ / SHIFT+↓	Move one row / one page
SPACE	Mark / unmark the highlighted file (and move on)
a	Mark everything that is shown, or unmark it again when all of it is marked
t / SHIFT+t	Pre-filter **type**, forward / backward: all files, lossless (FLAC, WAV, ALAC), FLAC, WAV, M4A, OGG, OPUS, AAC, MP3
r / SHIFT+r	Pre-filter **minimum bitrate**: any, 320, 500 or 1000 kbps
h	Pre-filter **hi-res only**: more than 16 bit or more than 48 kHz
← / →	The **target**: MP3 320 kbps, MP3 V0 (about 245 kbps, variable), MP3 192 kbps, AAC 256 kbps (.m4a), Opus 128 kbps
/ or TAB	Type in the search bar (folder and file name, all words must match); TAB or ESC hand the keyboard back to the list, ENTER too (in a plain file search)
f: / p: in the search bar	Same as in the main search: typing f: turns the bar into /f: and the list into the **folders** that hold files (filtered by what you type after it), p: turns it into /p: and lists the saved **playlists**. ENTER on a folder or playlist narrows **FILES TO CONVERT** to just its files (a folder: the files directly in it, like f in the main list; the pre-filter still applies, the info line says how many match). The search then works inside that selection. Typing / in the bar goes back to the full search (and drops the selection); BACKSPACE on an empty /f: or /p: removes the prefix; ESC leaves the folder / playlist list, then the selection, then closes the overlay.
ENTER	Convert the marked files (the highlighted one when nothing is marked)
c	Cancel the running conversion
CTRL+p	Play the highlighted file (the overlay stays open)
ESC or SHIFT+c	Close the overlay. A running conversion goes on in the background and reports on the status line.

The files are read with ffprobe in the background right after the overlay opens (the list says reading 12/340 meanwhile); filters that need those details (hi-res, minimum bitrate, lossless M4A) show a file as soon as it has been read. The converted files go to the **CONVERSION EXPORT PATH** (Settings → PATHS; by default the conversion-export folder inside the download folder), in the same sub folders as the originals below your library folder, with the new extension. **The originals are never changed or deleted.** A file that already exists in the export folder is skipped (so converting the same song to a second MP3 preset needs the old file moved away first). Tags and the cover picture are copied (not to Opus); sample rates above 48 kHz become 44.1 or 48 kHz, more than two channels become stereo. The export folder is left out of the list. Needs ffmpeg with

`libmp3lame` and `libopus`; the installers and `setup.sh` / `setup.ps1` provide it. The key can be changed with `HKeyConvertOverlay` in `config.txt`.

Latin letters for Japanese, Korean and Chinese text

Press `"` (that is `SHIFT+'` on a US keyboard; on a German keyboard `SHIFT+2`) to show / transliterate Japanese, Korean and Chinese text in Latin letters, press it again to go back. It converts what is *shown*: the titles, artists, albums and file names in the lists, the queue, the metadata panel and the editors, the lyrics in the main screen, the karaoke overlay and the READ LYRICS overlay (translations as well). The files and tags themselves are never changed. The status line says `Latin letters: on` / `off`; the switch is remembered (`LatinLetters=true/false` in `config.txt`; the key is `HKeyTranslit` in Settings → REFERENCE).

In the radio mode the same key switches the station names, the title that plays now, the station lists, the presets and the radio browser (the radio's cheat sheet lists it); the setting is the same one, so it carries over when you switch modes, and the radio writes `LatinLetters=` into `config.txt` for you.

Script	Becomes	Example
Japanese kana (hiragana, katakana)	Hepburn romaji: `shi`, `tsu`, `kya`; the small *tsu* doubles the next consonant (がっこう → `gakkou`, まっちゃ → `matcha`); the long vowel mark gets a macron (ラーメン → `rāmen`); ん before a vowel gets an apostrophe (しんあい → `shin'ai`); ファ, ティ, ウィ … as `fa`, `ti`, `wi`	さくら → `sakura`
Korean Hangul	Revised Romanization, sound by sound (한국어 → `hangugeo`); a final consonant before a vowel moves on to it. Pronunciation changes between consonants (nasalisation …) are not applied	안녕하세요 → `annyeonghaseyo`
Chinese characters	Hanyu Pinyin with tone marks, one syllable per character; a character with several readings gets its most common one (长 is always `cháng`, 行 always `xíng`; sung and spoken text will be wrong in places)	周杰伦 → `zhōu jié lún`

Kanji and Chinese characters: Japanese or Chinese? The same characters are read very differently (東京 is *tōkyō* in Japanese and *dōng jīng* in Chinese; in Japanese the reading even depends on the word), and only a large dictionary could name the Japanese reading. So Mousiki only converts Chinese characters when it is **sure the text is Chinese**, and leaves them alone otherwise (a wrong reading is worse than none). A text counts as...

- **Japanese** when it has kana in it, or when any other tag of the same track has (ありがとう as the title makes the artist 周杰倫 Japanese for that track), or when it has a character only Japanese uses (桜 楽 変 沢 畑 峠 …). The characters stay: 愛してる becomes 愛 `shiteru`.
- **Chinese** when it has a character only Chinese uses (the simplified forms 们 这 乐 伦 爱 谢 …), or when another tag of the track says so. They become pinyin.
- **Not known** when nothing says it (東京, 周杰倫, 你好 are the same in every writing): unchanged. Once **one** track of an artist is recognised (a title with kana, a simplified-only character in any tag), the artist's name is remembered as Japanese / Chinese for all the other tracks, as soon as their tags are read.
- The switch `LatinHanziDefault` in `config.txt` decides what such unknown characters are: `leave` (default) leaves them alone, `chinese` reads them as Chinese (pinyin), if your library is mostly Chinese, and `japanese` treats them as Japanese, if your library is mostly Japanese (**Settings** → **GENERAL** →

> **TRANSLITERATION → Translit. Kanji** does the same: `Leave` / `Chin.` / `Jap.`): they stay as they are unless the optional kanji reader (below) is installed, which then reads them in the background like any other kanji of Japanese text.

Names written both ways. A name stored as `Kenshi Yonezu（米津玄師）`, `米津玄師 - Kenshi Yonezu` or `Kenshi Yonezu / 米津玄師` (a Latin part and a part in Chinese characters or kana, separated by `（ ）`, `[ ]`, `-` or `/`) is shown as just its **Latin part** when the switch is on, and the pair is learned: the same characters on their own in another tag (`米津玄師` as the artist of another track) are then shown as `Kenshi Yonezu` too.

Learned from your own library. Many libraries name the files in Latin letters while the tags use the original script (`Music/Eason Chan/...` with the artist tag `陈奕迅`). When at least three tracks of an artist written in Chinese characters or kana sit in folders (artist or album folder) or in files (`Artist - Title`) that name the same Latin spelling - and no other spelling is as frequent - Mousiki learns the pair and shows the Latin name from then on. Learned pairs, and pairs from `Name（名前）`-style tags, are kept in `kanji_readings_learned.txt` next to `config.txt` (you can edit or delete lines; your own `kanji_readings.txt` always wins).

Spelling of Japanese (Settings → GENERAL → TRANSLITERATION). By default Japanese is written the way English and German readers find easiest: long vowels spelled out (`kienuyou`, `koohii`) and the particle を as `o` (`koe o kikasete`). A small っ doubles the next consonant (`ittemo`); a full-size つ before て / た after another kana, as many lyrics sites write it (`いつて` for `いって`), is read the same way (`itte`, not `itsute`; `かつて` stays `katsute`). The particle は is written `wa` when it stands alone (`は いけない` = `wa ikenai`), after で / に / と / へ / から at the end of a phrase or before ない (`kokodewa ikenai`), and after a kanji (`僕は` = `boku wa`); inside words it stays `ha` (`nihatori`). **Latin Macrons** (on) writes long vowels with a macron instead (`kienuyō`, `kōhī`, `ōkii`); **Latin Wo** (on) writes を as `wo`. Both are off by default and take effect at once. **Translit. Kanji** (same category: `Leave` / `Chin.` / `Jap.`, default `Leave`) decides what characters that could be Japanese or Chinese (`東京`) are read as, see the switch `LatinHanziDefault` above: it is the same setting, so it also changes `config.txt`. Spaces are only where the text has them: the conversion does not split a run of kana into words.

Latin Name Lookup (opt-in, Settings → GENERAL → TRANSLITERATION). For artists written in *Chinese characters* whose Latin name is still unknown, Mousiki can ask MusicBrainz in the background, one name at a time (about every 1.5 seconds, longer pauses when MusicBrainz is busy or you are offline). The answer is kept in `kanji_readings_learned.txt`, so every name is asked for only once; names MusicBrainz does not know are remembered as well (`none: <name>`). It needs Python 3, like the cover fetch. **Privacy:** switching it on sends the artist *names* from your library - and, as with any web request, your IP address - to musicbrainz.org. Nothing else (no titles, files, paths or play history) is sent. That is why it is **off by default** (`LatinNameLookup=false`); with it off nothing leaves your computer.

Kanji readings with pykakasi (optional). Kanji in Japanese text stay as they are, because their reading depends on the word. If you install the small Python package **pykakasi** (`pip install pykakasi`; about 10 MB), Mousiki uses it while the Latin letters are on: titles, artists and albums of Japanese tracks whose kanji stayed are read in the background in batches (`scripts/kanji_reading.py`), and then show up in Latin letters (`夜に駆ける` → `yoru ni kakeru`). The readings are kept in `kanji_readings_cache.txt` next to `config.txt` (each text is read once; delete the file to read everything again). It all happens on your computer, nothing is sent anywhere, and without pykakasi everything works as before (the status line says once that it is not installed). Your own `kanji_readings.txt` wins over it. pykakasi is **not** part of Mousiki and is not downloaded by the build: it is licensed GPL-3.0-or-later, so it is a separate program that you install if you want it; Mousiki only calls it. Texts that could be Chinese as well as Japanese (`東京` alone, without kana or other

hints) are never sent to it. **Word spacing (janome, optional).** Japanese is written without spaces, so kana alone (わたしはあなたがすきです) come out as one long word (watashihaanatagasukidesu). With the small package **janome** (Apache-2.0, pure Python, about 20 MB with its dictionary; `pip install janome`) next to pykakasi, the reader cuts every Japanese line into words first: watashi wa anata ga suki desu, raamen o tabe ni ikou (particles stand alone and は / へ / を are read wa / e / o; endings stay with their verb). Lines with five or more kana are sent to the reader as well, not only those with kanji. Korean already keeps the spaces of the text, and Chinese is written one syllable at a time (wǒ ài nǐ), so only Japanese needs this. Readings read before janome was installed stay as they were: delete `kanji_readings_cache.txt` to read everything again. **Installing it:** the Windows installer has an unticked option, *Download pykakasi so kanji are shown in Latin letters too*; it downloads pykakasi, janome and their small helper packages from pypi.org (five pure-Python files, the same on every platform; each is checked against the exact checksum pinned in `scripts/kanji_pins.json`, any other file is refused; `python release.py pin` refreshes the pins) into the `pylib` folder of the installation, using the Python that comes with Mousiki. It needs internet during the installation; if the download fails, Mousiki just goes without. `setup.sh --with-kanji` / `setup.ps1 -WithKanji` run `pip install --user pykakasi janome` for a source build. A new installation of a newer version removes `pylib`; the option is remembered and downloads it again. **Common repairs on top of the two packages:** the na of a na-adjective, the endings *desho* / *darou*, and *kedo* / *keredo* are written as words of their own (oshare na, nai desho, kamoshirenai kedo); donna ni / sonna ni; saretatte (not sareta tte); a full-size つ before て / た is read as the small っ (いつて = itte); and a hiragana のむ right after a katakana word is the verb 飲む (コーヒーのむのよ = koohii nomu no yo); *kara* / *node* / *noni* / *shi* / *ga* after a verb are words of their own (dekiru kara, wakaranai node); nandemo is one word; numbers against Japanese text are read out (1日 = ichinichi, 3周 = sanshuu, 2羽 = niwa, 15ぴょこ = juugo pyoko; F1 stays); loanword sounds are spelled as sung (ティー = tii, ウィ = wi); and a space in the lyrics always starts a new word; は before ない stays apart (nikumitaku wa nai), a noun after a verb ending too (tsubureta bun), the figures of a number belong together (nijuuni seiki), 一人 / 二人 are hitori / futari, the middle dot ・ and ( ), -, , in Latin remarks are spaced as in writing (parappa parappa (wow-oh)), and a katakana へ after a katakana word is the particle e. A line of a song with a Latin remark in brackets is no longer taken for a "name (Latin name)" pair. The reader marks long vowels, so they follow the **Latin letters: macrons** setting like the built-in conversion does (kyou / kyō, koohii / kōhī). Delete `kanji_readings_cache.txt` once after an update to have earlier results read again.

Name and spelling side by side. A tag such as Kaneko Ayano カネコアヤノ or HAKU ハク。 (Jap.) (the Latin name followed by the same name in kana, without brackets) shows just the Latin part: when the kana really spell the Latin name (also with the words swapped, long vowels and small spelling differences ignored). Artist tags with kanji (Anri 杏里, Ichiko Aoba 青葉市子) are shown as the Latin part too, as soon as the track has been seen in a list; the characters alone elsewhere (杏里) then show the Latin name as well. Particles after a kanji get their own word (日本 no shitipoppu), and kana written with a separate voicing mark (ト + ゛) are joined first.

The reading dictionary. Mousiki knows the readings of some fifty well-known Japanese artists whose names are written in kanji (米津玄師 = Yonezu Kenshi, 椎名林檎 = Shiina Ringo, 坂本龍一 = Sakamoto Ryuichi ...). You can add your own words (or correct one) in the text file `kanji_readings.txt` in the folder of `config.txt` (`~/.config/mousiki/`, `%USERPROFILE%\.config\mousiki\` on Windows), one per line, UTF-8:

```
# a word (or a whole title) = its reading; the longest match wins, also inside
longer texts
夜に駆ける = Yoru ni Kakeru
```

```
一青窈 = Hitoto Yo
# which language a text is (used for its characters when nothing else says it)
chinese: 周杰倫
japanese: 東京事変
```

The file is read when Mousiki starts. The dictionary wins over everything else, and the searches use it too.

Searching needs no switch: the library search (`/`), the meta editor, the playlist editor and the search of the queue overlay always also look at the Latin spelling of titles, artists and albums, so `sakura` finds さくら, `hanguk` finds 한국어 노래 and `zhou jielun` finds 周杰伦 (Chinese: only when the text is recognised as Chinese, see above; the typo tolerance, the accents and the run-together words of the fuzzy search work on that spelling too). The characters themselves are found as before. The **radio's** station search (the main screen, the menus and the station lists) does the same with the Latin spelling of station names, genres and countries. The **Radio Browser** search (the online station search) is answered by the radio-browser.info server, which only matches the text as it is stored there, so the Latin spelling does not apply to it. The radio's station search (main screen, menus, station lists) does the same with station names, genres and countries. The **Radio Browser** search (`SHIFT+s`-style online search) is answered by the radio-browser.info server, which only matches the text as it is written there, so it cannot use the Latin spelling unfortunately.

Cover fetch overlay (`ALT+c`)

On macOS the default is `SHIFT+q` (see `ALT` on macOS); rebind Open Cover Fetch under Settings → Reference if you like.

Finds the **front cover** of albums on MusicBrainz / the Cover Art Archive and saves it next to your music. It is an overlay of its own (and not a tab of the meta editor) on purpose: MusicBrainz is sometimes wrong or unsure about album titles that come from loose files, so fetching those was not included in the meta data menu and should be a deliberate step on a list you have looked at, not something that runs along while tags are edited. Music player only (`HKeyCoverFetch` in `config.txt` changes the key; `SHIFT+c` stays the conversion overlay). Needs Python 3 (`scripts/fetch_cover.py`, only the standard library) and an internet connection.

Two tabs, switched with `←` / `→` or `ALT+←` / `ALT+→`:

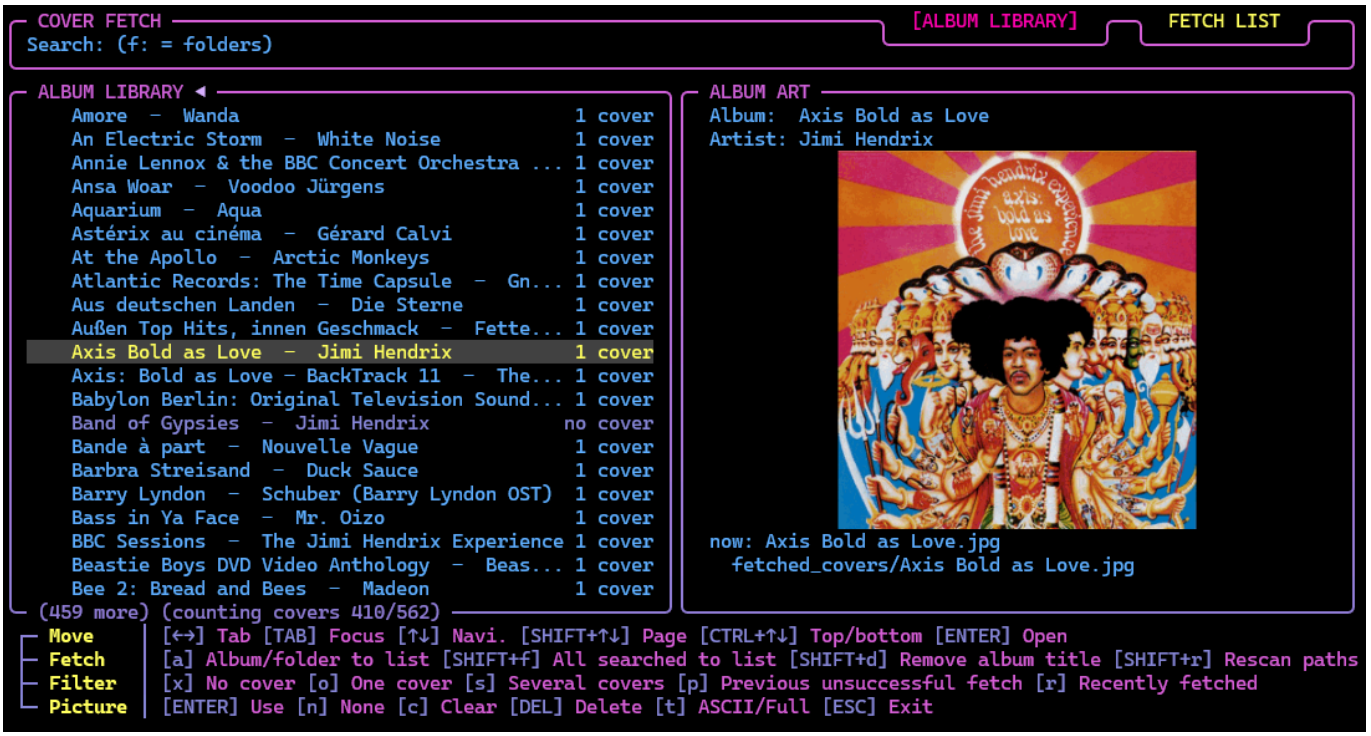
ALBUM LIBRARY looks like the meta editor: a search bar on top, the **ALBUM LIBRARY** on the left, the **ALBUM ART** on the right.

- The search works like the meta editor's: `f:` lists matching folders (`f:abbey`), anything else searches the whole meta data of the tracks. The result is a list of **folders** (`ENTER` or `SPACE` opens one, the albums are indented below it); inside a folder only the **album names** (the album tag) are listed, each once, with the number of covers it has. Tracks without an album tag are not listed (the pane says how many).
- An album **without any cover** is drawn in the legend colour. "Cover" means a picture connected to the album: the one inside the first file, a fetched cover, a picture of the folder whose name is close to the album, `cover.jpg` / `folder.jpg` ... when the folder holds only this album, or a picture you chose for it.
- Filters: `x` albums with **no cover**, `o` with **one cover**, `s` with **several covers**, `p` albums with a **previous unsuccessful fetch**, `r` albums **recently fetched** (the last 14 days; the list shows just album and artist; check the covers in the picture pane), (the pane title shows it, `ESC` takes it off). Albums MusicBrainz or the Cover Art Archive had nothing for are **remembered** and are not listed any more, so they are not

asked for again and again; only `p` shows them, and `a` on one tries it again. A temporary problem is not remembered but tried again: HTTP 500 (*internal server error*) and 503 (*service unavailable*) mean that the MusicBrainz / Cover Art Archive server is busy or hiccups, not that the album is unknown. Such albums are asked for again after the rest of the list, up to three more times, after pauses of 45, 90 and 135 seconds (the status line counts down; `SHIFT+c` stops). The title search first asks for the exact title and then uses MusicBrainz' fuzzy search, which tolerates typos and small differences (a close title is still required). While the covers are still being counted the footer says so.

- The ALBUM ART pane starts with the **album title and the artist**; the highlighted album's row and these two lines scroll as a marquee when they are too long (Settings → *Marquee Scrolling*).
- `SHIFT+d` **removes the album title** of the highlighted album (after a question): the album tag of all its tracks becomes an empty, *pending* edit of the meta data editor, so a wrong title can be taken away here and the album is tagged again there; nothing is written to the files until `CTRL+s` in the meta editor (`CTRL+SHIFT+x` discards). The album leaves this list as an untagged one. Pending album edits of the meta editor are also what this list shows.
- `a` puts the highlighted album (on a folder row: all its albums) on the fetch list, `SHIFT+f` puts everything the search shows (respecting the filter) on it.
- `t` switches the cover of the right pane between **ASCII** (braille dots) and **full resolution** (a real picture, with Kitty / Sixel terminals). Full resolution is the default; a terminal without Kitty / Sixel always shows ASCII. The switch is shared with the cover pane of the meta editor (`t` there, see below).
- `TAB` moves the focus search bar → library → **ALBUM ART**. The right pane shows the cover the album has now and, below it, the pictures that belong to it. In that list `↑` / `↓` preview a picture, `ENTER` makes it the **cover of this album name** (an album default), `n` shows no cover for the album, `c` clears the choice (Settings → Cover Search decides again), `DEL` / `d` deletes the picture from the disk after a question (not the one inside a file). A picture you chose for a **single track** in the meta editor goes before this album default.

FETCH LIST holds the albums to fetch. `ENTER` (after a question that says that the album name and the artist (the one most tracks of the album have) are sent to MusicBrainz, and song titles only as a fallback: the search asks for album + artist first, exact and then fuzzy; only when that finds nothing, up to three song titles of the album are added, which limits the search to releases that contain one of those songs, and a release found that way is marked `[songs confirmed]` in the `r` filter) fetches them one after the other, `SHIFT+c` stops, `DEL` removes one, `SHIFT+d` empties the list. Every album is asked for **once**, however many songs it has; only the **front** cover is taken, and where the archive offers several sizes the lightweight JPEG is preferred. The cover is saved as `fetched_covers/<album>.jpg` **inside every folder that holds a track of the album** (copied when the album is spread over several folders, so there can be duplicates; that is fine with JPEGs). The folder is part of every Cover Search option except **Within File Only**, so a fetched cover is found by the player and the other overlays right away. Albums MusicBrainz does not know, or without a front cover in the archive, are marked in the legend colour with the reason. Closing the overlay does not stop a running fetch. `ALT+c` opens the overlay and closes it again (also from the search field); `SHIFT+r` rescans the music folders (new, moved or removed files) without leaving the overlay.



5. Queue (main UI)

The queue is a list of tracks that play **before** the normal list continues. The bottom border of the pane shows how many titles are below the visible rows (`( 5 more )`), like the list pane. Press `TAB` to move focus into the queue panel when you want the arrow keys or `d`, `4`, `5`, `SHIFT+4`, `SHIFT+5` to work on it.

Key	Action	What it does
`a`	Add hovering track as **next**	With the **list** focused, puts the highlighted track at the **front** of the queue, so it plays next. Pressing `a` on several tracks in a row keeps their order: A, B, C play as A, B, C. On a playlist row it queues all of the playlist's tracks at the end instead. With the **queue** focused, `a` does nothing (the **bulk-add** panel is `SHIFT+g`, see below).
`e`	Add hovering track to the **end**	With the **list** focused, adds the highlighted track to the end of the queue. On a playlist row it queues the whole playlist at the end. With the queue focused it only reminds you to focus the list first.
`d`	Remove hovering track from queue	Removes the highlighted queue item. Focus the queue with `TAB` first.
`4`	Move hovering queue item up	Moves the highlighted queue item one place up. Focus the queue first.
`5`	Move hovering queue item down	Moves the highlighted queue item one place down. Focus the queue first.
`$` (Shift+4)	Move to top	Moves the highlighted queue item to the very top of the queue.
`%` (Shift+5)	Move to bottom	Moves the highlighted queue item to the very bottom of the queue.

Key	Action	What it does
`!`	Lock / unlock the queue	The queue is **locked by default**: a played track moves to the end of the queue. Unlocked, it leaves the queue. See *Locked queue* below.
`X` (Shift+X)	Clear the whole queue	Asks "Want to clear queue?" first. See below.
`CTRL+SHIFT+z`	Undo the last queue clear	Brings back the queue that `SHIFT+x` cleared. See *Undo clear* below.
`CTRL+SHIFT+u`	Queue to playlist	Saves the queue's local tracks as a playlist. See *Queue to playlist* below.
`SHIFT+a`	Add the highlighted library track to a playlist	Opens a small overlay (new / existing playlist) and saves the track into it at once. See *Add a track straight to a playlist* in the Playlists chapter.
`SHIFT+g`	Bulk add	Opens the bulk-add panel (paste a YouTube playlist link) from any pane, not only with the queue focused. See *Bulk add* below. Rebindable (Settings → REFERENCE: *Bulk Add*).
`K` (Shift+K)	Big queue overlay	Floats a larger version of the QUEUE pane over the main UI. See below.

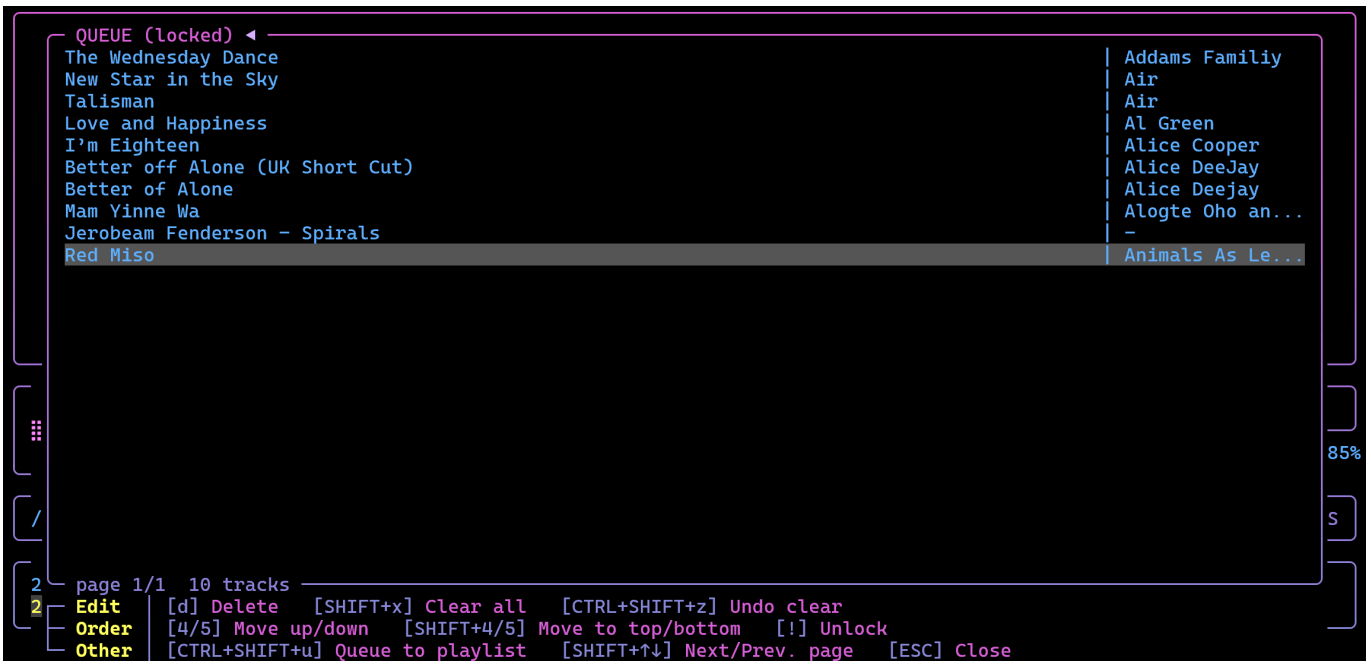
Big queue overlay (`SHIFT+k`)

The same idea as the big list overlay, for the queue: a large window that shows the QUEUE pane with many more rows. It is on `SHIFT+k` (and not on `q`) so that you cannot quit the app by accident. It shares the cursor with the small queue pane, and the queue is automatically focused while it is open, so the arrow keys move through the queue. The artist column has twice the room it has in the small pane (32 characters instead of 16, in a window wide enough for it).

Key	Action
`SHIFT+ARROW_DOWN` / `SHIFT+ARROW_UP`	Next / previous **page**. At the end the cursor jumps to the last / first entry.
`ARROW_UP` / `ARROW_DOWN`	Move one row
`4` / `5` (default)	Move the hovered track up / down in the queue
`SHIFT+4` / `SHIFT+5` (default)	Move the hovered track to the top / bottom of the queue
`!` (default)	Lock / unlock the queue
`d`	Remove the hovered track from the queue
`a`	Does nothing while the queue is focused: it only adds a track from the library pane. Use `SHIFT+g` (rebindable: **Bulk Add**) to open the bulk-add panel from any pane

Key	Action
SHIFT+x	Clear the whole queue (asks first)
CTRL+SHIFT+z	Undo the last queue clear
CTRL+SHIFT+u	Save the queue as a playlist (opens the playlist editor)
ESC or SHIFT+k	Close the overlay (the previous focus is restored)

Only one of the big overlays can be open at a time: SHIFT+k while the list overlay is open switches to the queue overlay, and vice versa. The same goes for the **folder overlay** (SHIFT+f): from the list or the queue overlay SHIFT+f switches to it, and inside it SHIFT+l / SHIFT+k switch back, without closing the overlay first. Pressing / in the queue overlay opens its own **search bar at the bottom** (under the queue box, so it cannot be mistaken for the search of the list overlay): the entries of the queue that match (typo tolerant like the library search; it looks in the title, artist, album, year, file and folder names and in **every tag of the file**, also the ones no screen shows, such as genre, composer, album artist or comment: the tags of the queued files are read in the background when you start typing, so a match on a hidden tag can take a moment to appear) are marked in the header colour and the cursor jumps to the first one; ↑ / ↓ go to the previous / next match, ENTER leaves the bar (the matches stay marked), ESC clears the search (and the next ESC closes the overlay). The queue keeps its order, nothing is hidden. The bar shows the number of matches. Playback keys (n, b, p, seek, volume) keep working. The bottom border of the frame shows the page counter and the number of tracks. All commands of the overlay are listed in a gray **legend below the frame** ([d] delete, [SHIFT+x] clear all, [4/5] move up/down, [SHIFT+4/5] move to top/bottom, [!] lock / [!] unlock, [CTRL+SHIFT+u] queue to playlist, [CTRL+SHIFT+z] undo clear, [SHIFT+UP/DOWN] page, [ESC] close).



Big queue overlay can be opened via SHIFT+k and closed via the same command or ESC. Fast scrolling (scroll per page) is possible via SHIFT+↑/↓.

Locked queue (!)

The queue is **locked by default**. A locked queue keeps all its tracks: when a track is played (by auto-advance or by n) it **moves to the end of the queue**, so the queue loops instead of draining, and the next track is always the one at the top, also in shuffle mode: n and the end of a track always take the next title of the queue, only # picks a random one (it is sent to the end the same way). d and SHIFT+x still remove tracks, locking only stops tracks from disappearing by themselves. The panel title shows QUEUE (locked).

Press ! to **unlock**: a track then **leaves the queue** once it is played, and the queue runs empty. Press ! again to lock it. The lock state is part of the saved session, so a session saved by an older version keeps the state it was saved with (press ! once if it comes back unlocked). The play modes do not change this, with one exception: in Q (queue then stop) a locked queue is played through once and playback then stops instead of looping.

Undo clear (CTRL+SHIFT+z)

Brings back the queue that was cleared last with SHIFT+x. The restored tracks go in **front of** anything that was queued after the clear. There is **one** level of undo: after it is used (or before anything was cleared) the status line says that there is nothing to undo.

Queue to playlist (CTRL+SHIFT+u)

A small overlay asks first: **New playlist** or **Existing playlist** (← / → or TAB to choose, ENTER confirms, or press n / e directly; ESC closes it). With **Existing playlist** the overlay shows a search field and a list of the saved playlists (all of them while the search is empty); ↑ / ↓ choose, ENTER adds the queue's tracks to that playlist (ones it already holds are skipped), ESC goes back. Either way the playlist editor then opens on the Create/Edit tab and **the change still has to be saved with CTRL+s**.

With **New playlist** the editor opens with the queue's tracks already in the new playlist and the **name field focused**: type a name and press CTRL+s to save (the editor stays open, ESC leaves the name field, a second ESC leaves the editor). Playlists hold local files only, so **online (streamed) queue items are left out** and counted in the status line; duplicate files are added once. With an empty queue, or a queue with online tracks only, nothing opens and the status line says so.

Clear queue prompt (SHIFT+x)

The prompt starts on **No**, so an accidental ENTER never wipes the queue.

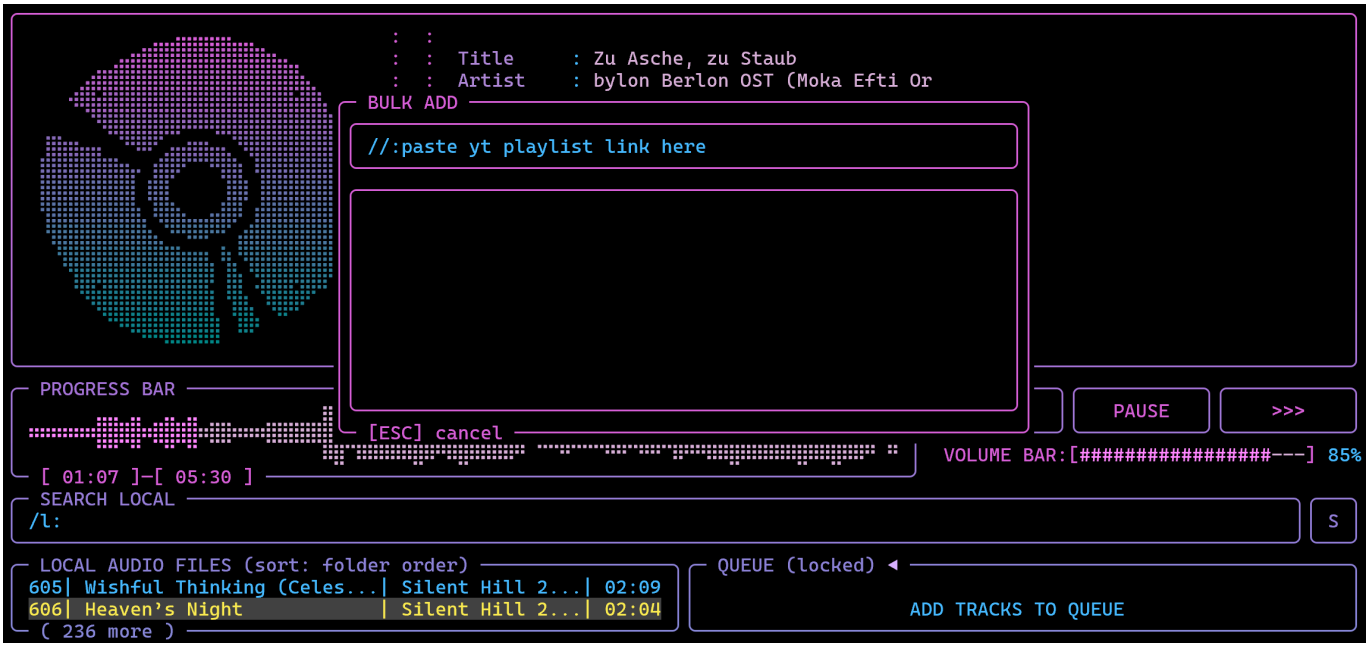
Key	Result
←	Highlight Yes
→	Highlight No
TAB	Toggle between Yes and No
ENTER	Take the highlighted answer
y	Yes: clear the queue
n, ESC or any other key	No: cancel

If the queue is already empty, the status line just says so. A cleared queue can be brought back with CTRL+SHIFT+z (see above).

Bulk add (SHIFT+g)

Paste a YouTube playlist link to queue tracks from it. Bulk add only puts the titles into the queue: **nothing is downloaded when adding**; each track is fetched when it is played.

1. **Type or paste the link** and press ENTER to fetch it (ESC cancels). The link field is a normal text box: ← / → move the caret, SHIFT+← / SHIFT+→ mark, HOME / END, DEL, CTRL+c / CTRL+x / CTRL+v.
2. Once the results appear: ↑/↓ move, SPACE stars or unstars a row, a queues **all** of them, and ENTER queues **only the starred** ones.
3. ESC throws everything away.



Bulk add with the fetched results.

---

6. Playlists

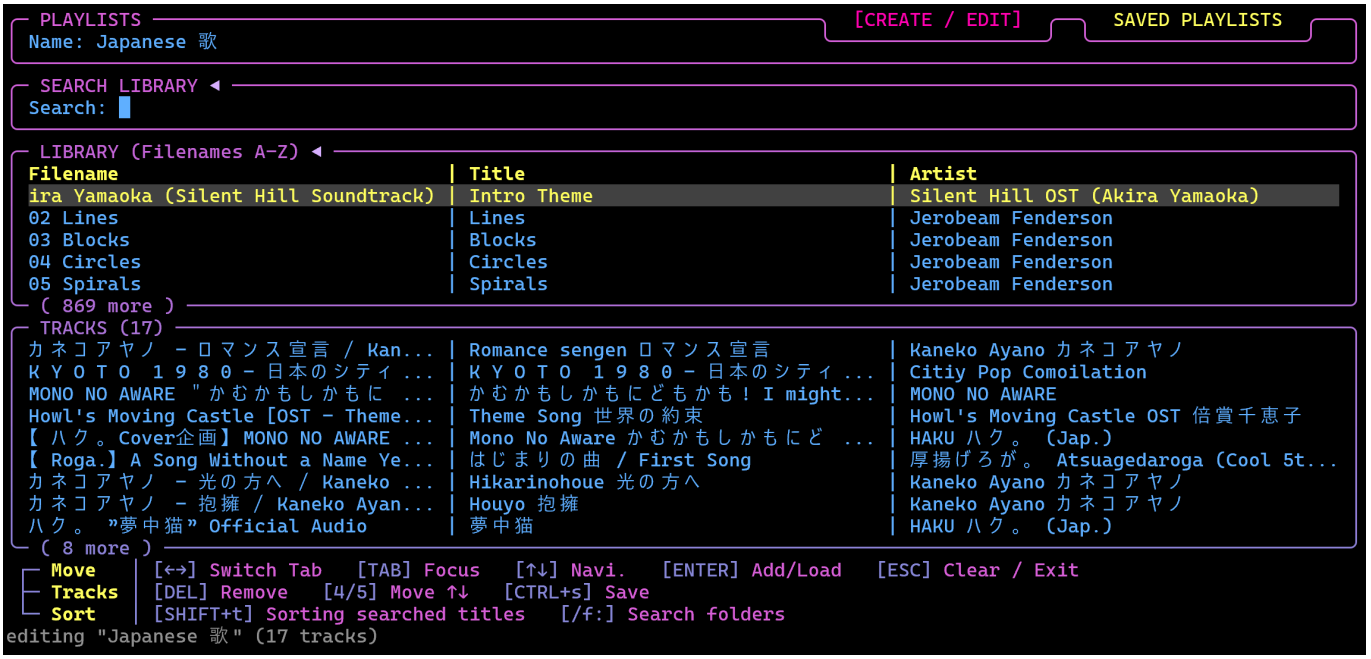
P (Shift+P) opens the **playlist editor**, a full-screen overlay for building playlists from your local (or downloaded) tracks. It has two tabs: **Create/Edit** and **Saved Playlists**. Playlists are used from the main screen with /p: (see Search). The editor uses the same tab strip as the settings: the title and, on the Create/Edit tab, the **name field** (25 characters) sit on its top line, the tab names on the right.

The LIBRARY and TRACKS panes of the Create/Edit tab share four columns: **Filename** (a narrow one: half as wide as it used to be), **Title**, **Artist** and **Album** (the album tag, - when there is none). On the row under the cursor every column that is too long for its width scrolls as a marquee (Settings → GENERAL → *Marquee Scrolling*; off: cut with ...).

Playlists are stored in **one** folder, set under **Settings** → **PATHS** → **PLAYLIST PATH**. Without it, the first local path plus /playlists is used. Changing the playlist path **copies** the existing playlists to the new folder; nothing is moved or deleted.

When the meta editor **renames** a file, every saved playlist that contains it is updated, so the track does not turn up as [missing]. A track whose file is no longer at the stored path (moved to another folder, or a folder renamed) is looked up by file name in your library, i.e. in the folders added under **Settings** → **PATHS**, and is used from its new place; the playlist file is rewritten when you save the playlist and also whenever the library is

rescanned (the rescan updates all saved playlists and the titles already in the queue, and re-reads their tags). Only a file moved outside those folders stays `[missing]`. The title and artist columns of the Create/Edit tab are read from the files' tags in the background, also for files outside your library (for example a download folder); until a file has been read the columns show `-` and the folder name.



Create / Edit *tab: the name field, the library picker with its search (/), and the tracks of the playlist being built.*



Saved Playlists *tab: the search field and the list of saved playlists with their track counts.*

Key	What it does
P	Open Playlists (create / manage)
← / →	Switch between the Create/Edit tab and the Saved Playlists tab. In the name field or a search box they move the caret instead **once you have typed something there**; ESC leaves the box and gives them back to the tab switch (see Menus with tabs and text boxes).

Key	What it does
ALT+← / ALT+→	Switch the tab from every pane, also while typing.
TAB	Cycle focus. On Create/Edit: name field → library picker → track list. On Saved Playlists: search box ↔ list.
↑ / ↓	Move through the focused list or picker
ENTER	Depends on focus. See the table below.
4 / 5	Move the highlighted track up or down in the playlist you are building
SHIFT+t	Library picker: cycle the **sort** of the library list (and of a search result): folder order → *Filenames A-Z* → *Title A-Z* → *Artist A-Z* → *Album A-Z* → *Recently added* (newest first, by when the file arrived in the library). The current sort is shown in the LIBRARY title. Works as long as nothing was typed in the search box yet (a capital T typed into the box is a letter; press ESC to leave the box, or start with a small t). The key is the main list's *cycle sort* hotkey (HKeyCycleSortMode).
/f:	In the search box: search **folders**. /f:abbey lists every track whose folder (or its parent folder) contains abbey; several words must all match. Combines with the sort.
D / DEL / BACKSPACE	Remove the highlighted track (track list focused). On the Saved Playlists tab, DEL deletes the selected playlist after a Yes/No confirmation.
e	On the Saved Playlists tab (list focused): **export** the selected playlist as an **M3U8** (default) or **M3U** file. See *Exporting a playlist* below.
i	On the Saved Playlists tab (list focused): **import** .m3u / .m3u8 files from a folder (default: the playlist export folder, else the playlist folder). SPACE marks a file, a marks all, TAB switches between folder field and list, ENTER imports the marked files (or the highlighted one), ESC cancels. Missing files and stream URLs are skipped and counted in the status line.
CTRL+s	Save the playlist (from every pane of the Create/Edit tab, also while typing)
SHIFT+← / SHIFT+→, HOME / END	Mark text / jump to the start or end in the name and search fields
CTRL+C / CTRL+X / CTRL+V	Copy, cut and paste text in those fields

Add a track straight to a playlist (SHIFT+a)

In the **main player UI**, with the **library / search result pane** focused (not the library picker inside the playlist menu), SHIFT+a (rebindable: **Add Track To Playlist**) adds the highlighted track to a playlist without opening the playlist editor. It uses the same small overlay as *Queue to playlist*: **New playlist** or **Existing playlist** (← / → or TAB, ENTER, or n / e). With **Existing playlist** you search and pick from the saved playlists; with **New playlist**

you type a name. ENTER adds the track and **saves the playlist at once**; the status line reports it. A track that is already in the playlist is not added twice.

Only tracks can be added, not playlist rows or folder rows (the status line says so). A track from **YouTube, SoundCloud or Bandcamp** is **downloaded automatically** into the download folder first (in the background, the status line says `downloading ...`) and is then added as the local file it has become, so it also shows up in your library. With the queue pane focused the key only reminds you to focus the library pane.

What ENTER does in the playlist editor

Where	Result
Name field	Confirms the name and jumps to the library picker
Library picker	Adds the highlighted track to the playlist. (Typing in this pane filters the library live.)
Saved Playlists, search box	Moves focus to the list
Saved Playlists, list	Loads the selected playlist into the editor

Exporting a playlist (M3U8 / M3U)

On the **Saved Playlists** tab, select a playlist in the list and press e. A small overlay opens:

Row	What it is
Folder	Where the file goes. It starts as **Settings → PATHS → PLAYLIST EXPORT PATH** (or, while that is empty, the playlist folder) and can be changed right here for this one export. The usual text keys work (←/→, SHIFT+←/→, HOME/END, CTRL+C/X/V); ~ is your home folder. A folder that does not exist yet is created.
Format	**M3U8** (the default, UTF-8) or **M3U**. ←/→ or SPACE switch while the row is selected.
File	The file name that will be written: the playlist name plus `.m3u8` / `.m3u`. An existing file of that name is replaced.

TAB or ↑/↓ move between Folder and Format, ENTER (or CTRL+s) exports, ESC cancels. The file is an *extended M3U*: `#EXTM3U`, the playlist name, and per track an `#EXTINF` line (`Artist - Title`, length unknown = `-1`) followed by the track's absolute path. Both formats are written as UTF-8, which current players expect for `.m3u` too. Tracks whose file no longer exists are left out; the status line says how many were exported and how many were missing.

Leaving

In a text box you typed into, the first ESC only leaves the box (the text stays). The next ESC closes the editor. If there are unsaved changes on the Create/Edit tab (a typed name counts), it asks `Save changes to "…" before exiting?`: y saves, n discards and leaves, ESC cancels the question and keeps editing.

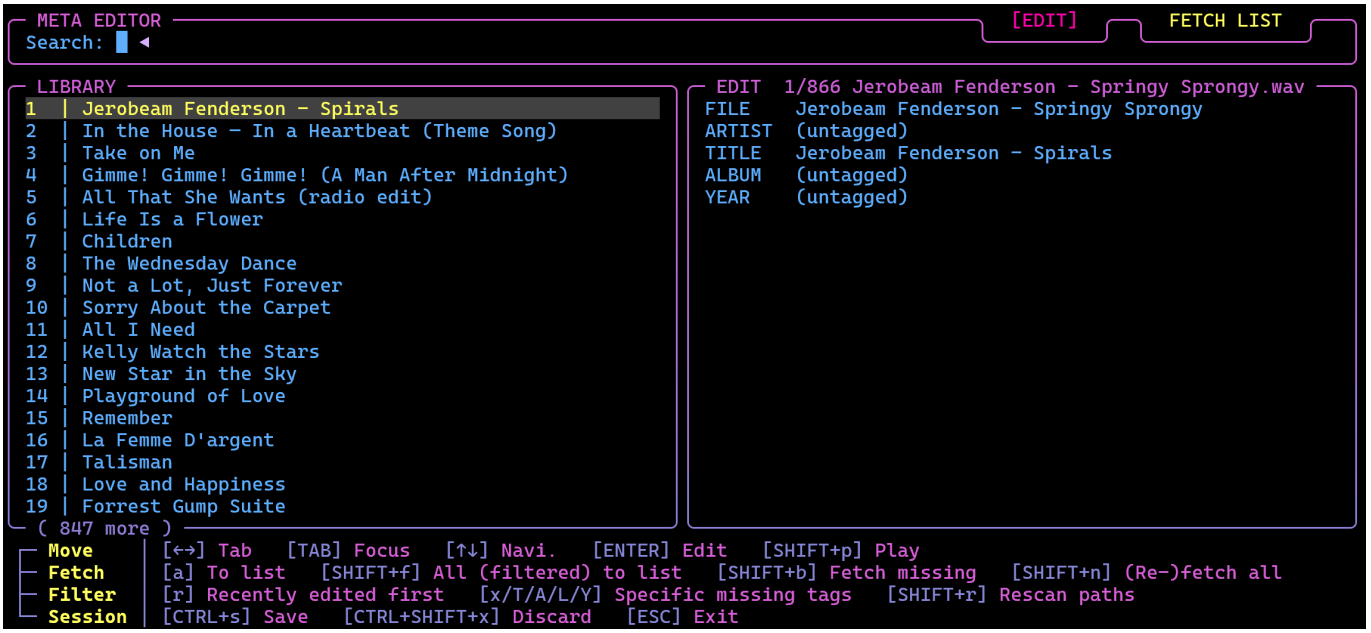
---

7. Meta editor

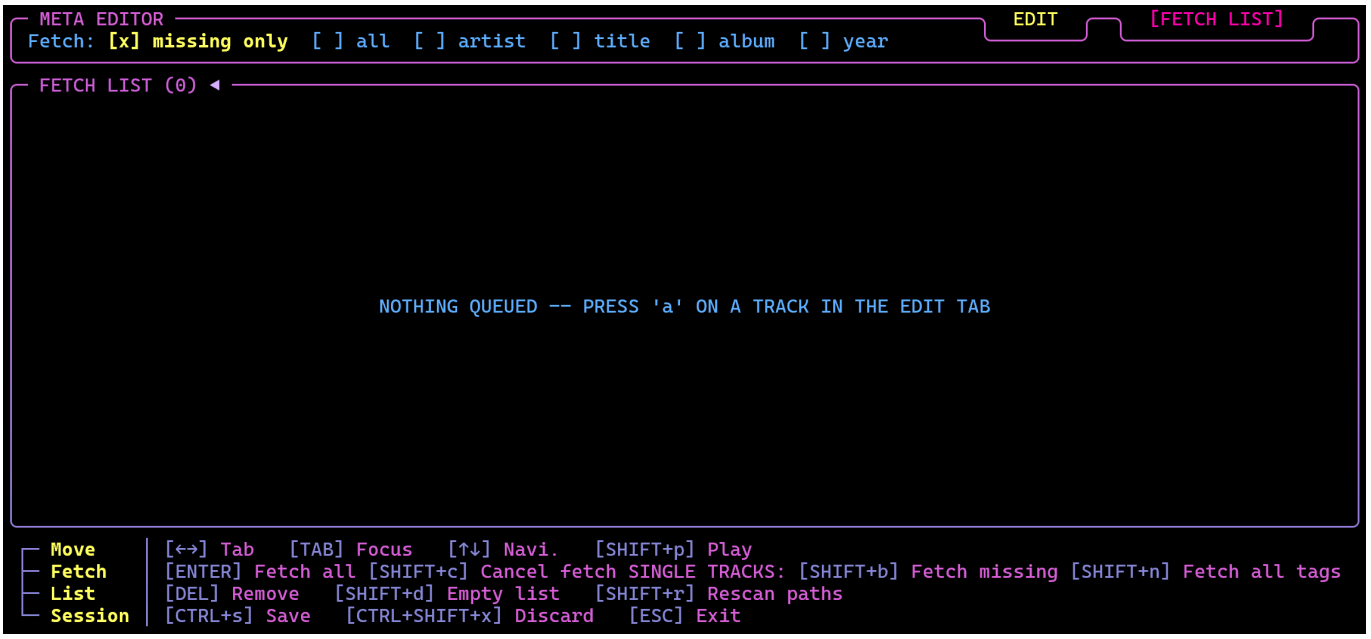
M (Shift+M) opens the **meta/tag editor** for changing a file's **file name**, **artist**, **title**, **album** and **year**, and for looking up missing tags with AcoustID (an audio-fingerprint service) and, for album and year, MusicBrainz. It took quite a while to make this editor and its legends understandable but it is a rather complex menu that may need some time to understand. Alterantive software you could use are Metatogger, but this menu, together with the cover fetch menu, serves the same purpose. If you have ideas to make it even more accessible, feel free to discuss on the github repo of Mousiki Plus!

Important safety rules

- Editing never touches your files directly. All changes go into a **pending edit session**, which is autosaved after every keystroke to ~/.cache/mousiki/meta_session/. Closing the editor, quitting, or even a crash keeps the session.
- **The main screen follows the editor live.** The first line (Title / File) and the Artist / Album / Year lines of the metadata block (and the track title in the oscilloscope / spectrogram windows) show the pending edits of the track that is playing right away, typed by hand or fetched in the editor with SHIFT+n / SHIFT+b, before anything is saved. The first line is labelled **Title** or **File** and follows SHIFT+n like the list rows do: **Title** is the title tag (the file name if the file has none), **File** is the file name (a pending FILE rename shows there). Edits left over from an earlier run appear as soon as the track starts. CTRL+s writes them, and the screen keeps showing the saved values. Sampling, Type, Format, File size and Location are read from the file and are not affected.
- Touched fields and the matching library rows are drawn in the **header colour**, so you can see what will be written.
- Only CTRL+s writes to the files, and it asks first.



***Edit** tab (the search field sits on the second line of the tab strip, left of the tab names): the search field, the library on the left, and the five fields (FILE, ARTIST, TITLE, ALBUM, YEAR) of the highlighted file on the right. The footer lists every key as a small tree table: one row per group (Move, Fetch, View, Session), the group name on the left, its keys on the right.*



Fetch List *tab: the titles queued for an AcoustID lookup. The status line below the footer confirms what was added.*

Key	What it does
`M`	Open the meta editor
`←` / `→`	Switch between the **Edit** tab and the **Fetch List** tab. In the **search field** they move the caret instead once you have typed something there (`ESC` gives them back to the tab switch); in the **field editor** they always move the caret.
`ALT+←` / `ALT+→`	Switch the tab from everywhere, also while typing.
`TAB`	Cycle panels on the Edit tab: search field → library → field editor
`↑` / `↓`	Move through the focused list, or between the five fields in the field editor
`ENTER`	Depends on focus (see below). On the **Fetch List** tab it fetches the full list (with the ticked options). On a field with several fetched options it opens the choice overlay.
`SHIFT+←` / `SHIFT+→`	Mark text in the search field and the field editor
`CTRL+C` / `CTRL+X` / `CTRL+V`	Copy, cut, paste in the search field and the field editor
`a`	Add the highlighted file to the **fetch list** (library focused). Add a single title and tick the boxes on the Fetch List tab to fetch just some tags of it
`SHIFT+f`	**Add full (searched/filtered) list**: adds every title the library pane shows right now to the fetch list (library focused). The search and the missing-tag filter (`x`, `SHIFT+t/a/l/y`) are applied, titles already on the list are skipped, the status line says how many were added. Typical use: filter for `SHIFT+l` (missing album), press `SHIFT+f`, switch to the Fetch List tab and press `ENTER`
`f`	**Folder view** (library focused)

Key	What it does
`r`	Toggle **edited files on top** of the library pane. If **no titles appear** (or fewer than you expect), a missing-tag filter (`x`, `SHIFT+t/a/l/y`) may still be active: it hides every file that is not missing that tag. The status line then ends with `NOTE: [MISSING TITLE] filter active, hit [ESC] to clear filter` (the name of the active filter); `ESC` in the library pane clears the filter (a second `ESC` then switches the `r` / `n` order off). The same note appears after `n`.
`n`	Toggle **recently added first** in the library pane (newest arrived files on top; with `r` on, the edited files stay above them). What is active is shown in the pane title, joined with a plus: `FILE LIBRARY [EDITED FIRST + ADDED FIRST + MISSING TITLE]`. `ESC` in the library pane takes things off step by step: the first `ESC` clears the missing-tag filter, the next one switches `r` and `n` off, the one after that moves up to the search bar (`r` and `n` can also be switched off by pressing them again).
`x`	Filter the library to files missing **any** metadata (library pane focused; press again to clear)
`SHIFT+t`	Filter the library to files missing a **title** (press again to clear)
`SHIFT+a`	Filter the library to files missing an **artist** (press again to clear)
`SHIFT+l`	Filter the library to files missing an **album** (press again to clear)
`SHIFT+y`	Filter the library to files missing a **year** (press again to clear)
`SHIFT+p`	**Play** the hovering track (library pane and fetch list)
`SHIFT+b`	**Fetch missing tag**: look up the highlighted title via AcoustID and fill in only its empty tags (asks first)
`SHIFT+n`	**(Re-)fetch all**: the same, but all tags are fetched and overwrite the existing ones (library pane or fetch list focused; asks first)
`SHIFT+c`	**Cancel the running fetch** (Fetch List tab). The lookup stops at once. What had already arrived stays as pending edits; the titles that were not fetched yet (and the failed ones) stay on the fetch list, so you can start them again later
`DEL` / `d`	Remove the highlighted title from the **fetch list**. It only takes a title off that list: it never deletes the file and does not touch pending edits. If the title is not on the fetch list, the status line says `not on the fetch list`.
`CTRL+s`	Apply all pending edits to the files (asks first). Every file is rewritten through ffmpeg (the audio is copied, not re-encoded), so hundreds of edits take a while. The program stays alive: the status line counts `saving 37 / 412 ...`, and when it lasts longer than about a second a **Please wait, this may take a few seconds** panel with a progress bar appears. `ESC` stops after the current file; what is not saved yet stays pending, and so does a file that failed
`SHIFT+d` / `SHIFT+DEL`	**Empty the whole fetch list** (fetch list tab; asks first). Only the list: pending edits -- the tags already fetched included -- stay until `CTRL+s` saves or `CTRL+SHIFT+x` discards them. Not while a fetch runs (`SHIFT+c` stops it).

Key	What it does
CTRL+SHIFT+x	Discard all pending edits, fetched tags included, **and** empty the fetch list (asks first)
SHIFT+r	Rescan the library (library pane or fetch list focused), e.g. after new files arrived
SHIFT+↑ / SHIFT+↓	Library pane, fetch list and fields: move one **page** up / down
CTRL+↑ / CTRL+↓	The same lists: jump to the **first / last** row (some desktops use CTRL+↑↓ themselves, e.g. macOS Mission Control; then use SHIFT+↑↓)
ESC	In the field editor: back to the library. In the library pane with a missing-tag filter (x / SHIFT+t / a / y / l) on: the **first ESC only removes the filter**, the next one moves to the search field. In the search field: the first ESC **clears the query**, the next one closes the editor (the session is kept). Otherwise: close the editor.
/f:	In the search field: search **folders**, e.g. /f:abbey lists every track whose folder (or its parent folder) contains abbey (several words must all match). Same as in the playlist editor.

What ENTER does in the meta editor

Where	Result
Search field	Keeps the filter and moves to the library list
Library list	Starts editing the highlighted file's fields
Field editor	Finishes editing this field and goes back to the library (ESC does the same). On a field with several fetched options: opens the choice overlay.
Fetch List tab	**Fetch full list**: every title in the list, only the ticked tags (asks first)

The cover in the meta editor: Cover Options

On the EDIT tab the cover of the highlighted track is shown under the five fields (centred in the free space). It is a real picture on Kitty / Sixel terminals (the default) and braille dots otherwise; t switches between **ASCII** and **full resolution** (the same switch as in the cover fetch menu; shown in the Filter row of the legend). While a floating panel (Cover Options, a tag choice, saving) is open the cover is drawn as dots. Below the fields sits the button **Cover Options** (move to it with ↓, ENTER opens it). The overlay lists what the track can use, with a preview of the highlighted one on the right:

- **Automatic**: Settings → Cover Search decides (removes your choice for the track),
- **No cover**: the track shows the disk,
- the picture **inside the file**, the pictures in the track's **folder** and in its **fetched_covers** folder, and the covers of the track's album,
- a **search by file name** (TAB or /): filters that list and also looks into the folders around the track.

ENTER uses the highlighted picture for **this track**; DEL / d deletes a picture from the disk after a question (pictures in the folder or in fetched_covers; the picture inside a file cannot be deleted); ESC closes. A choice made here goes **before** the album's default (cover fetch overlay) and before the Cover Search setting, with one exception: **Within File Only** always uses the picture inside the file. Choices are kept in ~/.cache/mousiki/covers/choices.txt.

The style of a track: Style Option

Next to the button **Cover Options** sits **Style Option** (→ / ← switch between the two buttons, ENTER opens). Its small overlay tunes how the cover of **this track** looks, row by row (↑↓ select, ↔ change, DEL or d puts a row back to *as in Settings*). On a terminal at least 100 columns wide the overlay grows a **preview** on its right: the cover of the track with the look, contrast, brightness and colors you have chosen so far (the plain disk when the look is *Disk* or the track has no cover): in a **Kitty / Sixel terminal as a real picture** (the default) and in braille dots otherwise; t switches between picture and braille, as in the cover options. The *Cover ASCII* looks are braille dots anyway.

From the main screen: SHIFT+s opens this overlay for the **track that plays**, on its own (no meta editor behind it); ESC closes it. Opened this way it also has m, which leads on to the **meta data of that very song** (the meta editor, with that track picked). The key can be changed in Settings → REFERENCE (*Open Style Options*, HKeyStyleOptions in config.txt). Music player only; the track has to be in your library.

- **Look of this track**: *as in Settings*, *Disk (no cover)*, *Just Cover*, *Cover with Gradient*, *Cover behind Disk*, *v2*, *Full Anima*, *Cover ASCII*, *Cover ASCII with Gradient*,
- **Cover Contrast**, **Cover Brightness**, **Cover Colors**: 0–100 % in steps of 5, the same settings as in Settings → Disk → Cover, but only for this track,
- **Look of the whole album**: the same list, for every track with the same album tag (a track without one: for its folder).

What a track has of its own wins over the album's look, and that over Settings → *Album Cover* / *Cover Mode*. While the track plays, CTRL+T / CTRL+Z change its look (the track's own, else the album's). Everything is saved at once in ~/.cache/mousiki/covers/choices.txt.

Using the AcoustID lookup

- SHIFT+b (**Fetch missing tag of a single track**) looks up one title and fills in only its empty tags. It works from the meta editor and also directly from the **main list** (only for local files). SHIFT+n (**Fetch all tags**, meta editor) overwrites all its tags. Neither uses the fetch-option boxes; for other combinations add the title to the fetch list and tick the boxes there.
- a collects titles into the fetch list (SHIFT+f adds the whole filtered library pane at once), and ENTER on the Fetch List tab runs them as a batch.
- A running batch is **not** stopped by leaving the meta editor: it continues in the background, the progress (AcoustID: 3/12 ...) shows in the status line of the main screen, and the results arrive as pending edits (open the editor again to review them). SHIFT+c on the Fetch List tab stops it. Quitting Mousiki (or switching to the radio) cancels a running batch too and keeps what had arrived.
- Before anything is fetched you get a disclaimer that the result is not always accurate and that only all or ticked tags overwrite existing tags. Answer with y, n or ESC.
- Results only land in the **edit session**, never directly in the files. Low-confidence matches are reported as "no match" rather than written as wrong tags.

- Applying (CTRL+s) writes the tags without re-encoding the audio. A file name edit becomes a plain rename.

Choosing what is fetched: the fetch options

The header of the **Fetch List** tab has an option line with one checkbox per option:

```
Fetch: [x] missing only [ ] all [ ] artist [ ] title [ ] album [ ] year
```

Key	What it does
TAB	move the focus between the list and the option line (◀ marks the focus)
← / →	move the cursor over the boxes (on the option line)
SPACE	tick or untick the box under the cursor
ENTER	fetch **every track in the list**, only the ticked tags

Option	Fetches
missing only (default)	only the tags that are **empty**; anything that already has a value, typed or in the file, stays as it is
all	artist, title, album and year, **overwriting** what is there
artist / title / album / year	the ticked tags only, overwriting them; these four combine freely

missing only and all exclude each other and the four tag boxes: ticking one of them unticks the others, and ticking a tag box unticks missing only / all. At least one box always stays ticked. The choice is saved with the session and applies to the fetch list (ENTER); SHIFT+b / SHIFT+n do not use it. A title with nothing to fetch is skipped with the message *nothing to fetch*. The lookup itself uses the audio fingerprint only; tags that are already there are not part of the search.

Album and year: MusicBrainz and the choice overlay

Album and year belong to one specific release, so a song often has several answers (the album, its remaster, ...). They come from MusicBrainz (one request per second). The first answer is put into the field; the colour shows what is left to do:

Colour	Meaning
Header colour	like any edit: typed by you, fetched with only one candidate, or a choice you made
Legend colour	several candidates: a choice is waiting. The matching **file row in the LIBRARY pane** uses the same colour

ENTER on a field with several candidates opens the **choice overlay**: ↑/↓ select, ENTER takes the highlighted one, DEL or d discards the fetched value together with all options (the field goes back to what the file has), ESC closes it. Choosing an album also sets the year of that release while the year is still a fetched suggestion.

Open choices are part of the autosaved session. `CTRL+s` mentions them in its question; if some are still open, the first candidate is what gets saved.

---

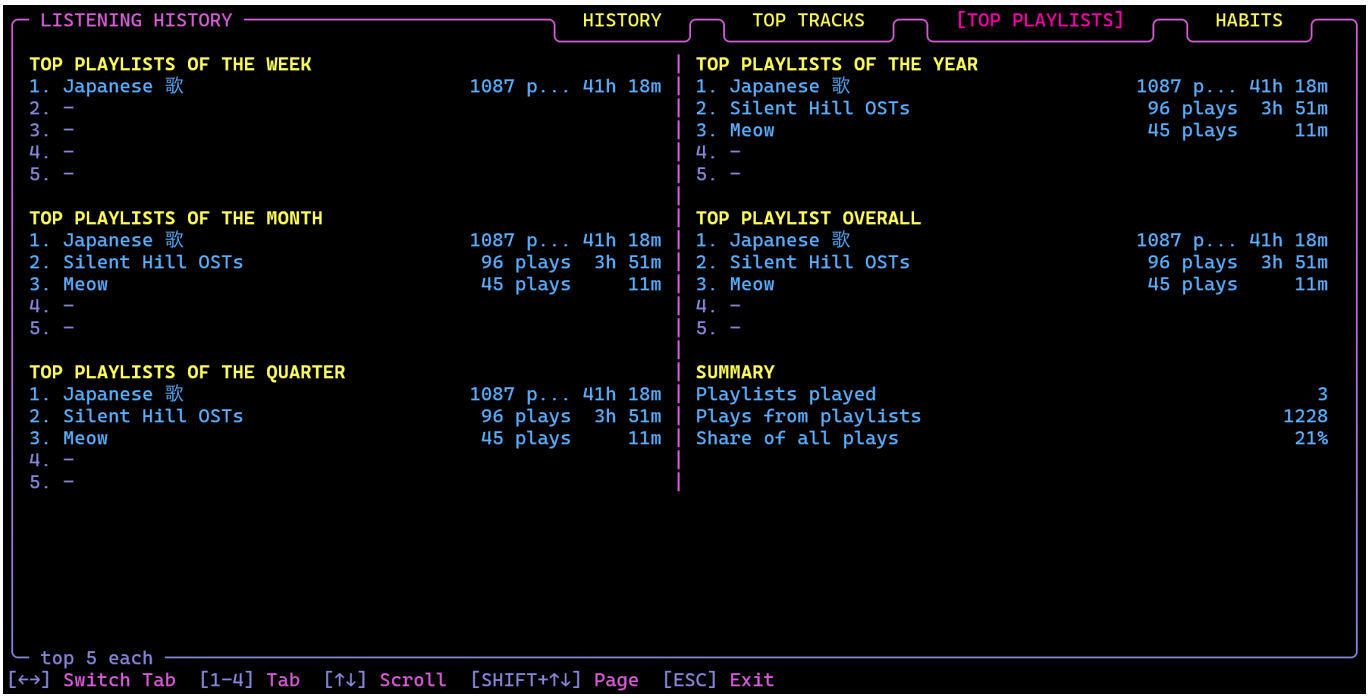
8. History

`H` (Shift+H) opens the **listening history** overlay, with four tabs. Nothing you do here changes your music.

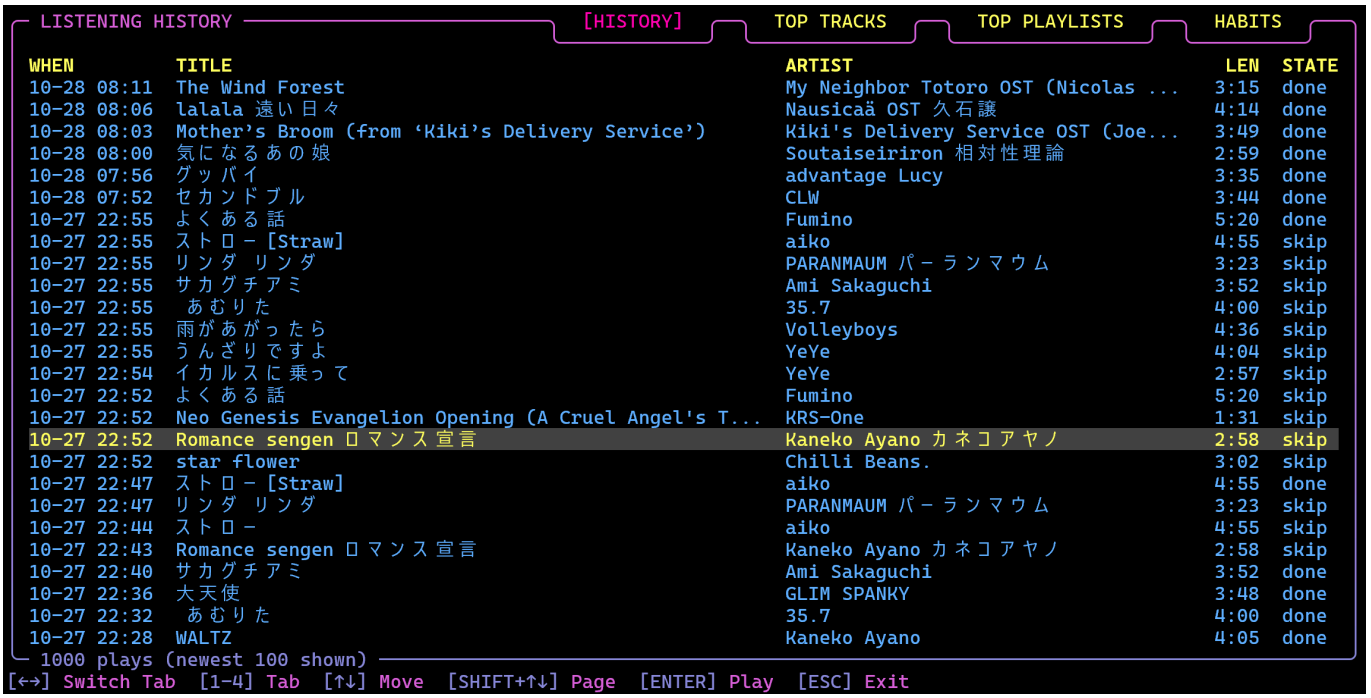
Key	What it does
`H`	Open the history (and close it again). `ESC` and `q` also close it.
`←` / `→`	Switch the tab (not while the ADD SMART HISTORY TO QUEUE pane has the focus, see below)
`1` – `4`	Jump to the tab: **1 History**, **2 Top Tracks**, **3 Top Playlists**, **4 Habits**
`↑` / `↓`	Move the cursor in History and Top Tracks. On Top Playlists and Habits they scroll.
`r`	On **Top Tracks**: flip between *most played first* and *least played first*
`TAB`	On **Top Tracks**: switch between the track list and the **ADD SMART HISTORY TO QUEUE** pane. `TAB` never switches tabs.
`ENTER`	On a track in **History** or **Top Tracks**: **play it right away** (the overlay stays open and the footer says `playing: …`). A local file that no longer exists is reported instead. In the ADD SMART HISTORY TO QUEUE pane: queue the highlighted list.
`ESC`	In the ADD SMART HISTORY TO QUEUE pane: give the focus back to the track list. Otherwise: close the history.

The four tabs

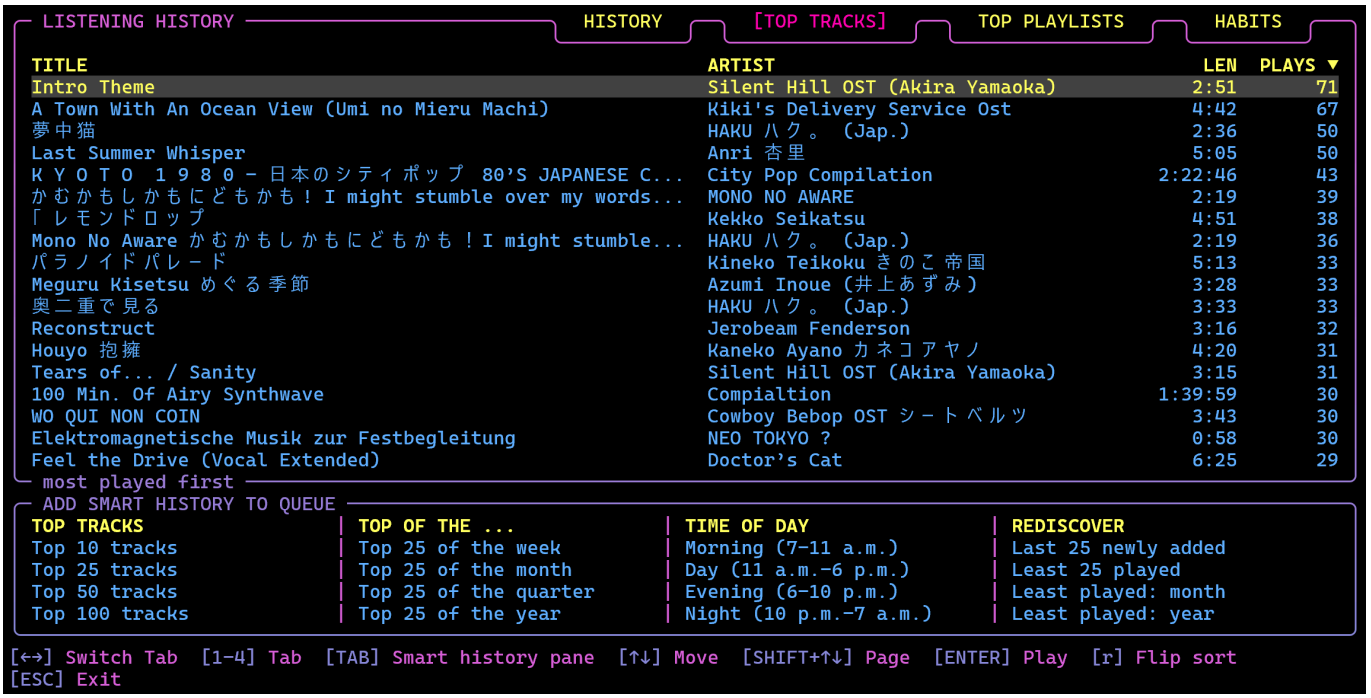
- **History**: the last 100 plays. `ENTER` plays the hovered one.
- **Top Tracks**: one row per title with its artist (separated from the title by `|`, as in the playlist editor), its length and play count, sorted by play count. `ENTER` plays the hovered title.
- **Top Playlists**: the five most played saved playlists of the **week**, **month**, **quarter**, **year** and **overall**, all in one pane (two columns on a wide terminal), with the number of plays and the time listened, plus a small summary (playlists played, plays from playlists, share of all plays). A play counts for a playlist when the track was queued from it (`ENTER` or `a` on a playlist row in the main list, or a queue restored from the last session). Tracks you picked one by one count for no playlist, and plays from before this tab existed carry no playlist, so the lists fill up from now on. Week, month, quarter and year are the last 7, 30, 91 and 365 days, like the smart lists below.
- **Habits**: listening statistics, including average session length, listening time per day, tracks per session, skips, replays and completion rates. *Listening by weekday* shows, per weekday, the **AVERAGE** time (every such weekday since your first play counts, days without music as 0; the bar follows this value) and the **CUMULATIVE** lifetime total.



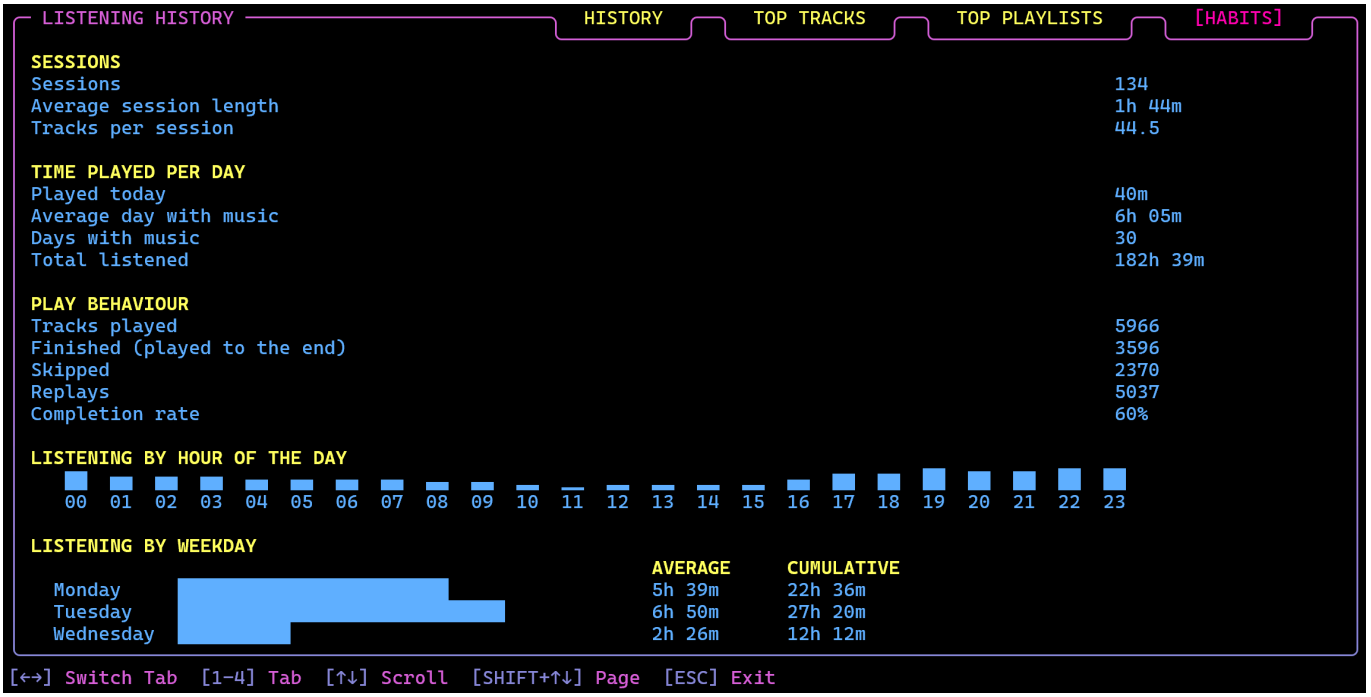
TOP PLAYLISTS tab.



History *tab: when each track was played, its title and artist (in separate columns, laid out like on the Top Tracks tab), its length and its state (*`PLAY` *= playing now,* `done` *= played to the end,* `skip` *= skipped).*



Top Tracks *tab: titles by play count, with the queue pane underneath (now called* ***ADD SMART HISTORY TO QUEUE****, see below; the screenshot shows the older version).*



Habits *tab: sessions, time played per day, and play behaviour.*

The list cursor behaves like the one of the local file list: the column header stays in place and the window only scrolls when the cursor leaves it.

The history is stored in `history.json`. The folder is set under **Settings** → **PATHS** → **HISTORY PATH** (one folder). If the new folder already holds a `history.json` it is used, otherwise the current one is copied there.

In radio mode the radio has its own history of channels, see 11.11.

ADD SMART HISTORY TO QUEUE

The pane under the Top Tracks list holds **sixteen ready-made lists** in four columns, separated by | in the border colour:

TOP TRACKS	TOP OF THE ...	TIME OF DAY	REDISCOVER
Top 10 tracks	Top 25 of the week	Morning (7-11 a.m.)	Last 25 newly added
Top 25 tracks	Top 25 of the month	Day (11 a.m.-6 p.m.)	Least 25 played
Top 50 tracks	Top 25 of the quarter	Evening (6-10 p.m.)	Least played: month
Top 100 tracks	Top 25 of the year	Night (10 p.m.-7 a.m.)	Least played: year

1. Press 2 (or →) for Top Tracks.
2. Press TAB to move into the pane (a ◀ appears behind its title).
3. Pick a list with the arrow keys. **While the pane has the focus, ← / → move between its columns and do not switch tabs.**
4. Press ENTER to add the list to the end of the queue. ESC (or TAB) takes you back to the track list.

What the lists contain:

- **Top 10 / 25 / 50 / 100:** the most-played titles of all time. "Top N" always means the N most-played titles, even if you flipped the list above with r. While fewer titles have been played, the number in brackets shows how many there are.
- **Top 25 of the week / month / quarter / year:** the 25 titles played most in the last 7 / 30 / 91 / 365 days.
- **Morning / Day / Evening / Night:** the 25 titles you play most at that time of day (by the time a play started): morning 7-11 a.m., day 11 a.m.-6 p.m., evening 6-10 p.m., night 10 p.m.-7 a.m.
- **Last 25 newly added:** the 25 files that arrived in your music folders most recently (by the time the file was created / copied there, or its modification time if that is newer). Taken from the local library, played or not.
- **Least 25 played:** 25 tracks of your local library with the fewest plays; tracks never played count as 0. Tracks with the same count come in a random order every time, so this is a good way to rediscover forgotten music.
- **Least played: month / year:** among the titles played in the last 30 / 365 days, the 25 played least often.

Files that have been moved or deleted since they were played are skipped, and the status line reports how many tracks were queued (and how many were missing, or that fewer were available). Online tracks are queued as online tracks.

The history keeps the newest 1000 plays one by one and folds older ones into lifetime totals per title. From v3.1.0 on those totals also remember the day and the time of day of every play, so the period and time-of-day lists stay exact over years. Plays folded by an older version only count for the all-time lists.

---

9. Downloads

Key	Action	What it does
`y`	Save stream	Saves the **currently playing streamed track** -- from YouTube (`/s:`), SoundCloud (`/sc:`) or Bandcamp (`/b:`) -- into your download folder (**Settings → PATHS → DOWNLOAD PATH**, or `~/.cache/mousiki` if none is set). The file is named `Title - Artist.ext`, the cached copy is removed, and the library refreshes so the file appears as a local track. The file keeps the format the site delivered: Opus for YouTube, MP3 / Opus / AAC for SoundCloud, the 128 kbit/s MP3 stream for Bandcamp.

Status messages:

- `saved to <path>`: success
- `already saved: <name>`: a file with that name is already in the folder
- `not a cached stream`: the current track is a regular local file, so there is nothing to download

---

10. Settings (individual tabs)

Press `s` on the main screen to open **Settings**. It has six tabs: **COLORS**, **GENERAL**, **ANIMA/VIZ**, **PATHS**, **REFERENCE** and **ABOUT APP**. Settings always open on the first tab. The footer shows `[TAB] Switch [ENTER] Edit [s] Save settings [ESC/q] Discard` (on the COLORS tab also `[e] Edit/Save current state [SHIFT+e/i] Ex-/Import theme`), and the line below it reports what just changed. While there are changes that are not saved yet, that line shows a green `Unsaved changes! Save with `s` or discard with `ESC`.` note. While a field is being edited the footer changes to `[ENTER] Apply [ESC] Cancel [↔] Cursor [SHIFT+↔] Mark [HOME/END] Jump [Ctrl+C/X/V] Copy/Cut/Paste`. On every tab that scrolls, `SHIFT+↑` / `SHIFT+↓` moves a whole **page** (`[SHIFT+↑↓] Page` in the legend). The bottom line shows the message of your last change (e.g. `lyrics name variants: off ...`) followed by *(unsaved)* while the settings differ from the saved ones.

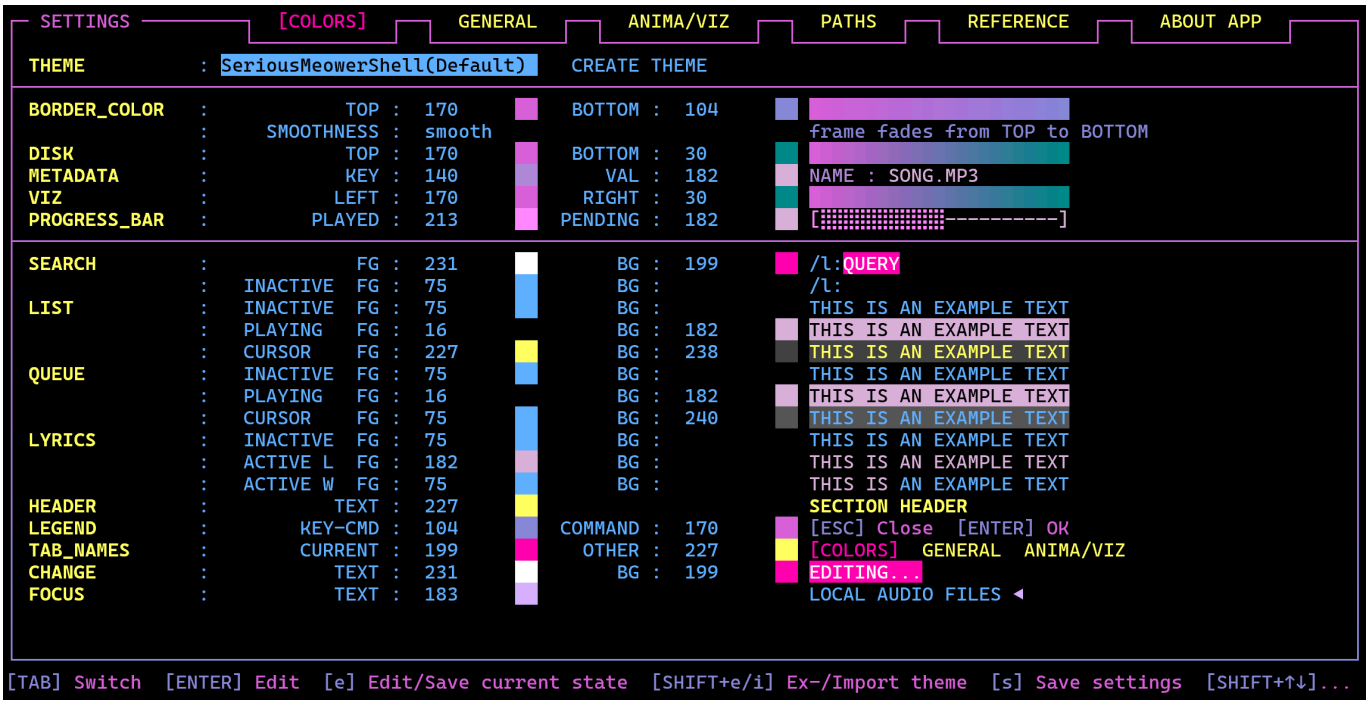
Moving around and editing (all tabs)

Key	What it does
`TAB`	Next tab (wraps from ABOUT APP back to COLORS). The cursor returns to the first row. Not while a field is being edited.
`↑` / `↓`	Previous or next row. On ABOUT APP they scroll the text.
`←` / `→`	On a row with a fixed list of values (switches, sliders, choices), steps through the values and applies the change **immediately**. On COLORS they move between the first and second cell of a row instead.
`ENTER`	Edits the value in place as free text. Not available on ABOUT APP or on the read-only rows of REFERENCE. On PATHS it edits the selected path, or adds one on a `+ new path` row.
`s`	**Saves to `config.txt` and closes** Settings.
`ESC` / `q`	**Discards** every change made since Settings were opened (they are put back as they were) and closes Settings.

Good to know

- Every change is **live**. It takes effect as soon as you make it, so you can see and hear it while you are still in Settings.
- Only `s` writes the changes to `config.txt`. If you leave with `ESC` or `q` instead, everything you changed on the screen, including paths, is put back as it was when you opened Settings. The radio's settings work the same way (see 11.12).
- **Text editing** (after `ENTER`, in every field: colours, paths, values, keys): ←/→ move the caret, `SHIFT+←/→` mark text, `HOME`/`END` jump, `DEL`/`BACKSPACE` delete, `CTRL+C/X/V` copy, cut and paste. `TAB` and the arrows never leave the field: only `ENTER` (confirms) or `ESC` (cancels and discards the edit) do. Ordinary fields hold up to 18 characters, folder paths up to 240.

Tab 1: COLORS



The COLORS tab with the live preview on the right.

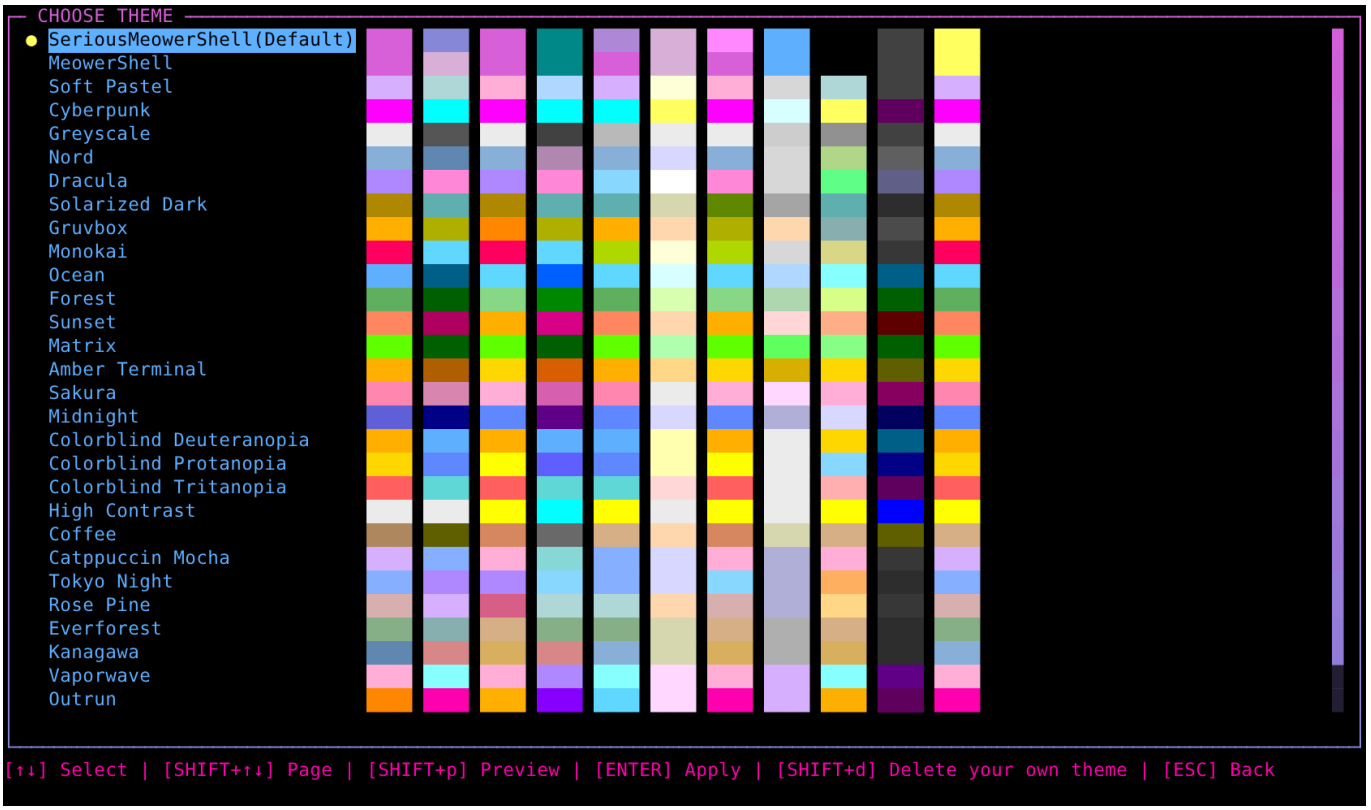
Border gradient (SMOOTHNESS)

The row under BORDER_COLOR switches the frame gradient between **smooth** (default: the border lines fade row by row from the TOP colour to the BOTTOM colour) and **rough** (only the bottom border line of each pane takes the BOTTOM colour). ↔ or `ENTER` toggle it; config key `BorderGradient=smooth|rough` (music player and radio each have their own). The smooth gradient also colours the frames of the floating overlays (big list, queue, folder, conversion and the other panels), not only the main screen.

Colour themes

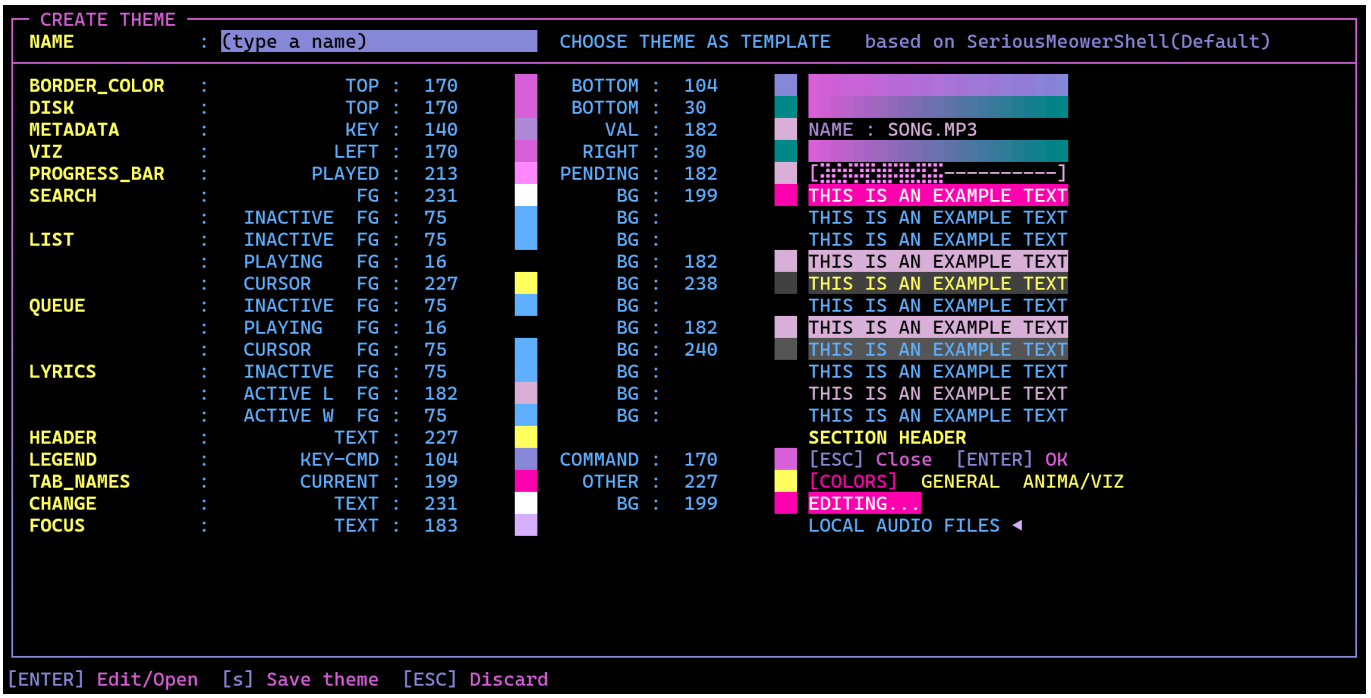
The first row of the COLORS tab (music player **and** radio) is **THEME**. `ENTER` on the theme name opens a list of ready-made colour schemes with swatches; `ENTER` applies one (the field shows `(custom)` when the colors match none). Two themes carry the standard Mousiki look: `SeriousMeowerShell(Default)` (the default of the music player; the colors of the default config.txt) and `MeowerShell`. The default of the radio is `Dracula` and `Soft Pastel` for the audio book player. Thirty more ship with it: Soft Pastel, Cyberpunk, Greyscale, Nord, Dracula, Solarized Dark, Gruvbox, Monokai, Ocean, Forest, Sunset, Matrix, Amber Terminal, Sakura, Midnight, three colour-blind-friendly schemes (Deuteranopia, Protanopia, Tritanopia), High Contrast, Coffee, Catppuccin

Mocha, Tokyo Night, Rose Pine, Everforest, Kanagawa, Vaporwave, Outrun, Ember, Glacier and Lavender Haze. Themes you made yourself are listed after the built-in ones, with their names in the header colour. The list scrolls with ↑ ↓ (SHIFT+↑ / SHIFT+↓ a page at a time) and HOME END when there are more themes than fit on the screen; a scrollbar on the right shows where you are. The template picker of CREATE THEME works the same way. A theme only changes the Colors tab, and like any change it is kept when you save with s and dropped with ESC.



CHOOSE THEME: every theme with its colours; SHIFT+p shows the main screen in the highlighted one.

→ to **CREATE THEME** and ENTER opens a full-size editor: type a name on top (27 characters at most), optionally press ENTER on **CHOOSE THEME AS TEMPLATE** to start from an existing theme, then edit any color cell like on the tab (with the live preview). s stores the theme and applies it; ESC throws it away -- but with anything changed it **asks first** (*Unsaved theme!* s save it, d discard it, ESC keep editing), so a theme is not lost by forgetting s. If the name is already a theme of your own, s asks **"Do you want to overwrite theme ...?"** (y overwrites, anything else goes back); a built-in theme can never be overwritten, its name is refused.

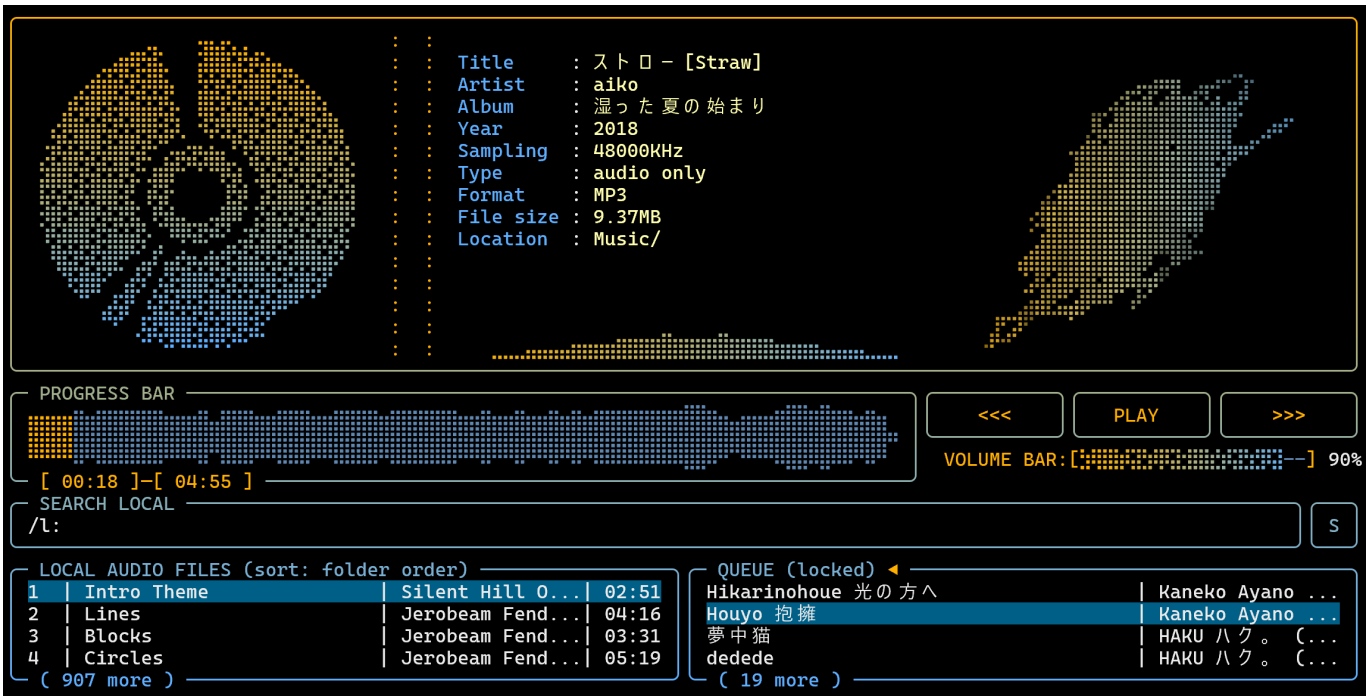


CREATE THEME: name, template and every colour cell with its live preview.

Preview (SHIFT+p). In the CHOOSE THEME list (player and radio) SHIFT+p shows a **still copy of the main screen** drawn with the highlighted theme; any key goes back to the list (nothing is applied). The list's scrollbar is drawn in the colour of the border gradient at its row.

Colours that look the same everywhere. Colour numbers 16-255 are fixed colours: every terminal shows them the same way. 1-15 are the terminal's 16 base colours and follow its colour scheme -- 10 is green in CMD's default scheme but may be yellow in yours -- and an empty text colour means the terminal's own text colour. The built-in themes therefore only use 16-255 (since v4.2.0; a config that still held the old SeriousMeowerShell / MeowerShell values is moved to the new ones once). With **Black Background** on, text that has no colour of its own takes the theme's LIST INACTIVE colour (the terminal's default text colour is set while Mousiki runs and given back on exit), so plain text looks the same in CMD, PowerShell, Windows Terminal or any other terminal.

Colour-blind friendly themes. *Colorblind Deuteranopia* and *Colorblind Protanopia* (red-green) build on blue / orange / yellow contrasts instead of red against green, *Colorblind Tritanopia* (blue-yellow) on red / cyan; *High Contrast* helps on dim screens. Each can be the template of a theme of your own.



Delete a theme (SHIFT+d). In the CHOOSE THEME list SHIFT+d deletes the highlighted theme of your own, after the question *Do you want to delete theme "..."?* (y deletes, anything else keeps it). Built-in themes cannot be deleted. If the deleted theme is the one in use, its colors stay set until you pick another.

Edit the theme in use (e). On the Colors tab e opens the same editor on the colors currently set. If they are a theme of your own, its name is already in the NAME field: change the colors and press s to overwrite it (after the question above), or change the name to save a copy. For a built-in theme (or colors that match no saved theme) the name is empty: give it a new name. Theme names are at most 27 characters, as wide as the highlight in CHOOSE THEME.

Leaving the settings. ESC / q leave without saving, as before -- but if anything was changed, a line at the bottom asks *Unsaved changes!* s save and leave, d discard and leave, ESC keep editing (player and radio).

Export / import: SHIFT+e on the Colors tab opens **EXPORT THEME**: name (27 characters at most) and folder (default ~/.config/mousiki), s writes the colors now set as <name>.theme (player and radio colors in one file). SHIFT+i opens **IMPORT THEMES**: pick a folder, ENTER imports the highlighted .theme / .txt file (it may hold several [Name] themes), a imports every file listed. An imported theme whose name exists gets (2), (3) ... added; it then shows up in the THEME row.

Note: every colour number is a palette number, in every field -- text, background and the ends of a colour fade (104 is palette colour 104 wherever you type it). Older config.txt, radio_config.txt and themes.txt files, which still used 30–37, 90–97 (text) and 40–47, 100–107 (background) as plain 16-colour codes, are converted once when they are loaded, so your colours look the same; the files then carry ColorCodes=palette (themes: # format: 7). Black is 16, because 0 means "no colour".

All themes live in themes.txt next to config.txt (~/.config/mousiki/); player and radio share the file. Each theme is a [Name] line followed by ColorXxx=value lines using the keys of the config files (keys starting with Radio. are the radio's own values: Radio.ColorHeader, Radio.ColorLegend, Radio.ColorFocus in the built-in themes, and *every* colour of a theme made or saved in the radio). Built-in themes can be edited there.

Player and radio can look different. Each program keeps its own colours (`config.txt` / `radio_config.txt`) and picks its own theme: choosing a theme in one mode never changes the other. A theme made in the radio stores its colours as `Radio.` keys, so the player's look of that theme is not touched; a theme made in the player has no radio values of its own, so the radio shows the same colours for it (except the radio's header, legend and focus colours).

Sets the colours of the interface. Each row has a name (drawn in the **header colour**), one or two value cells, a colour swatch next to each value and a **live preview** on the right.

Values are numbers from the 256-colour terminal palette (`1`–`255`); any number works in any field. `0` or an empty field means "no colour", so the terminal's own default is used (black is `16`; `8` is the usual dim grey).

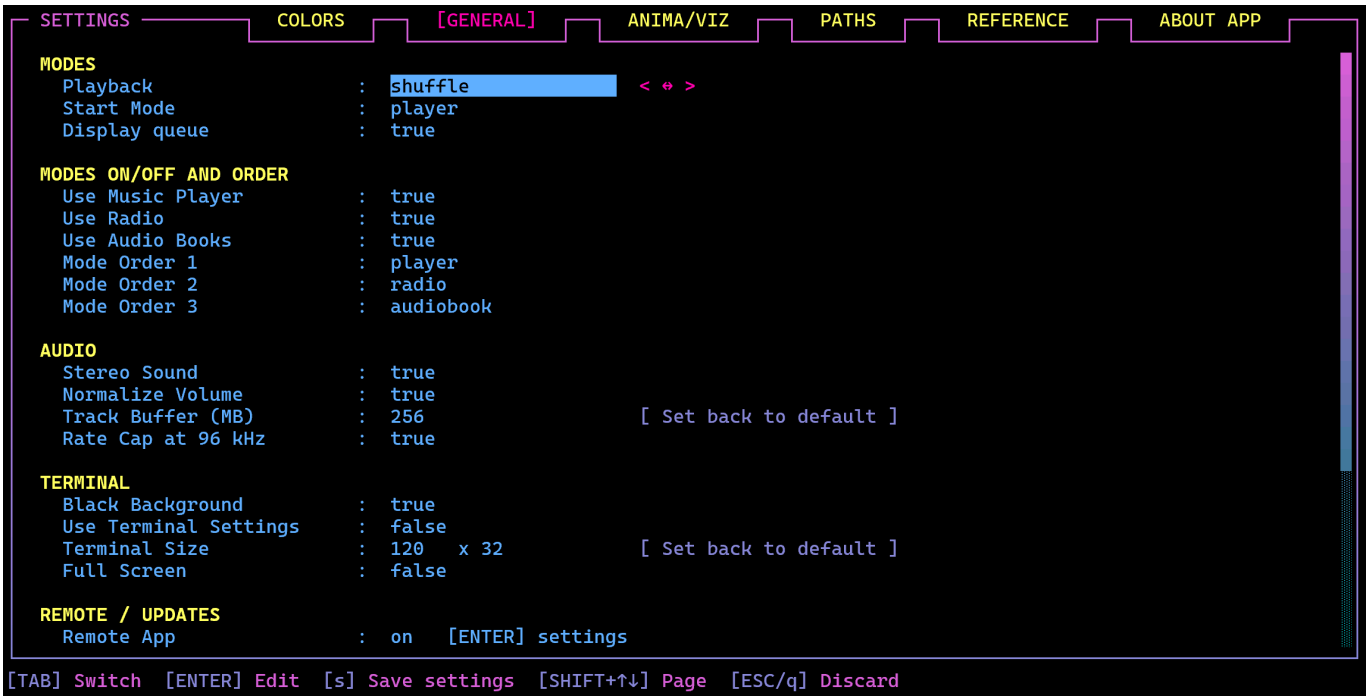
Row	First cell	Second cell	What it colours
BORDER_COLOR	TOP	BOTTOM	The frame lines, fading from top to bottom.
DISK	TOP	BOTTOM	The spinning disk (gradient).
METADATA	KEY	VAL	The labels and the values in the metadata panel.
VIZ	LEFT	RIGHT	The visualizer bars (gradient).
PROGRESS_BAR	PLAYED	PENDING	The played and the remaining part of the progress bar.
LIST	INACTIVE FG	BG	Ordinary rows of the track list (text / background).
	PLAYING FG	BG	The row of the track that is playing.
	CURSOR FG	BG	The highlighted (hovering) row.
QUEUE	INACTIVE FG	BG	Ordinary rows of the queue.
	PLAYING FG	BG	The queue row that is playing.
	CURSOR FG	BG	The highlighted queue row.
LYRICS	INACTIVE FG	BG	Lyric lines that are not active.
	ACTIVE L FG	BG	The active line.
	ACTIVE W FG	BG	The active word.
HEADER	TEXT	none	The section titles in Paths and Reference. Text colour only, no background.

Row	First cell	Second cell	What it colours
LEGEND	KEY-CMD	COMMAND	The key command legends: the hint lines such as `[ESC] close` at the bottom of the Settings, the big list and queue overlays (`SHIFT+l` / `SHIFT+k`), the playlist editor, the meta editor and the listening history, plus the small `< ↔ >` and note hints inside the Settings. **KEY-CMD** colours the keys in `[square brackets]` (default `199`), **COMMAND** the descriptions behind them (in both MeowerShell themes the TOP border colour, the list text colour in the others; KEY-CMD there is the BOTTOM border colour, "just the other way round"); the row labels of the tree-table legends (`Move`, `Fetch` ...) keep the HEADER colour, while the tree lines left of them fade from the HEADER colour in the first row to the KEY-CMD colour in the last. One-line legends use the same two colours. A legend of several lines under a big overlay (`SHIFT+l`, `SHIFT+f`, `SHIFT+k`, `SHIFT+c`) is centred on the main screen's bottom border line (with three rows the second one lies on it); the tree lines of those follow the border colour as a smooth gradient. The option overlays (oscilloscope `SHIFT+o`, spectrogram `SHIFT+i`, loudness `SHIFT+v`, equalizer `SHIFT+e`; in the radio too) draw their legend in the bottom border colour and centred on the panel's bottom border line the same way (two rows: one inside, one on the line; three rows: the second one on the line, the third below the panel). Text colours only, no background; `0` = the terminal's own text colour. Also available as `ColorLegend=` and `ColorLegendCommand=` in `config.txt` (the radio keeps its own values in `radio_config.txt`).
SEARCH	FG	BG	The text the user typed into a search bar (the `/` box, the meta editor's, the playlist editor's SEARCH LIBRARY and `Search:` rows). Only highlighted behind the length of the query, and only once something was typed. Empty = same as LIST INACTIVE. Also `ColorSearchFg=` / `ColorSearchBg=` in `config.txt`.
	INACTIVE FG	BG	The rest of the search bar (prefix, placeholder, empty field). Empty FG = same as LIST INACTIVE; empty BG = no background, so only the query is highlighted. Also `ColorSearchInactiveFg=` / `ColorSearchInactiveBg=`.
TAB_NAMES	CURRENT	OTHER	The tab names of Settings and of the playlist, meta and history menus: the current tab (drawn as `[NAME]`) and the others. Text colour only. Also `ColorTabCurrent=` / `ColorTabOther=` in `config.txt`.

Row	First cell	Second cell	What it colours
FOCUS	TEXT	—	The pane focus indicator ◀ after the title of the pane that has the keys (main screen: search box, list or queue; also the meta and playlist editors). Defaults to the header colour; every theme sets it to its header colour.

`FG` is the text colour, `BG` the background. Use ←/→ to pick the cell, then `ENTER` to type a new number.

Tab 2: GENERAL



The GENERAL tab: its categories (MODES, MODES ON/OFF AND ORDER, AUDIO, TERMINAL, REMOTE / UPDATES, TEXT AND TRANSLITERATION (JAP./KOR./CHIN.)). (The folder settings are on the PATHS tab; the screenshot is from before the categories.)

The tab has several categories (in the header colour); change a row with ←/→:

MODES

Setting	Values	What it does
Start Mode	player, radio, audiobook	Which mode Mousiki **opens with**. Picked in any mode's Settings; it is one value, stored as `StartMode=` in the player's `config.txt`, so it is the same whichever mode you set it in. Only the modes that are switched on can be picked. `Start Mode` only decides the start: you can still switch at any time with `*` / `_`. (`StartMode=`)
Playback	list, loop, shuffle, stop, queue then stop	The play mode. Same as the `m` key (`loop` is the mode shown as *repeat*). (`PlaybackMode=`)
Display queue	Shows or hides the Queue panel. (Not in	

Setting	Values	What it does
	the audio book mode: the chapter list is always there.)	

MODES ON/OFF AND ORDER

Setting	Values	What it does
Use Music Player, Use Radio, Use Audio Books	true, false	Whether the mode is part of the `SHIFT` and `+` / `SHIFT` and `-` cycle. **One mode always stays on**: the last one cannot be switched off. A start mode that is switched off moves to the first mode that is on. (`UseModePlayer=`, `UseModeRadio=`, `UseModeAudiobook=`)
Mode Order 1, 2, 3	player, radio, audiobook	The order of the cycle, set like *Viz Order 1..4* on the ANIMA/VIZ tab: giving a place a mode swaps it with the place that held that mode, so the order always has all three. `SHIFT` and `-` walks the same order backwards. (`ModeOrder=player,radio,audiobook`)

AUDIO -- switches, most of them true/false. (The folder settings are on the PATHS tab; the **Lyrics/Viz Default**, **No-Lyric** and **Viz Order** rows are on ANIMA/VIZ.)

Setting	What it does
Choose Audio Device	Shows the sound output in use (**System Default** unless you picked one). `ENTER` opens the **CHOOSE AUDIO DEVICE** overlay (also from the main screen with `°`, see below): every sound output of this computer (speakers, headphones, HDMI, USB and Bluetooth devices ...), the first row being **System Default** with the name of the device the system uses now. `↑`/`↓` choose, `ENTER` switches **at once** (a track that plays goes on at the same place on the new device, a paused one stays paused), `r` reads the list again (a headset that was just plugged in), `ESC` closes. The choice is **one value for the music player, the radio and the audio books** and is written to `config.txt` at once (`AudioDevice=`, the name as the system gives it; empty = the system default), so `s` / `ESC` of the settings screen neither save nor undo it. A chosen device that is not there (unplugged) plays on the default one until it is back; the overlay lists it as *(not found)*.
Playback Speed	**Audio book mode only.** `0.5x` - `3.0x` in steps of 0.05, default **1.0x**; `←`/`→` (or typing a number) change it. The voice keeps its pitch. The same value as `SHIFT+←` / `SHIFT+→` on the audio book's main screen (12.2). Config: `BookSpeed=`.
Stereo Sound	On plays in stereo (about twice the memory per loaded track), off folds left and right into mono. Turning it **off** is immediate. Turning it **on** applies from the next track.
Normalize Volume	Loudness normalization on or off. Same as the `v` key. Target and boost are set with the `SHIFT+v` overlay.
Track Buffer (MB)	A number, `64` - `16384` (at most 6 digits; `[ENTER]` types it, `→` then `ENTER` on *Set back to default* restores 256). Default **256**. A track is decoded into RAM as 32-bit float (stereo takes about 21 MB per minute at 44.1 kHz, 23 MB at 48 kHz, 46 MB at 96 kHz and 92 MB at 192 kHz; mono half of that). While the decoded audio is not bigger than this number the **whole**

Setting	What it does
	track is held in RAM: seeking anywhere is instant, which helps most when you adjust lyrics timing. A bigger track is held in a moving **2-minute window** around the playing position instead (so a very long file or mix does not need gigabytes); a jump outside the window then takes a moment while the decoder moves there. `ENTER` types a number; `→` moves to the button **[Set back to default]**, and `ENTER` on it restores 256. The change applies to the next track that is loaded. Config: `TrackBufferMB`. Only the audio counts: the extra 25 % that is reserved on top (the length comes from the file header and can be a little off, and the buffer must not move while it plays) is address space that is only used as far as the decoder fills it.
Rate Cap at 96 kHz	true, false

TERMINAL

Setting	Values	What it does
Black Background	true, false	Default **true**: while Mousiki runs, the terminal's background is **black** and text without a colour of its own takes the theme's LIST INACTIVE colour (Mousiki sets the terminal's default background with the standard OSC 11 sequence). On exit -- quitting, `Ctrl+C`, closing by a signal -- the terminal gets its own background back: Mousiki asks the terminal for its colour the first time (Linux / macOS) and resets it (OSC 111). One value for the player and the radio (`BlackBackground=` in the player's `config.txt`; the radio's row writes that line). Most terminals support it (Kitty, WezTerm, foot, Alacritty, xterm, GNOME Terminal, iTerm2, Windows Terminal); one that does not simply keeps its colour. `false` leaves the terminal's background alone.
Use Terminal Settings	true, false	Default **false**. **true**: Mousiki leaves the terminal exactly as it is: **Terminal Size and Full Screen are ignored** (they keep their values and apply again when you switch this back). Config: `UseTerminalSettings=`.
Terminal Size	two numbers: columns × rows	Default **120 × 32** (it shows four rows in the list and queue panes). When Mousiki starts, and when you change the numbers, it **asks the terminal to resize itself** to this size. `←` / `→` choose a field or the **[Set back to default]** button, `ENTER` types the number (or sets the size back to 120 × 32); `0` in either field means *leave the terminal as it is*. The smallest size is **100 × 28**, the largest what fits on the screen (the terminal is asked for its screen size; a terminal that does not tell gets a rough estimate). Config: `TerminalCols=`, `TerminalRows=`. **Terminals decide for themselves** whether they obey: xterm, GNOME Terminal, iTerm2, Terminal.app and recent versions of Windows Terminal usually do; Konsole, kitty, Alacritty, tmux and tiling window managers ignore the request, and then the size stays as it is.

Setting	Values	What it does
Full Screen	true, false	Default **false**. **true**: the terminal is asked for full screen at every start (and now) and **Terminal Size is ignored**. xterm-style terminals get the full-screen sequence; under Windows Terminal Mousiki presses the window's `F11` for you (only while that window is in front, and only if it is not already full screen). Config: `FullScreen=`.

REMOTE / UPDATES

Setting	Values	What it does
Remote App	`[ENTER] settings`	Opens the **REMOTE APP** overlay (13.1): on / off (default **off**), port, PIN, the address and a QR code for the phone. One value for the player and the radio (`RemoteApp=`, `RemoteAppPort=`, `RemoteAppPin=` in the player's `config.txt`).
Update Notice	true, false	Default **true**. At start-up Mousiki looks, in the background and at most **once a day**, whether a newer release exists on the project's GitHub page and shows a small **New version** window (player and radio) with the new version and the address of the release -- **once per version**. `ESC` closes it, `o` opens the release page in your browser. Nothing is installed or downloaded, nothing about you or your music is sent (only the public releases page is asked, by the small script `scripts/check_update.py`, which needs Python 3 like the lyrics). Without Python or a network nothing happens. Read at the next start. (`UpdateCheck=`)
Check Update	action row	Not a switch: press `ENTER` on the row to ask GitHub for the newest release **now**. The answer is written on the settings screen in one line: *Mousiki 4.7.1 is the newest release (checked just now)*, or *a newer release is out: Mousiki ... (you have ...):* *, or the reason the check failed (no Python, no network, no release listed). It works even when **Update Notice** is off; if a newer version is found, the same window as at start-up opens as soon as you leave Settings (`[ESC]` closes it, `[o]` opens the release page); it installs nothing. While the check runs the row reads checking ....*
Media Keys	true, false	Default **true**. **Windows:** the media pop-up of the volume flyout / lock screen and the media keys. **Linux:** Mousiki appears in the desktop's media widgets (MPRIS: the volume pop-up, a panel applet, the lock screen, `playerctl`) and its media keys, headphone buttons and sliders control it. **macOS:** Now Playing and the media keys. See 13.2. Read at the next start; player and radio. (`MediaKeys=`)

TEXT AND TRANSLITERATION (JAP./KOR./CHIN.) (its category at the bottom of the GENERAL tab; *Font* is its first row)

Setting	Values	What it does
Terminal Default Font	**false** (default) = Mousiki's window uses **Cascadia Mono** (Windows Terminal: the profile *Mousiki*; macOS Terminal, iTerm2 and the old Windows console: Mousiki's window), **true** =	

Setting	Values	What it does
	Mousiki leaves the terminal's own font alone. Applied and saved at once (`TerminalDefaultFont=`), one value for all modes. Another font than Cascadia Mono: `TerminalFont=<font name>` in `config.txt` (no row in the settings).	
Replace Emoji	*All* (default): every emoji in a title is drawn as a single `?`, so the frame borders stay aligned. *Safe*: plain one-codepoint emoji (note, radio, book) are kept; only the ones terminals and fonts draw differently (joined sequences such as the black cat, flags, skin tones, heart-style forms with a variation selector, keycaps) become `?`. *Off* draws every real emoji. (`ReplaceEmoji=true` / `safe` / `false` in `config.txt`.)	
Marquee Scrolling	On (default): a name that is too long for its column scrolls -- the hovered book folder and chapter in the audio book mode, the row under the cursor in the lists, Name / Artist / Album of the metadata block, the playlist editor's lists. Off: nothing scrolls anywhere and a too long text is cut off with `...`. (`MarqueeScrolling=` in `config.txt`.)	
Latin Macrons	true, false	Default **false**. Japanese long vowels with a macron (`kōhī`) instead of spelled out (`koohii`, `ou`).
Latin Wo	true, false	Default **false**. The particle を as `wo` instead of `o`.
LatinHanziDefault	leave, chinese, japanese	Default **leave**. Characters that could be Japanese or Chinese (東京): leave them, read them as Chinese (pinyin) or as Japanese. Settings → GENERAL → TRANSLITERATION → **Translit. Kanji** (`Leave` / `Chin.` / `Jap.`).
Latin Name Lookup	true, false	Default **false**. Asks MusicBrainz in the background for the Latin name of artists written in Chinese characters (one name at

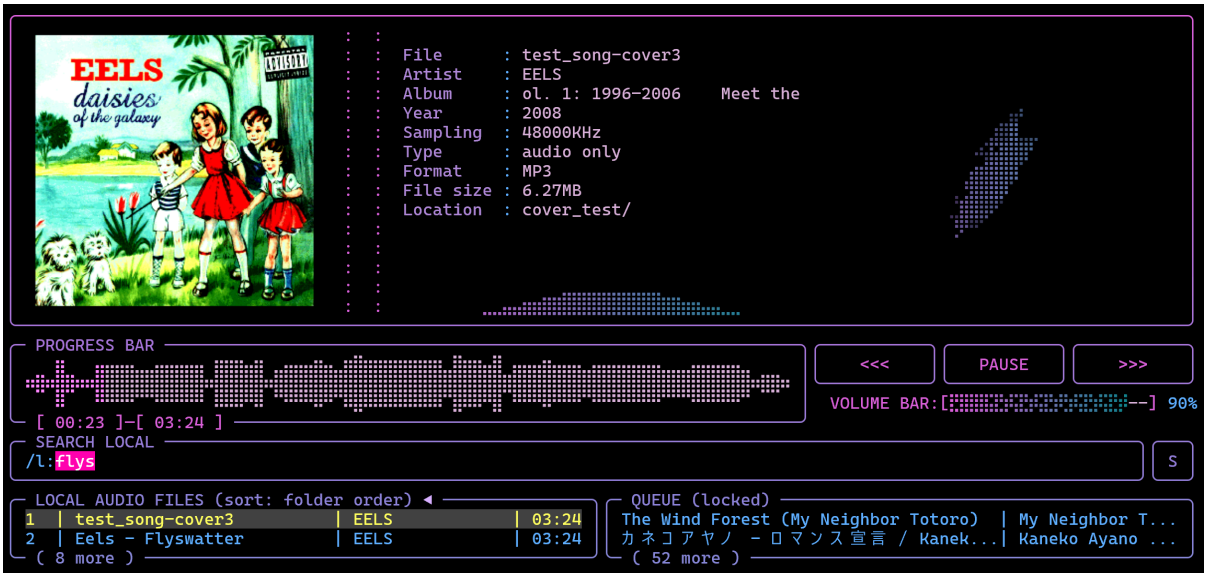
Setting	Values	What it does
		a time; needs Python 3). **Sends the artist names, and so your IP address, to musicbrainz.org** - nothing else; answers are kept in `kanji_readings_learned.txt`. See *Latin letters for Japanese, Korean and Chinese text*. (`LatinNameLookup=`)
Lyrics Name Variants	true, false	Default **true**. A lyrics search that finds nothing also tries the Latin spelling, the title / artist without their Latin or Japanese part, and the title alone.

The album cover (music player). With **Album Cover** on, the disk's place shows the cover of the track that is playing, taken from the file or from its folder. **Cover Mode** chooses how it is shown, in seven ways:

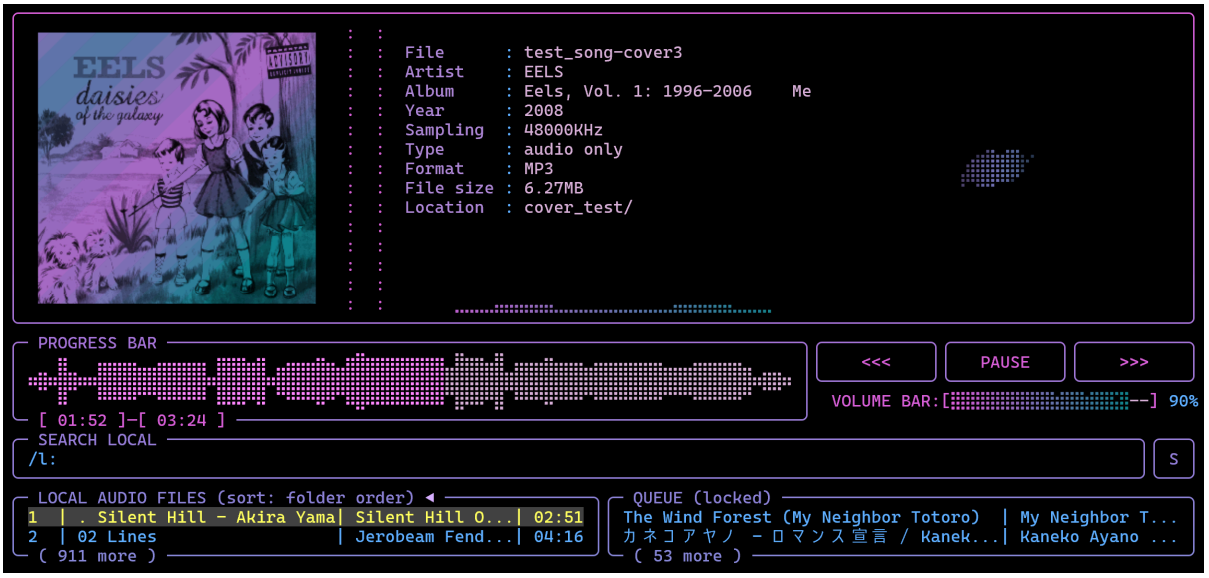
1. **Just Cover** -- the cover in its own colours, fitted into the field with a little room around it.
2. **Cover with Gradient** -- a grey version of the cover with the gradient of the disk put over it (disk colour to disk colour end, set under COLORS). The gradient is a slow **moving wave** that runs diagonally over the picture, from the upper left to the lower right, like the colour wave of the audio book cover.
3. **Cover behind Disk** (default) -- the grey cover in **full resolution** fills the field **behind the turning disk**, and the disk's braille dots act as a kind of **pinhole pattern**: the background stays **black**, and the cover only comes through the dots of the disk, at full brightness (in the gradient colours). The dots stay on their fixed grid (blocks of horizontal lines) and only the **pattern of the disk turns** through them, at the speed of *Disk Speed* (ANIMA/VIZ); no dot comes or goes. Think of the terminal background as a sheet of paper in front of the cover and the dots as holes in it: outside the dots you see the background (black with *Black Background*, else the terminal's own colour). A cover with a **removed background** (transparent parts, such as the audio book's standard picture) does not cut the disk down to its silhouette: the dots over the transparent parts show a plain grey, so the whole disk stays visible.
4. **Cover behind Disk v2** -- like 3, but the **dots themselves turn** around the centre, smoothly (they do not stay on the grid).
5. **Cover behind Disk (Full Anima)** -- like 3, but the pinholes follow the **exact braille animation of the disk**: its dots are turned and rounded to the dot grid, so some of them **come and go** as the disk turns (the same effect as the *disk* look of the *Volume Indicator*).
6. **Cover ASCII** -- the cover as **braille dots** in its own colours (dithered), also where the terminal could show a real picture. A look of its own for terminals with Kitty / Sixel: the oscilloscope's image style and the picture slot stay free.
7. **Cover ASCII with Gradient** -- the same dots under the disk's moving gradient.

Dark covers behind the disk: in the *Cover behind Disk* looks (and the dots of the looks that use the disk's dots) a dark part of a cover would make the disk's silhouette disappear. Where the cover is dark, the dots are therefore lifted a little towards white (up to about a quarter of the way) and given some extra local contrast, so the lifted features do not turn grey. The lift follows the *local* brightness, smoothly: bright parts, also a bright part at the edge of an otherwise dark cover, are left exactly as they are, and a cover that is bright anyway is not touched.

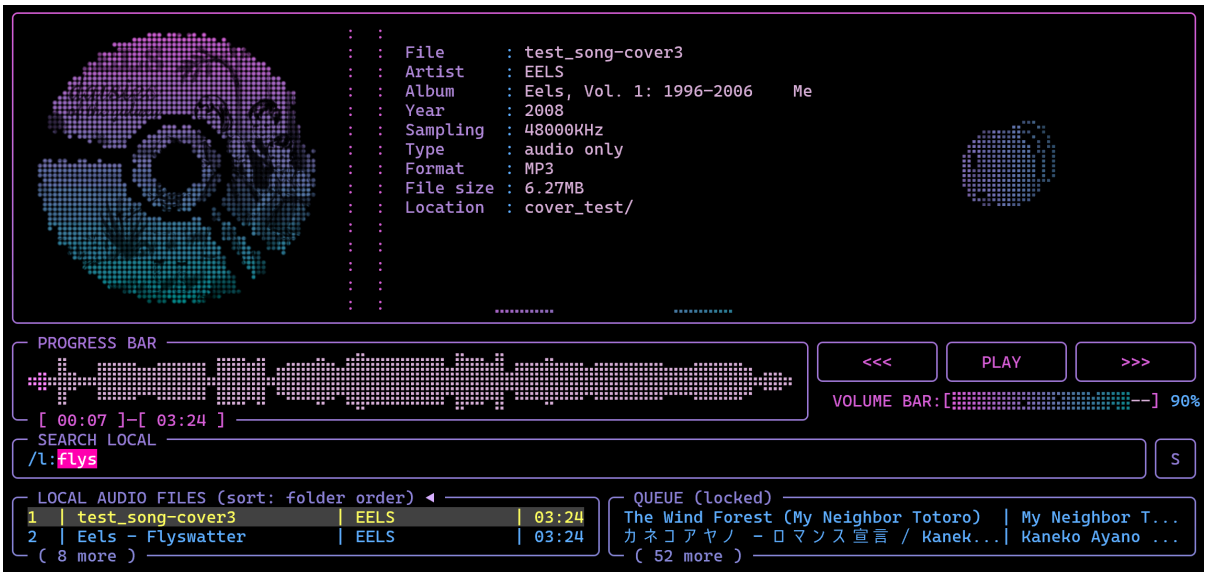
With the pixel looks 1 to 5 the oscilloscope can be an image (its *Style* in SHIFT+o) in the main screen at the same time: the cover and the oscilloscope are two pictures side by side.



Just Cover



Cover with Gradient



Cover behind Disk

With **Kitty graphics or Sixel** (Windows Terminal 1.22+, Kitty, WezTerm, Ghostty, foot ...) the cover is a real picture at the terminal's full resolution (at most 640 x 640 pixels, whatever *Image Resolution* says: *Just Cover* and *Cover with Gradient* are only sent when the cover changes). Sixel draws 240 colours (*Just Cover*) or 16 gradient steps of 15 brightnesses (the other two), Kitty all of them. While a cover is a picture, the oscilloscope next to it is drawn in braille, like beside the audio book picture. Without Kitty and Sixel the same looks are drawn with **braille dots**: the cover dithered (*Just Cover*, *Cover with Gradient*), or the turning disk with every cell lit by the part of the cover under it (the *Cover behind Disk* looks); the status line says so when the row is changed.

Where the cover comes from. Per track, the cover is looked for in two places:

- **Inside the file:** the picture attached to the audio file (mp3's ID3 picture, FLAC / Ogg / Opus pictures, the cover of an m4a ...), read by ffmpeg in the background.
- **In the folder of the file** (not the folders below it): the picture whose name is **close to the title of the track or to its album tag** (the title falls back to the file name). "Close" means a **fuzzy match**: upper and lower case, punctuation and track numbers do not matter, a word more or less or a typo does not either (`Abbey_Road - front.jpg` and `abbey road.png` both belong to the album *Abbey Road*). That makes it possible to keep the covers of **tracks from different albums in one folder**: each track gets the picture named like its album (or like itself). If no picture is close enough, a picture named `cover`, `folder`, `front`, `albumart` or `album` is taken. If **nothing** of this gives a picture, the **first picture of the folder by name (alphabetically)** is taken as the last resort -- in every Cover Search value except *Within File Only*, which never looks at the folder.

Picture formats. Pictures in the folder can be jpg / jpeg / jpe / jfif, png / apng, webp, bmp / dib, gif, tif / tiff, avif, heic / heif, jxl, jp2, ico, tga, ppm / pgm / pnm, pcx -- every regular picture format, read by ffmpeg (avif, heic and jxl only if your ffmpeg build can decode them). Camera RAW files and other very large formats are not looked at. The **audio book mode** uses the same list for the cover of a book. The name only has to be close: `test-song-cover.jpg` belongs to `test_song-cover3.mp3`, and an abbreviation such as `cov` counts for `cover`. The console log (`t`) names the closest picture and its match in percent when none was close enough.

Cover Search decides the order of the two places:

Value	What is looked at
Default	First the picture **inside the file**. If it has none, the folder: the closest-named picture, then `cover.jpg` and its like.
Folder First	First the **folder** (the closest-named picture, then `cover.jpg` and its like), and only then the picture inside the file.
Within File First	First the picture **inside the file**; if there is none, only a **closely named** picture of the folder (no `cover.jpg` fallback -- a folder of mixed albums does not give every track the same picture).
Image in Folder Only	**Only the folder** (closest-named picture, then `cover.jpg` and its like); the pictures inside the files are never looked at.
Within File Only	**Only the picture inside the file**; the folder is never looked at.

A track that has no cover keeps the disk (the console log, `t`, says what was tried: `album cover: none for ... (no picture inside the file; no closely named picture in the folder; ...)` and which file was used: `album cover: using ...`). While the next track of the same album is read, the cover on screen stays.

How these switches work together. No combination is left contradicting itself: choosing a view that is switched off (in Lyrics/Viz Default or When No Lyrics Show) **turns its Use switch on**; switching a Use switch off **takes its dependents with it** instead of being undone -- Use Lyrics Engine off stops the field showing the lyrics, Use Oscilloscope / Spectrogram / Sphere / Lyrics Engine off moves Lyrics/Viz Default and When No Lyrics Show to the next view that is on (When No Lyrics Show to `none`, an empty field, when none is left). The status line says what moved. Earlier versions turned the oscilloscope (or the spectrogram) back on by themselves while it was the No-Lyrics pick, so it could not be switched off.

Preview of the highlighted option (GENERAL and ANIMA/VIZ). On a terminal at least 107 columns wide, the empty space right of the rows holds a **preview box that shows only the option you are on** (never several at once), live and in the colours and settings you have at that moment:

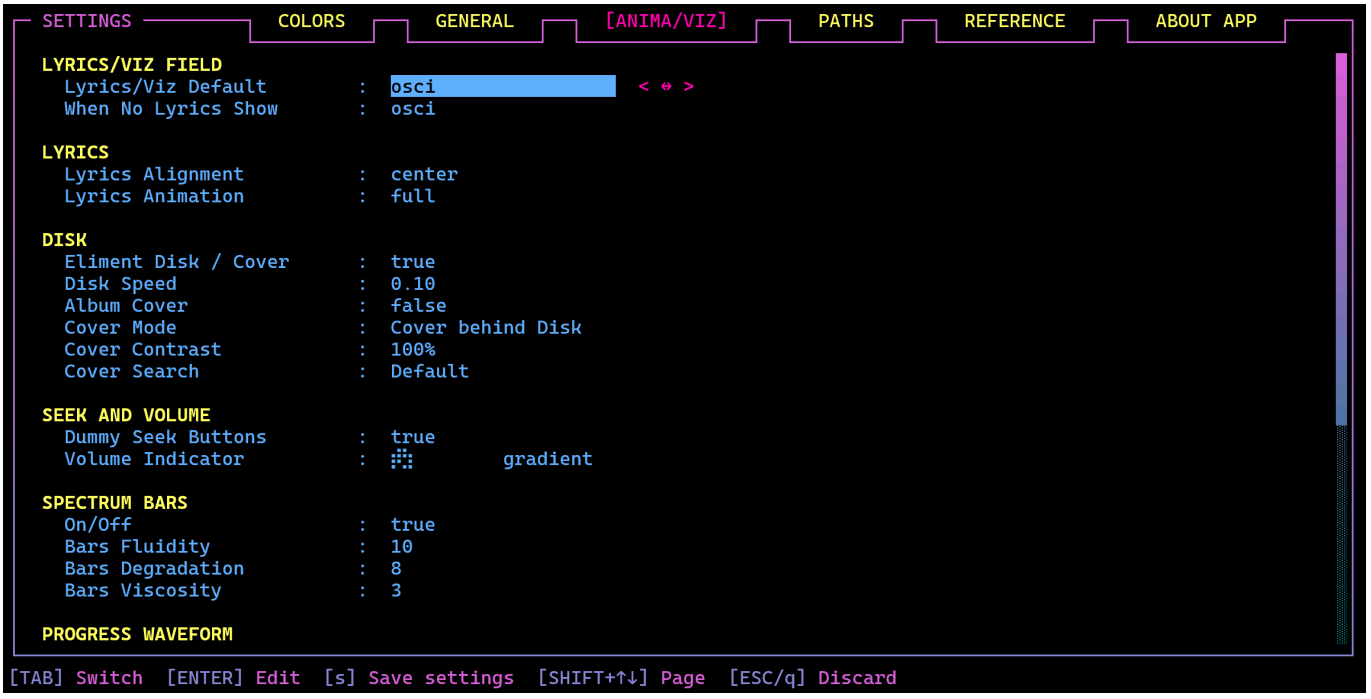
- *Lyrics Alignment, Lyrics Animation, Use Lyrics Engine*: four sample lines that are sung in a loop, drawn by the real lyrics renderer;
- *Eliment Disk / Cover, Disk Speed*: the disk, turning at the chosen speed; *Album Cover, Cover Mode, Cover Contrast, Cover Brightness, Cover Colors, Cover Search*: the colour version of the audio book picture as the sample cover, in the chosen look: a real image in a Kitty / Sixel terminal (unless *Full Res.* is off or the mode is one of the ASCII ones), braille dots otherwise;
- *Dummy Buttons*: the three buttons (on or off); *Volume Indicator*: the volume bar at **85 %**;
- *Spectrum Bars* rows: the bars below the metadata with the fluidity, degradation and viscosity you set; *Progress Waveform* rows: a sample waveform (raw or smooth) with the played part moving along, or the plain bar when it is off;
- *Use Oscilloscope, Use Spectrogram, Use Sphere* (*Modes Share Settings* has no preview) (and the *Lyrics/Viz Default / When No Lyrics Show* rows, which show the visual they are set to): the visual with a test signal. The oscilloscope, sphere and bars use the signal of the radio station **TEST Stereo Chords** (**not a file, no internet**: the radio makes it with ffmpeg (`lavfi:chords`), the preview makes the very same two-tone signal inside Mousiki, so not even ffmpeg is needed); the spectrogram uses a spectrogram made by the

Creator from the text **"Mousiki Plus"**, so you see the letters scroll by. The spectrogram preview scrolls over a short stretch of time and is drawn as a **picture** in every Kitty / Sixel terminal, whatever the spectrogram style is set to, and in braille dots only where the terminal has neither;

- on GENERAL: *Latin Macrons, Latin Wo, Translit. Kanji, Latin Name Lookup*: the transliteration examples of this manual (さくら, がっこう, しんあい, ラーメン, コーヒー, きえぬよう, こえをきかせて, 안녕하세요, 周杰伦, 東京, 愛してる, Kenshi Yonezu) shown for the option you are on, with the result for each of its values side by side and the one in use lit (*Latin Macrons*: `raamen | rāmen`, *Latin Wo*: `koe wo | koe o`, `anata wo | anata o`, `suki wo | suki o`, *Translit. Kanji*: 東京 as it is / `dōng jīng` / `toukyou`, *Latin Name Lookup*: カネコアヤノ `kanekoayano | Kaneko Ayano`, with a note that the Latin spelling is looked up online at MusicBrainz), and a few examples that never change (さくら, 猫の手も借りたい, しんあい, 안녕하세요) and a short poem split into its phrases (草の名も / 寂しうなりけり / 春の雨), which shows how the words of unspaced Japanese are cut. The Chinese example is the Taiwanese independent singer-songwriter 张悬. A row that is too wide for the box is split instead (the source on one row, each result on a row of its own, named by its value) and long explanations wrap, so nothing scrolls; *Replace Emoji*: note, radio, alien, book, heart and thumbs up with skin tone for each of All / Safe / Off; *Marquee Scrolling*: a long (cat-themed) title that scrolls or is cut; *Lyrics* options use meow lines as the sample text; *Dummy Buttons* shows the real framed `<<<` / PLAY-PAUSE / `>>>` buttons (only the play button on a narrow box).

On narrower terminals the preview is left out.

Tab 3: ANIMA/VIZ



The ANIMA/VIZ tab (the screenshot shows its predecessor, the ANIMATION tab). The `< ⇔ >` hint shows that ←/→ cycle the value.

The tab collects everything about the **animations and the visualizations**, in these categories (in the header colour, with a blank line before each). All rows are cycled with ←/→ (or typed after `ENTER`). If the terminal is too short, the tab **scrolls with the cursor (a scrollbar like the help wizard's marks where you are)** (▲ / ▼ show that there is more) while the note at the bottom stays in place.

LYRICS/VIZ FIELD

Setting	What it does
Lyrics/Viz Default	The view the field **starts with when Mousiki opens**: `sphere` (the audio-reactive ball), `osci` (the XY oscilloscope, see *The oscilloscope* above), `spectro` (the spectrogram, see *Spectrogram*) `lyrics`, or `last used`. The `.` key changes the view while Mousiki runs, but that is not remembered: the next start begins with the chosen view again (picking a value here also shows it at once). With `last used` it is remembered after all: Mousiki opens with the view it was closed on. Default `osci`. With the lyrics view on and no lyrics found, **When No Lyrics Show** below decides what is shown. The sphere and the oscilloscope's *gradient* palette use the **VIZ** colors (Settings → Colors → VIZ); the spectrogram has its own colour schemes. The oscilloscope's look is tuned with `SHIFT+o`. (`VizDefault=sphere|osci|spectro|lyrics|last` in `config.txt`)
When No Lyrics Show	What the lyrics area shows while the **lyrics view is on but there are no lyrics** (nothing found, still fetching, track without lyrics): `sphere`, `osci` (default), `spectro` or `none` (an empty field). Before this row existed the area showed whatever view `.` had been on before the lyrics. If the visual you pick is switched off in **Use Sphere** / **Use Oscilloscope** / **Use Spectrogram**, picking it turns that switch **on**; switching the switch off later moves this pick on to the next visual that is on. (`NoLyricsViz=`)

LYRICS

Setting	Values	What it does
Lyrics Alignment	left, center, right	Where lyric lines sit in their area.
Lyrics Animation	full, word by word, line by line, letter by letter, active line only, active word only	How lyrics are revealed and highlighted as the song plays.

DISK

Setting	Values	What it does
Eliment Disk / Cover	Shows or hides the **disk field** in the player area: the spinning disk or, with *Album Cover* on, the cover of the playing track. (`ElimentDisk=`; before: *Eliment Disk*)	
Disk Speed	0.01, 0.05, 0.10, 0.17, 0.25, 0.50, 0.75, 1.00	How fast the disk spins. Default `0.10`.
Album Cover	true, false. Default **false**. **true**: the **album cover of the playing track** is shown in the disk's place (see *The album cover* below). A track without a cover (and every stream) keeps the disk. Needs *Eliment Disk / Cover* to be true. Music player only. (`AlbumCover=`)	
Cover Mode	*Just Cover*, *Cover with Gradient*, *Cover behind Disk* (default), *Cover behind Disk v2*, *Cover behind Disk (Full Anima)*, *Cover ASCII*, *Cover ASCII with*	

Setting	Values	What it does
	Gradient. How the cover is shown, see below. (`CoverMode= cover` / `gradient` / `disk` / `disk2` / `full` / `ascii` / `ascii2`)	

Switch the cover look with the keyboard: on the main screen `CTRL+T` goes one look back and `CTRL+Z` one forward, in the order *plain disk* (Album Cover off) → *Just Cover* → *Cover with Gradient* → *Cover behind Disk* → *v2* → *Full Anima* → *Cover ASCII* → *Cover ASCII with Gradient* → back to the plain disk. In the audio book mode the same keys switch between the **default picture**, the **book cover with the gradient wave** and the **book cover in its own colours**. They only work while **Eliment Disk / Cover** is on; the choice is saved at once and the status line names it. Both keys can be changed in Settings → REFERENCE (*Cover Look Back* / *Cover Look Forward*). When the playing track or its album has **its own look** (meta editor → Style Option, see above), the keys change that look and Settings stay as they are. On macOS and Linux `CTRL+Z` normally stops (suspends) a terminal program; Mousiki switches that off while it runs, so the key reaches it. | Cover Contrast | 0% (default) to 100% in steps of 5%: adds contrast to the cover, but only where the cover is shown through the gradient or the disk: *Cover with Gradient*, *Cover ASCII with Gradient* and the *Cover behind Disk* looks (music player), and the book cover with the *Book Gradient Wave* on (audio book mode). *Just Cover*, *Cover ASCII*, a book cover in its own colours and every preview (meta editor, cover fetch) always show the picture as it is. (0% = the cover as it is; 100% = the brightnesses move 2.5 times as far from the middle grey). (`CoverContrast=`) | | Cover Brightness | 0% to 100% in steps of 5%, default **50%**. *Cover behind Disk* looks (music player): the brightnesses of the cover are spread over the whole range, so the dots shine as brightly as the plain disk's, and dark parts of the cover are lifted to at least this share of full brightness (0% = dark parts may go black, 100% = even black parts are clearly lit); these looks also show more detail (the cover is sharpened inside the dots). **Audio books** (BOOK COVER on the ANIMA/VIZ tab, the cover with *Book Gradient Wave* on): a brightness curve, 50% = the cover as it is, more = brighter (dark parts lifted), less = darker. The same value for both modes. (`CoverBrightness=`) | | Cover Colors | 0% (default) to 100% in steps of 5%. How much of the cover's **own colours** shows through the gradient: in the *Cover behind Disk* looks (music player) and on the **book cover with the gradient wave** (audio books, BOOK COVER on the ANIMA/VIZ tab; also on the phone). 0% = the gradient colours only (as before), 50% = the gradient lies over the cover and its colours shine through, 100% = the cover in its own colours (the gradient is gone, the brightness, the dots and the wave's shape stay). With Sixel (Windows Terminal) these pictures use a fixed set of 240 colours with fine dithering. (`CoverColors=`) | | Cover Search | *Default*, *Folder First*, *Within File First*, *Image in Folder Only*, *Within File Only*. Where the cover is looked for, see below. (`CoverSearch= default` / `folder first` / `file first` / `folder only` / `file only`) |

SEEK AND VOLUME

Setting	Values	What it does
Dummy Buttons	Shows or hides the three decorative buttons next to the progress bar.	
Volume Indicator	What the **VOLUME BAR** is drawn with: `#`, ⠶, ⣿, ⣉⣉ or the **disk** look (shown as two moving braille blocks). The first three repeat one character; ⣉⣉ is a fixed, not repeating row of braille characters, so 100% reads `[⣉⣉⣉⣉⣉⣉⣉⣉⣉⣉⣉⣉⣉⣉⣉⣉⣉⣉⣉⣉⣉⣉]`. The **disk** look follows the braille effect of the disk animation: the bar is a strip of solid dots that is turned around a centre two cells	

Setting	Values	What it does
	in from the left, so close to that centre all dots are there and further out (also towards the left end) dots come and go as the disk turns (it stands still while the disk does). Right of the look sits **gradient / no gradient**: with *gradient* the filled part takes the colours of the VIZ gradient from left to right, like the oscilloscope (`VolumeGradient=`). ← / → switch between the two values of the row, `ENTER` changes the one that is lit. The Colors tab previews follow the look but never show the gradient; the empty rest of the bar (`-`) stays as it is. Default: the **disk** look, in all three modes. Also set in the radio (**Volume indicator** on its GENERAL tab). (`VolumeIndicator=`)	

Seek indicator. When you seek within a track with the arrow keys (5 seconds per press), the `<<<` or `>>>` label turns the colour of **BORDER_COLOR BOTTOM** (Settings → COLORS) for about 0.7 seconds, so you can see which way you went. Seeks from a phone or the remote app do not light it up. The same works in the audio book mode; the radio's `<<<` and `>>>` change stations, so they do not light up.

SPECTRUM BARS -- the bars under the meta data (the *On/Off* row was *Spectrum Bars* on the General tab; before: *WAVE*, *Wave Fluidity* ...).

Setting	Values	What it does
On/Off	Shows or hides the **spectrum bars below the meta data** (the live frequency bars; before: *Visualizer*). With it off the meta data get the two rows. Their motion is set on ANIMA/VIZ → SPECTRUM BARS. (`Visualizer=`)	
Bars Fluidity	1–10	How the spectrum bars **rise**. It affects only the rising motion. Default `10`.
Bars Degradation	1–10	How quickly bars **fall**. `1` is a slow, VU-meter-like fade, `10` a near-instant cutoff. Default `8`.
Bars Viscosity	1–10	How strongly the bar motion is damped and smoothed between neighbouring bars. Default `3`.

PROGRESS WAVEFORM -- the braille waveform in the progress bar.

Setting	Values	What it does
On/Off	Shows or hides the braille **waveform inside the progress bar** (the whole track as a wave). With it off, a plain `[####----]` bar is drawn instead. (`ElimentWaveForm=`)	

Setting	Values	What it does
Waveform Style	raw, smooth	Waveform drawing style of the progress bar. Same as the `w` key.

OSCI/SPECTRO SETTINGS

Setting	Values	What it does
Modes Share Settings	true, false	Default **false**. **true**: the radio uses the player's oscilloscope and spectrogram settings (the `SHIFT+i` / `SHIFT+o` screens) instead of its own, so both modes look the same. The radio's own values are **not lost**: they are kept as a backup in `radio_config.txt` (lines starting with `## own `) and come back unchanged when you turn the switch off. While it is on, the radio's visual settings are shown but changes there change the player's values. Stored as `ShareProfiles=` in the player's `config.txt`; the row exists in both modes' Settings. The colours and themes are **never** shared by this switch.

VIZ/LYRICS ORDER

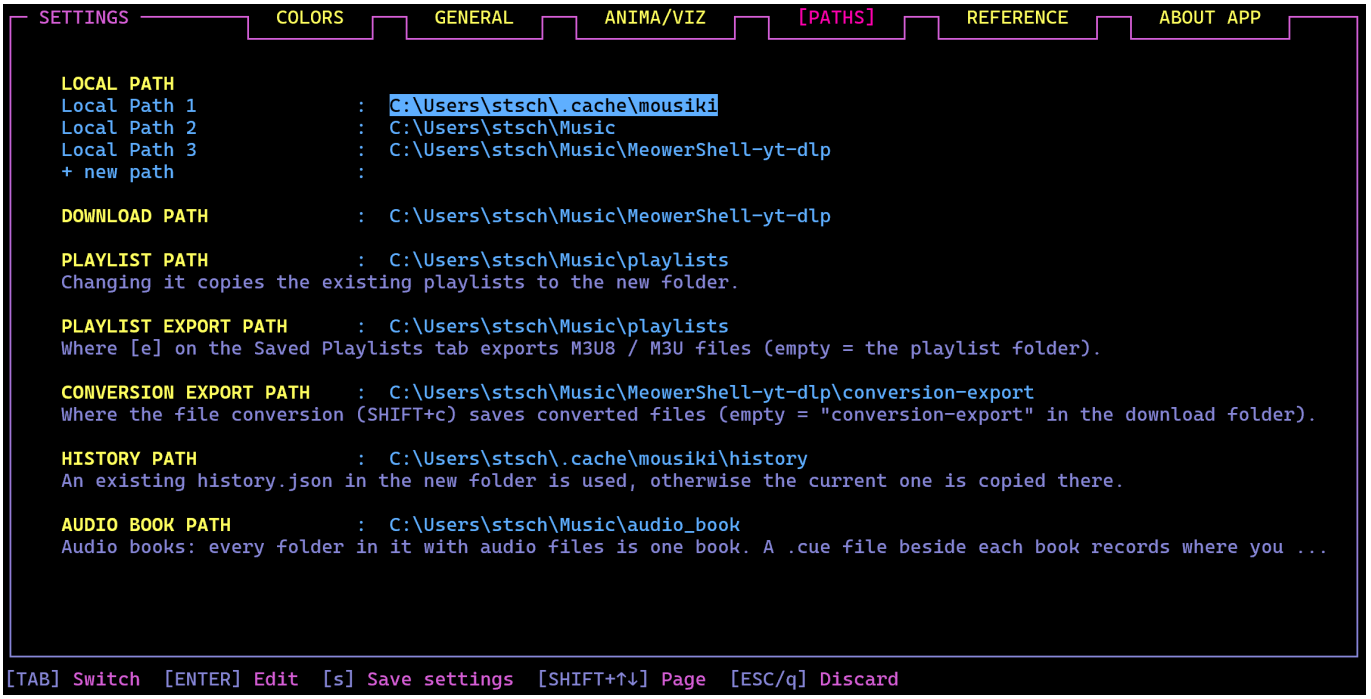
Setting	What it does
Viz Order 1 … 4	The order of the four views (`sphere`, `osci`, `spectro`, `lyrics`) when you press `.` / `,`. Each row says which view comes at that place; ← / → puts another view there, and the view that was there takes the place it left, so every view stays in the list. The status line shows the whole order, e.g. `"." cycle: osci > lyrics > spectro > sphere`. (`VizOrder=osci,lyrics,spectro,sphere`)

MAIN UI VIZ/LYRICS FIELD (the field right of the meta data; before: *VIZ/LYRICS FIELD*)

Setting	What it does
Viz/Lyrics Field	The master switch of the **field right of the meta data** (lyrics, sphere, oscilloscope, spectrogram). `false`: the field is gone, the meta data and the spectrum bars take its width, no lyrics are fetched for it and `.` says so. The big overlays and the windows still work. Default `true`. (`VizLyricsField=`)
Use Lyrics Engine	`false` switches the lyrics off **entirely**: they are never fetched and `.` skips them (the field then only shows the visuals). `true` lets the field show the lyrics (fetched from the net when it does; turning it on while a track plays fetches them at once); whether the field starts with them is set by **Lyrics/Viz Default**, and `.` switches the view while Mousiki runs. Default `true`. (`UseLyrics=`; this replaces the former *Lyrics Engine* row, which did the same)
Use Oscilloscope	`false` leaves the oscilloscope out: `.` and the **Lyrics/Viz Default** row skip it, and the picks that pointed at it (Lyrics/Viz Default, When No Lyrics Show) move on to the next visual that is on. The scope window (`)`) still works. (`UseOscilloscope=`)

Setting	What it does
Use Spectrogram	`false` leaves the spectrogram out of the lyrics area: `.` skips it. Full screen (`SHIFT+u`) and the spectrogram window (`(`) still work. (`UseSpectrogram=`) For example: Use Oscilloscope and Use Spectrogram `false` = `.` only switches between the lyrics and the sphere.
Use Sphere	`false` leaves the sphere out of the `.` cycle (it used to be always there). Picks that pointed at it move on to the next visual that is on; picking it in **Lyrics/Viz Default** or **When No Lyrics Show** turns it on again. (`UseSphere=`)

Tab 4: PATHS



The PATHS tab: the folders Mousiki reads music from, downloads to, and keeps playlists and the history in. (The screenshot is from before the PLAYLIST EXPORT PATH row was added.)

Seven sections, each under its header in the header colour. Move onto a row and press `ENTER` to edit it. The tab scrolls with the cursor (a scrollbar like the help wizard's marks where you are) (a scrollbar like the wizard's shows where you are), so a short terminal is fine.

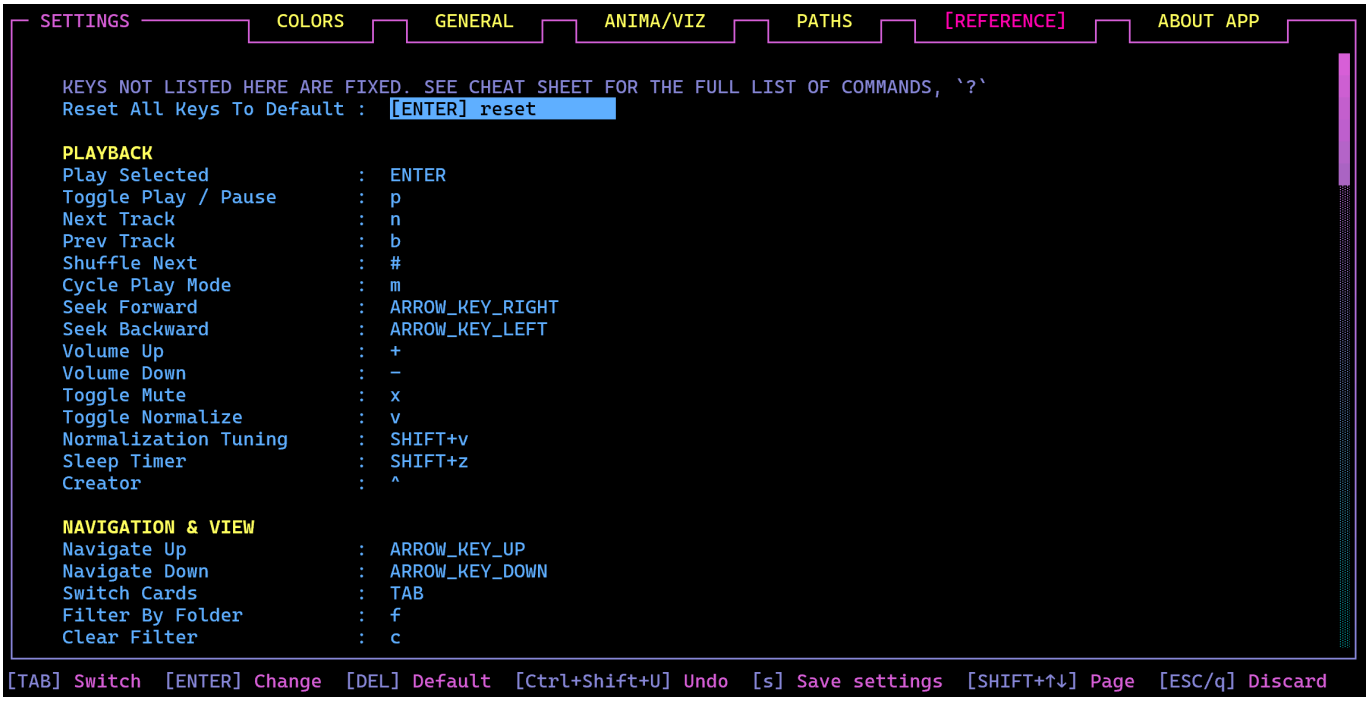
Section	Rows	What it does
LOCAL PATH	`Local Path 1`, `2`, … plus `+ new path`	The folders scanned for music. `ENTER` edits one. `+ new path` (`ENTER`) adds an empty line and opens it for typing. Committing a change **rescans the library immediately**.
DOWNLOAD PATH	one row	Where `y` (Save stream) puts downloaded tracks. Until you set one it shows the default cache folder (`~/.cache/mousiki`). It is added to the scanned folders automatically, so you do not repeat it as a local path. The radio uses the same folder by default.

Section	Rows	What it does
AUDIO BOOK PATH	one row	The **one** folder of the audio book mode (chapter 12): every folder in it that directly holds audio files is one book, a single long file works too. Under the path a note says that a `.cue` file beside each book records where you last stopped listening. Empty = no audio books. Changing it rescans the books, and the music player's library no longer lists the files in this folder, in no list, search or folder filter. **The book folder may lie inside a music folder** (e.g. `Music` as the local path and `Music/Books` as the audio book path): the books stay out of the player. **The very same folder is a conflict**: the settings refuse it with a message (in the PATHS tab of every mode, in either direction, also for the download folder); pick a folder around it or beside it. A music folder that lies inside the book folder keeps its own files. It is the **last row** of the PATHS tab. The row is on the PATHS tab of **every** mode (the radio's settings list it too and keep it in the player's `config.txt`). (`AudioBookPath=`)
PLAYLIST PATH	one row	The **one** folder playlists are loaded from, saved to and deleted in. If none is set, the first local path plus `/playlists` is used. Under the path a note says that changing it copies the existing playlists to the new folder.
CONVERSION EXPORT PATH	one row	The **one** folder the file conversion overlay (`SHIFT+c`) writes its converted files to. Empty = the `conversion-export` folder inside the download folder (the row shows the folder in effect). Changing it only affects the next conversion. (`ConversionExportPath=`)
PLAYLIST EXPORT PATH	one row	The **one** folder `e` on the playlist editor's Saved Playlists tab exports M3U8 / M3U files to (see Exporting a playlist). Empty = the playlist folder. Nothing is copied or moved when it changes.
HISTORY PATH	one row	The **one** folder that holds the listening history (`history.json`). Under the path a note says that an existing `history.json` in the new folder is used, otherwise the current one is copied there.

Shared download archive. Every YouTube track Mousiki downloads is also written as `youtube <video id>` to `<download folder>/history/downloaded_history.txt`, the file format of yt-dlp's `--download-archive`. Use the same file for downloads you make in a terminal, e.g. `yt-dlp -x -P <download folder> --download-archive <download folder>/history/downloaded_history.txt <playlist-url>`: yt-dlp then skips what Mousiki already fetched and Mousiki's downloads are known to the next terminal run. Changing DOWNLOAD PATH copies this file to the new folder's `history/` (the old one stays; an existing one in the new folder is kept). Mousiki only appends to the file and never skips a download because of it. An existing `downloaded_history.txt` lying directly in the download folder is moved into `history/` the first time Mousiki records a download. Do not put `--download-archive` into yt-dlp's own config file: Mousiki's yt-dlp would then refuse to fetch a song whose file you deleted.

DOWNLOAD PATH, AUDIO BOOK PATH, PLAYLIST PATH, PLAYLIST EXPORT PATH, CONVERSION EXPORT PATH and HISTORY PATH are single paths and therefore have no `+ new path` line. Paths accept `~` and `%USERPROFILE%` shortcuts, and both slash directions on Windows. Emptying a path line and pressing `ENTER` removes that path (for the single paths: resets it to the default). Changed folders only take effect for good when you save with `s`; with `ESC` or `q` they are put back.

Tab 5: REFERENCE



The REFERENCE tab: the rebindable hotkeys (scroll for the rest).

The longest tab. It scrolls as one list and has two parts: the hotkeys, then the font map.

Hotkeys (editable). A note at the top says that keys not listed here are fixed and points to the cheat sheet (`?`), and the rebindable commands (including *Next Mode / Previous Mode* under SYSTEM and *Karaoke Lyrics Bigger / Smaller* under VIZ, LYRICS & KARAOKE) are listed under the headers PLAYBACK, NAVIGATION & VIEW, VIZ, LYRICS & KARAOKE (the cheat sheet calls this group LYRICS & KARAOKE), VISUALIZATIONS, SEARCH, QUEUE, PLAYLISTS, META EDITOR, HISTORY, EQUALIZER, DOWNLOADS, LIBRARY and SYSTEM. Each row shows a label and the key currently bound to it.

- Press `ENTER` on a row, type the new key, and press `ENTER` again.
- A key is written as the character itself (`n`, `T`, `#`, `+`; a capital letter means `SHIFT` + the letter) or as a name: `ENTER`, `TAB`, `SPACE`, `BACKSPACE`, `ARROW_KEY_UP`, `ARROW_KEY_DOWN`, `ARROW_KEY_LEFT`, `ARROW_KEY_RIGHT` (any case is accepted; `UP`, `DOWN`, `LEFT`, `RIGHT` work as well).
- A combination cannot be typed as a character. **Press it while the field is being edited** and its name is entered: `ALT+L` (`OPTION+L` on a Mac; `SHIFT+j` there by default), `ALT+C` (`SHIFT+q` on a Mac by default), `CTRL+L`, `CTRL+T`, `CTRL+Z`, `CTRL+SHIFT+U`, `CTRL+SHIFT+Z`. These seven are the combinations that can be bound; in `config.txt` they are written by name, e.g. `HKeyReadLyrics="CTRL+L"`.
- An empty field **unbinds** the command (it then shows `-` in the cheat sheet and legends). `DEL` on a row restores its default.
- Something that is not a key (`foo`) is refused with `NOT A KEY -- ...`; `*` (switches to the radio) and `ESC` (back to the home view) are reserved and refused.
- If the key is **already used by another action**, the change is refused with `KEY "x" ALREADY USED BY "<command>" -- try another key`, and you can type another one.
- The help wizard's key (`SHIFT+w`) is listed under SYSTEM and can be rebound like the others.
- Since this version the tab also lists **Rescan Library** (`SHIFT+r`), **Fetch Missing Tags** (`SHIFT+b`, also used inside the meta editor), **Lyrics Timing Overlay**, **Read Lyrics Overlay**, **Undo Clear Queue** and **Save Queue As Playlist**. They used to be fixed keys.

- Only `/` (opens the search) is a key. The prefixes typed *inside* the search box (`s: sc: b: p: f: r: a:`) are fixed and are no longer listed here; the cheat sheet describes them.

What stays fixed, and why. These are not listed on the tab because rebinding them would break something. In general, making every key rebindable would atm mean to change a loooot of if statements etc., so I have not taken this into account so far. I am more interested on community feedback on what would be a key that makes sense to make it rebindable and what default bindings would make more sense than the current... Other key bindings that are reseverd are just too conventional, such as CTRL+x to cut marked text, apart of meaning too much work to rewrite the current code...

Fixed key	Reason
`ESC`, `ENTER`, `TAB`, the arrow keys in menus	They mean the same in every overlay; `ESC` is the way out of anything. (The main screen's *Play*, *Switch Cards*, *Navigate Up / Down* and *Seek* are rebindable.)
The mode keys and the karaoke size keys	Rebindable now (*Next Mode*, *Previous Mode*, *Karaoke Lyrics Bigger / Smaller* in the REFERENCE tab; default `*` / `_`, i.e. `SHIFT and +` / `SHIFT and -`, on a German keyboard; `'` / `;` on an English (US / UK) one, chosen when `config.txt` is first made - an older file keeps the keys it has). The radio reads the two mode keys from the same `config.txt`, so they are the same in all modes; a key you give them also works there, so pick one the radio does not use itself (it uses `[ ] { }`, for example).
`Y` / `N` in prompts, `CTRL+s`, `CTRL+SHIFT+x`	Confirmation keys must not collide with typed text or a rebound command.
Keys inside an overlay (playlist and meta editors, READ LYRICS `t` / `SHIFT+t` / `d` / `e`, conversion, history, equalizer, normalization, oscilloscope and spectrogram overlays, sleep timer, big folder / list / queue overlays, the windows' own `F` / `F11` / `T`)	They only exist while that overlay is open, are shown in its own legend, and share letters with the main screen on purpose.
Text editing: `SHIFT+←→`, `CTRL+C/X/V`, `HOME` / `END`, `DEL`	Terminal conventions for any text field.
`SHIFT+↑↓` (pages in the big overlays), `CTRL+p` (play in the folder / conversion overlay)	Modifier combinations that only mean something inside those overlays.

FONT / CHARACTER MAP (read-only). Shows the `A = A, a` table from `config.txt`, which lets you re-font the interface with fancy Unicode letters without changing the terminal font. It cannot be edited here. Edit the `font_en={ … }` block in `config.txt` while the app is closed.

Tab 6: ABOUT APP

The credits and versions of the original app and of this port, centred on the tab (each line, and the block in the vertical middle, two rows higher than the exact centre); ↑ / ↓ scroll it only when the window is too short to show all of it. The text is built into the program (no longer part of `config.txt`, where it used to collect empty lines over time) and always shows the running version. An old `ClassTextAboutApp= { … };` block in an existing `config.txt` is ignored and disappears with the next save.



The ABOUT APP tab.

Settings that exist (only) in `config.txt`

Key in `config.txt`	What it does
`ConsoleVerbosity`	`basic` logs every command the app runs and its raw output. `verbose` adds internal and OS-level events.
`AutoSave`	Resumes the exact song, position, queue and play mode at the next launch.
`AutoSaveIndicator`, `AutoSaveChr`, `AutoSaveIndicatorType`, `AutoSaveC1`, `AutoSaveC2`	The small autosave indicator: whether it shows, its character, `blink` or `color` style, and the two pulse colours.
`SidPlayLength`	How many seconds of a C64 SID tune are rendered and played (10 – 1800, default 180). SID tunes have no end of their own.
`WizardSeen`	Whether the help wizard (`SHIFT+w`) has already opened itself once (default `false`, set to `true` the first time it is closed). `false` makes it greet you again on the next start. The radio has the same line in `radio_config.txt`.
`AutoSaveDelayInSec`	How often the session snapshot is saved (default 30 seconds).

Key in `config.txt`	What it does
`UpperLeftCorner`, `Vertical`, `Horizontal`, `Seprator`, `ListSeparator` and the other border entries	The characters used to draw frames and the list column separator.

11. Radio mode

Besides the music and audio book player, Mousiki contains an **online radio**. It is tuned like an old radio set: a frequency band with a needle, an **ON AIR** sign while a station is live, 16 quick-tune presets and a search for stations all over the world. The radio lives in the same program but has its **own audio path, its own settings (`radio_config.txt`) and its own files**; nothing is shared with the player's `config.txt`.

Chapters 1 to 10 describe the music player. **This chapter only describes what is new in the radio or different from the player.** Everything the two modes have in common (equalizer, oscilloscope, loudness normalization, sleep timer, text fields, the settings screen and so on) is explained once in the chapters above, and section 11.4 lists the few places where the radio behaves differently.

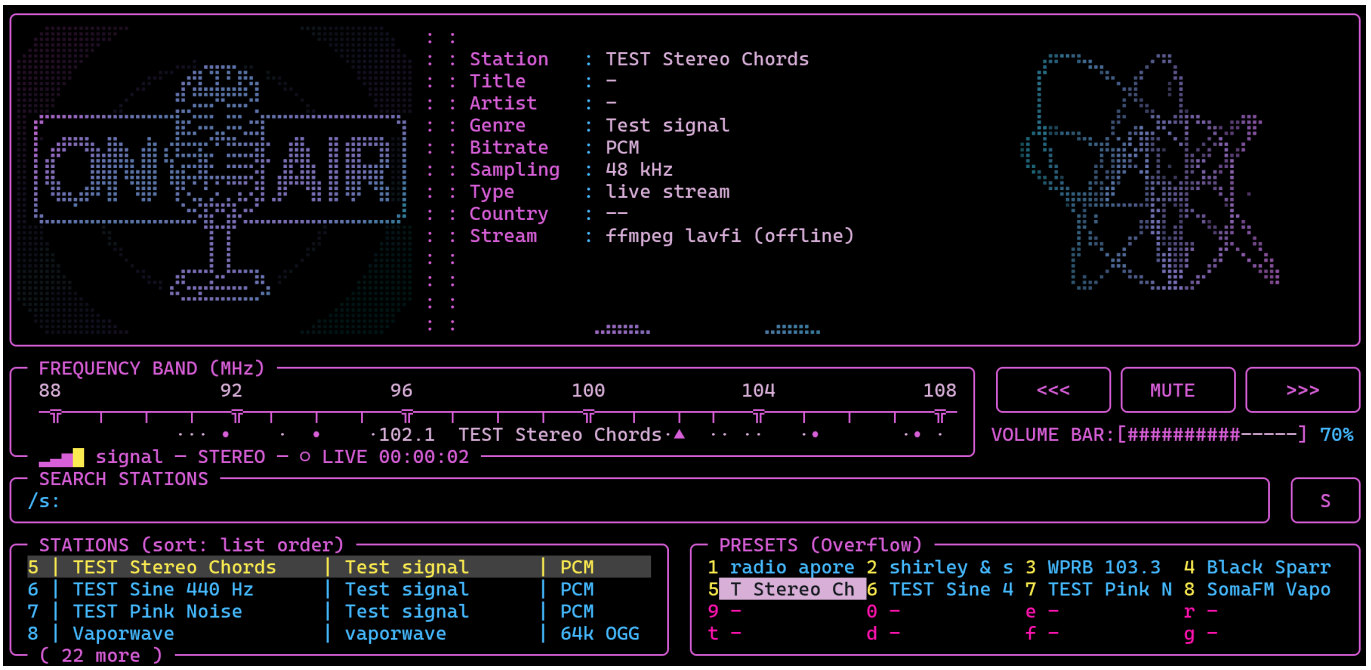
Requirements: `ffmpeg` (decodes the streams, also needed by the player), `curl` for the Radio Browser search, and a terminal of at least **100 x 28** characters (the default window is 120 x 32).

11.1 Switching between player and radio

Press the next-mode key to switch to the next mode (the previous-mode key: the previous one), in the player and in the radio; with the audio books switched off in the settings the two modes just switch between each other: `SHIFT` and `+` / `SHIFT` and `-` on a German keyboard (the characters `*` / `_`), `'` / `;` on an English (US / UK) one. The first line of the cheat sheet (`?`) of both modes shows the combination that fits **your keyboard layout** (detected automatically, `MOUSIKI_KEYBOARD=us|de|fr|…` overrides it). The keys can be rebound under Settings → Reference (the radio reads them from the same `config.txt`).

- **Player → radio:** the player is **paused and kept in memory** with its queue, position and screen exactly as they were.
- **Radio → the next mode:** the radio is **closed completely** (threads, audio device, buffers), so it only uses resources while you are in it. The player comes back instantly, without a loading screen.
- Files added to your music folders while you were in the radio are not known to the player yet: press `SHIFT+r` to rescan the library (see chapter 1).
- `q` (or `CTRL+c`) in the radio quits the program; both modes end.

11.2 The radio screen



The radio's main screen with a test station tuned.

From top to bottom:

- **Top pane.** The **ON AIR** sign (the **OFF AIR** sign while nothing is live) with a colour wave, the **station info** (station, title, artist, genre, bitrate, sampling rate, type, country, stream) and the **oscilloscope**, the audio-reactive **sphere** or the **spectrogram** on the right (`.` switches, see below). A spectrum analyser sits under the station info.
- **FREQUENCY BAND (MHz).** A tuning dial. The needle shows the tuned station, small dots mark the other stations of your list (each station may carry its own dial frequency). The line underneath shows the signal strength bars, `STEREO` or `MONO`, `LIVE` with the time since you tuned in (`‖ PAUSED -m:ss` while paused, `◑ TIMESHIFT -m:ss` while you listen behind live), and `REC mm:ss` while you record.
- **Volume bar** and the three decorative buttons next to the dial.
- **SEARCH STATIONS** with the **play mode letter** on its right (`S` shuffle or `L` list, `m` toggles; it only affects `b`).
- **STATIONS** (your station list) and **PRESETS** (the 16 slots of the active preset) side by side.

The frame is as tall as the terminal. A wider terminal widens the top pane and the search box, a taller one gives rows to STATIONS and PRESETS. With only four list rows the 16 presets switch to four columns.

11.3 Keys on the main screen

All of them are also in the radio's own cheat sheet (`?`, categorized and scrollable). Keys that are not hard coded can be rebound under **Settings** → **REFERENCE** (see 11.12). Letters are **case sensitive** in the radio: `r` is a preset key, `R` reconnects.

Key	Action
`↑` / `↓`	Move in the station list
`ENTER`	Tune the hovered station

Key	Action
`n` / `b`	Next / previous channel. `b` follows the mode letter: in `S` it goes back to the channel played before, in `L` to the one before it in the list.
`#`	A random channel (never the one already tuned)
`m`	Mode `S` shuffle ↔ `L` list (only affects `b`)
`1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 0 e r t d f g`	Recall slot 1 to 16 of the active preset
`SHIFT+←` / `SHIFT+→`	Previous / next preset
`/`	Search (see 11.5)
`p`	Mute / unmute. With no channel loaded it tunes the hovered station like `ENTER`.
`+` / `-`	Volume
`R`	Reconnect the tuned station
`x`	Stop
`SHIFT+t`	Sort stations: list order ↔ name A-Z
`SHIFT+i` / `SHIFT+u`	Spectrogram options / spectrogram full screen (see chapter 3, *Spectrogram*)
`SHIFT+0` (the `=` key)	Oscilloscope full screen: YT left, XY right; inside it `SHIFT+a` grid, `SHIFT+v` axis values, `SHIFT+c` grid colour, `SHIFT+p` grid metrics, `SHIFT+o` options (see chapter 3, *Oscilloscope full screen*)
`.`	Scope block: oscilloscope → sphere → spectrogram, skipping what **Use oscilloscope / Use spectrogram** switch off on the GENERAL tab (the same key that cycles the lyrics area in the player; up to v3.0.0 this was `o`, which no longer does anything; an old `HKeyScopeToggle=o` line in `radio_config.txt` is ignored and rewritten as `.`)
`v` / `SHIFT+v`	Loudness normalization on/off / its overlay
`SHIFT+e`	Equalizer overlay
`SHIFT+o`	Oscilloscope tuning overlay
`)` / `(`	Scope window / spectrogram window: the oscilloscope / the spectrogram in their own windows (see chapter 3). German `SHIFT+9` / `SHIFT+8`, English `SHIFT+0` / `SHIFT+9`
`SHIFT+z`	Sleep timer
`SPACE`	Pause / resume the station; the stream keeps buffering (see 11.10)
`[` / `]`	Jump back / forward 30 seconds in the timeshift buffer (German keyboard: `ALT GR+8` / `ALT GR+9`)

Key	Action
{ / }	Jump back 5 minutes / back to live (German keyboard: ALT GR+7 / ALT GR+0; English: SHIFT and [/])
y	Record: opens the RECORD overlay, or stops a running recording (see 11.10)
SHIFT+p / SHIFT+s / SHIFT+k	PRESETS menu / RADIO BROWSER / STATION LISTS
SHIFT+l	Big STATIONS overlay
h	Listening history
s	Settings
SHIFT+w	Help wizard: the same wizard, with the radio chapters (3) at its end
?	Cheat sheet
° (German SHIFT+^; other keyboards &)	Choose audio device: the sound outputs of this computer, ENTER switches at once (one choice for all modes; rebindable as *Choose Audio Device*)
< (German; English SHIFT+,)	Menus index: every menu and overlay of the radio by category with its key (↑↓←→ select, ENTER opens, ESC closes; rebindable as *Menus / Overlays Index*)
* (German SHIFT and +, English ')	Switch to the music player
q / CTRL+c	Quit

11.4 What the radio shares with the player

The following features exist in both modes, with the same keys and the same overlays. They are described in the chapters named in the table; only the differences are listed here.

Feature	Where it is described	What is different in the radio
Equalizer (SHIFT+e)	Chapter 2, *Equalizer overlay*	Same overlay, same 12 presets and keys. It is applied to the stream before volume and normalization and is stored separately in radio_config.txt (EqualizerEnabled, EqualizerBands, EqualizerPreset=), so the radio and the player can use different curves and custom presets. There is no conflict with the preset key e: the radio tells e and SHIFT+e apart.
Spectrogram (SHIFT+i, SHIFT+u)	Chapter 3, *Spectrogram*	The same spectrogram in the scope block (. or **Osci/sphere** = spectro), the same overlay and full screen; the stream is analysed as it arrives. Settings in radio_config.txt.

Feature	Where it is described	What is different in the radio
Scope window ()) and **spectrogram window** (()	Chapter 3, *Scope window* / *Spectrogram window*	The same windows: they stay open when you switch modes and show the station and song as their title.
Oscilloscope (SHIFT+o) and the lyric visual	Chapter 3, *The oscilloscope* and *Oscilloscope tuning overlay*	Same scope, same overlay rows, braille and image style included. In the radio the scope sits right of the station info instead of in the lyrics area, and . switches between oscilloscope, sphere and spectrogram. The radio keeps its own values in radio_config.txt (OsciStyle=, Osci<name>=, OsciImage<name>=). The image-style environment variables MOUSIKI_GFX / MOUSIKI_CELLPX apply to both (the older MOUSIKI_RADIO_GFX / MOUSIKI_RADIO_CELLPX are still accepted).
Loudness normalization (v, SHIFT+v)	Chapter 2 and *Loudness normalization overlay*	Same overlay, range and gating. A live stream has no end, so the loudness is measured **since you tuned in** and the gain glides in over about a second. Settings: radio_config.txt.
Sleep timer (SHIFT+z)	Chapter 3, *Sleep timer overlay*	Same minute entries (15 / 30 / 60 / 90 / 120). When the time is up the stream is **stopped** (a radio has no song to wait for), and there is **no "Stop after current song"** entry. The fade-out works the same way.
Search	Chapter 4	Fuzzy and typo tolerant like the player's. - _ . / count as spaces. With a query the best match comes first; SHIFT+t (A-Z) overrides that order. The Radio Browser menu searches on the server and is neither fuzzy nor transliterated.
Text fields	*Before you start* and the editors' chapters	Same editing keys in every field: ←/→ caret, SHIFT+←/→ mark, HOME/END, DEL / BACKSPACE, CTRL+C/X/V. While a text field has the keyboard CTRL+c copies instead of quitting and SHIFT+←/→ marks text instead of switching the preset.
Lists	Chapter 3	The window only moves when the cursor leaves it. A hovered row that is too long scrolls as a marquee.
Playlist-style menus	Chapter 6	The STATION LISTS menu is built like the playlist editor, the PRESETS menu is laid out like it.
Listening history	Chapter 8	The radio has its own history with channels instead of tracks (see 11.11).
Settings	Chapter 10	Same frame and tab strip, but its own file, radio_config.txt (see 11.12).

Feature	Where it is described	What is different in the radio
Cheat sheet, rebinding	Chapter 1 and *Settings → REFERENCE*	Own list of keys, rebindable under the radio's Settings → REFERENCE.

11.5 Searching: stations, station lists and `p:`

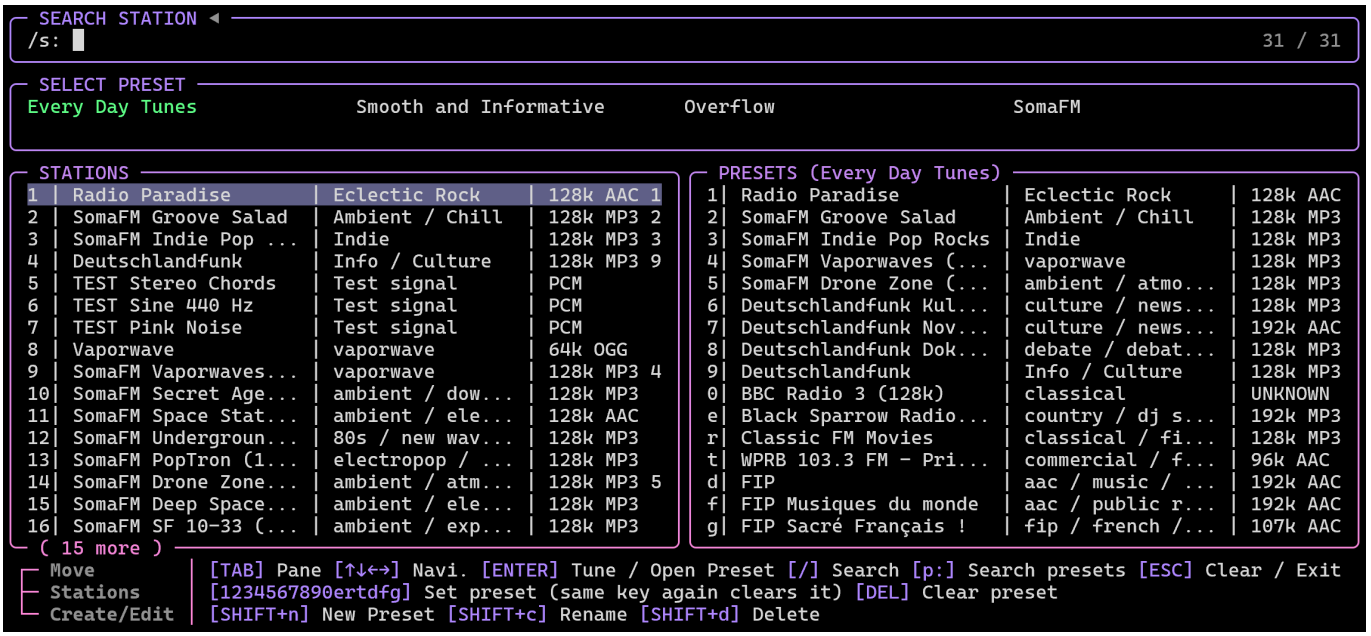
`/` opens the search box under the frequency band. The list filters live as you type; `ENTER` tunes the hovered hit and `ESC` clears the search.

Typed in the empty box	What it does
(a name, genre or country)	Filters the STATIONS pane
`s:`	Back to searching stations (the default)
`p:`	Searches the **saved station lists** (see 11.8): the STATIONS pane turns into STATION LISTS and filters live. `ENTER` fills the STATIONS pane with that list's stations **and tunes its first station**.

While a list is shown, the pane title reads `STATIONS (LIST: name - ESC: all)` and its rows are numbered by position in the list. **`n`, `b` and `#` surf only through the stations of that list**, in the list's order. `ESC` clears a search that is still in the box; the next `ESC` returns to all stations, and surfing covers every station again. The station list itself is not affected by the search.

11.6 PRESETS menu (`SHIFT+p`)

A **preset** is a named set of 16 station slots on the keys `1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 0 e r t d f g`. You can keep as many presets as you like. The active one is shown in the title of the PRESETS pane (`PRESETS (Morning)`), and `SHIFT+←/→` switches to the previous / next one from the main screen.



The PRESETS menu (SHIFT+p): stations on the left, the slots of the selected preset on the right.

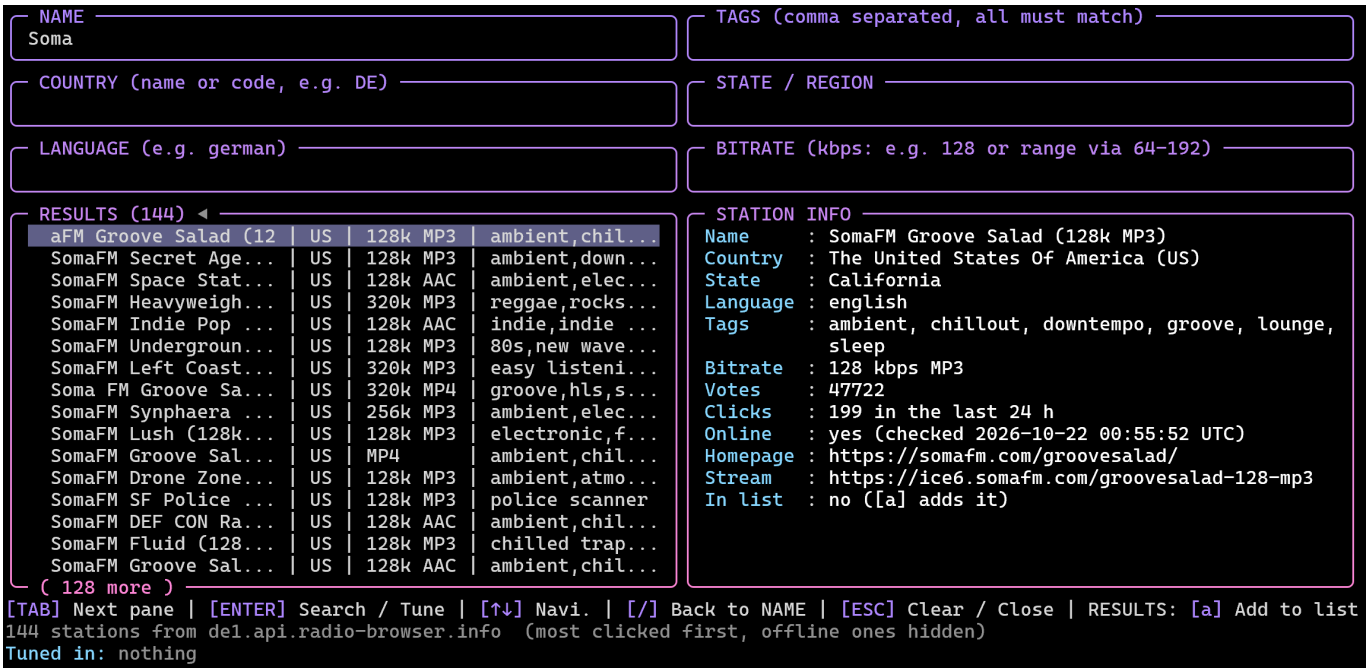
The full-screen menu is laid out like the player's playlist menu, from top to bottom: **SEARCH STATION / SEARCH PRESET** (`s:` filters stations, `p:` presets), **SELECT PRESET** (names in four columns) and **STATIONS** beside **PRESETS** (the 16 slots of the active preset). A small ◀ behind a pane's title shows which pane has the keyboard.

Key	Where	What it does
TAB	anywhere	Next pane: SEARCH → SELECT PRESET → STATIONS
↑ ↓ ← → (or j k h l)	SELECT PRESET / STATIONS	Move
ENTER	STATIONS	Tune the hovered station
ENTER	SELECT PRESET	Open the hovered preset **and tune its first filled slot**
ENTER	search	Tune the hovered station / open the hovered preset, then jump to that pane
SHIFT+n / SHIFT+c	SELECT PRESET	New preset / rename the hovered one (a small name box: ENTER applies, ESC cancels)
SHIFT+d	SELECT PRESET	**Delete** the hovered preset. Press it twice, any other key cancels. The last remaining preset cannot be deleted.
1…0, e r t d f g	STATIONS	Set the hovered station as that slot of the active preset. The same key again clears it. A station sits in one slot only, so it moves.
DEL / BACKSPACE	STATIONS	Remove the hovered station from the active preset
/	STATIONS / SELECT PRESET	Back to the search box
SHIFT+←/→	outside the search box	Previous / next preset
ESC	search	Clear the search; if it is already empty, close the menu
ESC	STATIONS / SELECT PRESET	Close the menu

Names have 1 to 24 characters and must be unique (capital letters don't matter). Presets are saved on every change to `presets.txt`.

11.7 RADIO BROWSER menu (SHIFT+s)

Searches the public station directory radio-browser.info and tunes or adds what it finds. Six input panes sit on top, **RESULTS** and **STATION INFO** (every detail of the hovered result) below.



The RADIO BROWSER with a search for "Soma". A dot in front of a result means it is already in your list.

Pane	What you type
NAME	Part of the station name
TAGS	Comma separated, **every** tag has to match (`rock, 80s`)
COUNTRY	A name (`Germany`) or a two-letter code (`DE`)
STATE / REGION	Part of the region name
LANGUAGE	As Radio Browser spells it (`german`)
BITRATE	In kbps: `128` = at least 128, `64-192` = range, `-192` = at most 192

Key	What it does
`TAB`	NAME → TAGS → COUNTRY → STATE → LANGUAGE → BITRATE → RESULTS → NAME
`ENTER`	In a pane: search (focus jumps to RESULTS when the results arrive). In RESULTS: tune the hovered station.
`↑` / `↓`	In a pane: one pane row up / down (down from the last row: RESULTS). In RESULTS: move the cursor.
`a`	In RESULTS: **add the hovered station to your station list** (appended at the end, so presets keep their slots)
`/`	In RESULTS: back to NAME
`ESC`	In a pane: clear it. Empty pane or RESULTS: close the menu.
`?` / `CTRL+c`	Cheat sheet (RESULTS only) / quit (in a pane `CTRL+c` copies)

Every search sends "hide broken streams" and sorts by clicks (most clicked first), with at most 200 results. Empty panes are left out. Results whose last check failed are dimmed and hidden by default. The line under

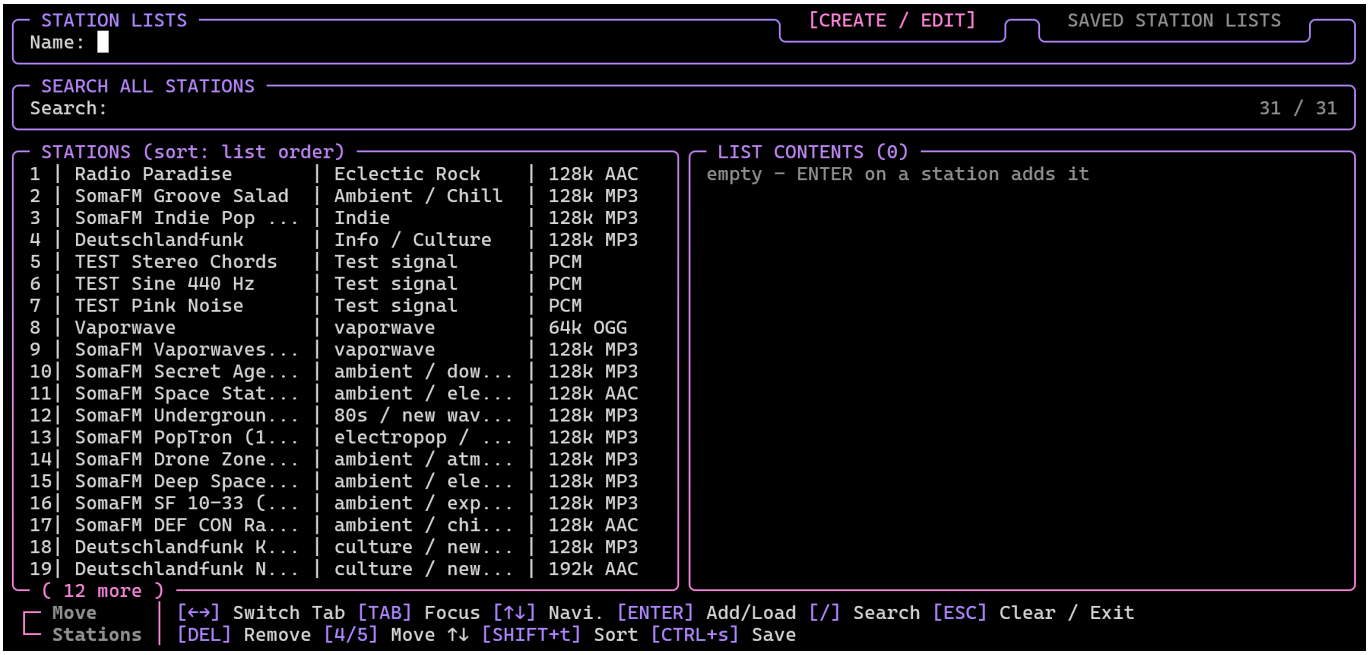
the results shows what is tuned in right now, including the track title if the stream sends one. Tuning a station counts one click at Radio Browser, as their API asks. If `a` finds no `stations.txt` yet, it creates one from the built-in list plus the new station.

11.8 STATION LISTS menu (`SHIFT+k`)

Named, ordered collections of stations (a "jazz" list, a "morning" list ...), built and managed like the player's playlist editor. Use `p:` in the search box (see 11.5) to open one on the main screen.

Two tabs, switched with `←` / `→` like the player's playlist editor (see Menus with tabs and text boxes): in the name field and the search boxes the arrows move the caret once you have typed something there, until `ESC`, `TAB` or `ENTER`. `ALT+←/→` (`Option` on macOS) switches from every pane, also while typing.

- **CREATE / EDIT.** The top pane holds the list's `Name:` field (25 characters, the field turns red while you type). Below it: SEARCH ALL STATIONS (name, genre, country), then STATIONS (all stations, or the search results) beside LIST CONTENTS (what you are building).
- **SAVED STATION LISTS.** The search field and the saved lists.



CREATE / EDIT: name field, search, all stations on the left, the list being built on the right.



SAVED STATION LISTS.

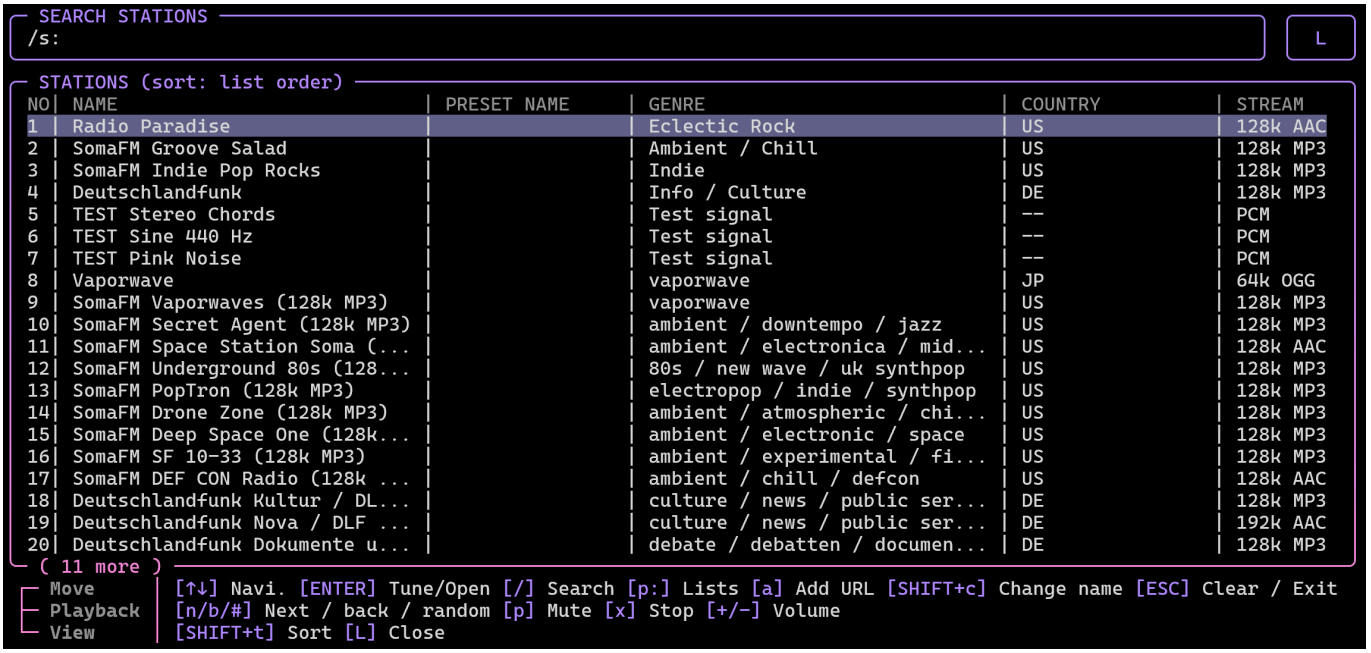
Key	Where	What it does
← / →	lists, and text boxes not typed in yet	Switch tab
ALT+←/→	anywhere	Switch tab
TAB	anywhere	Tab 1: name → search → STATIONS → LIST CONTENTS. Tab 2: search ↔ list.
ENTER	name	On to the search
ENTER	search, STATIONS	Add the hovered station to the end of the list (a station is in a list once)
ENTER	LIST CONTENTS	Tune the hovered station (to audition the list)
SHIFT+t	STATIONS	Sort: list order ↔ name A-Z (also sorts search results)
4 / 5, DEL / BACKSPACE / d	LIST CONTENTS	Move the hovered station up / down, remove it
CTRL+s	every pane of tab 1	Save under the typed name and stay in the menu (the same name overwrites; an empty name: "enter a name first")
ENTER	tab 2 search / list	To the list / load the hovered list into tab 1
DEL	tab 2 list	Delete the hovered list after a Yes/No question
/	STATIONS, LIST CONTENTS, tab 2 list	Back to the search box
ESC	a text box you typed in	Leave the box (the text stays; ← / → switch tabs again)
ESC	search with text	Clear it

Key	Where	What it does
ESC	otherwise	Close. With unsaved changes on tab 1 it asks Save changes to "x" before exiting? [Y]es [N]o [ESC] cancel.

CTRL+s saves from every pane, also while typing. As in the player, opening the menu starts a fresh list; an existing one comes back through tab 2 → ENTER. A dot behind a station in STATIONS means it is already in the list being built. Lists are stored in stationlists.txt; stations are matched by URL, then by name, and a station that has been removed from stations.txt is dropped when the list is read.

11.9 Big STATIONS overlay (SHIFT+l)

The STATIONS pane with the whole screen for its rows and an extra **PRESET NAME** column. It shares the search box and the state of the main screen (/, p:, s:, SHIFT+t; ESC clears the search, leaves a list, then closes). ENTER tunes the hovered station and n b # p x + - work as on the main screen. Keys that would open another menu are ignored while it is open.



The big STATIONS overlay with the PRESET NAME column.

Key	What it does
a	**Add a station by its stream URL.** TAB switches URL ↔ NAME, an empty NAME becomes the host name. The station is appended to the end (so the preset slots stay valid) and written to stations.txt. A stream that is already in the list is refused.
SHIFT+c	Give the hovered station a **preset name**: a shorter second name that is shown in the PRESETS pane instead of the station name (empty = the station's own name again). It is stored in preset_names.txt and the search also looks at it.
SHIFT+l / ESC	Close

11.10 Timeshift and recording (SPACE, [,], {, }, y)

Timeshift. From the moment a station is tuned, the radio keeps the last minutes of it in a rolling buffer on disk (**Timeshift buffer** on the GENERAL tab: 5, 15, 30, 45 or 60 minutes, default 30). That lets you treat live radio like a recording:

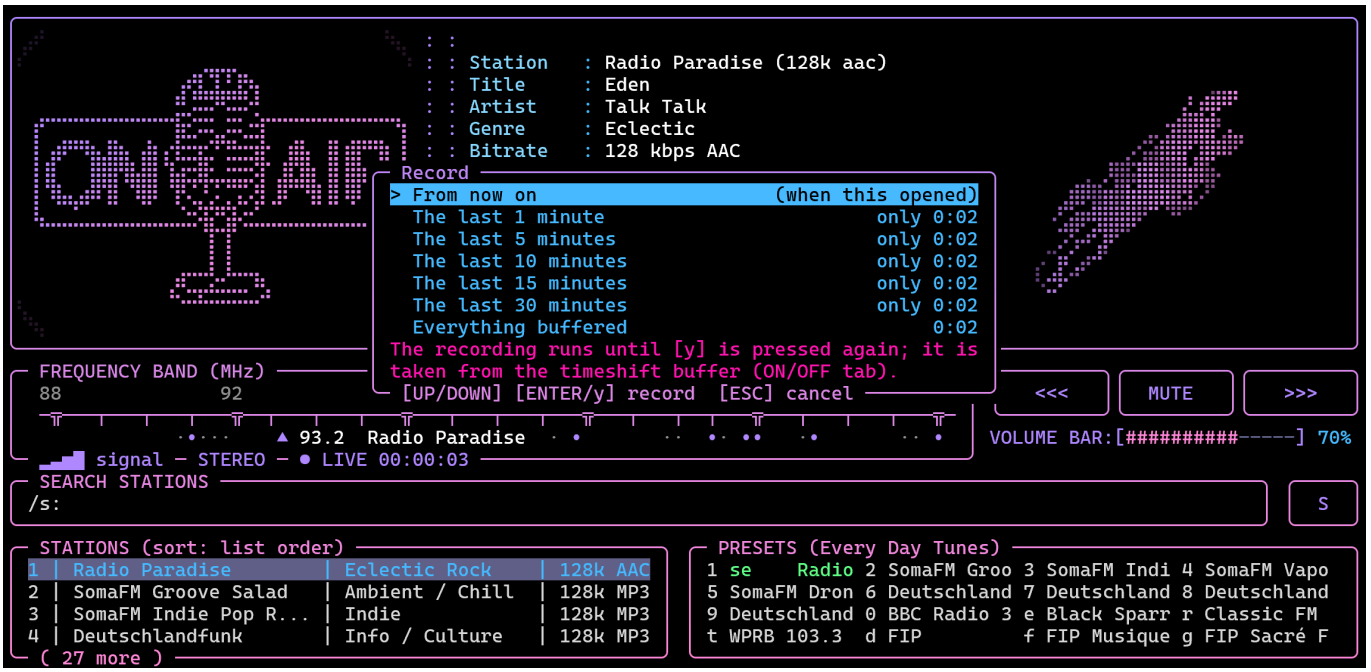
Key	Action
SPACE	Pause. The station keeps arriving in the buffer; SPACE again resumes exactly where you stopped, now behind live.
[/]	Back / forward 30 seconds
{	Back 5 minutes
}	Back to live

- Every jump is shown for 4 seconds at the bottom of the oscilloscope / sphere block, for example `-0:30 | 2:30 behind live`; the dial's footer shows `‖ PAUSED -m:ss` or `◑ TIMESHIFT -m:ss` while you are behind.
- You cannot go back further than the moment you tuned in (or further than the buffer size), and not ahead of live; at the edges the jump stops there. Catching up with] hands back to the live stream without a gap.
- If a pause is longer than the buffer, the oldest part is overwritten and playback continues from the oldest audio still there.
- Tuning another station, x or quitting clears the buffer. Internet radio streams (Icecast / Shoutcast) only deliver from "now", so the buffer can never reach back before you tuned in.
- The buffer is the file `radio_timeshift.pcm` in `~/.cache/mousiki/` (on Windows `%USERPROFILE%\.cache\mousiki\`), about 11.5 MB per minute (so about 345 MB for 30 minutes). It is written by the stream thread and is never touched by the screen loop, so the interface stays as fast as without it. It is deleted when the radio closes.

Recording. y opens the **RECORD** overlay and freezes the moment it was pressed, so no time is lost while you choose:

Row	Starts the recording at
From now on (when this opened)	The moment you pressed y (what you heard then)
The last 1 / 5 / 10 / 15 / 30 minutes	That much before the moment you pressed y. If the buffer does not reach that far back, the row says *only m:ss* and the recording starts at the oldest buffered audio.
Everything buffered	The oldest audio in the buffer

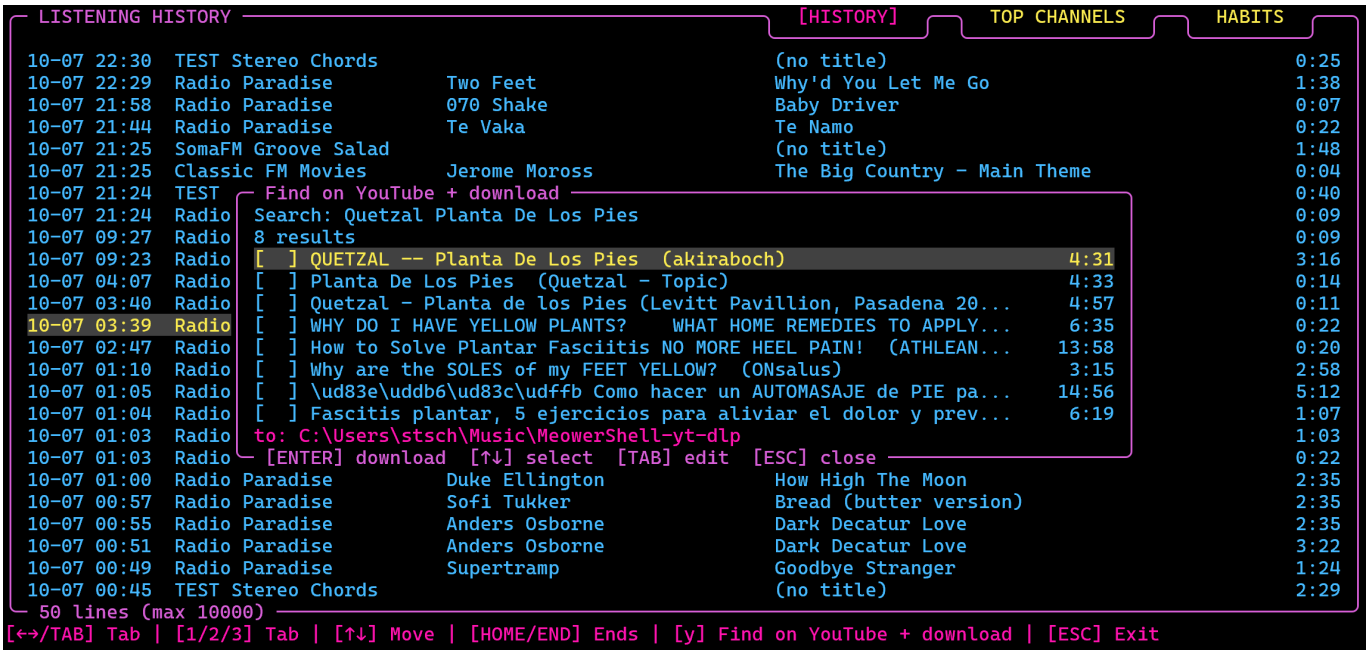
↑ / ↓ choose, ENTER or y starts recording, ESC cancels. While it runs the dial's footer shows `REC mm:ss`; y again stops (at what you are hearing at that moment, so in timeshift it ends at your listening position). The recording is written from the buffer as a WAV file, which ffmpeg then converts in the background to `<YYYY-MM-DD_HH-MM-SS>.mp3`, named by the time the first recorded second was **on air** (the ID3 title is the current "artist - title", or the station name). The WAV is removed afterwards (it is kept if the conversion fails). Tuning another station or x ends the recording too, and recordings shorter than half a second are discarded. Recordings go to the radio's download folder (see 11.12, PATHS), which by default is the player's one. The recording is taken before volume, mute and the mono fold.



The RECORD overlay: where the recording starts.

11.11 Listening history (h)

The radio keeps its own listening history, shaped like the player's (chapter 8) but with **channels** instead of tracks. Three tabs (1 2 3, ←/→, TAB), ↑/↓ move, HOME/END jump to the ends, ESC, q or h close. The bottom border shows the line count or the sort direction.



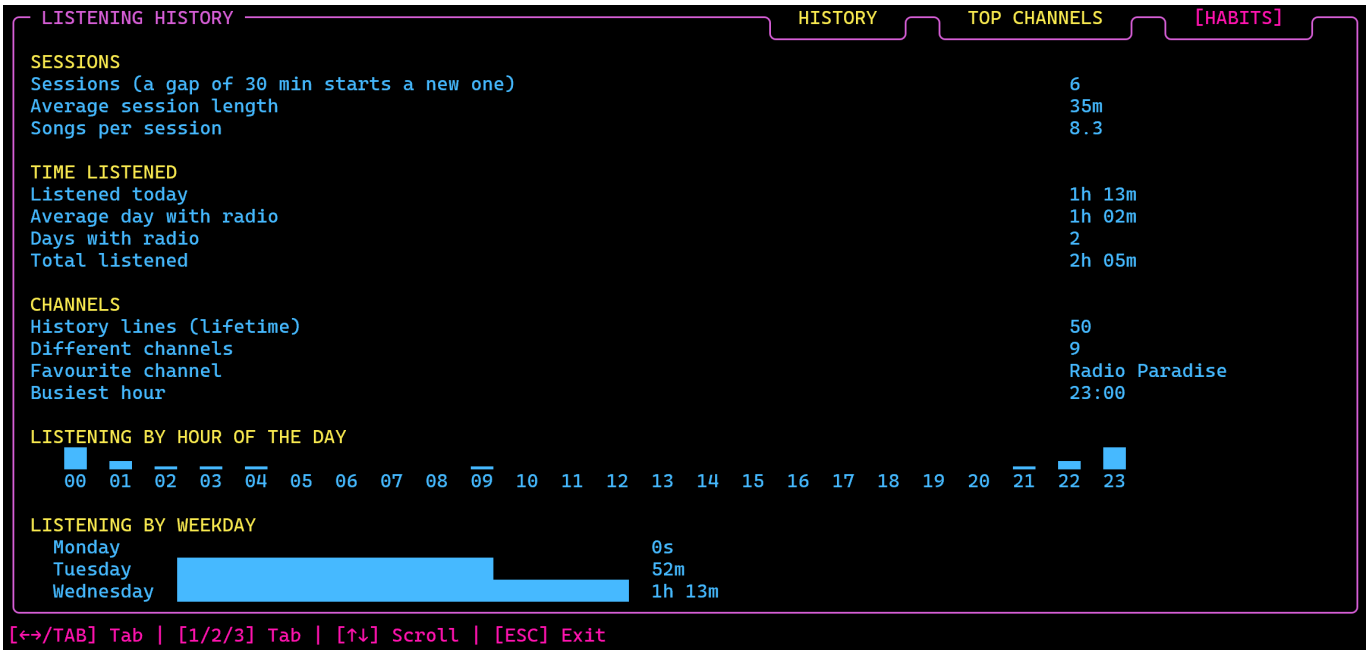
HISTORY tab with the "Find on YouTube + download" overlay open.

- **HISTORY.** WHEN / CHANNEL / ARTIST / TITLE / HEARD. A new line starts whenever the channel, artist or title changes; lines heard for less than 3 seconds are dropped. Hover a line and press y: a small overlay searches YouTube for "artist title" (the player's own online search). ENTER downloads the hovered result (yt-dlp, opus) into the download folder; [..] means downloading, [ok] done, [!!] failed. TAB edits the search query, ESC closes the overlay.
- **TOP CHANNELS.** Channels by time listened; r flips most / least first.

- **HABITS.** Sessions (a gap of 30 minutes starts a new one), time per day, channels, and listening by hour of the day and by weekday (AVERAGE time per weekday plus the CUMULATIVE total).



TOP CHANNELS.



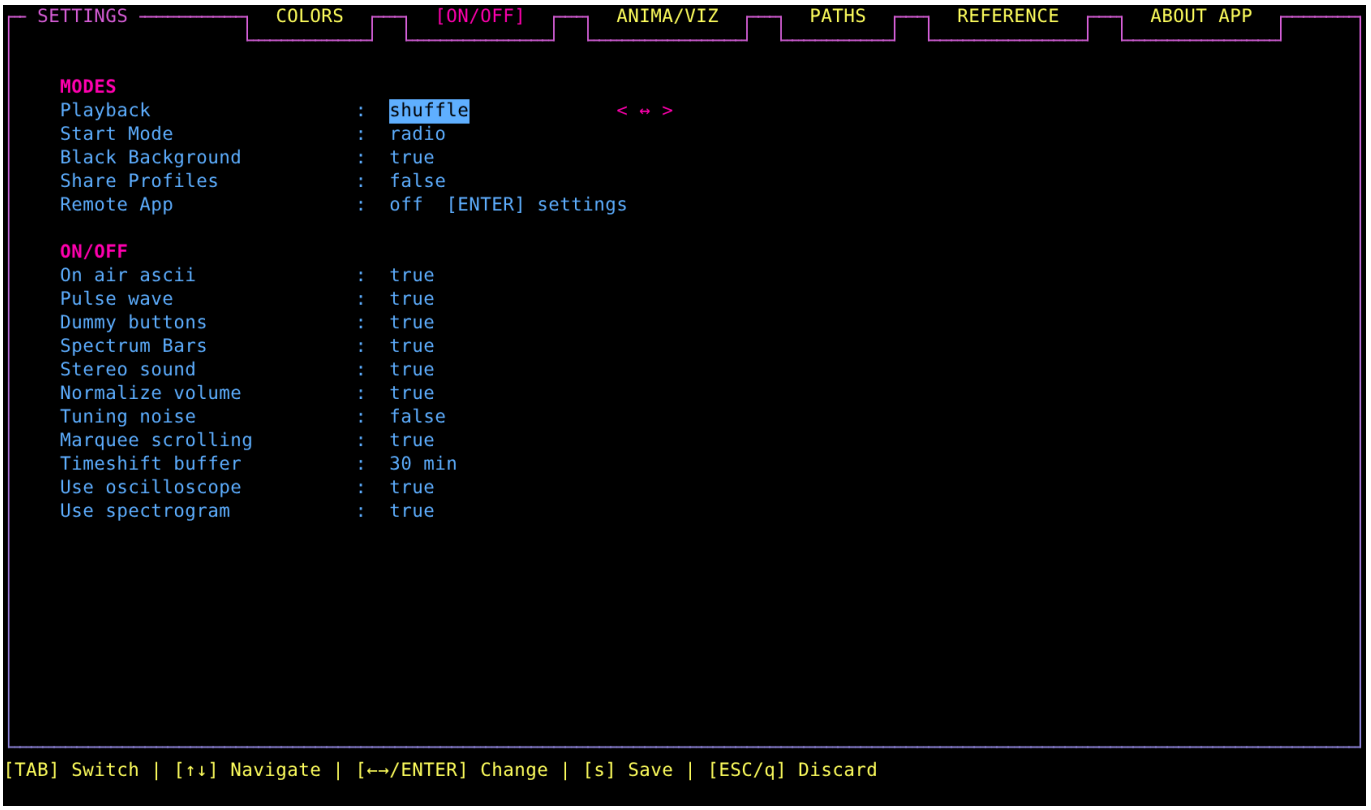
HABITS.

Like the player's, the history is light-weight: the newest 10 000 lines are kept in memory and in `history_radio.txt`; beyond that the oldest line is folded into `archive_radio.txt` (totals per channel, per day, per hour and per weekday), so TOP CHANNELS and HABITS stay lifetime figures.

11.12 Radio settings

`s` opens the radio's settings with the same frame, tab strip and editing keys as the player's (chapter 10): `TAB` next tab, `↑/↓` rows, `←/→` or `ENTER` change a switch, `ENTER` edits a colour, a folder or a key. **`s` saves and closes, `ESC` / `q` / `CTRL+c` discard** what was changed meanwhile and close. The settings always open on the first tab. They are stored in `radio_config.txt`; colours from the player's `config.txt` are not carried over. While a

colour, folder or key is being edited (after ENTER), ← / → move the caret (SHIFT+←/→ marks, HOME / END, CTRL+C/X/V work as in every other field) and TAB stays in the field; only ENTER (apply) or ESC (cancel) leave it. Colour fields take digits only.



The radio's settings, GENERAL tab (Remote App opens its own overlay).

COLORS. Cells hold palette numbers 0 to 255 (empty or 0 = the terminal's own colour). The rows that exist only in the radio:

Row	Cells	What it colours
ON_AIR	UPPER_LEFT, BOTTOM_RIGHT	The ON AIR sign's diagonal gradient (also needle, lamp, LIVE text)
OSCI	LEFT, RIGHT	The oscilloscope
FREQUENCY_BAR	LINE, MHz	The dial's line and ticks / the numbers and the small dots
VOLUME	CURRENT, POSSIBLE	The # and - of the volume bar
PRESETS	INACTIVE FG/BG, KEY FG	Unassigned preset slots / the shortcut letters

BORDER_COLOR, METADATA, VIZ, LIST, HEADER, LEGEND and TAB_NAMES work as in the player. **FOCUS** (ColorFocus) colours the pane focus indicator ◀ after the title of the pane that has the keys in the radio's menus; a radio_config.txt without it follows the radio's HEADER colour.

GENERAL has the categories **MODES**, **MODES ON/OFF AND ORDER**, **TERMINAL**, **REMOTE / UPDATES**, **AUDIO** and **TEXT**, as in the player (the rows the radio does not share with the player are left out):

MODES

Row	What it does
Playback	`shuffle` or `list` for the station surf (same as `m`). Saved as `PlaybackMode=`.
Start Mode	`player`, `radio` or `audiobook`: which mode Mousiki opens with (only modes that are on). The same value as in the player's Settings (`StartMode=` in the player's `config.txt`; the radio reads and writes that one line).
MODES ON/OFF AND ORDER: Use Music Player, Use Radio, Use Audio Books, Mode Order 1..3	The same rows as in the player (`UseMode...=` and `ModeOrder=` in the player's `config.txt`): which modes the `*` / `_` keys switch between, and in which order. One mode always stays on; if the radio is the only one, the key says so.
TERMINAL: Black Background	`true` (default) / `false`: the terminal's background is black while Mousiki runs and is given back on exit. The same value as in the player's Settings (`BlackBackground=` in the player's `config.txt`).

REMOTE / UPDATES

Row	What it does
Remote App	Opens the REMOTE APP overlay (its own overlay, the same as in the player; one setting for both)

AUDIO

Row	What it does
Choose Audio Device	The sound output; `ENTER` opens the CHOOSE AUDIO DEVICE overlay (also `°` / `&` on the radio's main screen). One choice for all modes, written to the player's `config.txt` at once (`AudioDevice=`); the stream moves to the new device without stopping.
On air ascii	The ON AIR sign and its colour wave
Pulse wave	The faint circle burst behind the sign
Dummy buttons	The `<<< MUTE >>>` boxes next to the dial (the volume bar stays)
Stereo sound	Off folds left and right into mono (the dial's footer then says MONO)
Normalize volume	Loudness normalization, as `v`
Tuning noise	Off by default. On: static with crackle fades in while another station is tuned and stays until the new stream plays. It follows volume, mute and the sleep-timer fade and is not recorded.
Timeshift buffer	How many minutes of the tuned station are kept for pause / rewind and recording from the past: 5, 15, 30 (default), 45 or 60 min (see 11.10). Saved as `TimeshiftMinutes=`.

Row	What it does
Use oscilloscope / Use spectrogram	`false` leaves that visual out of the scope block: `.` skips it (the sphere is always there). Full screen (`SHIFT+u`) and the windows `)` / `(` still work. (`UseOscilloscope=`, `UseSpectrogram=`)

TEXT

Row	What it does
Marquee scrolling	On (default): a station name that is too long for its column scrolls while the row is hovered (and the tuned preset). Off: it is cut off with `...`. (`MarqueeScrolling=` in `radio_config.txt`.)

ANIMA/VIZ (the tab used to be called ANIMATION) has these categories and, like the player's, a note at the bottom about `SHIFT+o`, `SHIFT+i`, `SHIFT+u`, `)` and `(`:

Category	Rows
ON AIR SIGN	**Gradient wave speed** (cycles per second of the ON AIR sign's colour wave) and **Pulse wave speed** (loops per second of the circle burst)
SEEK AND VOLUME	**Volume indicator** (what the volume bar is drawn with, as in the player's SEEK AND VOLUME)
SPECTRUM BARS	**On/Off** (the spectrum bars under the station info; before: *Spectrum Bars* on the General tab), Bars Fluidity, Bars Degradation and Bars Viscosity, as in the player (before: Wave ...)
OSCI/SPECTRO SETTINGS	**Modes Share Settings** (`ShareProfiles=`: the radio uses the player's oscilloscope and spectrogram settings instead of its own; the same row as in the player's ANIMA/VIZ tab), **Osci/sphere** (right of the station info: oscilloscope, sphere, off, or spectrogram (`spectro`)) and **Osci style** (`braille` or `image`) and **Scope mode** (`XY`, `YT`, `XY + YT (overlap)`, `XY + YT (row)` or `XY + YT (col)`, set in the `SHIFT+o` overlay; `OsciMode=` in `radio_config.txt`). The oscilloscope full screen (`SHIFT+0`, with grid `SHIFT+a`, axis values `SHIFT+v` and grid colour `SHIFT+c`) is there too (`ScopeBig`, `ScopeGrid=`, `ScopeValues=`, `ScopeGridColor=`)

The player's Waveform Style, Disk Speed, Lyrics Alignment and Lyrics Animation do not exist in the radio, so those categories are missing. The radio's Share Profiles row sits in OSCI/SPECTRO SETTINGS on this tab, not on the GENERAL tab.

PATHS. The radio's files live below these folders. The layout is the player's: the name of the setting in the header colour, its value in the list colour. Every path is a *base*; the radio creates its own sub-folders below it.

Row	Result
STATION LISTS PATH	`<path>/stations/stations.txt` (the overall list) and `<path>/station_lists/stationlists.txt`
PRESETS PATH	`<path>/presets/presets.txt`

Row	Result
DOWNLOAD PATH	`<path>/radio_downloads/`: recordings (`y`) and YouTube downloads from the history. Below the path: *SAME PATH AS THE MUSIC PLAYER IS USED* while the next row is on.
Same folder as music player	On = use the player's download folder instead of DOWNLOAD PATH
HISTORY PATH	`<path>/radio_history/` (`history_radio.txt`, `archive_radio.txt`)
AUDIO BOOK PATH	The player's audio book folder (`AudioBookPath=` in the player's `config.txt`), listed here so every mode can set it. No sub folder is made.

An empty path shows the default folder in effect. When folder paths are changed, the respective files are **only copied, never moved, and no deletions are performed**; playback is stopped and everything is reloaded from the new place.

REFERENCE. The keys that are not hard coded, grouped like the player's. `ENTER` edits the hovered key: type one character (case matters) or `SPACE` / `TAB` / `BACKSPACE`; `DEL` restores the default. A key already in use is refused (the fixed keys count too: the preset slot keys and `j` / `k`). The first line, *Reset all keys to default*, sits under the cheat-sheet note; `CTRL+SHIFT+u` undoes the last five key changes. Keys are stored as `HKey<Action>=` lines. The cheat sheet always lists the default keys.

ABOUT APP. The same text as the player's.

11.13 The radio's files

File	What it holds	Default place
`radio_config.txt`	The radio's settings, colours, equalizer and oscilloscope values	The config folder (`~/.config/mousiki/`, on Windows `%USERPROFILE%\.config\mousiki\`)
`stations.txt`	Your station list	Config folder, or next to the executable
`presets.txt`	The presets and the active one	Config folder
`stationlists.txt`	The saved station lists	Config folder
`preset_names.txt`	The preset names (`url<TAB>name`)	Next to `stations.txt`
`radio_history/`	`history_radio.txt` and `archive_radio.txt`	Config folder
`radio_timeshift.pcm`	The timeshift buffer (raw audio, about 11.5 MB per minute; deleted when the radio closes)	`~/.cache/mousiki/`
Recordings and downloads	MP3 recordings, YouTube downloads	The player's download folder, otherwise `<path>/radio_downloads/`

`stations.txt` has one station per line: `name | genre | country | codec | kbps | url | [*] | [dial MHz]`. A `*` fills the first preset slots of the preset "Default" until a `presets.txt` exists. The URL `lavfi:chords`, `lavfi:tone` or `lavfi:noise` is an offline test signal generated by ffmpeg.

`presets.txt` is plain text and can be edited by hand:

```
@keys 1234567890ertdfg
@active Morning
[Default]
1 | https://stream.radioparadise.com/aac-128 | Radio Paradise
[Morning]
1 | https://st01.sslstream.dlf.de/dlf/01/128/mp3/stream.mp3 | Deutschlandfunk
```

The `@keys` line names the letters of the slots the file was written with (slot 1 = first letter … slot 16 = last), so presets keep their slots if the key letters ever change.

11.14 Not done yet

- Station lists steer `n` / `b` / `#`, but not yet the presets: the presets always refer to the overall station list.
- The PRESETS menu has no page-jump keys (arrows only).
- The radio is untested on macOS and Windows beyond what is described here.

---

12. Audio book mode

The third mode of Mousiki Plus is the music player shaped in an optomized way for listening to **audio books**: the left pane lists the books, the right pane the chapters of the open book (it takes the place of the queue), an **opening book** turns where the disk is, seeking gets faster the longer you hold the key, and the tag editor knows what a book has: author, narrator, chapter.

Everything the audio book player has in common with the music player (progress bar, volume, equalizer, loudness normalization, sleep timer, oscilloscope, spectrogram, sphere, settings, cheat sheet, help wizard, remote control) works as described in chapters 1 to 10. **This chapter only describes what is new or different.** It is a second player inside the same program, like the radio is: the music player keeps its queue, its position and its screen while you are in another mode.

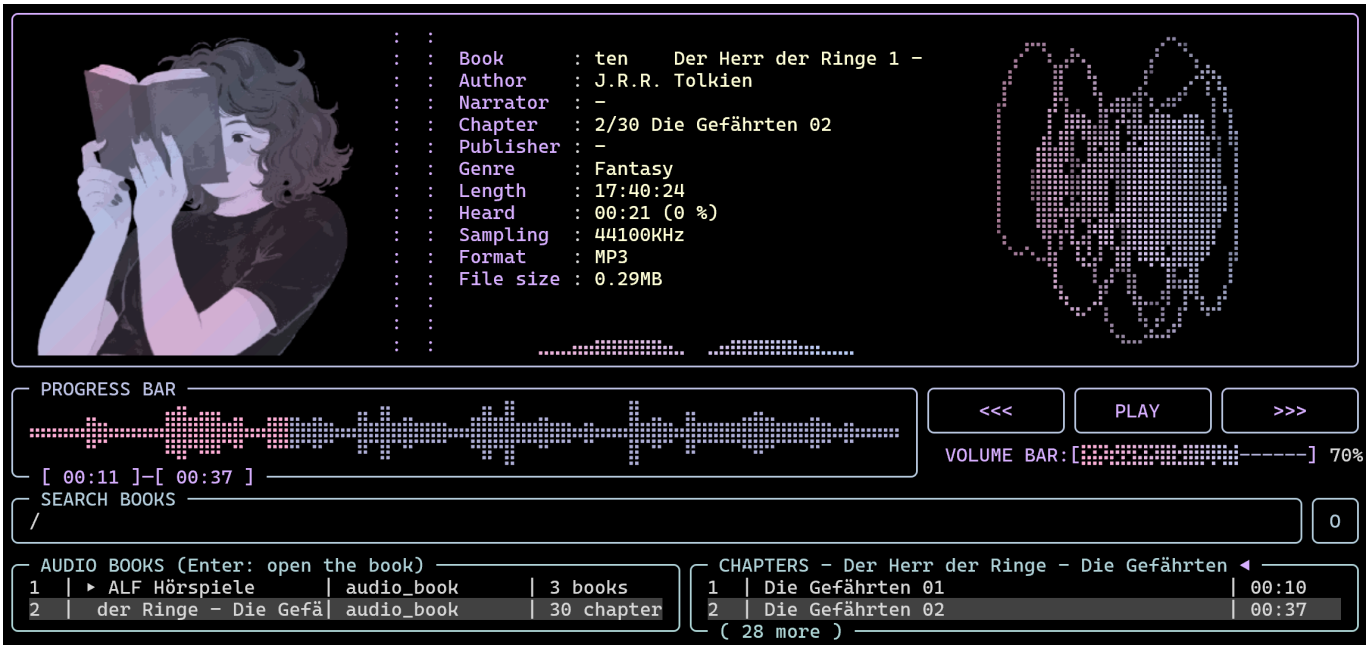
12.1 Switching, setting up and the screen

Switching. `SHIFT` and `+` (German keyboard; the `'` key on an English one) goes to the next mode, `SHIFT` and `-` (the `;` key on an English one) to the previous one. The order is music player → radio → audio books by default. **Settings** → **GENERAL** → **MODES** has *Use Music Player*, *Use Radio*, *Use Audio Books* (a mode that is off is skipped; one mode always stays on), *Mode Order 1..3* and *Start Mode*. The rows are in the settings of every mode.

Setting it up. Settings → **PATHS** → **AUDIO BOOK PATH** takes **one** folder. Every folder in it (also nested ones) that directly holds audio files is one **book**; its files are the chapters. A single long file (an `.m4b` or `.mp3`, for example) in a folder of its own is a book with one chapter. Under the path a note says that a `.cue` file beside

each book records where you last stopped listening. The first time the audio book mode opens, Mousiki scans the folder; **SHIFT+r** scans it again.

Walking through folders. The books pane (left) shows one folder level at a time: a folder that only holds audio files is a **book**; a folder that holds other books is shown as `▸ Name` with the number of books below it. `ENTER` on it goes in: the level below lists first the container's own audio files (when it has any, as a book named like the folder, `this folder` in the parent column), then its books and sub folders; the first row `← ..` (`ENTER`) goes back up and keeps the cursor on the folder you came from. While a search (`/`) is typed the list is flat, with every matching book of any level.



The audio book player: the books on the left, the chapters on the right, the opening book where the disk is, the meta data of the book and the field for the visualizations.



The audio book player, a second view of the main screen.

The screen is the music player's screen with these differences:

Where	Music player	Audio book player
Disk	The spinning disk	A **picture of a woman reading a book** (a grey version of a colour picture with a transparent background), drawn as small braille dots (a dithered 60 x 60 dot field), centred between the left border and the `:` of the separator. It is a still picture; the colour wave of the radio's ON AIR sign (from the disk colour to the disk colour end) runs over it **diagonally** from the upper left to the lower right. **Pixel image:** where the terminal speaks Kitty graphics or Sixel (Windows Terminal 1.22+, Kitty, WezTerm, Ghostty, foot ...), the picture is not made of braille characters but is a **real transparent image** at the full pixel resolution of the field (the original, 494 x 505 pixels, scaled down with an area average; its dark parts are dark grey, its transparent background stays transparent), and the diagonal colour wave runs over it. Without Kitty or Sixel the braille picture is used. *Settings* → *GENERAL* → *AUDIO* → ***Book Cover*** (`BookCover`, replaces the former *Eliment Book* and *Book Pic Image* rows: the field is always there and always a picture): *false* shows the standard picture, *true* shows the **cover image of the open book** where its folder holds one (a file named `cover`, `folder`, `front` or `albumart`, else the first picture there: jpg, png, webp, bmp, gif, tif; with no picture file the cover art inside the first audio file; decoded by ffmpeg in the background; if it cannot be read the status line says why and the console log, `t`, has the path). Like every switch the row changes with `←` / `→`. The cover is a real image, so it needs **Sixel or Kitty** (Windows Terminal 1.22+ speaks Sixel; if the terminal is not recognised, `OsciImageProtocol=sixel` in `config.txt` forces it); when you switch Book Cover on, the status line reports, short enough to read to the end, the protocol and the cover file that was found (`book cover: on
Library pane (left)	Titles	**Only folders**: one row per book with its number of chapters.
Queue pane (right)	The queue	The **chapters** of the open book
Field with the visualizations	Lyrics or a visualization	The notes field: a visualization (sphere, oscilloscope, spectrogram, as in the player). While **no book is loaded** a **stack of books** builds itself up there.
Meta data	Title, artist, album, year, ...	**Book**, **Author**, **Narrator**, **Chapter** (number and title), **Publisher** (with the year), **Genre**, the **Length** of the whole book and how much of it you have **Heard** (a `+` after the length: not every chapter length is known yet), then sampling, format and file size (no location in this mode)

12.2 Books, chapters and the keys

Key	What it does in the audio book player
ENTER	On a **book**: opens it, its chapters fill the right pane and the focus moves there. On a **chapter**: plays it.
TAB	Moves the focus between the books and the chapters (the ◀ marks it).
↑ / ↓	Move in the pane that has the focus.
/	Searches the **books** (fuzzy, over the folder names). ESC shows all books again. In the **chapter pane** ESC moves the focus back to the library pane. In the library pane, **inside a folder**, ← and ESC both go **one step up** in the folder tree (the ← .. row); at the top level ESC shows all books again.
n / b	The next / the previous chapter (asks about a bookmark first, 12.4). The same happens when a chapter ends (m, below, can change that).
m	Cycles the play mode: **on to the next chapter**, **repeat the chapter**, **stop after the chapter**.
→ / ←	Seek forward / backward: **5 seconds** with the first press, then **faster and faster the longer the key is held**; after a few seconds one second of holding jumps by minutes, so a long book can be crossed quickly. Releasing the key and pressing it again starts with 5 seconds again.
SHIFT+→ / SHIFT+←	**Playback speed** faster / slower in steps of 0.05, from **0.5x to 3.0x**. The voice keeps its pitch (the audio is stretched in time, not played faster like a record). A small box **left of the play-mode box** (right of the search bar) shows the speed, `1.0x`, `1.25x` ...; it is as wide as its text and the search bar gives up those columns. The speed is saved at once (`BookSpeed=` in `config.txt`) and is also a row in Settings -> GENERAL -> AUDIO (*Playback Speed*). Times, bookmarks, notes and the progress bar stay in the time of the book itself: at 1.5x a 60-minute chapter still shows 60:00, it just takes 40 minutes. The music player and the radio always play at 1.0x.
° (other keyboards &)	The **CHOOSE AUDIO DEVICE** overlay, as in the player (chapter 10, GENERAL -> AUDIO).
p, + / -, x, SHIFT+z, SHIFT+e, SHIFT+v	Pause, volume, mute, sleep timer, equalizer, loudness normalization: as in the player.
SHIFT+m	The **book tag editor** (12.3).
SHIFT+b, SHIFT+n, SHIFT+l, CTRL+SHIFT+u	A **bookmark**, a **note**, the **notes overlay** and the **undo** of a deleted time stamp (12.4).
SHIFT+k	The **list of time stamps**: the auto-marks, bookmarks and notes of all books (12.5).
SHIFT+s	The **library overlay**: search pane and books with their chapters (12.5).

Key	What it does in the audio book player
SHIFT+h	The **reading history** (12.5).
ALT+l (macOS: SHIFT+j)	**Chapter marks** and cutting a file into chapters (12.6).
SHIFT+c	The **file conversion** overlay works on the audio books too; /f: searches folders (the way it does in the player).

12.3 The book tag editor (SHIFT+m)

SHIFT+m opens a small overlay instead of the meta editor of chapter 7. It is **only an editor**: nothing is fetched, no AcoustID, no MusicBrainz. It shows **one chapter at a time** with seven rows:

Row	Stored as
File name	The file's name (a rename; the extension stays, typing Chapter 3 gives Chapter 3.mp3)
Book title	the album tag
Author	the artist and album_artist tags
Narrator	the book's .cue file (REM NARRATOR), also the composer and narrator tags (many taggers keep the narrator as the composer)
Chapter	the title tag
Publisher, Year	the publisher and date tags: one row, written like Penguin, 2019 (a last part with four digits is the year)
Genre	the genre tag

↑ / ↓ pick a row, ENTER types into it (a second ENTER puts the cursor away; the usual text keys work: SHIFT+←/→ mark, CTRL+C/X/V, HOME, END). A changed row is drawn in the header colour. ← / → go to the other chapters (with unsaved changes they ask you to save or drop them first). s writes this chapter, d drops the changes. a writes the changed **book rows** (book title, author, narrator, publisher + year, genre) to **every chapter** of the book in one go; the chapter title stays each chapter's own. **The file name row** edits the name only: the ending (.mp3, .m4a, …) is shown after it and cannot be changed. **The chapter number always goes in front of the name** (01 Dune, 02 Dune, …): the folder is sorted by name, so the number keeps the chapters in their order however the titles are changed. With a a changed file name becomes the base of **all** files and every file gets its number in front; before it does so, the editor says it in the note rows and waits for y (rename all) or n (back). With s the renamed chapter gets its chapter number in front of the new name. **A number that is there already is not added twice:** the editor looks at all file names of the folder; if every name starts with its own number, that number stays; if every name **ends** with its own number (Dune 01), the numbers are **removed from the end and put in front** of **every** file of the folder (01 Dune) - with a warning that says why (to keep the track order from getting jumbled) and waits for y / n. A number you type yourself in front (or at the end, where the folder has them) is not doubled. The bookmarks, the auto-mark, the chapter marks and the notes follow the new file names. The files are renamed in two steps, so a chapter may take the name another one has just left, and if anything fails every file is put back. The legend of the editor is centred in several rows, in the colour of the bottom border. ESC leaves; with unsaved changes it asks y save / n discard / ESC keep editing.

Every file is a copy through `ffmpeg -c copy` (the audio is not touched), one file per frame, so the screen stays alive while a whole book is written. **Narrator, publisher and year** are also written to the book's **`.cue` file** (`<book folder>/<folder name>.cue`: `REM NARRATOR "…"`, `REM PUBLISHER "…"`, `REM DATE 2019`, and with `a` also `TITLE` / `PERFORMER`), and the cue is read first, so they survive in a **WAV** file, which has no tags for them. Other lines in the cue are kept as they are. A file that is being played cannot be replaced on Windows (the status line says so); pause or pick another chapter first. The tag values shown in the chapter pane and the meta data block are read again afterwards.

12.4 Bookmarks and book notes

A book carries **three kinds of time stamps**. They all live in the book's own files and all of them can be listed (12.5), played from and deleted:

Kind	What it is	Where it is kept
Auto-mark	Where you stopped listening. The program writes it by itself every few seconds while a chapter plays and when you leave (change the chapter, switch the mode, quit). A book has one.	`REM AUTOMARK "Dune 01.wav" 1234.5 <date>` in the `.cue`
Bookmark	A place you set on purpose. A book (and a chapter) may carry **many**; they are numbered automatically: *Bookmark 1*, *Bookmark 2* … in the order they were set.	`REM BOOKMARK "Dune 01.wav" 1234.5 <date>` in the `.cue`
Note	A bookmark **with a text** (12.4, below). A note works like a bookmark; if it has no title it is numbered automatically: *Note 1*, *Note 2* …	`<folder>_notes.txt`

In the chapter pane the chapter that carries the newest bookmark is drawn in the **header colour** with a ◆ in front of its title. When you open the book (`ENTER`), the cursor is on it.

Key / event	What happens
`SHIFT+b`	Sets a bookmark **right now** (chapter and exact time); the status line says which number it got. Several bookmarks can be set in a book and in one chapter.
`d` (chapter pane)	**Deletes the bookmark** of the chosen chapter: a small overlay asks first (`y` / `ENTER` delete, `n` / `ESC` keep). `CTRL+SHIFT+u` brings it back.
`n`, `b`, `ENTER` on another chapter	Before the chapter changes, a question asks **Set a bookmark here?** with the chapter and the exact time (`mm:ss` or `h:mm:ss`) and what you are about to do. `y` / `ENTER` sets it, `n` does not, `ESC` stays where you are (the audio goes on). **The audio is paused while the question is open.**
`SHIFT` and `+` / `SHIFT` and `-` (another mode), `q` (quit)	The same question first, then the mode switches or Mousiki quits.
`ENTER` on a chapter that was left and **not**	The question **Do you want to continue where you left?** with the time: `y` / `ENTER` **Continue** there: the chapter starts at the auto-mark (from there you can listen on or set a bookmark by hand). `n` **Leave, but keep the auto-mark**:

Key / event	What happens
bookmarked (it only carries the auto-mark)	nothing is played, the auto-mark stays as it is. `b` **Convert auto-mark to bookmark and leave**: the auto-mark becomes a regular bookmark (kept for good), nothing is played. Only *yes* starts the chapter; after a leave you open the chapter again on purpose. `ESC` cancels like `n`.
`ENTER` on a chapter with **one bookmark**	The **Resume** overlay: *right on the spot*, *10 / 20 / 30 / 60 seconds before* (each with the time it jumps to), or *the start of the chapter*. `↑` / `↓` and `ENTER`, or `1` to `6`; `ESC` does not play it (the chapter that was paused for the question goes on). `n` / `b` arriving at the chapter show it as well.
`ENTER` on a chapter with **several time stamps** (a bookmark and the auto-mark, or more bookmarks)	An overlay lists them with their time: **Auto-mark**, **Bookmark 1**, **Bookmark 2** …, the notes of the chapter by their title (or *Note 1* …) and *the start of the chapter*. `↑` / `↓` and `ENTER`, or `1` to `9`; the choice opens the Resume overlay above. An auto-mark within five seconds of a bookmark is the same place and is not listed twice.
`CTRL+SHIFT+u`	**Undo**: brings back the last deleted time stamp (bookmark, note or auto-mark), at its old place in the list. Up to 30 deletions are remembered, newest first; it works in the book window, in the `SHIFT+k` list and in the notes overlay.

Settings → GENERAL → BOOKMARKS → Ask for Bookmark switches the question *Set a bookmark here?* off (`BookmarkAsk=false`); `SHIFT+b` still works and the auto-mark is written in any case.

Notes. A note is a title and a text that belongs to a point in a chapter. **The point is the time at which you pressed `SHIFT+n`**, not the time at which you save: it is shown in the editor's header (*set when SHIFT+n was pressed* where there is room). The header and the line under a shown note are `chapter @ h:mm:ss`; when the field is narrow the **chapter name is cut (`...`) and the time stamp always stays whole** and stays while you type, also when the chapter changes meanwhile.

Key	What it does
`SHIFT+n`	**Writes a note** at the current time. The field of the visualizations turns into the editor: the first line is the **title**, `ENTER` goes on to the text (`ENTER` is a new line there, `↑` / `↓` change the line, the usual text keys work). The audio goes on. `CTRL+SHIFT+s` saves (the legend under the editor wraps to the width of the field). `ESC` stops the typing; then `SHIFT+s` saves, `ENTER` types on and `ESC` again discards (it asks `y` / `n` when there is text). Long lines wrap to the width of the field or the overlay (only on the screen, the text keeps its lines); `CTRL+C` copies instead of ending the program: in the editor the marked text (nothing marked: the whole text), on a note that is shown in the field or chosen in the notes overlay the whole note.
`CTRL+n`	**Small field ↔ big overlay.** In the small field (while you write a note, or while one is shown) `CTRL+n` opens the **big notes overlay** with the same note: the text and the caret stay where they are and you go on writing in the right pane. A note that is only shown is opened there for editing; with no note in the field a new one starts there. In the overlay's editor `CTRL+n` goes back to the small field.

Key	What it does
SHIFT+s / SHIFT+k / SHIFT+m / SHIFT+l (in one of these overlays)	The library overlay, the time stamp list, the tag editor and the notes overlay **switch to each other** without closing first (not while something is typed or asked; the tag editor with unsaved changes asks first). The key of the overlay that is open closes it, as before.
. / ,	Switch the field between the notes and the visualizations (forward / backward); a note that is shown is put away by ., and the view that was on before the note (sphere, oscilloscope, spectrogram or lyrics) comes back. , on a note that is shown (for example right after saving it) **writes it again**: the note opens in the editor.
SHIFT+l	The **notes overlay**, a big window. **The window fills the whole terminal. Left:** every note with its chapter number, file name, time and title (the bookmarks and the auto-marks are in the list of 12.5 as well). **Right:** the chosen note. ↑ / ↓ choose. ENTER (or t) **changes the note right there** (see below). f shows the note in the field of the main screen (the overlay closes). SHIFT+p opens the note and **starts playing from that point**; the overlay stays, and the note is in the field once you close it. The right pane becomes the editor (title, then the text; the keys are those of the editor in the field: ENTER new line, CTRL+SHIFT+s saves, ESC stops typing, then SHIFT+s saves or ESC throws it away) and the list stays visible. n writes a **new note** at the point that plays, also in the overlay. x deletes a note (asks y / n; CTRL+SHIFT+u brings it back). SHIFT+t sorts the list: by **chapter** with the highest chapter and, inside a chapter, the furthest time on top (the default), or by the **last edit**, the most recently written or changed note first (notes without a date come last); ESC closes the window and the next one opens in the chapter order again. ESC closes. The legend below the window is a small table like the legends of the meta editor: the group names (*List*, *Note*, *File*) in the header colour, the keys and their descriptions in the legend and command colours.
SHIFT+e / SHIFT+i (in the overlay)	**Export / import** the notes: a path field appears (the file <folder>_notes_export.txt in the folder notes inside the book folder is suggested; the folder is made when the file is written); ENTER does it. An import adds only the notes you do not have yet and says how many it added.

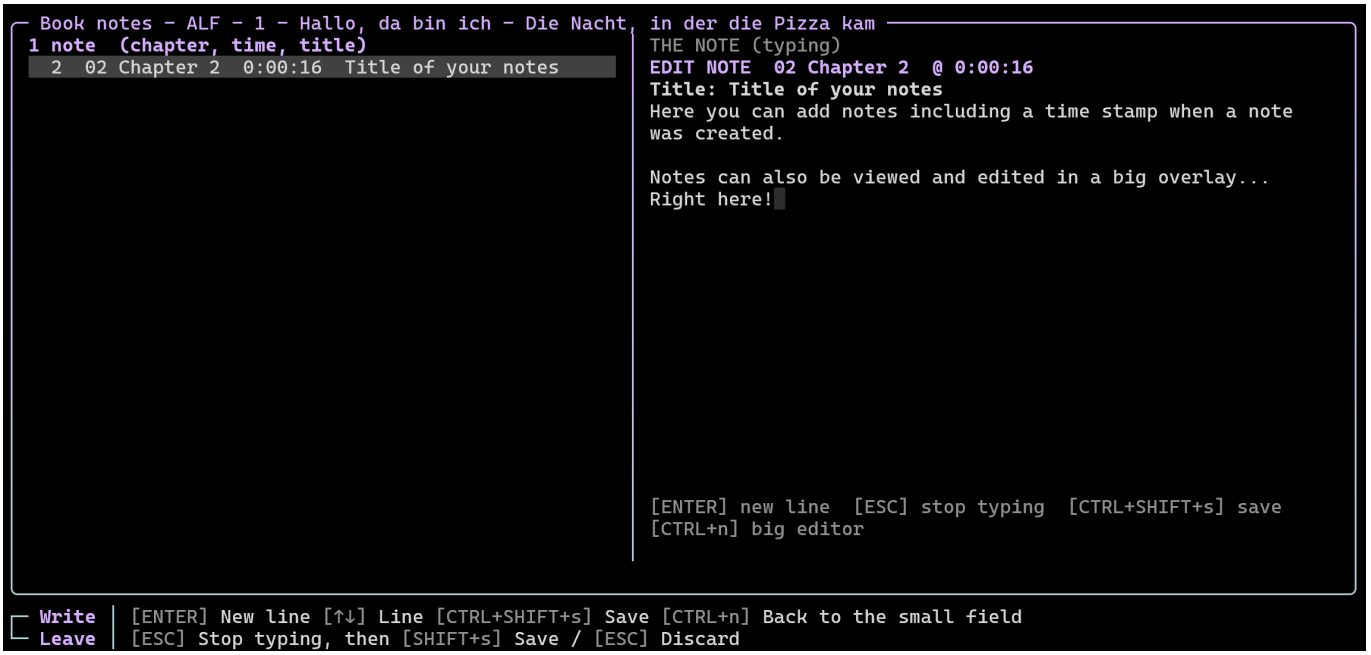
The notes are saved in **<book folder>/<folder name>_notes.txt**, a text file you can read and edit by hand:

```
=== Dune 01.wav | 0:12:34 | The title of the note
the text of the note,
as many lines as it takes
```

While a chapter plays and passes the time of a note, the note **shows itself in the field** (for 20 seconds, or until the chapter changes); the oscilloscope and spectrogram are shown whenever no note is. A text line that starts with === is written with a space in front of it.



The main screen while a note is shown in the field of the visualizations (it appears when the playback passes it, or with `f` / `,`).



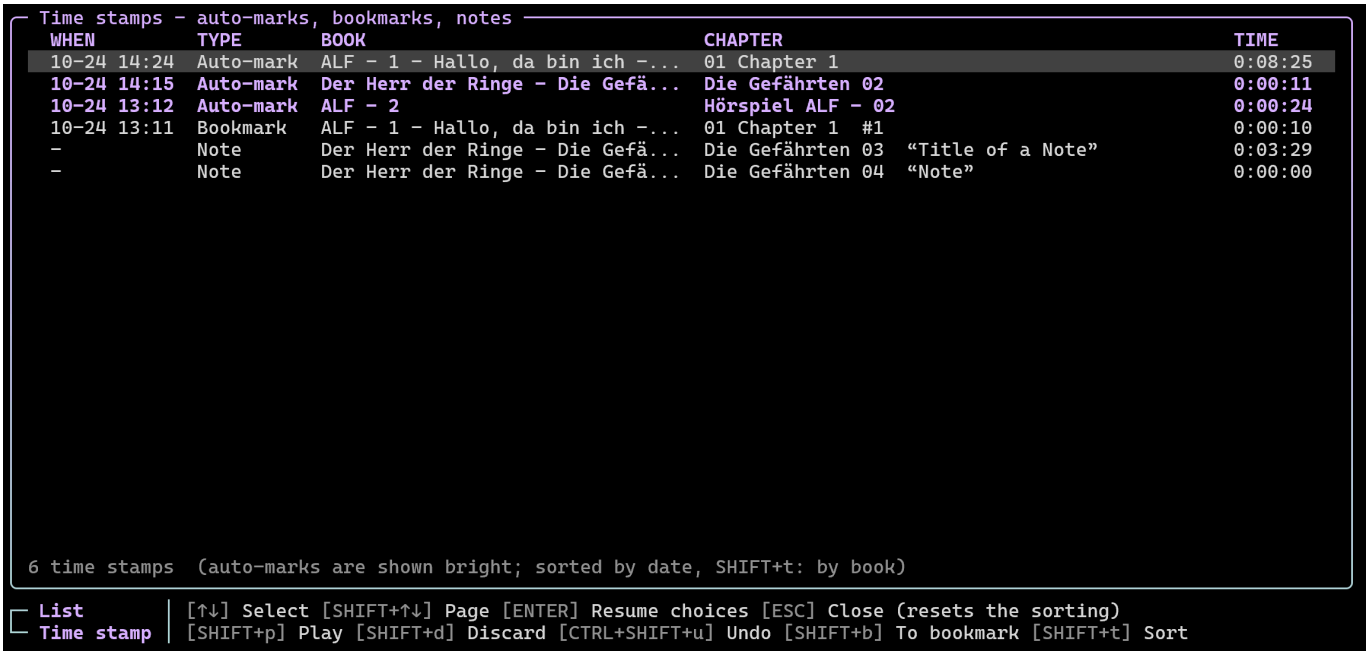
The big notes overlay (`SHIFT+L`, or `CTRL+n` from the small field) with the note being edited in the right pane.

12.5 The list of time stamps, the library overlay and the reading history

A book has an **auto-mark**, any number of **bookmarks** and **notes** (12.4). Three big windows help to find your way around the books. Like the notes overlay they fill the whole terminal and have their legend in the table of the meta editor's legends: categories in the header colour, then the keys with their descriptions (list of time stamps: *List*, *Time stamp*; library overlay: *Open*, *Play*, *Find*; chapter marks: *Marks*, *Listen*, *Cut*).

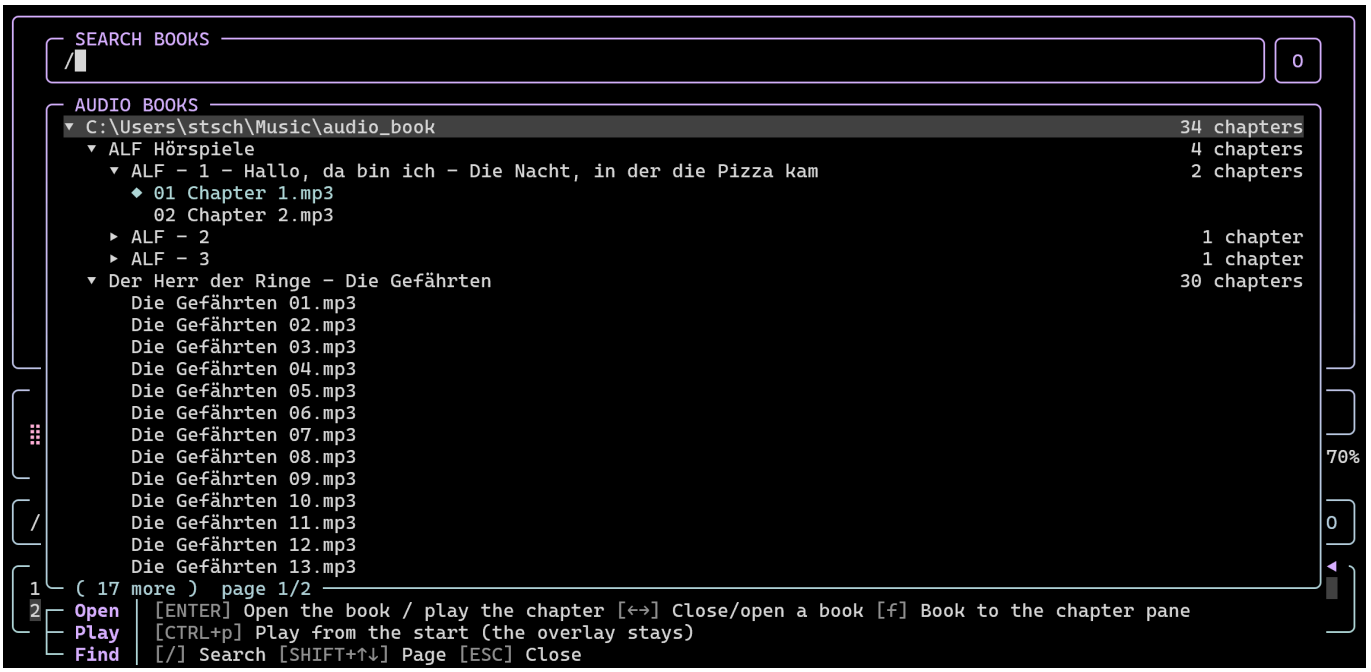
The list of time stamps (`SHIFT+k`). Every auto-mark, bookmark and note of every book, one row each: when it was set (notes have no date: `-`), the **TYPE** (*Auto-mark*, *Bookmark* or *Note*), the book, the chapter (a bookmark with its number, a note with its title or number) and the time; the newest first, the notes after them. `↑` / `↓` choose (`SHIFT+↑` / `SHIFT+↓` turn a page). `ENTER` opens that book, goes to its chapter and shows the *Resume* choices of 12.4 (after the usual question about a bookmark where you are). `SHIFT+p` opens the book

and plays at once from the time stamp; the list stays open. SHIFT+b converts an **auto-mark** into a regular bookmark (the row turns into *Bookmark N*). SHIFT+t switches the sorting: **by the date the time stamp was set** (the newest first; the default; a note counts from the day it was written, older notes have no date: -) or **by book** (the books A-Z; inside a book the **highest chapter first**, inside a chapter the **furthest mark first**, so the top row of a book is how far you have come). ESC goes back to the date sorting and closes the list. SHIFT+d discards the chosen time stamp of **any** kind: a warning in the header colour says so, y does it, anything else cancels. CTRL+SHIFT+u brings the last discarded time stamp back (up to 30). ESC (or SHIFT+k again) closes.



The list of time stamps (SHIFT+k): auto-marks, bookmarks and notes of every book with the TYPE column.

The library overlay (SHIFT+s). A big window made like the folder overlay of the player: the **search pane** on top (/ types, the words narrow the list, ESC / ENTER / TAB leave the field) and the **audio book pane** below it: the book folder and its books with their number of chapters. ENTER (or →) on a book **opens it and inserts its chapters** below it, ← closes it again (or goes up to the book). A ◆ in front of a chapter marks a bookmark. The book that is open in the chapter pane is opened already. ENTER **on a chapter** plays it (the question about a bookmark comes first, then the continue question, the Resume choices or the list of time stamps if the chapter carries any), CTRL+p plays it from the start at once and the overlay stays, f opens the book in the chapter pane and closes the overlay. SHIFT+↑ / SHIFT+↓ turn a page. ESC or SHIFT+s closes. The playback keys (pause, seek, volume) work while it is open.



The library overlay (`SHIFT+s`): the search pane on top, the books below with their chapters inserted.

The reading history (`SHIFT+h`). The listening history of the player, made for books and kept in its own file, `reading_history.json`, next to `history.json`. Every chapter you listen to is recorded with the book as its "artist" and "playlist". Four tabs (← / → or `1` to `4`): **HISTORY** (the last plays: when, chapter, book, length, whether it was played to the end or skipped), **TOP CHAPTERS**, **TOP BOOKS** (how often and how long each book was heard) and **HABITS** (when you listen). `ENTER` on a chapter of the history opens its book and plays it. `ESC` closes. (The history is switched off for everything with *History* off in the settings, as in the player.)

12.6 Chapter marks and cutting a file into chapters

A book often is **one long file**. `ALT+l` (macOS: `SHIFT+j`; the key of the lyrics timing in the player) opens the **chapter marks** of the chapter that plays; if nothing plays, the chapter under the cursor starts. A big window shows where you are (`playing at 0:12:34 of 1:20:00`), and a list of the marks: number, time, title, length; the part you are in is marked with a ▶. You set marks while you listen:

Key	What it does
`m`	**Marks the point you are listening at.** The first mark also adds the start (`0:00:00`, *Chapter 1*). A new mark gets the **standard title "Chapter N"** (N is the number of the chapter at that place; the standard titles are renumbered when a mark is inserted), and the title field opens with the title selected: `ENTER` keeps it, typing replaces it.
`a`	Adds a mark **by its time**, typed as `h:mm:ss` (or `m:ss`; the field starts with the current time, selected); then the title field.
`t` / `r`	Change the **time** (`h:mm:ss`) or the **title** of the chosen mark. The first mark always stays at `0:00:00`.
`x`	Deletes the mark (asks `y` / `n`).
← / →	**Seek** as in the player: 5 seconds at first, **faster and faster the longer the key is held**, up to jumps of minutes; `p` pauses, `+` / `-` change the volume.

Key	What it does
ENTER	Plays from the chosen mark.
c	**Cuts the file** (below).
SHIFT+d	**Deletes the backup** (below).
ESC	Closes (the marks are saved in the book's .cue after every change, as REM CHAPTER "Dune.wav" 3723.5 "Chapter 4" lines, and are there when you come back).

Cutting. c asks once (y / n) how many chapters the file becomes. t answers yes **and trims the blank audio** at the edges of the parts: ffmpeg (silencedetect, -50 dB, stretches of 2.5 s or more) looks for silence at the start and the end of every part, and a blank of, say, 10 s is cut down to **2 s** (the blank at the end of one part and at the start of the next are each trimmed). The audio itself is still copied without re-encoding. A part that is blank nearly all through is left alone. Bookmarks, the auto-mark and notes follow the new times: a place inside the removed blank moves to the edge of its part. The status row says how many parts were trimmed. Then ffmpeg copies the parts **without re-encoding** (-c copy, the audio is not touched; the tags of the file are copied, and each part gets its chapter title as title tag and its number as track) into the book folder as **01 Chapter 1.wav**, **02 The Storm.wav**, **...** (the number comes first so the natural order is the order of the book; characters a file system refuses are left out of the title). The playback of that file stops while the cut runs (one part per frame, the screen stays alive). If anything fails, the new files are removed again and the original is untouched.

The backup. When all parts are written, the original is renamed to **Dune.wav.mousiki-backup** in the book folder (it has no audio ending, so the library does not list it as a book or a chapter) and **stays there until you delete it on purpose**: SHIFT+d in the chapter marks window shows how many files and how much space they take, and asks y / n (*the uncut original is gone then*). Mousiki lets go of the file itself first (the decoder that plays or analyses a long file is told to close it). If another program still holds the file (a virus scanner, a sync client) Mousiki **waits for it for up to 90 seconds** (the status row counts the seconds) before it gives up with the system's reason; nothing is changed then. A book with a backup says so in the status row of the window. To get the original back, delete the new parts and remove the .mousiki-backup ending by hand.

Bookmark and notes follow the cut. The bookmark and every note that pointed into the cut file are moved to the part that holds their place, with the time inside that part (a note at 0:25:00 of the old file, with a chapter starting at 0:10:00, is at 0:15:00 of the new second chapter). Bookmarks and notes in other files are not touched; the marks that were used up are removed from the .cue. The library is scanned again, so the new chapters show up in the chapter pane at once.

12.7 Settings in the audio book mode

The settings are the same screen as in the other modes, with the rows that make no sense for a book left out (and *Ask for Bookmark* added under BOOKMARKS): the GENERAL tab has no *Playback*, no lyrics switches, but *Playback Speed* under AUDIO (the same value as SHIFT+← / SHIFT+→); the ANIMA/VIZ tab no lyrics rows and no *Disk Speed*, but *Notes/Viz Default*, *When No Notes Show* and the *Viz/Notes Order*. The PATHS tab is the same in every mode.

The audio book mode has its own look. Its colours and theme, the border characters, which elements and visualizations are shown (with their oscilloscope and spectrogram settings), the volume bar, the disk and spectrum tuning, the list display (*Show meta data only*), the play mode and the sound (loudness normalization,

equalizer, stereo / mono) are kept apart from the music player's and the radio's, in `audiobook_config.txt` next to `config.txt` (same notation, only these lines). It starts with the theme **Rose Pine** (a profile that is still an untouched copy of the player's look gets it, too); from then on a theme picked or a colour changed in the audio book mode changes nothing in the other modes and the other way round. Everything that concerns all players stays shared in `config.txt`: the paths (library, download, playlists, history, conversion, audio books), the hotkeys, the mode switches and their order, Black Background, the remote app, buffer size, media keys and the like. The radio keeps its own look in `radio_config.txt` as before.

---

13. Remote control and key bindings

A running Mousiki (player, radio **or** audio book player) can be controlled from outside with the same program:

```
mousiki --cmd next            mousiki --cmd volume 60      mousiki --cmd seek
+10
mousiki --status              what is playing (state, title, artist, volume,
playback mode ...)
mousiki --cmd --help          the list of commands (also: mousiki --cmd help,
mousiki --remote-help)
mousiki --remote-info         address and PIN of the remote app (13.1)
mousiki --help / --version    the command line options / the version
mousiki --selftest-fetch      the fetch health check (below)
```

Fetch health check. `mousiki --selftest-fetch` (in a terminal; no window, no sound) checks everything Mousiki fetches or downloads and prints one line per check: `OK`, `WARN` (works partly or is optional, e.g. no `yt-dlp` or `fpcalc`), `FAIL` (that part cannot do its job right now) or `SKIP`. It tests the two lyrics sources (Better Lyrics and LRCLIB) with a lookup of a famous song, MusicBrainz and the Cover Art Archive with a famous album, the GitHub releases page of the update check, the helper programs (`ffmpeg`, `ffprobe`, `yt-dlp`, `fpcalc`), the helper scripts, and whether the downloads pinned for the kanji reader still exist on their servers. Options: `--offline` (only what needs no internet), `--verify-pins` (downloads the pinned files and compares their SHA-256), `--only lyrics,cover,update,tools,pins,scripts` and `--json`. The exit code is 0 when nothing FAILed. Use it first when lyrics or covers suddenly stop arriving: a website that changed its address or went down shows up here in seconds, and network failures that happen only once are simply a reason to run it again. The same program is `scripts/selftest_fetch.py` (`python3 scripts/selftest_fetch.py`).

Checksum failures. Downloads that are pinned (the kanji reader on Windows or with `setup.sh --with-kanji`, SDL2, the SID player of `setup.sh`) are compared with their SHA-256 before anything is installed. A damaged download is tried a second time; if the checksum still differs, nothing is installed, the message names the expected and the received checksum, and Mousiki simply works without that optional part. Run the installer again later; if it keeps failing, the file on the server is not the one that version of Mousiki was built with (update Mousiki, or report it on GitHub). Never install such a file by hand.

Commands: `play-pause`, `play`, `pause`, `stop`, `next`, `prev`, `shuffle` (player: shuffle next; radio: a random station), `volume-up`, `volume-down` (optional number, default 5), `volume <0-100>` (`+10` / `-10` change it), `mute`, `unmute`, `toggle-mute`, `seek <seconds>` (`-30` jumps back; in the radio inside the timeshift buffer), `live`

(radio), `playback-mode` (player: the next play mode like `m`; radio: S ↔ L like `m`), `wizard` (opens / closes the help wizard), `switch-mode`, `quit`. Exit code: 0 sent, 1 nothing running, 2 wrong command or value.

Keyboards without media keys. Mousiki itself only sees keys while its terminal has the focus. For keys that work everywhere, bind **any key combination you like** in your system to a `mousiki --cmd ...` line:

System	Where
GNOME	Settings -> Keyboard -> Custom Shortcuts: name *Mousiki next*, command `mousiki --cmd next`, shortcut e.g. `Ctrl+Alt+Right`
KDE Plasma	System Settings -> Shortcuts -> Add Command
i3 / sway	`bindsym Ctrl+Mod1+Right exec mousiki --cmd next` in the config file
Hyprland	`bind = CTRL ALT, Right, exec, mousiki --cmd next`
Windows	AutoHotkey: `^!Right::Run "mousiki.exe" --cmd next, , Hide`
macOS	Shortcuts app (action *Run Shell Script*, then a keyboard shortcut) or skhd: `ctrl + alt - right : mousiki --cmd next`

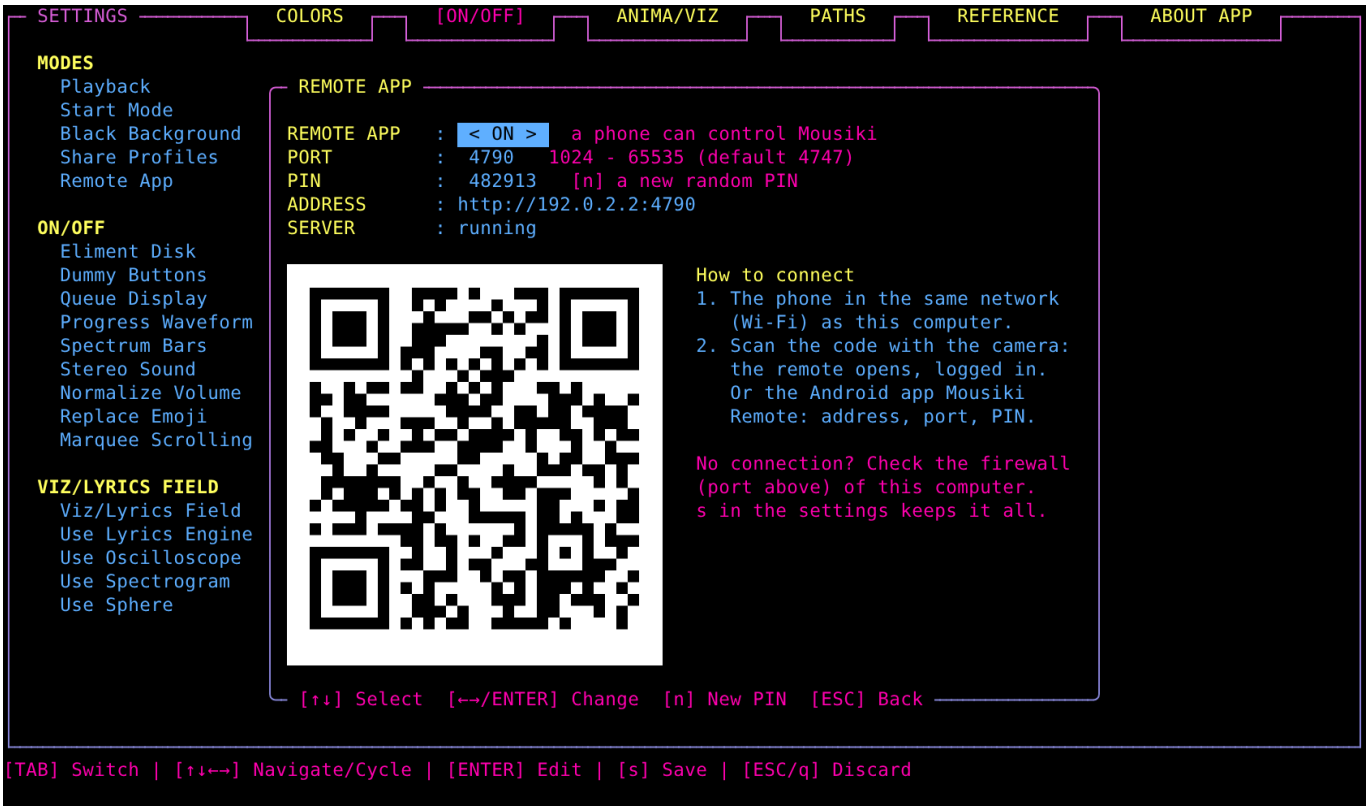
How it works: the program keeps a small folder `control/` in the config folder. The client writes one command file; the running Mousiki reads and deletes it (about ten times a second) and writes `status` once a second. Only the fixed command names above with a short number are accepted; anything else is ignored.

13.1 The remote app (Android / phone browser)

Mousiki can be controlled from a phone in the same network. It is part of the program itself: it works the same with a Mousiki you built yourself and with an installed one -- nothing else has to be installed on the computer.

Setting it up: Settings (`s`) -> GENERAL → REMOTE / UPDATES → Remote App -> `ENTER` (or ←/→) opens the **REMOTE APP** overlay (player or radio; one setting for both):

- **REMOTE APP** `< ON >` / `< OFF >` (←/→/`ENTER`): switches the small web server on; the first time a 6-digit PIN is made.
- **PORT** (`ENTER`, type, `ENTER`): 1024-65535, default 4747. **PIN** (`ENTER`, type 4-8 digits, `ENTER`); `n` makes a new random PIN.
- **ADDRESS** and **SERVER** (running / off / why it does not run, e.g. the port is in use) are shown, and a **QR code**: scan it with the phone camera and the remote opens in the phone's browser, already logged in (the code carries the PIN). The QR code needs a window of about 70 x 27; in a smaller one the address is written out instead.
- `ESC` closes the overlay; `s` on the settings screen saves (as for every setting). `mousiki --remote-info` prints the address and the PIN as well.



The REMOTE APP overlay: switch, port, PIN, address and the QR code for the phone.

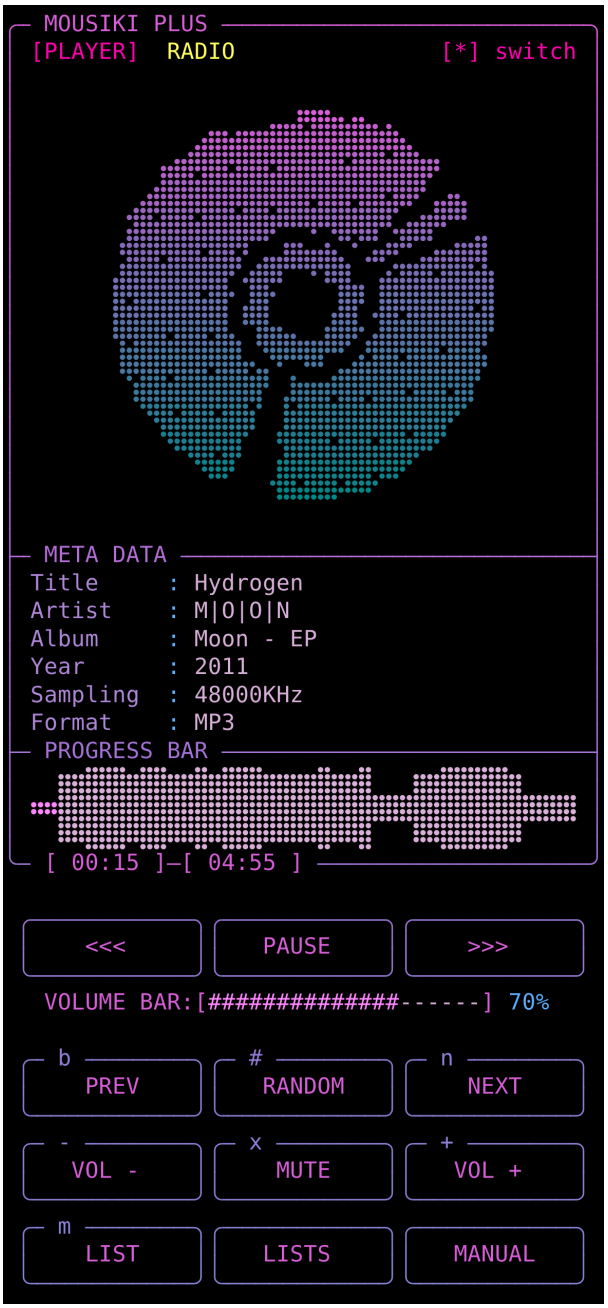
- **Android app** (`remote_app/android`, APK from the GitHub workflow *Remote app (Android)*, see `remote_app/README.md`): enter the address (or tap *FIND MOUSIKI IN THIS NETWORK*) and the PIN once; it connects by itself from then on.
- **Any phone browser:** open the address, enter the PIN ("Add to home screen" makes it look like an app).

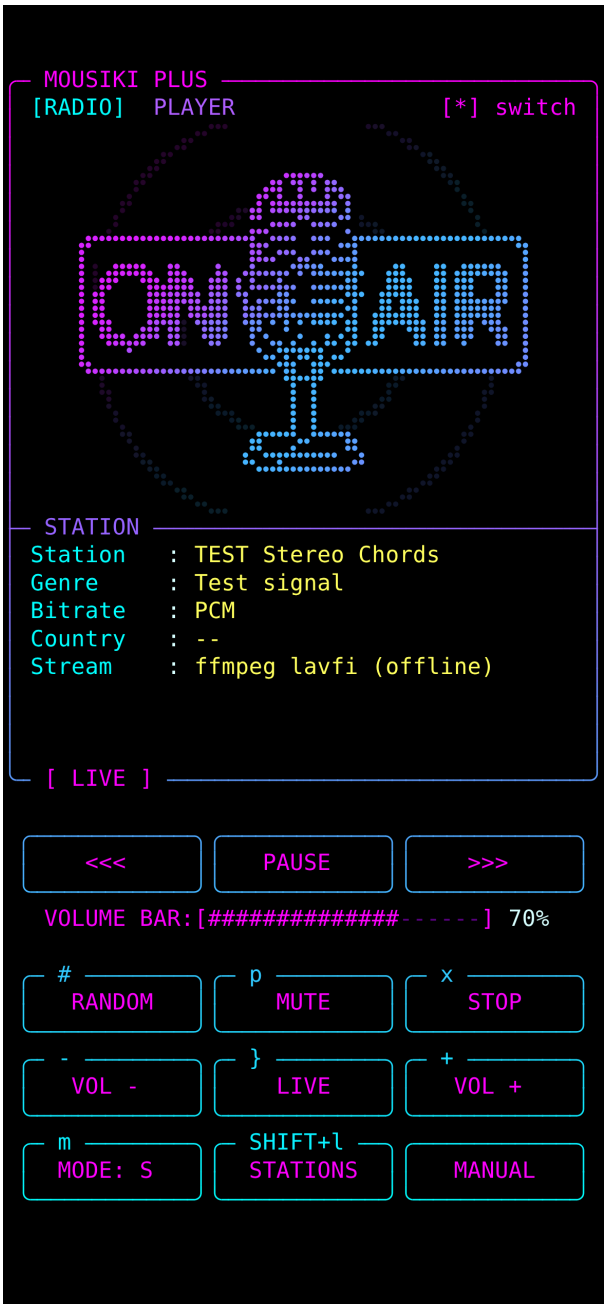
The phone shows a narrow version of the main screen, **drawn by Mousiki itself** in the colours of the theme in use (the border gradient included), and follows the mode:

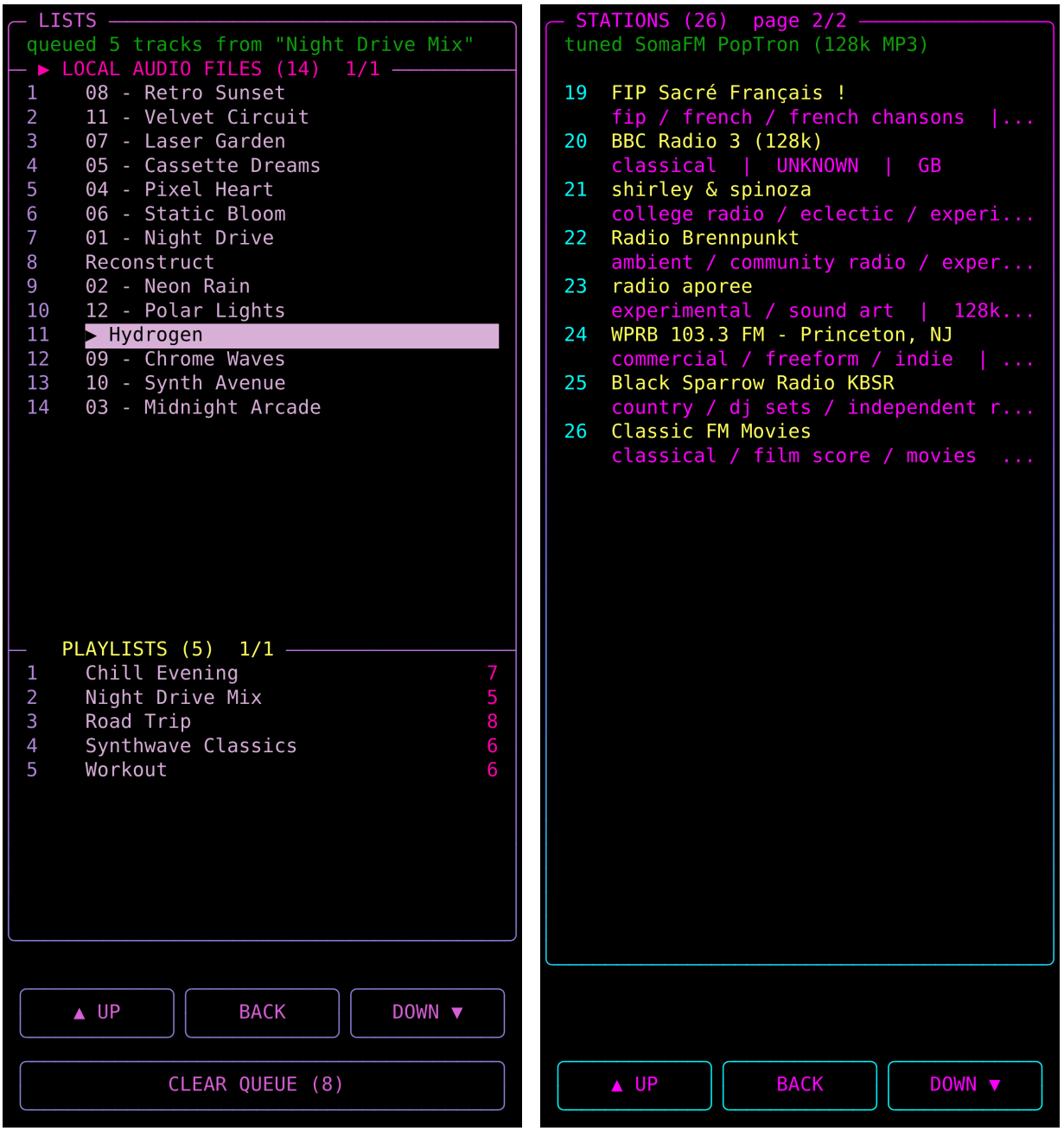
- **Player:** the spinning braille disk (speed 0.10; tap it: play / pause), the meta data, the waveform progress bar (tap: jump there), the dummy buttons -- working here: `<<<` / `>>>` seek 5 s, PLAY / PAUSE -- the volume bar (tap: mute), and boxes for PREV (`b`), RANDOM (`#`), NEXT (`n`), VOL - / VOL +, MUTE, the playback mode (`m`, shows the current one), LISTS and MANUAL (opens this manual on the phone).
- **LISTS** (player) opens two lists. On top **LOCAL AUDIO FILES**, the local list as it is sorted and filtered on the computer (the playing title marked ▶; it opens on its page): tap a title and it plays (`mousiki --cmd track <n>`). Below it, smaller, **PLAYLISTS**, your saved playlists (A-Z, with the number of titles): tap one and its titles go into the queue; when nothing was playing, the first one starts (`mousiki --cmd playlist <n>`).
  - One list has the focus (▶ and the colour of the current tab in its title). A tap on the other list only gives it the focus; then its titles can be tapped. ▲ UP / ▼ DOWN move the list in focus by a whole page, BACK returns to the main screen.
  - **CLEAR QUEUE (n)** at the very bottom clears the queue: tap it, then tap again within 5 seconds (`TAP AGAIN TO CLEAR`). `CTRL+SHIFT+Z` on the computer brings it back (`mousiki --cmd clear-queue` clears at once).
- **Radio:** the ON AIR / OFF AIR sign with its colour wave (tap: pause / resume), the station, the state (LIVE, PAUSED, how far behind live), `<<<` / `>>>` previous / next station, PLAY / PAUSE, the volume bar,

RANDOM, MUTE, STOP, VOL - / VOL +, LIVE, MODE S / L, STATIONS, MANUAL.

- **STATIONS** (radio) opens the whole station list (number, name, genre, bitrate / codec, country; the tuned one is marked ▶): tap a station and it is tuned. ▲ UP / ▼ DOWN page, BACK returns. Same as `mousiki --cmd tune <n>`.
- **Audio book player:** the same screen as the player, but the picture of the audio book mode (the standard picture, or the cover of the book when *Book Cover* is on) takes the disk's place (tap: play / pause) -- as a real picture at full resolution (the phone fetches it once per book; the cover in its own colours, or in the disk colours when the colour wave is on; braille dots only while the cover is being read or when the picture cannot be loaded) (meta data of the chapter, waveform, the buttons); PREV / NEXT walk the chapters (no questions are asked on the computer: the auto-mark is kept and the chapter plays from its start), RANDOM does nothing. **LISTS** opens the **library** in the style of the big library overlay, with its folder hierarchy: a folder (▸ closed, ▾ open, with the number of chapters below it) opens and closes with a tap, the books and their chapters are indented below it, the chapter that plays is marked ▶, and the book that is open is already unfolded. A tap on a chapter plays it from its start (`mousiki --cmd track <n>`; `mousiki --cmd book-open <n>` opens / closes row n). There is no search field. ▲ UP / ▼ DOWN page, BACK returns.
- **[PLAYER] [RADIO] [BOOKS]** at the top (the modes that are on, in the order of the mode key; or `Switch >>` at the right, which goes to the next mode) changes the mode: a tap on a tab goes to that mode (`mousiki --cmd switch-mode` the next one, `switch-mode -1` the previous one).
- Long-press anywhere or tap the title: the remote's own settings -- the 16 base colours (pick the scheme of your terminal: Windows Terminal, xterm, GNOME), the size of the braille dots (thick / normal / small), the PIN, the manual.


MOUSIKI PLUS
[PLAYER] RADIO
[*] switch
META DATA
Title : Hydrogen
Artist : M|O|O|N
Album : Moon - EP
Year : 2011
Sampling : 48000KHz
Format : MP3
PROGRESS BAR
[00:15]–[04:55]
<<<
PAUSE
>>>
VOLUME BAR:[##############------] 70%
b
PREV
#
RANDOM
n
NEXT
-
VOL -
x
MUTE
+
VOL +
m
LIST
LISTS
MANUAL


MOUSIKI PLUS
[RADIO] PLAYER
[*] switch
ON AIR
STATION
Station : TEST Stereo Chords
Genre : Test signal
Bitrate : PCM
Country : --
Stream : ffmpeg lavfi (offline)
[LIVE]
<<<
PAUSE
>>>
VOLUME BAR:[##############------] 70%
#
RANDOM
p
MUTE
x
STOP
-
VOL -
}
LIVE
+
VOL +
m
MODE: S
SHIFT+l
STATIONS
MANUAL



The phone remote in the music player (theme SeriousMeowerShell) and in the radio (theme Cyberpunk).

No connection? Check, in this order:

1. **Same network:** the phone in the same Wi-Fi as the computer (not the mobile network, not a guest Wi-Fi that keeps devices apart).
2. **VPN on the computer (or the phone):** most VPN apps send everything through the VPN and block the home network. Switch on *allow local network / LAN access* (the name differs: "Local network sharing", "Allow LAN", "Split tunneling" ...) in the VPN app, or switch the VPN off. With a VPN the overlay marks it in red and lists the computer's other addresses (**ALSO**): the phone needs the home-network one (usually `192.168.x.x`), which the overlay puts first.
3. **Windows firewall:** if Windows' question was answered with "cancel", or the network is marked *public*, incoming connections are blocked. `f` in the REMOTE APP overlay adds a rule that opens the port (Windows asks for administrator rights); by hand: `netsh advfirewall firewall add rule name="Mousiki Remote" dir=in action=allow protocol=TCP localport=4747 profile=any` in an administrator terminal.
4. **Port:** another program on 4747 (the overlay's SERVER line says so): choose another PORT.

5. **Test on the computer:** open `http://127.0.0.1:4747` in its browser. If that page loads, Mousiki works and the block is between the phone and the computer (points 1-3).

The boxes are labelled with the keys of the computer (your own key bindings). Settings rows `RemoteApp=`, `RemoteAppPort=` (default 4747) and `RemoteAppPin=` are in `config.txt`. **Security:** off by default; only the home network can reach it (nothing is forwarded to the internet unless you set that up in your router); it answers only addresses of the home network and the computer itself (192.168.x, 10.x, 172.16-31.x, link-local, hotspot / Tailscale 100.64-127.x; anything else is turned away); every command needs the PIN, and 10 wrong PINs in a row lock **that device** out for a minute (another device on the Wi-Fi cannot lock your phone out by guessing); only the fixed remote commands exist. The connection is plain HTTP, like most remotes for the home network: someone who can read your Wi-Fi traffic can read the PIN, so use it on a network you trust, and change the PIN in the REMOTE APP overlay if you think it got out. On Windows the firewall asks once whether Mousiki may accept connections: allow *private networks*.

13.2 System media controls: media keys and now playing (Windows, Linux, macOS)

Mousiki (player **and** radio) shows what is playing to the operating system and answers its media controls, so the keys of your keyboard and headset, the volume pop-up and the lock screen work without any set-up:

System	What you get
Linux	**MPRIS**, the desktop standard: Mousiki is listed as *Mousiki Plus* in the media widgets of GNOME, KDE, Cinnamon, XFCE panels and in tools such as `playerctl` (`playerctl -p mousiki next`, `playerctl metadata`). Play / pause, next, previous, stop, seeking (the position slider) and the volume slider work; the title, artist, album and length are shown. Needs a desktop session with D-Bus (a normal Linux desktop); on a server or over SSH the feature stays off by itself. The D-Bus library (`libdbus-1`) is loaded when needed, nothing has to be installed for Mousiki.
macOS	**Now Playing** (the widget in the menu bar / Control Center) shows the title, artist, album and position, and the media keys (play/pause, next, previous) and the headphone buttons control Mousiki.
Windows	The **System Media Transport Controls**: Mousiki appears in the media pop-up of the volume flyout and on the lock screen with title, artist, album and a position bar, and the media keys (play/pause, next, previous, stop) and headset buttons control it. If your keyboard has none, bind keys to `mousiki --cmd ...` (see above).

In the radio, a live station has no length, so the position slider is off; the song is the title and the station is shown as album (or as the title when the station sends no song name). Switch the feature off with Settings -> GENERAL → REMOTE / UPDATES → Media Keys or `MediaKeys=false` in `config.txt` (read at the next start). If another Mousiki is already running, the second one registers under its own name (`org.mpris.MediaPlayer2.mousiki.instance<pid>`).

Good to know (macOS): the system sends the media keys to the app it considers "the" Now Playing app. A program started from a terminal is not always picked for that; when the keys still go to Music, start playback in Mousiki first (so it becomes the last app that played), or use the `mousiki --cmd` bindings above.

14. Automated tests

`cmake -DMOUSIKI_BUILD_TESTS=ON ..` then `make mousiki_tests && ./mousiki_tests` (Windows: `cmake --build . --config Release --target mousiki_tests`, then `Release\mousiki_tests.exe`) runs the checks of the text editor and fuzzy search, themes, settings files and their upgrade backup, the shared oscilloscope settings, Share Profiles, the remote control, the remote app's server and phone screen, the oscilloscope drawing, the JSON reader, the lyrics text helpers, saved playlists, the listening history of the player and of the radio, the playback speed (time stretching keeps the pitch), the library's tag cache and the audio device setting, that text from outside reaches the screen without control characters, the remote's per-device lockout and home-network check, and Mousiki's own terminal font (227 tests). On GitHub the workflow *Tests* builds and runs them on Linux, macOS and Windows with every push. `./mousiki_tests remote` runs only the tests whose name contains "remote". The tests use a temporary config folder and never touch yours. GCC and Clang builds (Linux, macOS, MinGW) compile Mousiki's own sources with the warnings `-Wall -Wextra` (the vendored libraries in `third_party/` stay quiet); `-DMOUSIKI_WARNINGS=OFF` switches that off. Warnings never stop a build; MSVC keeps its `/W3`.

Screen and installer tests (Python, no extra build). `ctest` also runs three Python checks next to `mousiki_tests` (build the target `mousiki` as well: `cmake --build . --target mousiki mousiki_tests`). `tests/ui_smoke.py <path to mousiki>` starts the real program in a pseudo terminal (needs `pip install pyte`; Linux and macOS; it is reported as *skipped* without it) with a temporary home folder and a tiny generated library and walks through the first-start help wizard, the lists, the cheat sheet, the MENUS index, every settings tab, the meta editor with its cover options (in a Kitty-graphics terminal too: `[t]` must switch between the picture and braille dots), the radio mode's Latin-letters key and `mousiki --selftest-fetch`, and checks that nothing crashes, that frames keep their right border in one column, and that the Latin-letters key really turns Japanese and Korean titles into Latin ones and back. `tests/test_install_kanji_reader.py` runs the kanji installer against a local web server (right checksum, wrong checksum, a damaged download that is fine on the second try, a wheel with an unsafe path). The third check runs the offline part of the fetch health check. On GitHub they run with every push on Linux and macOS (the installer test on Windows too).

15. Upgrades and your settings

New version notice. With **Update Notice** on (Settings -> GENERAL -> REMOTE / UPDATES, `UpdateCheck=true`, the default), Mousiki asks the project's releases page once a day, in the background, whether a newer version exists and tells you **once per version** with a small window (*Mousiki 4.7.1 is out. You are using 4.6.0.* and the address of the release, plus the note that your configuration stays the same when you update by installing the newer version (a new command whose default key you already use for something else is left unbound, see Settings -> REFERENCE); for the portable versions the note says: unzip the new version over the old folder, or copy your `data` folder into the new one, and keep `portable.txt` next to the launcher (without it the configs in `data` are not found); `ESC` Close, `o` Go to release). It appears as soon as the main screen is showing (not on top of a menu or the help wizard). It never installs anything -- how to update depends on how you installed Mousiki (`winget upgrade`, `scoop update`, `brew upgrade`, the installer or the `.deb`). The answer is kept in `update_check.txt` in the config folder. **Check Update** (Settings -> GENERAL -> REMOTE / UPDATES, the row under *Update Notice*) does the same check at once: press `ENTER` on the row and the answer appears on the settings screen; it ignores the once-a-day rule and works even when *Update Notice* is off.

Installing a new version never deletes your settings (`config.txt`, `radio_config.txt` ... live in the config folder, not in the program folder). The first time a new version saves a settings file, the previous file is kept as

`config.txt.bak` / `radio_config.txt.bak` next to it (one backup, replaced at the next upgrade), so you can go back if something looks wrong. The files carry a `# Written by Mousiki v...` line for that.

About this app

Original developer of v1.0

Developer	ender	**GitHub**	itzender5820
Email	itz.ender5820@gmail.com	**Version**	original and final v1.0
		Licence	Apache Licence 2.0

Windows port, incl. extensive modifications up to v4.8.0 (including the radio and audio book modes)

Developer	Steffen Schwerdtfeger	**GitHub**	StSchwerdtfeger
Email	fanti.blub@gmail.com	**Version**	current v4.8.0
		Licence	Apache Licence 2.0

Third-party software and licences

Mousiki is licensed under the Apache Licence 2.0 (file `LICENSE`). It contains or uses the following third-party software; the full licence texts are in `THIRD_PARTY_LICENSES.txt`, which is next to the program in every installer and portable package (and in the repository root).

Component	Used for	Licence	How
miniaudio 0.11.25	Audio output and decoding of MP3 / FLAC / WAV	Public domain (Unlicense) or MIT-0	Compiled in
KISS FFT	Spectrum visualizer, spectrogram	BSD-3-Clause	Compiled in
miniz 3.1.2	Compresses the image-style pictures (Kitty graphics)	MIT	Compiled in
Roseus colour map	Default spectrogram colours	CC0 1.0	Compiled in
Chromaprint 1.6.2 (with its own KISS FFT)	`fpcalc`, the AcoustID fingerprint helper	MIT (upstream treats the full project as LGPL-2.1 because of FFmpeg parts that are not included here)	Compiled into `fpcalc`

Component	Used for	Licence	How
SDL2	Scope window and spectrogram window	zlib	Loaded at run time; `SDL2.dll` is included in the Windows packages
FFmpeg (`ffmpeg`, `ffprobe`)	Decoding, metadata, tag writing, radio streams, recordings	GPL-3.0 (bundled builds)	Separate program; bundled on Windows and in the Linux portable zip
yt-dlp	YouTube / SoundCloud / Bandcamp streams and downloads	Unlicense	Separate program; bundled in the packages
Python (embeddable, Windows)	Lyrics, fast search, AcoustID and Bandcamp scripts (standard library only, no PyPI packages)	PSF	Bundled in the Windows package
sidplayfp, libopenmpt, libgme	C64 SID tunes, tracker modules, game music	GPL-2.0+ / BSD-3-Clause / LGPL-2.1+	Optional, not bundled (sidplayfp runs as a program, the others through FFmpeg)
curl	The radio's Radio Browser search	curl licence	Separate program (part of Windows 10+, macOS and most Linux systems)

Each package also has a `THIRD-PARTY.txt` that lists the tools bundled in exactly that package, with their download sources.